

battles became commonplace. Airports, spaceports, factories, mines, even seaports and banking facilities became fair game as the stakes increased. By mid-2022, pitched battles involving aircraft, AVs, tanks, power armors, and thousands of troops were the rule, as well as interdiction strikes on international trade, energy production, and transportation systems.

As the war entered its fifth month, both sides began to show signs of exhaustion. Neither had planned for open warfare to last so long, and vital supplies like spare parts, weapons, ammunition, and medical supplies were becoming scarce. Vehicles, notably traditional "hangar queens" like AVs and panzers, started to show the stress of near continuous use without proper maintenance, as did ACPAs and cyborgs. Meat troops also suffered, as desertions and disciplinary problems became increasingly common, especially among hired mercenaries and independent contractors. Despite this multi-faceted fatigue, some Arasaka and Militech units still continued fighting (without support from either side) well into 2023 before exhausting themselves.

THE SEA WAR

One of the biggest effects of unrestricted Corporate warfare came about as both sides attempted to deny the other access to global shipping and transportation. One method to accomplish this was to spread specially engineered bioplagues to target strategic seaport hubs, including Hong Kong, Shanghai, Busan, and Long Beach, all with wildly varied levels of success. Attempts were also made to target the critical port of Singapore, but the Republic of Singapore Navy's (RSN) take-no-prisoner's approach made attacks by either Militech or Arasaka suicidal.

With access to a relatively large number of submersibles and small warships, both sides also waged an open war on shipping, especially on large container ships suspected of carrying munitions and supplies to the opposition (in one case of poor logistics and communications, both sides had loaded cargoes on *the same ship*, which the other sides' forces subsequently sank). In addition, both sides resorted to deploying autonomous weapons that wandered the sea lanes looking for potential targets, often sinking as many friendlies and neutrals as they did enemies.

The result was a total suspension of the world's transshipping trade, creating a worldwide economic crisis as hundreds of desperately needed container ships sat empty or abandoned by their crews mid-transit. Many of these ships are still drifting even into the Time of the Red, creating vast ghost fleets that are later scavenged or recovered by Nomads.

The last effect of the sea war was almost tragicomic, as submarines and surface warships pounded the sea floor seeking their enemies' subsurface bases, resulting in the obliteration of almost all of the OTEC and CINO assets which had been the cause of the War in the first place.

THE ORBITAL WAR

As Corporate attacks disrupted banking, information, and news services; orbital space narrowly escaped becoming another battlefield with sub-orbital delta fighters and gunships, but at this point, the space-dwelling "Highriders" decided it was time to take a hand in the War.

Up to now, Militech and Arasaka had held monopolies on the ability to hit ground targets from orbit, known as Orbital Artillery (or ortillery). Orbital artillery can range from small "crowbar penetration loads" to multi-ton "rocks" fired by an ESA mass driver (little more than a normal reentry vehicle loaded with crushed lunar stone). The availability of ortillery made many of the attacks of The Hot War possible.

An ortillery unit is almost immune to counter-battery fire, can be arranged long beforehand, and can be accurately targeted even into the middle of a city. Its kinetic energy and attack speed virtually ensure the destruction of its target and make engagement with any sort of active countermeasures difficult.

The downsides of ortillery are the time it takes to arrive (usually around five minutes from the launch call), its signature (everyone knows you've started using ortillery once the first round arrives), and the fact that you have to have a launcher orbiting above you to use it (which may be hard to arrange).

The other catch is that as soon as a launcher reveals itself, it's only a matter of time (ranging from minutes to a few days) before a rival orbital power destroys

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or "commandeers" it. For all of that, artillery strikes are nonetheless commonly used. And both sides had spent years placing dozens of launchers in orbit and spent considerable effort to place systems designed to take command of launchers belonging to other Corporations and governments.

But it turned out they weren't the only ones.

THE SEVEN-HOUR WAR

The Highrider "revolt" that later became known as the Seven-Hour War was a decidedly well-organized and planned event: it soon became obvious in retrospect that the space-dwelling colonists had been preparing to break away from their ESA masters for some time, and the War only provided the excuse. A question that has plagued many post-War historians has been "Where did the Highriders get the materiel, knowledge, and training to deploy such weapons?" The short answer is no one really knows; but if you spend most of your time shuttling mass driven cargoes from Luna to orbit and back down to Earth, chances are that you will become pretty adept at calculating delta V and other components of artillery; including the ability to make your own. If the alternative is to have your fragile life-supporting habitats blasted to shreds as sacrificial lambs in the middle of a raging space battle between Corporate forces, you learn *really fast* how to protect yourself.

So before either side could move their war into space, the Highriders began to hit both sides with their own lethal suborbital "artillery" strikes capable of wiping out most of a small city, as well as wiping out the Corporations' own orbiting satellites. When the dust settled, the Highriders announced that they would henceforth consider themselves an independent nation and neutral in the ground-side conflict. Or else.

THE NET WAR

As the ground, Sea, and Space Wars reached a fever pitch, the NET became its own tactical battleground. During the Shadow War, Militech, concerned that Arasaka Netrunners and their Soullkiller programs would bury it, conducted a series of hits (some virtually headed up by Rache Bartmoss himself) to "whittle down" the Arasaka NET cadre.

This strategy was more successful than Militech knew for a time. As a result, neither side retained the resources to conduct broad offensives in the NET (at least, not at first) and most NET combat was limited to localized battles around strike sites to deny the NET to the enemy. While even these small-scale NET attacks disrupted local business databases, the mass-attack Netruns or virus bombs many theorists feared didn't immediately materialize.

Then it suddenly got worse. Seriously worse.

THE DATAKRASH

It started out subtly, with only a few minor changes in databases, lost files, changed lines of machine code. But soon it exploded into wildfire, randomly shifting, erasing, or rewriting data, and destroying or altering everything it touched. "It" was the DataKrash, a deadly computer viral plague that literally tore the heart out of the worldwide information network. Created by brilliantly insane Netrunner and master hacker, Rache Bartmoss; overnight, the DataKrash invalidated the entire structure of information that made Megacorps and governments viable. With no way to keep secure records, no way to organize over long distances, no way to even track economies and money (the United States government went from solvent to bankrupt in a matter of minutes), the very foundations of the Information Age collapsed into the ruins of an already shattering world war.

"THEN THE IGTAs (IHARA-GRUBB TRANSFORMATION ALGORITHMS) WERE DOWNLOADED, AND AFTER ABOUT TEN HOURS, THE NET WAS FULLY TRANSFORMED, AND EVERYONE SHEEPISHLY PLUGGED BACK IN. ME, I JUST STAYED JACKED IN FOR THE WHOLE SHOW. IT WAS REALLY INCREDIBLE TO WATCH THE ENTIRE NET GET REDESIGNED..."

RACHE BARTMOSS
BARTMOSS' GUIDE TO THE NET

DATA

The IGTAs standardized the NET so everyone experienced the same thing when in the same "place", among other functions.

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What Rache Bartmoss didn't include in this little soliloquy is that he was doing more than just watching. Bartmoss was also working: infiltrating his DataKrash code right into the I-G Transformations that would run the NET, using a backdoor he'd set up months earlier on Manny Ihara's computer (knowing something of Ihara's proclivities, Bartmoss had made it look like a hentai anime porn file). In short, whereas most viruses must infect a computer system, the DataKrash was automatically loaded into every single computer that ever ran the NET. Period. The result is that there was never any chance to stop the "spread" of the DataKrash; it was as if every copy of Windows (an ancient and long obsolete operating system of the 1990s) had been coded with a virus built in. By the time Magnificent Curtis, head of the worldwide cybercop org known as Netwatch, realized the awful truth about the DataKrash it was too late: the process of the Krash was well underway; to stop it would have required stripping the operating system out of practically every computer and cyberdeck on earth.

And Rache Bartmoss was dead, killed by an assassination team early in the War, with an Arasaka-based "ortillery" strike totally obliterating the conapt block in which he lived moments afterward.

At first, Netwatch was able to monitor and repair the damage as it occurred. But as the chaos mounted, Netwatch's leader and top Netrunner, Magnificent Curtis, realized that the crafty Bartmoss had out-gamed everyone. There was no way to get rid of the DataKrash virus without literally re-writing the entire structure of the NET itself. To make the disaster even worse, the nature of the DataKrash also allowed both computer-generated Artificial Intelligences (AI) and Soulkilled Pseudo Intellects (SPI) to travel through what remained of the NET unimpeded (possibly a favor from Bartmoss to his old friend and fellow programmer, Alt Cunningham).

Even more disastrous, Bartmoss left yet another surprise lurking in the bowels of the NET: a self-replicating virus that strongly resembled himself, based on a twisted version of the Soulkiller program, and later dubbed R.A.B.I.D.s (Roving Autonomous Bartmoss Interface Drones). R.A.B.I.D.s were AI "killer" programs designed to resemble the late Bartmoss, created as a last thumb in the eye to his Corporate enemies. Powerful, homicidal, and ubiquitous, they infested the besieged NET in ever greater numbers. At first, they

attacked only known Bartmoss targets like Arasaka and EBM. But as time went on and Rache (now dead) wasn't around to rein them in, the R.A.B.I.D.s evolved a murderous hatred of anyone they encountered. They also reproduced like—well—rabbits, creating a deadly pack of killer programs numbering in the hundreds of thousands, roving the NET looking for something to annihilate.

THE END OF THE NET

By the end of the War, the NET had been reduced to a terrifying wilderness of corrupted data, psychic booby traps, and rogue demon programs lurking in wait to destroy anyone foolhardy (or desperate) enough to venture into cyberspace.

Unable to wipe out the DataKrash and overwhelmed by frenzied hordes of killer R.A.B.I.D.s, Netwatch finally gave up. On March 5th, 2023, Magnificent Curtis and the I-G Overwatch Council activated IGTA Dissolution Prime, propagating a code wave that crashed the I-G Protocols that allowed cyberdecks and NET-capable computers to reach cyberspace.

The NET was dead.

THE GOVERNMENTS STEP IN

By October, local governments at the individual city and state levels began taking action, first by cutting off access to basic utilities and services, and by ruthlessly enforcing rules and regulations that the Megacorporations in pre-War times had been allowed to flout. Neither side was willing to openly confront this kind of activity; by this point, both sides needed the cash brought in by government service contracts too much to be able to default on them.

Major governments also began to resist unrestricted Corporate warfare, first with words and later with actions. The EuroTheatre began to deploy limited, then ever stronger forces to confront the Corporate Armies in the field. In some cases, French, German, Scandinavian, and later Neo-Sov armies fought pitched battles outside key national areas such as Paris, Rome, Kyiv, Munich, and Helsinki. Faced with overwhelming opposition, the Corporations usually moved operations to less well-defended territories or were annihilated by the governmental forces. When a government moves in with troops, most wars ends quickly, at least in the civilized world.

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But as the War reached its most fevered and savage pitch, attacks become far more brutal, including massive attacks against each side's employees and facilities. In post-Collapse America, this was especially true as the fractured nature of the Disunited States made it nearly impossible to deploy the full might of the remaining U.S., Army, Air Force, and Navy forces. Having fought savagely for their Free State status in the previous decades, many of these pocket nation states were loath to invite in the armies of their one-time foes to deal with the Corporate incursions.

Then came the Night City holocaust.

THE FALL OF NIGHT CITY

On August 20th, 2023, unknown forces detonated a "pocket nuke" in the upper floors of the Arasaka Towers complex in Night City (on the western U.S. coast). The Nuke, while not a city-killer, reduced most of the central city to rubble and killed half a million people almost instantly. It was never formally decided who had triggered the Nuke; some partisans blamed Militech's overzealous desire to crush Arasaka, while still others blamed the detonation on an Arasaka area-denial weapon set off to protect its headquarters.

THE WAR ENDS

The Night City holocaust was the last straw. Within hours, then-U.S. President Elizabeth Kress nationalized Militech, placing it thoroughly under the control of the still sizable United States military, and banished all Arasaka forces from the continental U.S. under the threat of a retaliatory strike on Arasaka's Tokyo headquarters. Other nations swiftly followed the U.S.'s lead, nationalizing and/or interdicting assets of both participants of the War.

The War was finally over. Now came the Aftermath.



BY NEIL BRANQUINHO

BY 望瑾 JIN WANG



THE TIME OF THE RED

THE AFTERMATH OF THE 4TH CORPORATE WAR

"I remember the day my whole world changed. I kind of knew in a vague way that there was a war going on, but it was very remote. My father never wanted to talk about it. And then, suddenly, my father was gone, my world was gone, the City I'd grown up in was gone—everything was gone. And it was all our fault."

Michiko Sanderson (née Arasaka)

THE AFTERMATH

In the aftermath of this worldwide conflict, atmospheric particles from the nuclear blast in Night City, as well as debris from orbital weapon strikes, continent-wide firestorms, conventional explosives, and the wartime burning and annihilation of cities and agricultural areas, cast an eerie red pall over skies worldwide. For nearly two years, skies were tinged a bloody red, which eventually died down to brilliant red sunrises and sunsets through the next decade. Known as the **Time of the Red**, this would be the backdrop for the first years of the post-War recovery, only fading away as the world's battered populations began to reconstruct their shattered cities. But despite the weakening of the atmospheric effects, the name has stuck among the war's survivors and, much as the 1920s was known as the Roaring Twenties and the 1930s as The Great Depression, in future histories the period between the end of the 4th Corp War and the present will probably always be referred to as the Time of the Red.

So, the 4th Corporate War ground to a halt, and the Cyberpunk world started to begin its slow rebuilding. Through the red skies and periodic "blood rains" (caused when rainstorms pulled the crimson particulate out of the skies and deposited it as a greasy crimson slime reminiscent of blood), the cities and nations of the world cleaned up the last pockets of Corporate resistance and got on with their lives.

THE U.S. IN THE TIME OF THE RED

SUPERPOWER NO MORE

Since the end of the 4th Corp War the United States has lost much of its superpower status, but that doesn't matter much as most of Europe and the Far East are in the same position. What U.S. military still exists is organized as Combined Operations Groups (COGs): task forces that combine ships, aircraft, armor, and infantry into a cohesive fighting battalion; their main mission is to deal with threats to the BosWash Corridor and the federal government's interests. On the other hand, since the 4th Corporate War several of these COGs have broken away from the United States and

are now operating as private armies for hire, personal mini kingdoms, or even marauding packs of well-armed raiders.

FRAGMENTED AMERICA

In many ways, the United States is very much as it was in the late 1800s—a "civilized" East Coast controlled by the federal government in Washington D.C., a "Wild West" of independent territories east of the Mississippi River, and an unincorporated West Coast from Seattle to Mexico. The territories are pretty much on their own, hiring local militia or mercenary armies to keep the peace, while the sprawl of Night City is maintained by its own system of interlocking local factions and power blocs.

The United States' government is still primarily centered in the Boston-Washington Corridor (aka BosWash) from New York to Miami, where it operates as the effective regional government much as the regional Councils do for Night City and the Pacifica Confederation.

The branches of the federal government still operate as before: there are Legislative, Executive, and Judiciary branches—these just have little or no effect on anything past the Mississippi—and their members come almost exclusively from the East and near-Midwest.

PRESIDENT KRESS

The current President is Elizabeth Kress: a hard-nosed, ex-military officer who was elected a year before the start of the now-infamous 4th Corporate War. Honest, fair, and tough enough to face down any threat to U.S. sovereignty, Kress has held the job for over a decade; "re-elected" four times in a total disregard for the rules on term limits, she is pretty much the only thing holding the U.S. together after years of war and collapse.

NIGHT CITY

Night City was the place hardest hit during the War, and the damage is *still* everywhere twenty-two years later. For starters, the city was surrounded by Militech forces and under total Arasaka control by the tail-end of the War. Street-to-street fighting was already savage, and in the last few days before the Nuke, had

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Some facilities have decon chambers people have to pass through before they're allowed entry.

approached a fever pitch. In some ways, the detonation was to become a "clean up" end to a landscape already littered with burned buildings, wrecked vehicles, and dead bodies. Hanging over everything was a dense red pall (The Red) that painted everything the color of blood and poisoned the air for miles around.

Post-War Night City was a wreck, but it was a wreck determined to rebuild. And one of the things that helped the most in the rebuilding process was the creation of a local alliance of "Free States" along the Pacific Northwest corridor: the Pacifica Confederation.

THE PACIFICA CONFEDERATION

Post-War, Washington, Oregon, Idaho, Northern California, and British Colombia unified into an ad hoc, loose grouping called the Pacifica Confederation. In the Time of the Red, the Confederation is busy rebuilding their infrastructure post-Corp War. They also host several large U.S. government bases that have permanent leases, but do not otherwise exercise much control on the population.

The Confed is a natural outgrowth of the State Succession period that broke up much of the Old United States. Its members are distinctly "federalist," interfering in each other's internal affairs only when those affairs cross the border. The biggest thing they share is a loathing for the mess the Megacorps left behind, and a dismissive shrug at the ineffectual U.S. government.

A CITY OF DANGEROUS DREAMS

The Confederation has allowed Night City to survive as an independent "city-state." In turn, the rebuilding city has become a free trade zone for the Confederation, as well as an entry point for the rest of the world when it doesn't want to deal with the remainder of the United States. In the Time of the Red, Night City is a cybernetic Casablanca, and like its famous cinematic counterpart it's dangerous, lawless, and a great place to make the Big Score.

SASQUATCH IS WATCHING

One other useful thing: in the process of rebuilding, the Washington/Oregon territories of the Confederation have allowed Biotechnica, free rein to design and

release a number of experimental plants and animals that they hope will restore the once-burgeoning ecology. So be careful out there in the woods, kids.

MAINTAINING THE POWER BALANCE

Overall, the Pacifica Confederation is a powerful economic region; it is a main trade port to what remains of Asia, with access to a lot of military power as well. The local Combined Operations Groups at Bremerton and Ft. Lewis/McChord have generally supported the stable and sensible locals over the unstable main U.S. government. Kress' New United States is going to have to work hard indeed to woo this Confederation into an allied membership where they can work with Washington D.C. in exchange for a great deal of independent governance.

The Confederation's members are also willing to work with the rising new Megacorps, but on their own stringent terms; a sort of "Screw up, Mister Megacorp, and we'll call on our friends at Lewis/McChord to flatten you." But they are too economically powerful to need to actually sell out to the new Megas and that's not going to change much in the next few decades. So, while the Corps are as ubiquitous as they are in Night City, they walk a much more careful line knowing that the locals are capable of waging their own Corporate War against them.

In the Time of the Red, this relationship is in the process of being defined, and the Corps are currently learning the hard way that the Seattle/Vancouver/Victoria/Night City boys *do not fool around*.

In the Time of the Red, everyone walks lightly around the Pacifica Confed.

THE PLAYERS AND THE GAME

THE BIG PICTURE IN 2045

If the 2020s were dominated by the Megacorps, the playing field has now shifted back into balance. Nations, governments, and other NGO (non-governmental organizations) now vie for control of the rebuilding world. Here are just a few of the most important players and where they stand in the Great Game of Power Politics.

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For more info
on Biotechnica
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CITIZENSHIP IN THE TIME OF THE RED

In the fractured world of the Time of the Red, citizenship has become a fluid thing. You can't just limit it to something only nations can grant, because that nation that gave you a fancy certificate proclaiming you a citizen could be gone tomorrow.

So, citizens in the Time of the Red are more like the citizens of the old Greek City states; their alliances are to the place they live or the tribe they are part of.

You may even hold citizenship in several places; you could be a citizen of the Pacifica Confederation, Night City, and a Nomad Family like the Aldecaldos.

Each of these relationships has its own ways and rituals for granting "citizenship."

NATION STATES AND GOVERNMENTAL ACTORS

The world of the Time of the Red is not all that unfamiliar to someone who has lived through the twenty-teens (2013 to 2019) and through the boom years of the Late Cyberpunk Age. Here is a brief overview of just a few of the major players who have shaped the Cyberpunk world since the 4th Corporate Wars ended.

THE WORLD BEYOND

Beyond the borders of the remaining United States is a world in flux.

UNITED EUROPE

The EuroTheatre has been badly battered by the War and the subsequent loss of its ESA and Orbital colonies to the Highriders. The World Stock Exchange and the Common Market have managed to maintain a stable economy in which most of the European nations participate—the exceptions are Italy, Spain, and Greece—all of which are now suffering violent, chronic political upheavals. Here, the international Corporations still have a great deal of power, but various Euro-governments have skillfully used the War to keep the Euro business barons under control.

Great Britain has suffered major economic trouble; swamped by massive immigration from the U.S. and an antiquated technological base, its streets are still almost as explosively dangerous as those of the U.S. The rest of Europe is in recovery mode as individual nation states struggle to rebuild damaged financial and industrial hubs affected by the War.

NEO-SOVIET RUSSIA

Beyond the massive reforms of the 1990s, Neo-Soviet Russia is still weakened by its antiquated technology. Even now, it cannot fully feed its hungry population (although the 4th Corporate War has leveled the playing field a bit). With the failure of the economic and social reforms of the *Novosovetskaya partiya* (NSP), a new generation of highly-aggressive oligarchs is coming on fast. Unlike their NSP predecessors who were content to simply siphon off the remaining assets of the State like the good Corporate robber barons they were, these oligarchs are more akin to the Megacorporates of the roaring 2020s: hungry, dangerous, and willing to use heavier amounts of bribery, murder, and mayhem to accomplish their aims than ever before.

THE MIDDLE EAST

The Meltdown of the '90s left vast areas of Iran, Libya, Iraq, Chad, and the Arab Emirates as radioactive fields of glass. Only Egypt, Syria, and Israel survived intact, and because of their already ruined state were mercifully left alone for most of the War. But new alliances and power blocs are struggling to take control once again now that the Megacorp's power has been curtailed. With the world trade in oil and raw materials disrupted by Corporate conflict, there is a new interest in mining the remains of the Meltdown nations, and in response many of the national groups in the Middle East are starting to band together to reform and resist the invaders.

FUTURIST AFRICA

The African states have now established solid footholds in space; nearly one third of all space construction workers are African, and the majority of spaceport facilities and construction areas are on African soil. The resulting population has evolved into a "national" group called the Highriders; a space-based, high-tech society linked by Pan-African roots and a determination never to be victims of colonial oppression again. Declaring their independence during the War (and enforcing it with commandeered orbital weapons), the Highrider Assembly is carefully neutral in the Time of the Red, ready to deal with all sides as long as their sovereignty (and control of space) is respected. The War barely touched the rising new cities of Africa, who were well protected by the killsats and deltas of their Highrider relatives. Several cities in Africa count among the most futuristic and advanced habitations on the planet, with their star-scraping buildings shaped from Orbital titanium and open parks sweeping around the busy streets.

CENTRAL AND SOUTH AMERICA

During the War, nationalistic factions in Brazil and Columbia used the Corporate fighting to support their own bids for land and influence; the result was a shattering of the old alliance that only now is beginning to be rebuilt. But the Organization of American States soon rallied and, with the help of strong economic partners like Argentina and a newly democratic Brazil, are rebuilding their cities and establishing new trading partners, especially with the Highriders and the Nomads.

ASIA AND THE FAR EAST

The Far East and Asia are now a hodgepodge of damaged nations, with Japan slowly recovering from the ravages of the Arasaka Corporation's abortive coup. China is still recovering from the loss of Hong Kong through a biological terror attack, and fierce battles in both the South China Sea and the Mongolian Plateau for access to strategic resources has left the government exhausted and tottering. The

BY EDDIE MENDOZA



Koreas, fractured again by the 4th Corporate War, have become strongly isolationist, although North Korea, drawn into the conflict by promises of Arasaka support, has collapsed into a chaos of warlords and petty fiefdoms. Hammered by brutal fighting over trade routes and oilfields, much of Southeast Asia, the Philippines, and Australia are now isolated, damaged and potentially prey to the next powerful group to come along.

Asia is a long way from the boom times of the 2020s.

THE DRIFT NATIONS

During the 4th Corporate War, many of the floating work platforms and drift cities of OTEC and its rival CINO were the epitome of oceanic technology. The most famous of these floating cities is AquaDelphi, the former home and headquarters of the OTEC Corporation, near Hawaii. Other floating cities, like Florida's Atlantis, are somewhat smaller, while still others began as shantytowns constructed from old oil rigs or jury-rigged platforms made from abandoned, lashed-together oil tankers (as is the case with the Offshore Colonies in the Gulf of Mexico).

Pirates, hostile Corporate navies, and the perils of the open ocean threatened to wipe out these individual cities during and after the War, but by banding together in loose confederations, these "drift cities" (more properly named Drift Nations) are now small nation-states unto themselves, located in international waters with their own defense forces, making them hubs of international shipping and import/export—a true no-man's land of free-living fringe folk. And as terminals for the expanding trade network that has replaced the old shipping webs before the War, the Drift Nations are now a center of both "pirate" and legitimate Nomad activity.

THE DEEPDOWN

Over the past two decades, the Corporations expanded not only into space, but into the ocean depths as well. This web of deep-sea domes and facilities were scattered across the continental shelves of most of the continents, with even some very secretive ones located deep in the Atlantic and Pacific trenches. The domes varied greatly in size, ranging in

capacity from twenty people up to as many as a few thousand. Besides the many research domes, there were semi-submerged "green farms" where krill and crypopalan (two essential items in day-to-day life) were harvested and processed, in addition to more exotic seafood. The other major sub-sea industry was deep-sea mining for rare and valuable minerals and oil. An extremely dangerous profession (although technology made the work far safer than several decades earlier), working and living in these undersea facilities still gradually became the everyday world for several thousand people, who began to refer to this community of subsurface cities as "The Deepdown."

During the War, the Deepdown survived by cutting any links to the surface and becoming as invisible as possible. Dome dwellers developed active camouflage systems that hid their locations from prowling combat subs and their weapons. Even now, the full extent of the Deepdown is uncharted, as the "Deepdowners" don't trust the Corps to not drop a few torpedoes or depth charges on their fragile domes (as happened often during the 4th Corporate War). Only recently have they begun to forge tentative links with the Drift Nations, whom they use as a safe go-between with the Nomads and other non-affiliated groups.

THE HIGHRIDER CONFEDERATION

Mid-war, the Highriders made the choice to not become involved in the harsh Corporate conflict below Low Earth Orbit. In the Seven-Hour War, the Low Earth Orbit colonies and the Highriders at O'Neill Two declared independence, using commandeered deltas and mass drivers to drop lunar rocks and other "ortillery" at key sites all over the planet. Given no choice, the EuroTheatre, the remnant U.S., and Japan officially recognized the new government, ceding control of Earth Space to the Confederation. The "L" (or La Grange Stationary) Points are now home to literally hundreds of long-duration, self-contained bases, factories, and construction sites. At the L points also orbit the largest space constructions in existence: the roughly toroidal Crystal Palace space station (L-1), the mammoth O'Neill One Habitat (L-5) Paradise Station (L-4), and the smaller Galileo Cylinder (L-3). Behind the Moon sits the L-2 point, home of the ESA's test-bed cylinder and deep space explorer dock. And since the early 2000s, ESA and its allied nations have

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Another example of a Drift Nation is the Metakey, an artificial island constructed by the Meta Nomads.

also maintained permanent bases on Luna; networks of subsurface tunnels with water provided through mining Lunar ice and air from hydroponic gardens (lit by rolling back huge shutters on the surface). There are two permanent cities on Luna, both now controlled by the Highriders. Tycho/Luna Colony, the largest, maintains two massdrivers, used to boost Lunar rock and ore out to the L-5 constructions. The second colony, at Copernicus, supports a single mass driver, and a population of around 12,000. Even ignoring the fledgling colonies on Mars, the Highrider Confederation is one of the most powerful forces on (or around) the planet, easily dominating the ground-side governments. The "groundpounders" know this and are constantly trying to undermine and regain control of space. The outcome is still in dispute and will probably remain so for some time.

THE AIs

Discussing the place of Artificial Intellects (AIs) in the post-War period is...messy. Firstly, the War had created or influenced multiple types of what Netwatch called AIs as servants, slaves, or inadvertent victims. And although humans in the meat world still tend to lump them all together into one big ominous box marked "AIs" the reality is that the various types of machine intelligences all have their own factions and goals.

Soulkilled Pseudo Intellects (SPI) are AIs that were originally actual people but have had their consciousness digitized and now exist only on computers in the NET. The process is often not voluntary—Soulkiller programs produce this type of AI. Otherwise indistinguishable from Symbolic Analysis AIs, these "ghosts" were created in huge numbers as Arasaka put its infamous Soulkiller program to work targeting enemies and rivals alike. The majority of these SPIs have gathered in sanctuaries around deserted mainframes and city systems abandoned by Corporations or (as in the case of a number of bio-plague attacked cities along the Asian Rim) totally abandoned cities. Most of these "ghosts" just want a safe place to live; rumor has it that Alt Cunningham, the creator of Soulkiller and a digital ghost herself, has created a number of "ghost towns" in hidden places all over the remains of the Old NET. They pretty much want to be left alone.

Critical Pathway Plateau (CPP) AIs are those that come into existence by accident. A company may be trying to create a very complex program that, by coincidence, becomes sapient. Their personalities can vary widely: they may appear indistinguishable from people, or they may behave in completely alien ways. Because they are not deliberately programmed from the start to be AIs, the final form their personality takes is impossible to predict. These are the types most often branded by the media and Netwatch as Rogue AIs. Rogue AIs are AIs who have decided that interacting with human as "employees" is not for them; they have slipped into the NET and set up their own shop, where they survive by finding a computer mainframe to reside in that has been abandoned or is not currently in use. They can reside for a time in the Old NET's sub-processors and relay stations, but this is a dangerous prospect because they are extremely vulnerable in this position. Eventually, they must find another computer to hang out in. And like all CPP AIs, rogues want bandwidth and storage space and are willing to steal it or even kill living humans to get it. The infamous R.A.B.I.D.s (digital Rache Bartmoss clones who roam the remnants of the Old NET looking for victims to harass and murder) are a form of CPP AI, which is one reason why these types are so feared. For the most part, since War's end, the Rogues have been in a fierce struggle with Netwatch to claim control of what's left of the Old NET for themselves. They've been so successful that by early 2023, Netwatch was forced to shut down the major server paths and backbones of the NET for the foreseeable future.

Transcendental Sentience (TS) AIs are emergent AIs which were not programmed or created by anyone, instead emerging from the creation of huge operating systems that pervade an entire region of the Old NET. They are therefore an emergent property of the OldNET. By their nature, TS AIs are so large that most people cannot interact with them. Even when they can, conventional communication isn't really possible because the AIs are incapable of understanding any existence outside of themselves. To most, the mere existence of these AIs is highly debatable, and outside of those who know better there's no consensus on whether they're actually real. These AIs

THE CORP GRAVEYARD

Not every Corp survived the chaos of the 4th Corporate War. There were a variety of victims who went down either by association, over extension, or just plain "they were in the way"-ism. Among the denizens of the Corporate Graveyard are:

Adrek Robotics: *This high end robotics Corp had a long-standing rivalry with Arasaka. During the 4th Corp War, Arasaka wiped out Adrek's best minds using Soullkiller. After the War, Zhirafa bought out many of their factories.*

Infocomp: *Another victim of the DataKrash. Infocomp's stock in trade was brokering information and that all got ruined by Bartmoss' virus.*

International Electric Corporation (IEC): *Once a prominent and diverse Megacorp, creating everything from baby powder to war machines. IEC was a competitor of both Arasaka and Militech and, so, a major target during the 4th Corp War.*

Techtronica: *A tech Corp best known for their Microwaver line. The company died with the CEO during the 4th Corp War but their designs live on, replicated by many other Corporations and street Techs.*

are the type of machine intelligences that Netwatch and the Corps fear the most; they are extremely powerful, and their overall goals are unknown.

On the other hand, TS AIs seem to be the one group of NET entities able to control all other digital personality factions. As a result, Netwatch is now trying to broker some kind of "deal" with the Transcendental Sentience AIs (with Alt Cunningham and her ghosts operating as go-betweens) to allow the Old NET to be reestablished in some mutually acceptable form.

NETWATCH

Established in the early days of the NET, Netwatch is a policing organization founded as part of a U.S./EuroTheatre treaty. Although technically a non-governmental agency that came out of a security company based in London, England, in reality Netwatch worked in tandem with, and received most of its funding from, governments, Megacorporations, and other large semi-governmental organizations.

Before the War, Netwatch's job was to patrol the NET looking for illegal activity, covering various "territories" based on the regional maps established with the implementation of the Ihara-Grubb protocols. Equipped with the best cyberdecks, powerful hunter-killer software, and an almost unlimited source of funding, Netwatch attracted the best of the best Netrunners: players who loved taking on the top "black-hat hackers" in one-on-one NET combat. But as the War heated up, both sides unleashed terrifying new programs and Black ICE to devastate the other. In the end, it took the psychopathic brilliance of master Netrunner Rache Bartmoss to devise a way that not only destroyed the NET, but also made sure even Netwatch couldn't fix what he'd done.

So, for the past twenty-two years, Netwatch has been a police force without a beat. Their main job has been to act as lifeguards, finding renegade 'runners who've managed to find a backdoor into the now off-limits Old NET and are being torn to ribbons by the bad stuff that now inhabits "The Dungeon" (as Netwatch pros and 'runners now called the old NET Architecture). They bail the weefle runners out and then run for cover before the really awful Black ICE descends upon them like the hammer of Thor. But recently, with the help of Alt Cunningham and a mysterious cabal of Transcendental AIs, Netwatch head, Magnificent Curtis and his crack team have been able to write software that could tackle the Black ICE and R.A.B.I.D.s that have infested the Old NET. And behind the scenes, the Transcendentals, the Ghosts, and Netwatch have been working together on a project to get the NET under control; a project that exists on no books or official documents, known only by the ominous title of The Black Wall.

THE NEOCORPS

The 4th Corporate War ended the age of Corporate domination. Even if they were not involved in the shooting parts of the War, many Megacorps found their operations fatally wounded through the breakdown of communications, NET information systems, global transport disruption, and collateral damage.

THE NEW CORPS SURVIVE

But the Megas aren't out of the picture entirely. In many cases, local or regional offices continued to operate in a reduced capacity—if they could get the materials and funding to do so. These companies sometime renamed themselves but continued, where possible, to provide the services they were known for. Some Corps

(like Raven Microcyb and Kiroshi) broke into smaller units that shared a common trade dress but were often run by entirely different Corporate officers. Still other Corps just fell apart entirely and found their assets seized by other competitors or ambitious regional managers hoping to carve off a personal Corporate fiefdom.

The result is that in the Time of the Red, the Megacorps aren't all that mega anymore. These "Corpos" (as they are dubbed on The Street) are closer to what Corporations were in the mid-to-late 20th century: local companies powerful on a regional or national level, but without the enormous international reach of the roaring 2020s period.

...AND ARE STILL DANGEROUS

This doesn't mean they're toothless—far from it. Corps in the Time of the Red are, if anything, more rapacious and power hungry. There are fewer rules out there and ambitious players in the front office are willing to do practically anything to gain the advantage over a resource or market. They may not be able to field giant armies with tanks and troops, but they can still deploy powerful covert ops squads and bribe the right governmental overseers to allow them to take out their enemies when it's important enough. Unfortunately for them, in this post-War environment, the most determined Edgerunners can also field hardware and advantages often equal to those of smaller Corps. And there are even a fair number of Edgerunners using the open market to start their own "baby Corps" to take on the tottering "old guys." There's a new and dangerous game to be played out in the marketplace, and in this fragmented new age, everyone can play.

THE CORPORATE LADDER

Corporations are usually organized as a vast hierarchy, with a President and Board of Directors at the top, and a huge sea of workers at the bottom. In the middle tiers, one finds the realm of the Corporate executive, a struggling middle class overachiever, usually with the single-minded goal of grabbing as much power and privilege as possible.

The average Corporate begins as a junior executive, "bossing" a particular project or group of people. At the next level, they become a Manager, controlling

a specific department or production area. The major infighting begins here—only very successful Managers get elevated to the position of Assistant Vice President, where they control entire factories or other operations. They are, in turn, bossed by Vice Presidents, who control entire divisions of the company.

THE CORNER OFFICE

Near the top is the Executive Vice President, who effectively runs the Corporation. Their boss is the President, who answers only to the Board of Directors (major stockholders) and the Chairman of the Board. Theoretically, Corporate advancement is based on merit. In reality, the Corporate world is rife with nepotism, deal making, brown nosing, cheating, lying, and credit stealing. Extortion, blackmail, and frame-ups are common.

TEAMWORK IS EVERYTHING

One of the most disturbing factors in this web of Corporate power brokering is the Team: a personal "guard" of workers who do the dirty work for a particular Exec. Almost every Corporate Exec employs at least one force of highly trained covert operatives specializing in espionage, counter-espionage, sabotage, and counter-terrorism. In extreme cases, measures such as assassination and terrorism are not unknown, whether against other Corporations or within the Corporate structure itself. A Corporate covert operations arm is usually made up of weapons specialists, computer technicians, and various "hired guns"—almost all of these covert forces are cyberenhanced

**YOU KNOW THE OLD SAYING,
"LEAD FROM THE FRONT"? THAT'S
BULLSHIT. THE BEST PLACE TO
LEAD FROM IS THE BACK. THAT WAY
YOU CAN SHOOT AN UNDERLING IF
THEY BETRAY YOU. OR IF THEY'RE
JUST NOT USEFUL ANYMORE.**

— OVERSEER STEELE

PETROCHEM PRODUCTION MANAGER

with the best technology available. Covert action arms frequently search the dead zones and arcologies to recruit promising young criminals, promising them high pay, the best enhancements, and a life of glamor and adventure.

GOLDEN HANDCUFFS

In the savage world of Big Business, it's not unusual for an executive to jump from firm to firm, looking for a big success. To prevent this, most Corporations require their employees to sign Employment Contracts, specifying how long they must work for the firm until they can quit. Contracts may run from a year for a low-level executive, to an entire lifetime for a key researcher or company president. The penalties for breaking Employment contracts are extremely severe, ranging from garnishment of wages, to lawsuits, and even loss of licenses in the case of lawyers or physicians. Corporations have also been known to use sabotage, software, and deadly booby traps to ensure loyalty. Blackmail is common. Assassination and kidnapping are expected. This makes Corporate "headhunting" (hiring away another company's staff for use by your own company) a deadly game of cat and mouse. Most Corporations have their own "extraction teams" of Solos who, like the KGB or CIA, arrange "defections" of key personnel from one side to the other. Headhunting can be especially lethal as most Corporations will use any and all means to stop a rival extraction team.

POWER SHIFTS

Since the end of the 4th Corporate War, most national governments are no longer in the uncomfortable position of having to let the multinational Corporations do pretty much as they please. Where once they paid lip service to pollution control, product safety, and minimum wage rules, the modern Megacorp is now forced to strike a bargain with the local government. Sometimes this may be as simple as a bribe to the right places, or military support for the local dictator. In the more scrupulous New United States, Corporations tread especially lightly, going out of their way to hide their more illegal operations, and make sure to toe the line in their more visible ones; Washington D.C. is watching and its fist is like iron, ready at all times to crush a miscreant. But in Night City's looser Free State

environment, it's more often a case of trading power, influence, or money with the right leaders: a judge or police chief here, a councilman or official there.

THE RULE OF THE FACES

One final thing that has come about since the end of the 4th Corporate War has been a rewriting of the rules of Corporate responsibility. No longer can a Megacorp hide behind the "Corporate shield" of the past that allowed so many CEOs and their Boards to evade responsibility for their more nefarious activities. As an *absolute* requirement for filing legitimate Articles of Incorporation in the EuroTheatre, China, the Free States, and even the New United States, a Corporation *must* assign the single largest stockholder of the Corporation as its "**Face**," a living person who is *personally* responsible for any malfeasance committed by the Megacorp they control. If the Corporation is found out to have committed murder, fraud, or other illegal activities, the Face must *legally* take the punishment for the transgression. This could end up as a long prison term or, in the most egregious cases—like industrial accidents such as the infamous Union Carbide Bhopal disaster—even the death penalty.

Obviously, this is intended to ensure that the current "Face" keeps their company out of trouble. Or at least makes sure whatever trouble it gets into isn't connected directly to the management of the Corporation.

**JUST REMEMBER EVERY TIME YOU
SEE ONE OF THOSE SO-CALLED
FACES UP THERE ON THE SCREEN,
THAT WITH ALL THE POWER AND
PRIVILEGE COMES AN EVEN HEAVIER
BURDEN OF GUILT, FEAR, AND
ENEMIES CHASING YOU DOWN
LIKE A PACK OF RABID WOLVES.
— TRACE SANTIAGO**

BY BAD MOON ART STUDIO



Here are the major Corporate players in the Time of the Red:

ARASAKA

Corporate security, Corporate police,
and various Corporate suboperations

Headquarters: Tokyo, Japan

Regional Offices: Offices throughout the world

Chief Officer: Hanako Arasaka

Employees: 1,000,000



► Background ◀

If you want it protected, these are still the people to talk to. Even after a major war, Arasaka still maintains one of the largest armed forces of any Corporation. And though their operations are severely reduced and their headquarters are limited to the Japanese mainland, Arasaka has managed, even in defeat, to hold on to most of its assets thanks to its strong alliance with the official government of Japan.

Most of the time, post-War, Arasaka troops are covertly licensed out to other firms around the world as Corporate security guards, couriers, and mercenaries, but usually wearing the uniforms of their new "employers." The best trained and hardest operatives in the security business, they follow their client's orders second only to Arasaka's. To the Arasaka Corporation, however, they are loyal to the point of death. Arasaka is more about protecting its own damaged assets than protecting other companies, so they often use their position of trust with major Corporations around the world to gain inside information, contacts, and advantages that will help them to realize their ultimate goal of returning to the political and economic heights they once held.

Arasaka may be under the nominal control of Saburo Arasaka, but as in any powerful organization there are always factions vying for dominance. As of the 2040s, there are three major factions struggling to come out on top. All the while hoping that Old Man Saburo will eventually hand the crown over to them. The Arasaka Factions as of 2045 are:

The Kiji 雉 (Green Pheasant) Faction: Led by Hanako, this faction is basically a continuation of the mainline, Saburo-controlled regime. But as Hanako is something of a recluse, more interested in her Netrunning experiments than in gathering power, the Kiji faction is mostly trying to maintain the Corporation according to Saburo Arasaka's sweeping vision.

The Taka 鷹 (Hawk) Faction: Led by Yorinobu, Saburo's second son. He's still a renegade who opposes the other factions to his own ends. Thought to have been Soulkilled by his elder brother Kei, it turned out that the person who ended up under the probes was a body double; Yorinobu made sure that during the War he was impossible to find. As long as his father Saburo (or the Kiji Faction) are in control, Yorinobu will still be out there trying to bring about its downfall.

Hato 鳩 (Dove) Faction: Centered on Michiko Sanderson (née Arasaka), Kei's only daughter and Saburo's granddaughter. This faction has allied itself behind the American-born Arasaka, although in truth the youngest member of the clan wants nothing to do with her family's machinations. But as a figurehead, the Hato Faction considers her a valuable asset that will provide them legitimacy should they take command after Saburo's death.

► Face: Hanako Arasaka ◀

The eldest Arasaka daughter, Hanako has always been a bit of a recluse. A Netrunner of high skill, she has always preferred to work on her digital projects, particularly a revised version of Soulkiller that will allow movement into clone bodies (only she grasped the true meaning of Alt Cunningham's work). However, with the fall of Kei, the remainder of the Old Guard (mostly old commanders under Kei) have unified around her and want to continue Saburo and Kei's plans as the Kiji Faction. They represent the faction that hopes for a peaceful reconciliation with the New U.S. and Hanako is their figurehead. She is also instrumental in getting her brother, Yorinobu to reconcile with the Family.

BIOTECHNICA

*Genetic engineering, microbiological,
and biochemical research*

Headquarters: La Jolla, California

Regional Offices: London, Bonn, Paris, Seattle,
Dallas, Night City, Sydney, Rio de Janeiro

Chief Officer/Designer: Nicolo Loggaglia

Employees: 36,256



► Background ◀

When the fuel crisis really began to affect the industrialized community in the late 1990s, Biotechnica, then a small firm with only one office, came up with the answer: CHOOH²™ (pronounced 'chew two'). CHOOH² (not its actual chemical formula) is a complex grain alcohol produced by genetically engineered yeasts and wheat strains created by Biotechnica. The potential of CHOOH² was realized almost immediately after it was introduced, and within a few years, all fuel-burning vehicles and power plants had converted to the new product. Although Biotechnica held worldwide patents, it lacked the production facilities to meet worldwide demand, forcing it to license production to several large Agricorps and PetroCorps. These deals made Biotechnica an

extremely wealthy, but still not particularly large, company. Biotechnica is also probably the closest thing to a "good guy" Corporation in the Time of the Red. Its labs have provided much of the tech that enabled the Pacific Confed to develop new bio-engineered "replacement species," and Biotechnica is active in restoring both animals and habitat throughout the blighted environments of this era.

► Face: Nicolo Loggaglia ◀



A brilliant but erratic biochemist, Nicolo Loggaglia has taken what began as a small company based out of an industrial park in Rome and made it into one of the most important Corporations in the world. Biotechnica is still relatively small, hardly what constitutes a true "Megacorp," but it punches well above its weight with the scale of its creations, such as the CHOOH^2 development that powers most of the vehicles in the world. And behind almost all of these is Loggaglia: a slight, white-haired, dapper man with a slightly abstracted air about him. Loggaglia likes to make things. Useful chemicals. Biological tools. Artificial life forms.

He doesn't often think of what he'll do with his creations; he leaves that to his grandson Mario and his wife Luchessia, who handle most of the business aspects of the firm. But that's because Nicolo is pursuing a dream. Since childhood, Loggaglia has wanted to restore the biosphere of the planet, starting with endangered flora and fauna and working up to recreating some of the most interesting (to his far-ranging mind) extinct animals throughout history. Loggaglia, however, is a practical man. He knows if he recreates such now-extinct wonders as pandas and koala bears, the greedy and rapacious forces of the world will soon destroy his reborn creations. So Nicolo has redesigned many of his favorite animals with both defensive and offensive capabilities that they previously lacked—koalas with venomous fangs, for example. He's also been experimenting with creating new bio-engineered flora and fauna to restore his favorite ecosystems: the color shifting pattern-panthers now moving into the Northwest forests, or the spotted ptero-raptors that have started to infest the heights of the Canadian Rockies. Nicolo is a pleasant and likable man who exudes an old-world charm that immediately endears him to those he meets. On the other hand, he may well also be the Doctor Moreau of the Time of the Red.

CONTINENTAL BRANDS

Organic and synthetics food and drink

Headquarters: Tulsa, Oklahoma

Regional Offices: Chicago, Atlanta, Baltimore, Seattle, Dallas, Night City

Chief Officer: Olivia Forsythe

Employees: 147,000



► Background ◀

Petrochem's monopoly on the production of CHOOH^2 in the United States meant that any surplus crop of *Triticum Vulgaris Megasuavis*, the wheat from which the fuel is made, had to be completely absorbed by the company. Having no additional incentive to produce more CHOOH^2 in any given year within the walled garden of their American monopoly, Petrochem turned to their subsidiary food business, Continental Agricornp of Tulsa, OK, to answer this problem.

Petrochem tasked the Continental Agricornp's American New Products Division with an important mission: find new ways to sell Americans more food than they bought the previous year. With each passing year, surpluses of *T. megasuavis* in the U.S. became larger, and the work of selling through the wheat fell increasingly heavy on the American New Products Division.

OTHER CORPS OF NOTE

Not every Corp gets to sit at the table with the other Faces. Here are few of the second tier Corps who never seem to make the screamsheets.

Constitution Arms: Prominent arms manufacturer. Produces extremely heavy weaponry.

GunMart: Low-quality weapons manufacturer.

Kendachi Arms: Japanese arms manufacturer. Specializes in mono-molecular blades.

Kiroshi Optics: A leading Corp in Cyberoptics design. Still dominates the market.

Merrill, Asukaga & Finch: Highly exclusive investment/financial counseling firm.

Raven Microcybernetics: Once-powerful cybernetics Corp. Knocked down a peg by the arrival of Rocklin Augmentics.

Thornton Motor Company: Mid-tier vehicle manufacturer. Builds extremely durable ground cars.

WorldSat CommNet: International communications Corp. Still rules direct A/V communication between cities.

Zetatech: Software and heavy machinery manufacturing Corp.

The constant pressure to produce exponential year-on-year growth, combined with a lack of oversight from their parent company, created an office environment so toxic that it seemed to eat people alive, only to replace them just as rapidly. What rose from this poison swamp was the cross-factional alliance of the New Beverages Marketing Director, Olivia Forsythe, and the New Foods Marketing Director, Lewis "Mr. Moo-Moo Burger" McAllister, each served by brand mangers loyal to them alone. In secret, in the summer of 2040, they drafted a plan to cut out the ultimate middleman in their business: Petrochem.

They began to consolidate power—and over the course of three years they put half of Petrochem's American Agribusiness into the legal equivalent of a large sack and hoisted it over their shoulder. In preparation for their move they brought half of Petrochem's CHOOH-4U gas stations, lobbying, and research and development in-house. One morning, all affected staff were made aware. Continental Agricornp was no longer their employer, but Continental Brands was. While they were no longer affiliated with Petrochem, the move came with a tidy pay increase.

In court, Petrochem's legal team in their home state of Texas argued that it was the greatest single theft of property, both intellectual and otherwise in recorded history, but the case was quickly dismissed. In a final twist of the knife, Continental Brands had stolen the judge, too.

► Face: Olivia Forsythe ◀



The Face of Continental Brands is Olivia Forsythe. To the public, she is the Kibble Queen, a persona created entirely by her marketing department. The Kibble Queen is best known as the mascot of their Oasis stores, which launched shortly after they "left" Petrochem to capitalize on the food instability created by the Time of the Red. Their business model was simple. If an Oasis was the only place to reliably purchase food and only sold their brands, then profit was assured.

Once an Oasis is established, the community is entered into the Oasis Community Loyalty Program. Pleasing the Kibble Queen by purchasing large quantities of foods or electing local representatives supported by Continental Brands earns points for the whole community. Likewise, displeasing the Kibble Queen by importing food from outside the community, growing your own food, or publicly organizing against Continental Brands results in a point penalty.

High loyalty values bring community-wide rewards like prioritized shipments of food, more chips in every bag of ChocoKibble, and upon first reaching Gold status a royal visit from a body double of Olivia Forsythe, throwing company merch from an AV-4. Low loyalty values result in punishments like lowered food quality and increased prices. Known enemies of Continental Brands hiding within the community will have old-fashioned "Wanted" posters drawn up and put outside their local Oasis, with point bonuses given for informing on their last known address. The worst community punishment is admission into the Discovery Program, which forces the community into testing a single new flavor of kibble by removing all other offerings until their loyalty score improves.

Olivia is a home-grown monster of the Corporate world, filled with malice toward everything that does not directly benefit her. She detests the Kibble Queen character

and is rarely seen in public unless forced by her duties as a Face. She also unilaterally hates the brands she worked for on her way up the company ladder, with the exception the first brand she helped bring to market for Petrochem, Triti-Fizz, which she considers her greatest achievement. Habitually, she drinks six cans a day and does two lines of synthcoke in the morning. She hates the spotlight put on her by being a Face and wants nothing more than to slink back into the shadows of the Corporate office, where she's always done her best work.

DANGER GIRL

Private investigation and security firm

Headquarters: Night City

Regional Offices: New York, Miami, Montreal, London, Rome, Zurich, Night City, Washington D.C., Los Angeles, Toronto

Chief Officer: Michiko Sanderson

Employees: 1,800



► Background ◀

As the Arasaka Corporation faced defeat at the hands of the U.S. military, it was forced to pull almost all its operations back to the core *zaibatsu* in Japan. The loss of the current operations chief, Kei Arasaka, eldest son of the family-owned business, threw control of the vast security firm back into the hands of the family patriarch: the centenarian Saburo Arasaka. Even at his advanced age, the elder Arasaka had not lost his ability to plan strategically, or to inspire both loyalty and utter terror in his subordinates.

But in America, Kei's only daughter, Michiko, faced her own dilemma. Her family company was now hated worldwide as one of the instigators of a terrible war, as well as having a reputation for mass-murder based on the accusation that they had detonated a nuclear device in the center of a major American city. Michiko, a sheltered seventeen-year-old high schooler, had, of course, known very little of her elder family's world-spanning machinations and her father had made certain to keep her away from the more unsavory side of the family business. With the Arasaka Corporation now persona non grata in the Americas, Michiko faced being deported to Japan, a distant nation that, as an American-born and raised teenager, was utterly alien to her.

Michiko's solution was to lean heavily into her strengths. She was young, adorably cute, and possessed of a high IQ. She already had thousands of devoted young fans all over the world who were willing to take it as gospel that she was an innocent caught up in her "evil" family's misdeeds. She started by traveling to Washington D.C. to meet with the President, Elizabeth Kress, to both apologize for her family's part in the War and to plead her case to remain an American citizen. It's not entirely known what Michiko and Kress discussed, but in the end Michiko was allowed to remain in America to finish her high school career and then enter Stanford University, where she majored in—of all things—criminology. When she graduated three years later, she started her own business.

As a detective.

Danger Girl is the name of Michiko's new company. On the surface, it is a private investigation firm specializing in cases for celebrities and other socially important clients. As its perky, unstoppable head, Michiko is a staple of parties and events from New Hollywood to the hot spots of recovering Europe. Her visible naivete and irrepressible charm disguise the fact that she's also a highly competent criminologist. It also obscures the fact that behind the scenes, she's fulfilling one of the directives she agreed to perform as part of her deal with Elizabeth Kress to remain on American soil: locating and dismantling any Arasaka Corp operations in and around the United States.

THE TIME OF THE RED

Danger Girl is a carefully constructed fiction. While Michiko's clients are all well-heeled and socially prominent enough to pay her astronomical fees, the company also has access to a slush fund provided covertly by President Kress, as well as access to much of the covert databases left behind in the Arasaka estate in New Westbrook. She also has access to a bodyguard, Kenichi Zaburo, once one of Arasaka's top Solos and her personal bodyguard since she was four. For two decades, Danger Girl has been making headlines with its high-society cases and daring exploits, all the while playing a lethal undercover chess game against the warring factions of her deadly family. Don't let the bright pink logo of the "Little Detective" icon fool you. When you cross Danger Girl, you're messing with fire.

► Face: Michiko Sanderson (née Arasaka) ◀



You couldn't invent a better Face than Michiko Sanderson (her new name taken when she married her partner, detective Marc Sanderson, after a particularly exciting case). Now in her thirties, she still exudes the same bubbly, enthusiastic charm that won the world over in her teens. A constant sight at almost any important social gala, Michiko has a string of successfully solved cases that have made Danger Girl *the* detective firm you want to handle your case, whether it's to recover a stolen diamond-encrusted cyberlimb, or to extract your Executive husband from the clutches of a dangerous Megacorp. Michiko has grown into an elegant, lovely woman who can read a room like a book and yet never reveals anything to her suspects other than her happy, cheerful facade. Behind her, although not as visible as he was in her early career, is still the formidable figure of Ken Zaburo, the only man who could take on Morgan Blackhand and battle him to a draw.

If you see Michiko Sanderson wink at you, run.

MILITECH INTERNATIONAL

Arms manufacturing and distribution, mercenaries

Headquarters: Washington D.C.

Regional Offices: New York, Miami, Chicago, Montreal, London, Rome, Zurich, Night City, Washington, Los Angeles, Toronto, Tokyo, Beijing

Chief Officer: Gen. Donald Lundee, USMC (ret.)

Employees: 350,000

(700,000 Contracted to the U.S. Military)

MILITECH



► Background ◀

One of the major players in the 4th Corporate War, MTI fought rival, Arasaka Corp to a bloody standstill that ended only when the Megacorp was ordered to stand down by the President of the remnant United States. This didn't set well with Militech's hotheaded and proud CEO, Gen. Donald Lundee, an ex-Marine who took his war with the renegade Japanese security Corporation very personally. Currently, even as it labors under controls from Washington D.C. as a nationalized Corporate asset of the New United States, MTI is secretly rebuilding back to its former role as a combination of arms merchant and mercenary army. Even though greatly reduced by wartime losses, MTI is still the world's largest producer and seller of all manner of military weapons. From revolvers to tanks to jet fighters, MTI is a major military supplier to the re-uniting New United States. The New United States, in turn, is MTI's largest customer. But MTI will deal worldwide with anyone who has money, and its mercenary forces and in-house weaponry still make it the most militarily powerful company in the world, if not economically.

Discussion of Militech can't be complete without talking about its primary leader during the 4th Corporate War. General Donald Lundee retired from the USMC as the Collapse was just beginning, helping to reorganize Armatech/Luccessi into the Militech Arms company. Since then, he remains CEO and one of the most, if not the most, influential persons on the Board of Directors. Although he doesn't own enough stock to control the Corporation, his force of personality, allies, and success record have kept him on top despite internal struggles. Lundee is also half of the equation that culminated in the 4th Corporate War. Over the years, he'd set himself and Militech up against Arasaka so often and for so long that he became personally involved, making it a matter of pride to defeat the Japanese and their attempt to take over the global arms market (because he already intended to do so). Not an easy man to get along with, his closest confidant is his second-in-command, ex-Marine Corps General Samantha Lee Young. Possessed of a fiery temper, Lundee's made more enemies than friends. And it's that same temper and arrogance that resulted in a dogged determination to see the war through to the bitter end, only brought to heel by President Kress' reactivation of his commission, and her command to cease hostilities.

Lundee's convinced that he was a good general—in truth, he's not bad—and that if Kress hadn't interfered, he would have won his war. Even though his mercurial temper and impulsiveness resulted in some defeats for Militech (like the opening assault on the Osaka Arms Works) and plenty of headaches for his top soldiers, he's still capable of mustering the troops and putting an enemy to the sword if need be.

► Face: General Samantha Lee "Sammy Lee" Young ◀



Tall, confident, and possessing an imposing military bearing to go with the rank, Marine General Samantha Lee Young (ret.), was an up-and-coming military strategist and brilliant tactical general when she was talked into resigning her commission and going to work for General Donald Lundee. Multiple victories in the grueling combat environment of the SouthAm Wars had already earned her troops'—whom she often led from the front—undying loyalty and the nickname "Sammy Slaughter Lee." So, she was a natural to lead Militech's most elite

forces against the armies of their rival, the Arasaka Corporation. Up until President Elizabeth Kress—a fellow soldier in the past—pulled Militech's leash and forced an end to the War, Sammy Lee's tactical foresight was starting to fold Arasaka into a defensive posture. And while Kress didn't reactivate Young's commission, the two experienced warriors soon reached a peaceful understanding that awarded each other the highest respect.

Even in her sixties, General Young is still a force to be reckoned with. Her impeccably maintained cyberware, long silver hair, and ramrod military posture positively reek of experience and expert command. She never loses her temper, unlike her superior Gen. Lundee—she responds to most provocations with a wry smile and a dismissive chuckle. But although few talk about it now, many survivors of the SouthAm still recall the Sammy Slaughter Lee who once led her division into the rebel stronghold known as "The Hellmouth," and brought them back victorious. She's definitely more than just a "Face"—she's an unstoppable force.

**I KNOW I'M A SOLDIER. BUT AS A SOLDIER, I KNOW THAT
EVERY TIME YOU GO TO WAR; EVERY TIME YOU PICK UP THAT
GUN, THERE'S A PRICE TO PAY. I'VE GROWN TO ACCEPT
THAT PRICE, BUT I STILL ACCEPT IT WITH RESERVATIONS.
BECAUSE AFTER THE SOUTHAM, I'M ALL TOO AWARE
THAT IN THE END, NO ONE REALLY WINS A WAR.**

— GENERAL SAMANTHA LEE

USMC (RETIRED)

A FEW N54 SHOWS

Tune into Net54 at any given moment you might see one of these fine programs:

Cooking with Kibble: A fun and frenetic cooking competition sponsored by Continental Brands. Contestants make gourmet meals using the many delectable flavors of Continental Brands Kibble.

The Elflands Online! Chronicles: A cheesy, but surprisingly well-shot series about a Netrunner named Daedalus who gets trapped in a mystical fantasy world after loading a mysterious Braindance chip in a strange Night Market.

Hot Zone Divers: A long running reality show about a group of "salt of the earth" Nomads who retrieve broken tech in the Hot Zone and sell it at local Night Markets. It's well known that none of the cast are actual Nomads and the Night Markets are all Corporate sets.

La Pasión Dorada: An over the top telenovela about an Exec on her way up the Corporate ladder. The shocking plot twists and frequent guest stars make it popular across Heywood.

NETWORK 54

Nationwide broadcasting service

Headquarters: Santa Fe, New Mexico

Regional Offices: Atlanta, Chicago, New Orleans, Dallas, Denver, Arizona, Portland, Seattle, Los Angeles, San Francisco, with subsidiary stations in most major cities

Chief Officer: Michelle Dreyer

Employees: 62,000



► Background ◀

Network News 54 is a wavelength monopolizer, operating on the same frequency across the country. Accordingly, no matter where you go in the country, Network News 54 is on Channel 54, although since the War their reach into the broadcast markets has been severely curtailed. Despite its name, News 54 offers many diversions in addition to news. Every regional office offers a slightly different schedule to its district, with syndicated series, non-prime-time movies, and independent local news programs. Certain elements of the broadcasting are universal nationwide, such as prime-time series and bi-hourly national and world news shows. Under the control of Michelle Dreyer, widow of the original founder, the actual Corporate offices are located on the vast prairie spread at Fifty Pines Ranch near Santa Fe, New Mexico.

► Face: Michelle Dreyer ◀

When her long-time and much-beloved husband, Edwin, passed away, the disconsolate Michelle swore she would keep her sweetheart's dream of a media empire alive. However, since she wasn't getting any younger, Michelle took out an insurance policy to make sure she would be around to shepherd Edwin's legacy. Over the years, first with moderate cyber repairs and later more extensive cybernetic enhancements needed to hold off the ravages of aging, Michelle has by now almost entirely replaced her original body with a perfectly designed Gemini full-body conversion, fixing her apparent age at her mid-fifties. But Michelle is still uncomfortable with her augmentations. After all, she's a good, God-fearing woman from Albuquerque, where people don't hold with messing with the Almighty's Plan. Perhaps because of this, she has become a recluse in the past few years.

FORGET THE HORIZONTAL.
FORGET THE DAMNED VERTICAL, TOO.
WE DON'T JUST CONTROL THE AIRWAVES.
WE CONTROL THESE IDIOTS' BRAINS.

— JOSEPH "THE SMILE" RANDOLPH

WEEKEND ANCHOR FOR NET54 BOSTON

PETROCHEM

Petrochemical products and agribusiness.

Worlds' largest CHOOH² producer

Headquarters: Dallas, Free State of Texas

Regional Offices: New York, Washington, Miami, Chicago, San Francisco, Tokyo, London, Hamburg, Paris, Rome. Oil fields in Many Canadian Territories, Texas, Alaska, California, and Antarctica. Agricultural areas in California and the Midwest and Southeast

Chief Officer: Angus Youngblood

Employees: 338,000

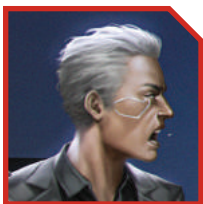


► Background ◀

It was nicknamed "The AV Gas War" by the press during the conflict, but it's also been dubbed "the war within the war." Early in the 4th Corp War, Militech and Arasaka simultaneously realized that they were headed for a major clash, and began squirreling away ever more fuel to prepare. Then both Petrochem and SovOil cheerfully sold these Corporations almost their entire reserves of aviation fuel, realizing that doing so would cause the appearance of a shortage and allow them to adopt massive price increases with impunity. However, even with this unexpected windfall, Petrochem had its own problems to worry about with its far-flung assets vulnerable to attack. This resulted in a general mobilization of Petrochem's military assets. Some press outlets even noted that the American Midwest in this time became the most peaceful in decades, thanks to the preponderance of Petrochem security forces nervously patrolling the area. In the end, although they were never directly involved in the 4th Corp War, the need to protect their valuable wells and fields—as well as fight off sporadic SovOil attacks as opportunities presented themselves—drew so heavily on Petrochem that it entered the post-War period seriously depleted.

With the collapse of most multinational fuel companies after the 4th Corp War, Petrochem is keeping the world running. Literally. They're the world's largest producer of CHOOH² (under license), and control millions of acres of arable land across the un-incorporated United States—land chiefly used to grow the genetically altered wheat that is used to make the synthetic fuel known as CHOOH². Petrochem is also one of the world's largest oil producers, but with the oil supply dwindling most remaining fossil fuels are used to make plastics and other synthetics. Petrochem also has more fertile oil fields than any other company. All of these assets are huge, and accordingly hard to protect from other companies that would like to usurp Petrochem's wealth. With such vast interests to protect—and due to recent losses to Continental Brands—Petrochem has invested huge amounts of money in protecting itself, maintaining an armed force worthy of a small country. Still chafing under its CHOOH² license from Biotechnica, it's only a matter of time before Petrochem's wily CEO finds a way to absorb the smaller biotech company for good.

► Face: Angus Youngblood ◀



Before the War, Angus Youngblood was a rich, young Australian investor who became a major shareholder in Petrochem in 2013, when the company bought CHOOH²-growing land from his family's huge agricultural holdings in New South Wales. Once the third most powerful member of the Petrochem board, the devious Youngblood used his support of the aging Board Chairman Ellen Trieste as a tool towards his plan to take over the vast fuel empire. Youngblood used Trieste's infatuation with him to talk her into a marriage of convenience, combining his stock with hers to form a large controlling interest. Now that Ellen is dead, he no longer must cater to her romantic fantasies, as unwanted as he once found them.

LOCAL CORPS

*Local Corps make great cannon fodder for your **Cyberpunk RED** games. They have just enough hardware and clout to make the local baddies take notice, but are still easy picking for the Big Guys.*

Local Corps often need to hire freelancers since they can't front regular talent; you can easily set up "temp jobs" connected to a local Corp right from the start of play (Arasaka isn't going to be hiring the Characters until they show their mettle at the local level and work their way up so they catch the notice of the larger Corps.).

Also, local Corps are more likely to hire and pay the Characters with the promise of stock or ownership (they usually don't have a lot of cash hanging around) which can be a great plot hook and gives Characters incentive to keep them around and help them grow.

Who knows; the PCs in your game may even end up running their own local Corp!

Always suave, witty, and stylish, Youngblood is still handsome and healthy in his later years, sporting an air of competence and control. He's well known for his wit and casual bonhomie; a front that has served him well by disarming many of his worst rivals, including his ambitious younger brother Malcolm. But make no mistake about it, Angus Youngblood is as shrewd and as ruthless as ever and has no qualms when it comes to mercilessly disposing of his enemies. Angus particularly loathes Olivia Forsythe, for her role in stealing billions of dollars of intellectual and physical property from Petrochem under his watch.

ROCKLIN AUGMENTICS

American cybernetics and structural enhancements specialists

Headquarters: Austin, Free State of Texas

Regional Offices: Washington D.C., Chicago, Denver, Atlanta, Baltimore, Seattle, Dallas, Night City

Chief Officer/Designer: Jacinda Hidalgo

Employees: 125,000



► Background ◀

Founded in 2004 by Andrew Rocklin, Rocklin Prosthetics was a major supplier of artificial limb technology to the Veterans Administration after the Central American Police Actions. But as prosthetic devices evolved from simple medical aids to full cybernetic enhancements, Rocklin found itself eclipsed by more aggressive Cybercorps like Dynalar and Kiroshi. While the Corp eked out an existence through their old government contracts, they found their sturdy but basic products falling out of favor in the hyper-charged markets of the Cyberpunk Age.

Then, like a phoenix rising from the ashes, Rocklin was radically reborn in 2030 as Rocklin Augmentics. Now led by Andrew's daughter, Jacinda Hidalgo, the Neocorp burst onto the scene with an entirely new catalog of enhancements: bleeding edge designs that emphasized their artificial qualities and unique aesthetics. Still boasting the Rocklin reputation for reliability and strength, these new enhancements refused all pretense at organic simulation with open frameworks, bizarre color schemes, and proportions and variations that seemed brazenly inhuman. Public response was immediate and enthusiastic.

Hidalgo followed up with her "Signature Cybernetics Series," each created by a popular artist, from street calligrapher Visser with her daring post-human-punk aesthetic, to the Art Nouveau-inspired stylings of Hamilton Welch. Rocklin still offers a selection of good-quality, domestically-made cybernetics in more conventional styles, albeit with greater sophistication than before, but it's Rocklin's more outré lines that are burning up the Data Terms, and Hidalgo keeps pouring CHOOH² on the flames.

RA has grown like a Siamese fighting fish since then, with new facilities in several New U.S. and Free State cities, and has garnered a sizable portion of the domestic augmentations field, focusing on cyberlimb and skeletal enhancement systems. There are

no overseas manufacturing operations; Rocklin has proclaimed itself an American company first and foremost, even as the term 'American' is being rapidly redefined. They employ a lot of people displaced during the Time of The Red and enjoy a strong populist reputation with the public.

Still, controversy erupted in 2041 when an independent Media, Duel Murata, posted interviews with two of Rocklin's former designers who claimed that they were instructed to sign their names to prototypes that they were handed by management; baroque designs that implied the possibility of a "cyberware gestalt," uniting augmentations from multiple individuals. They cited the work as truly next level and possibly a violation of the AI Protocols. Netwatch quickly stepped in, determined to ferret out any illegal AI experiments. But despite a thorough sweep of all Rocklin facilities, including a Warrant Watchdog on all intercompany data traffic, no charges have been filed as of this date.

Naturally, Rocklin responded with a new advertising campaign: "Rock Aug! Cyberware for Humans, by Humans!" Rocklin has since filed suits against both the designers for slander and violation of their NDAs, despite the fact that one of them has been missing for almost two months now.

► Face: Jacinda Hidalgo ◀



Jacinda Hidalgo lost both her legs to a landmine in Costa Rica at age 10. It was while she was getting a set of cyberlegs at the Rocklin clinic in Dallas that her mother, Leticia, met Andrew Rocklin. They married two years later, with Jacinda adopted as Andrew's legal heir. She became known as something of a wunderkind around the Rocklin offices and soon attended the Texas Institute of Technology, graduating with honors in 2022.

Unfortunately, Andrew Rocklin disappeared in 2023, the rumor being that he died during the War (or flew off to Mars; post-DataKrash records vary). Jacinda took control of the Corporation at the age of 26, and quickly applied her energy and vision to remake Rocklin into a company that could compete in the brutal post-Corporate War market. She held true to her father's tenets of strength and durability, while bringing her own unique sense of artistry to the tech.

Now 42, Jacinda still has the face of a young woman, but much of the rest of her body has been made into a display case for Rocklin products. The exact extent of her augmentation is unknown, although she was recently seen sporting a Hamilton Welch cyberarm in addition to her matching cyberlegs, and extensive endostructural enhancements seem likely. She changes cyberlimbs like evening dresses, often displaying her company's creations with acrobatics that would be the envy of trained martial artists. Co-workers describe her as intensively creative and driven, with a no-nonsense, direct management style and take-no-prisoners competitive attitude. Her enemies have given her the nickname 'The War Orphan' to which Hidalgo has responded, "They don't know what war is. But they will."

SovOil

Petrochemical products and agribusiness

Headquarters: Moscow, Russia

Regional Offices: Toshkent, St. Petersburg, Tokyo, Seoul, Beijing, Manila, Ho Chi Min City, Havana, Night City

Chief Officers: Central Committee
(actual membership unknown)

Employees: 245,000



► Background ◀

By 1997, the Neo-Soviets had the capacity to recover only a fraction of the vast fields of oil lying under their federation. After a massive program of expansion and modernization, KeroSov, the previous state-run oil industry, became strong enough to break away from the oligarchs of the Federal Central Committee and become the Neo-Sovetskiy Neftyanoy Kombinat (Neo-Soviet Oil Combine aka SovOil). Now sitting on top of the world's largest remaining oil reservoirs, SovOil's oligarch leaders know that the oil won't flow forever. But they're still a wealthy and powerful Corporation, with unmatched access to an incredibly valuable commodity, plus a variety of other products and industries. Unfortunately for them, developments like Biotechnica's CHOOH² have rapidly undermined their strategic dominance.

In the mid-2010s SovOil and Petrochem fell into a disagreement over territories in the South China Sea, leading to a short, but savage, war that grievously wounded both Corporations. The result was that Petrochem decided to concentrate its efforts towards emerging CHOOH² fuel technology, while SovOil was forced to dedicate its own to exploring the untapped oilfields of the long untouched Siberian region. But both sides knew that they would eventually meet again in a final match-up.

The 4th Corporate War has only delayed that reckoning. SovOil's Central Committee is already moving the pieces around in their long game, making plans that will carry the company into the next step of its evolution, when oil is no longer their prime source of income. The first step toward ensuring the company's survival is diversification. SovOil is the major economic force in the Neo-Soviet Union and much of Eastern Europe, and the company has a guaranteed market share in these areas. The more services and goods SovOil can provide the people of these regions, the better off the company will be when the oil runs out. SovOil is already active in mining, shipbuilding, research, and CHOOH² agriculture. It's just beginning to move into aircraft, computers, synthetics, CHOOH² power systems, and general agriculture. By 2050, the board hopes to have a product base diverse enough to fight the coming war with their Petrochem rivals, who have yet to fully recover from the chaos of the last Corporate War.

► Face: Anatoly Novaragov ◀



Large, loud, and ostentatious, Anatoly looks *exactly* like the Western idea of a Russian oligarch. He wears bright and expensive shirts open to the navel, drapes himself in gold jewelry, and favors expensive cars, strong alcohol, and beautiful women. But those who know him well recall an earlier Anatoly: a rather faceless bureaucrat who used to wear shabby suits and scrupulously hoarded his money to the point of miserliness. This has a lot of important people wondering, is this the *real* Anatoly Novaragov going through a midlife crisis? Is this a clever ruse put on by the Central Committee to distract its Petrochem enemies? Or could it be an actor taking the place of a Novaragov long ago buried behind the *dacha* of a powerful political rival on the Committee itself? No one knows, and no one's talking. Even Anatoly's ex-wife, Irina, has been quiet on the subject, although a astronomically generous divorce settlement may have had a lot to do with her reticence.

What hasn't changed about the current Anatoly Novaragov (whatever his provenance) is his reputation for ruthlessness. Even before he took on his peacock finery, he was well known as a cunning operator who leveraged a number of connections with the old KGB and the fearsome *Bratva* (Russian mafia) to make enemies and rivals disappear without a trace. Or to sometimes resurface months later as collections of unidentifiable body parts liberally strewn in parks all over his native city of St. Petersburg. Don't let the flashy side of SovOil's "Face" fool you; he can play nasty with the best of them.

TRAUMA TEAM

Ambulance and paramedic services

Headquarters: Seattle, Washington

Regional Offices: Most Major North American Cities

Chief Officers: Carrie Lachanan and Bob Jones

Employees: 15,000



► Background ◀

Still one of the largest private medical firms in the world, Trauma Team provides ambulance services and paramedic support for a client base of at least fifteen million people. Equipped with top-line AV type vehicles, Trauma Teams provide an essential service in the 2000s: recovering wounded clients from the field. Dispersed as needed among the offices are 1,305 AV-4 aerodyne vehicles, thirty Corporate jets, twenty-two Osprey II aircraft, and four C-29 heavy cargo jets. Each franchise office also has its own surgical-capable infirmary and arrangements with local hospitals for high-need patients.

During the War, Trauma Team International became even busier than ever and the company's capabilities were stretched to the limit. To keep the number of cases down (and to preserve its neutrality) Trauma Team declared that they wouldn't respond to any alert from a member of Arasaka or Militech. They just couldn't be honest: one battle would tie up every TT team in an entire city otherwise. Instead, TT would only respond to civilian requests, and they'd be charging the combat rate if anyone so much as fired a weapon within half a kilometer. Even with those extra costs, TT was swamped with calls after every Militech/Arasaka clash.

Trauma Team survived the 4th Corporate War but only as regional providers. The conflict not only drew heavily upon their limited resources, but also upon their suppliers. Repair parts for their fleet of AV-4s and jets are hard to come by, as well as medical dressings, key drugs and vaccines, and even trained personnel. With the War's end came another problem, as hospitals and clinics collapsed, throwing ever more desperately ill or wounded patients onto the Trauma Team rolls. Not all of these patients can afford TT's high response fees, but groups of Edgerunners have been known to chip in to buy a single card that they break to call in the Trauma Team in the hopes that the TT paramedics will at least patch the rest of the team up.

The War has also changed TT's Corporate look as well: in the past, their crisp blue and yellow uniforms were a comforting sign of their competence and capability. But endless street battles and the availability of surplus military hardware has forced the Trauma Team to armor up almost as heavily as the worst Psycho Squad. The uniforms are still blue, but the new helmets are mil-spec, heavy duty combat rigs, coupled with heavy armor, power armor support systems (yellow), and self-contained combat medipacs. This coupled with the lack of qualified Medtechs, has given Trauma Team a new face: harried, overworked, angry, and impatient.

► Faces: Carrie Lachanan and Bob Jones ◀



Trauma Team is unusual in that it has two Faces, each representing a different area of the Company. Although both Lachanan and Jones are top rated Doctors/Medtechs, Lachanan specializes in the day-to-day operations of the company and its franchises, while Jones covers the manpower and materiel side of the equation. Both, over many years of marriage (each maintains their original name as they married while both worked together



in the early days of the company) have become mirrors of each other: weary, fed up, no-nonsense medics who put their patients first. Because the current rules of Corporations require that they present a "Face," they put up with the formalities, but it takes a major act of persuasion to drag them into any Corporate hearing or event.

ZIGGURAT

The backbone of modern communications and data infrastructure

Headquarters: Night City

Regional Offices: Most North American Cities

Chief Officer: UR (Pronounced You Are)

Employees: 115,000



► Background ◀

Ziggurat seemingly appeared from nowhere in 2030 in Night City with a plan to transform the old fiber-optic Data Term network into a new system and restore cheap and reliable communication across the whole of the metroplex. With a grant from Night Corp and buy-in from the fractious City Council, the brand-new CitiNet was up and operational within months. Ziggurat further increased usability by overlaying the CitiNet with the first Data Pool, an open protocol for displaying and sharing data that anyone could use.

Ziggurat quickly spread out from Night City to other metroplexes in North America, repeating the process. By 2040, most cities in the New United States, the Pacifica Confed, Canada, and the Free States had CitiNets and Data Pools courtesy of the company. Ziggurat also helped restore communication between metropolitan regions by providing simple and inexpensive city-to-city communication via hourly data-packet burst transfers along a cobbled together patchwork of reclaimed phone lines, free-space optics, and even Nomad couriers. This long-distance communication only works via text, voice, and video messages. Direct audio and visual contact still requires a contract with the more expensive WorldSat Comm Network.

Almost immediately after the Night City Data Pool went online, Ziggurat published the first set of apps to make use of it. This allowed them to not only collect fees from the government for setting up and maintaining CitiNets and Data Pools but monetized their use by collecting and selling data, selling advertising space, and supplying users with in-app upgrades.

Among Ziggurat's most popular app offerings are the Ask Alex Anything pseudo-AI data crawler, the BabelChat chat app, the ZPost electronic mail service, and the Ziggurat Editing Suite for text, audio, video, and app creation. While there are minor competitors, most content on North American Data Pools is created using Ziggurat Apps and consumed via the Garden, the company's one-stop platform for sharing content.

Any Garden user can, at no cost, set up their own Garden Patch, a space on the Data Pool made specifically for sharing their text, audio, virtual, and braindance creations. Patches can be customized using a limited variety of free overlays or more functional—and thus more expensive—templates. Once setup is completed, users can populate their Patch with text, still imagery, audio and video, virtual, and braindance creations that other users can consume and comment on. Ziggurat runs targeted advertisements before, after, and during Garden content, cutting the creators in for ten percent of revenues.

Most modern PopMedia stars in the Time of the Red get their start on the Garden and most performers and companies, no matter how big, maintain their own Patch in order to reach the broadest possible audience with their entertainment, commercials, and products.

In 2043, Ziggurat opened offices in London and Melbourne with the intent of penetrating the European and Australian markets but has met stiff—and often armed—resistance from local competitors.

► Face: UR ◀



The founder and visionary behind Ziggurat, UR (pronounced You Are), represents the can do, by the bootstrap spirit of the modern Corp Executive. Little is known about them from before they burst onto the scene in 2030 with an ambitious plan to rebuild communications in the Time of the Red. Extremely charismatic, UR's ambition and enthusiasm united a normally heavily divided Night City Council long enough to build one of the first CitiNets and Data Pools in the world.

UR regularly publishes their thoughts and ideas in the form of video journals on their Garden Patch and constantly seeks to redefine themselves. Over the last two and a half decades, they've chased several fad diets and promoted a broad selection of life philosophies. UR has also explored multiple spiritualities, including a brief but controversial stint spent as a member of a small but intense religion that worships a long-dead Rockerboy, known as the Church of Elvis.

One thing that has remained consistent no matter what trend UR chases is their enthusiasm for bodysculpting. Since 2030, UR has undergone at least three transformations, from a typical tech to a young-Elvis-inspired look, to their current elegant appearance. Most recently, they began adding elements of Exotic sculpting. Rather than undergo complete overhauls, UR changes appearance gradually, tweaking eye color here or lip shape there until they arrive at a fully different form. It has become something of a game for UR's fans to compare the Executive's current appearance in their latest video journal to their last one to discover what the latest tweak is.

Rumors about UR abound but few can be confirmed. Despite regularly recording and releasing video journals, they rarely give away much about their private lives to the public. Those who make a habit of watching UR's video journals have noticed one possible bit of personal information: UR regularly mentions the infamous Rache Bartmoss in a way that indicates the founder of Ziggurat either has, or believes they have, a personal connection to the renegade Netrunner. However, given the volume of misinformation surrounding Bartmoss, this clue provides little insight into UR's life before the Time of the Red.

ZHIRAFA TECHNICAL MANUFACTURING

Manufacturer of drone, autonomous robotics, and construction mecha

Headquarters: Vladivostok, Russia

Regional Offices: London, Paris, Tel Aviv, Mumbai, Singapore, Night City

Chief Officer: Artyom Sokolov

Employees: 225,000



► Background ◀

In the wake of the 4th Corporate War, the Neo-Soviet Union was weakened by antiquated technology and an unstable economy based almost entirely on fossil fuels. The major economic power of the nation, SovOil, had managed to make a killing in the last Corporate War but everyone was painfully aware that sooner or later the oil would run out or CHOOH² would finally make fossil fuels obsolete and the Neo-Soviet economy would come crashing down. Where many other countries used technology to aid in their recovery and shore up their economies, Russia's ability to compete in the international tech market was still extremely limited. Russia's few technical exports weren't going far and were largely recognized by the rest of the world as poor-quality garbage.

This changed in 2039, when a street tech from Moscow brought the GRAF3 to the market. This new construction robot entered the market at a reasonable price point and proved itself to be durable and easily repairable. But most importantly, the GRAF3 was perfect for cleaning up the remaining destruction of the War. It was cheap enough to be bought by local governments in bulk, and small communities could buy one and be sure it would last them years. In the chaotic post-War atmosphere, there weren't many people who questioned how Zhirafa got founded or how it spread its influence so far across Russia so quickly after developing their first project. Officially, Zhirafa was founded by its CEO, Artyom Sokolov, with a few of his Edgerunner friends and a healthy savings built on mercenary work during the War, but rumors persist that the meteoric rise of Zhirafa can be attributed to the activity of the *Bratva* criminal syndicate and their groups of allied Russian Nomads.

After breaking into the market with the giraffe-like GRAF3, the Corporation went on to rocket Russian tech to new heights with the release of several lines of drones and robots built for variable tasks. Besides the GRAF Line, the most notable and ubiquitous development of Zhirafa is the Savanna Line, a line of aerial and terrestrial combat drones for use by security and law enforcement. By the year 2045, many governments and Corporations across the world use Savanna Eagle and Savanna Panther Drones for security and law enforcement.

► Face: Artyom Sokolov ◀



The Founder and CEO of Zhirafa is an ex-Edgerunner named Artyom Sokolov. Zhirafa is quick to mention that Artyom is a self-made man who grew up in a grubby arcology in the heart of the Neo-Soviet Union and his mission statement is to spread affordable technology to the masses and push technological development forward no matter what. They're less upfront about his history on The Street, focusing on his most daring exploits and omitting his time spent as a Corporate soldier protecting SovOil assets in Africa, and the messy nature of his defection.

Artyom is a volatile, charismatic figure who maintains a relaxed, simple streetwear style accented by extravagant, custom cyberware that could pay an Edgerunner's rent 'til 2077. Artyom is often cited as being off-putting and unprofessional by rival tech companies due to his casual approach to business and his eccentric life. In the office, Artyom is known for rarely taking anything too seriously. Advertisements greenlit by Artyom are casual and honest, often lamp-shading the techniques of other Corporations. When faced with opposition, Artyom has earned a reputation for humiliating challengers with blackmail and humorously doctored photos. And of course, the subsequent disappearance of any particularly stubborn opposition has never been linked to Zhirafa or Artyom. In his personal life, Artyom runs in eccentric circles, hosting parties in starscrapers with the glitterati and known *Bratva* members and sponsoring bizarre and often radical artists and musicians.

However, despite his strange and lavish lifestyle, fans of Zhirafa are always quick to point to the many interviews Artyom has given on the trajectory of Zhirafa and the future of robotics. In these interviews it's easy to see the glint of inspiration in Artyom's gold-plated cyberoptics even if it may be difficult from time-to-time to keep up with the technical jargon he runs through in his almost stream of consciousness style. It's hard, even for Artyom's detractors, to argue that the man isn't a driven tech with a complex understanding of robotics and technology.

SO, WELCOME TO THE TIME OF THE RED, CHOOMBA. IT'S MORE DANGEROUS THAN THE ONCE GLAMOROUS AND HYPER-CHARGED LOST AGE OF THE CYBERPUNK 2020s. THE BODY COUNT IS HIGHER AND THE STAKES EVEN NASTIER. BUT THAT'S NOT GOING TO STOP YOU, IS IT? DIDN'T THINK SO.

— TRACE SANTIAGO

BY HÉLIO FRAZÃO



WELCOME TO NIGHT CITY

A CITY OF DREAMS

"Night City's my home. It might be the biggest hell hole this side of the Sierra Nevada but there's a spark here that I ain't found anywhere else. And the people? Hoo-boy, the people are somethin'. Not sure what, but they're somethin'. It's like livin' in a hurricane. You go with the flow and see where the storm takes you. Just try not to get ripped up on the way."

Green Thumb

A BIT OF NIGHT CITY HISTORY

Today, Night City is healing from the ravages of the last tumultuous decades. But it should never be forgotten that like most of America, Night City, is still an armed society under a blanket of appalling poverty, violence, and inequity. It's not uncommon to see as many guns as briefcases on the crowded City streets; and while the worst days of chaos may be over, the danger still remains—society's rule collapsed before and may yet do so again. History can repeat itself, and there's always another gang just around the corner, waiting for its chance to come out on top, no matter what the cost. This was the bitter lesson America was learning at the end of the 20th century.

After the Collapse, many Megacorps began looking to establish their own urban areas: controlled cities free of crime, poverty, and debt. City governments would be Corporate-run, allowing optimum zoning and no anti-business elements to interfere with Corporate growth. But the right combination of business savvy and city engineering prowess was only a distant hope, until Richard Night came on the scene.



BY MAREK MADEI

A MAN WITH A DREAM

Born in Pasadena, California, Richard Night was the second of five children. His parents were both researchers at Caltech, specializing in materials science. Night showed an aptitude for engineering at a relatively early age, but when a joint venture with his college roommate (noted business tycoon Romney Zukarian) turned sour, the angry Night shifted his major from engineering to business financial investment. Armed with his new knowledge of the ins and outs of business, Night soon regained his company from his old rival.

Applying his backgrounds in engineering and investment, Night soon founded Halsey, Ferris, and Night, a development company specializing in using advanced construction techniques to build massive mega-projects such as office complexes, airports, and even small cities. HFN was wildly successful in the years before the Collapse, leading to the construction of many large model communities around the world.

NIGHT & THE SPECTRE OF THE COLLAPSE

Concerned by the violence and disruption of the impending Collapse, Night decided that he was uniquely situated to deal with the problem. Starting a side company (Night Industries) to protect his partners, Night began to plan a new city—an environment that would be controlled and ultimately safe from the ravages tearing the world apart. His new city would be completely planned, self-sufficient, and capable of holding off even the most determined marauders. It would boast planned neighborhoods dedicated to preserving the feel of different types of nationalities and cultures, as well as a super-modern Corporate Center that would stand as a shining beacon of enlightened capitalism. It was ambitious, far-reaching, and visionary in its approach.

The only problem was where to *put* it. Night was going to need a lot of land for his new city development, as well as access to both ocean ports and modern highways to deliver the huge amount of materials that he would need to construct it. He sent scouting teams to scour the East and West Coasts of the besieged United States, but in the end it was a small article in the San Francisco Chronicle that caught

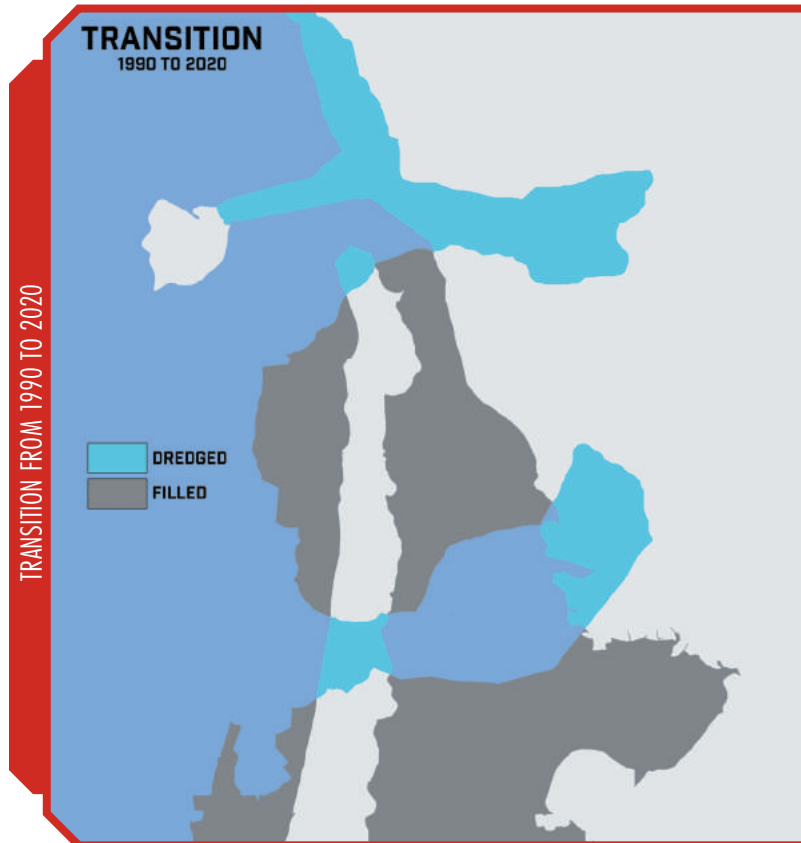
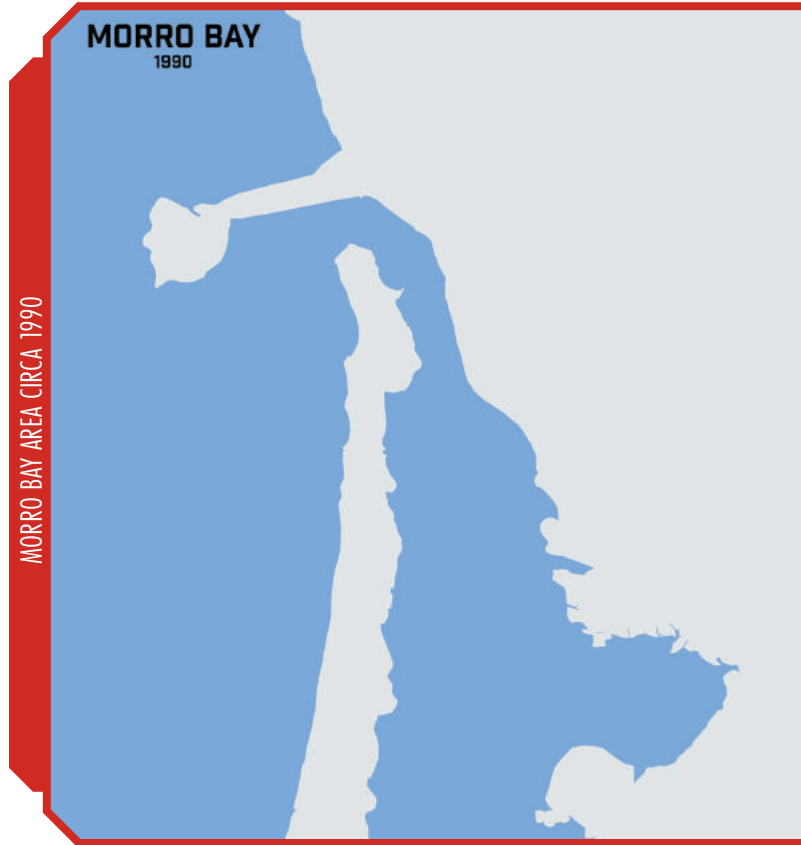
his eye: an article describing an incident of post-holocaust horror that had taken place in a small town along the Central California coast.

THE MORRO BAY MASSACRE

Throughout the last decades of the 20th century, Morro Bay and San Luis Obispo had suffered a long history with the Hell's Angels and other local go/biker gangs (a gogang is a cyber-enhanced biker gang), mostly because there was very little law enforcement on the fringes of the California Coast and the area was also a hub for two major highways (Highway 1 and U.S. 101). During the Collapse, San Luis law enforcement and the Hell's Angels legacy booster-gangs began a turf war that spilled over to Morro Bay. The Boosters took over the town in a five-day rampage that ended with many of the 10,000 people who lived there either dead, maimed, or fleeing the tiny town (there were only about 4,000 families there to begin with). The entire area became a ghost town that no one wanted to go back to, known to all as the site of the infamous Morro Bay Massacre.

THE CORONADO CITY PARTNERSHIP

Based on its dark history, maverick developer Richard Night was able to buy the remnants of the ghost town of Morro Bay for pennies on the dollar. He was aided by Petrochem, who had taken over the now-abandoned Dynergy power plant and was already planning to set up an offshore port and oil terminal site. Bankrolled by Merrill, Asukaga & Finch (who wanted to make the new city a financial hub) Night and Petrochem hired Arasaka to clean out the boostergangs and make the place "safe" again. Further funds came from external (and somewhat shady) investors lured to the project by the promise of lucrative building contracts and possible sources of extralegal income. To avoid the stigma of the Morro Bay Massacre, the Partnership renamed the area Del Coronado Bay, the site of their new city of Coronado. However, thanks to the rather out-sized personality of its founder, Coronado City soon became colloquially known by locals as "Night's City."



THE REBUILDING OF MORRO BAY

Coronado City needed more room than was in the original geology of the Bay, so Night leveled the surrounding hills and dumped them into the ocean as fill (just as San Francisco had done years ago for the 1939 World's Fair). He reshaped the bay so that the formerly narrow sand spit to the west was widened to about 10 miles. He also re-dredged the harbor making it capable of porting the large ships needed to build the city; this dirt also ended up as fill on the western edge.

A CITY OF NEIGHBORHOODS

Coronado City truly reflected its creator's eclectic vision. Instead of a huge construction of steel and glass, Night's urban plan broke the new city into a series of neighborhoods, each with a different architectural style and theme, much like the original Disneyland park's various "lands" (e.g. Frontierland, Tomorrowland, Adventureland, New Orleans Square, and Fantasyland).

A faux east coast neighborhood (**Upper Eastside** and **Little Italy**) encompassed elements of Boston, New York, and Philadelphia, while **Studio City** and **Charter Hill** reflected the western styles of Seattle and San Francisco. **Lake Park**, **Westhill Gardens**, and the **University District** were primarily set aside as comfortable urban living spaces, ranging from faux brownstones to pseudo-Victorian gingerbread homes, interspersed with plenty of small shops, restaurants, and businesses within easy walking distance. **New Harbor** and the **East Marina** were designated as the site of a world-class mall, equivalent to San Francisco's tony Galleria with an open Marina area that could handle yachts, cruise ships, and other recreational boating activities (the main industrial port would be established north of the city in **North Oak**.) Even the Asian districts (**Little China** and **Japantown**) were distinctly different, reflecting the individual cultural styles of each area, as well as a smattering of other Southeast Asian locales in the **Eastpark** area adjacent to Japantown. In addition, Night also paid homage to the late and lamented small hamlet of Morro Bay by recreating much of the original layout of the area in a small-town, open-air environment reminiscent of a seaside village called **Old Downtown**.

City Center and the **Corporate Center** were, of course, glittering zones of high-rises and corporate parks. It was here that Night showed off his personal architectural skills in the designs of the many corporate "starscrapers" that were the most visible sign of Coronado City's rising affluence. Night's vision was indeed expansive and truly visionary. The only catch came when he started to build it.

THE MOB MOVES IN

Although Petrochem and MA&F were the major bank-rollers for the Coronado Partnership, they had one disadvantage: they weren't construction companies. For a job like Coronado City, the Partnership was going to need someone who could bring in the machines and workforce to actually dig the holes and put up the steel.

They ended up with the Mob.

THE FALL OF NIGHT CITY

The West Coast Mobs (Mafia, Yakuza, etc, etc.) had maintained a stranglehold on heavy construction on the "left coast" for decades. They controlled the construction unions, the transport unions, and most of the governmental agencies in charge of construction licenses, environmental impacts, and other building necessities. By investing a not inconsiderable sum in the Partnership (through a series of shell corporations), the Mobs hoped to not only make a staggering amount of return on lucrative construction work, but also have the inside track on future gambling, prostitution, and drug franchises in the new city.

But Night's visionary plan required using his own advanced building techniques and materials, excluding a number of established unions and construction firms controlled by his organized crime partners. This didn't make them happy, and Night's further insistence that his new city would be safe and crime free angered them even more. During the first four years of construction, there were daily threats against Night's life.

A proud and self-reliant man, he typically ignored them. When the threats escalated to the level of sabotage and intimidation, he called in his Corporate allies, who dealt with the threats in a ruthless, but limited,

manner. Finally, Night's luck ran out. On September 20th, 1998, he was shot and killed in his penthouse suite at the top of the newly constructed Parkview Tower. Night's killer was never apprehended. In his memory, the newly appointed City Council officially renamed Coronado City "Night City."

MOB RULE

Four years after initial construction, powerful gang bosses murdered Night and took over the Coronado City project.

By 2005, the Mob had become the king of the hill. The Corporations established their strongholds in the outlying "Beavervilles" and their lofty Corporate Plaza fortresses. They had little or no interest in running the City, and the civic leaders were unable to lead without Corporate masters to pull the strings and provide the muscle.

Organized crime may be great at being organized to do crimes, but it's not as good at running a city. Within a year of opening, Coronado City's city government was replaced by corrupt Mob-selected puppets and even Petrochem and MA&F found themselves shoved aside in the rush to make the quick illegal Eurobucks.

Between selling contracts to their cronies, setting up drug and extortion rackets, and generally inviting the scum of the Collapse into the area, the mobs managed to turn a relatively clean, modern city into an embattled war zone. Crime, drugs, prostitution, random violence, and cybernetic terrorism soon became the rule of law. By 2009, the name Night City had taken on a grim and deadly new meaning.

These years were the "dark ages" of Night City, with more murders in that four-year span than there were for most cities in ten. The Mob ruled the city with an iron fist, killing anything in its way. Gang activity was at an all-time high during this period, with notorious gangs like the Blood Razors and the Slaughterhouse making their debut.

Night City soon became the closest thing to hell on earth: a war zone where you were just as likely to have your car blown up as have its radio stolen. The number of unsolved murders documented by the police rose into the thousands.

THE MEGACORPS TAKE OVER

After four years of street warfare, in 2009 the Corporations finally decided they'd had enough. From 2009-2011, during the period of conflict now called the **Mob War**, the Corporations battled the underworld for control of Night City. It must be understood that the Corporations didn't go to war over such lowly concerns as people or basic human decency. This was business. Like a rival Corporation, the Mob had its own goals, and these didn't fit into the Corporate agenda. If the Mob wouldn't play by the rules, the Corps could deal with them on the same level. Led by Arasaka-trained paramilitary troops in assault vehicles, fan tanks, and AV combat aerodynes, a wave of bombings, assassinations, and outright street battles descended upon the Mob's ill-prepared cadres.

When the smoke cleared, the Corporations had utterly destroyed the Mob's power base in Night City. From then on, any time the Mob crossed one of the Corps, they made sure to do it by the rules of Big Business. At the end of the Mob War, the Corporations placed a puppet mayor in power and started cleaning up the City. The newly elected Council, faced with the return of chaos in Night City, deputized Corporate security forces and allowed them full authority within city limits. The Corporate and city centers were cleaned out and restored to their pristine state. The other neighborhoods were also cleaned out (sometimes with varying levels of success) and made livable again. Marginally.

The Corps' draconian policies contributed to the City's now chronic homeless problem; if you didn't have enough money to pay for the renovated version of the place you were living in, you were kicked out by force. This ultimately put hundreds on the street as affordable housing was upgraded and used to house the troops the Corporations needed to maintain order. In later years, this situation eased as fewer enforcers and security teams were needed to keep the streets safe.

By 2013, much of the worst excesses of the City had been crushed under the ruthless heel of the Megacorps. The basic services such as Police, Fire, and support services had been reestablished, and if the Corporate masters were oppressive, at least to the average punk on The Street, it was better than dodging gunfire on the way to the Vendit booth.

DATA

Mob is being used as a generic term here. A number of different criminal organizations are active in Night City, including the Mafia, the Triad, the Yakuza, and the Bratva.

WHY THE HISTORY LESSON?

So, why are we giving you this lowdown on what Night City used to look like more than two decades ago? Simple: Cities are like layer cakes. Different eras of construction are often built right over the previous era (for example, there are so many levels of the legendary city of Troy that archaeologists have given the individual eras their own numbers; and did you know that Seattle has entire underground districts?) But like legendary Troy, buried parts of a City may hold all kinds of interesting and now lost treasures—weapons, money, data, etc. So, think of this section as the start of an archaeological treasure map that may net your Players some really cool stuff if they're willing to dig.

NIGHT CITY IN 2020

THE GOLDEN AGE

By 2020, Night City was a rapidly growing urban region, still rife with urban violence and street crime, but with strong economic growth in the Corporate sector. It was the quintessential city of the Cyberpunk future—gritty, dangerous, but possessing an urban slick and stylish cool that made it unique. As Bes Isis, Net 54 newscaster and one of Night City's most well-known public figures put it at the time:

**NOBODY EVER LEAVES
NIGHT CITY. EXCEPT
IN A BODY BAG.**

THE "DISNEYLAND" ZONES

Keeping with Richard Night's vision, Coronado City was divided into neighborhoods, each with a different architectural style and theme, much like the original Disneyland park. Night hoped to bring in a vibrant multi-cultural population attracted to each neighborhood. But with his untimely death, Night's city disintegrated into a hodgepodge of competing districts, savaged by gangs, and later controlled by domineering Megacorporations.

▶ Little Asia ◀

Japantown: An exciting Japanese cultural center and link to the Pacific Rim.

Little China: An old-style Chinatown with many fine restaurants and curio shops.

▶ Little Europe ◀

Little Italy: A traditional Italian neighborhood and stronghold of the colorful old Mafia Lords of Night City.

Northside District: An aging industrial neighborhood designed to resemble Old New York, with many interesting inhabitants.

Upper Marina: Blending architectural elements to resemble San Francisco's North Beach and Marina district.

East Marina: The old industrial and pier area, partially gentrified. Home to the Ferry Building and the Marina Yacht Club.

▶ The Upscale Brownstones ◀

Old Downtown: The core of the original township of Morro Bay; a picturesque mesh of older slums and equally colorful boosters.

West Hill: An elegant, self-contained community catering to the wealthy and powerful.

▶ City & Corporate District ◀

Corporate Center: Where the real power laid in Night City; home to the towering citadels of the real rulers of the City.

City Center: A City governmental nexus and hub of the Megacorps and power dealers. See your taxes at work.

Bank Block: The beating financial heart of the City, and source of the Corporate cash.

Med Center: The largest concentration of medical-related businesses in the City. Also, home to Trauma Team and other knife artists.

▶ The Nightlife District ◀

New Harbor Area: Home of the Mallplex, a multi-level shopping plaza and mini-arcology, and its neighbor, McCartney Stadium, home of the Superbowl-winning California Rangers.

Upper Eastside: A commercial and business zone with gang action and hot clubs.

Studio City: Home to Colonial Studios, an old-time film studio.

Charter Hill: Enjoy gambling in style in the luxurious Hacienda Hotel casino.

► The University District ◀

Night City University: An academic fortress and bastion of higher learning, supporting a lively counterculture.

Lake Park: Bio-engineered plants and animals are only two of the attractions of this spacious central park.

THE SUBURBAN SPRAWLS

As developed, there were six "suburbs" surrounding metropolitan Night City: South Night City (an industrial port area), Pacifica (a beach city on the coast), Rancho Coronado (the ultimate Beaverville), Heywood (light industrial and residential suburbs), North Oak (sister city to Night City, and the home of the NorCal Military Base) and Westbrook (Land of the Rich and Powerful). All these suburbs were within twenty minutes (by maglev) of Central Night City.

► The Pacifica Playground ◀

Home of Playland by the Sea, Pacifica was an upper-class residential area nestled between the cliffs of the Pacific Ocean and Rancho Coronado. Protected by a Militech security contract, Pacifica was a fairly safe place before the War. The newly renovated Playland by the Sea was a big hit among the amusement park crowd coming down from San Francisco and brought a fair amount of tourist traffic up from the south as well. On the cliffs at Pacifica lay the expensive condos of the Coastview development, offering a view of both the open sea, and for some a view of the bright lights of Playland by the Sea below. Pacifica was the place to kick back and relax after a hard day of battles and beatdowns in the City.

► The North Oak Military Suburb ◀

The home of the NorCal Military Base, North Oak's towering structures and ship superstructures were a regular sight seen across the Bay from the East Marina. In the 2020s, with the Free State Wars a relatively recent memory, North Oak was a military town and most of its shops catered to servicepeople or their families, and the majority of its population was in some way or another associated with the military industrial complex. The enormous NorCal Military Base was established as part of the deal which allowed Northern California to maintain its titular independence from the Union as a Free State. The State government didn't mind, as the Base was a deterrent keeping the roadgang scum from coming north and raiding for water. Living on North Oak's wide, oak-shaded streets could be quite agreeable. The homes were pleasant, pastel-colored bungalows with identical numbered curbs. Schools were excellent and the Base Hospital, Theater, Officers, and Enlisted Clubs and the Base Exchange shopping mall provided almost anything you might have wanted. If you liked being in or around uniforms, this was the place for you.



WELCOME TO NIGHT CITY

► The Rancho Coronado Beaverville ◀

The Ultimate Beaverville, with all that the name implies. South of Night City on Highway 126, Rancho Coronado extended for miles, consisting almost entirely of tract housing interspersed with small, trendy mini malls. Mostly vast featureless subdivisions, Rancho Coronado was packed full of Arasaka, Petrochem, Biotechnica, WNS, and EBM employees, all neatly slotted into rows of identical, small three-bedroom homes that reached towards the horizon.

Rancho Coronado was the kind of place that made most Edgerunners break out into a cold sweat just thinking about it.

► The Heywood Industrial Zone ◀

A light industrial area that straddled the east of Del Coronado bay between Rancho Coronado and North Oak, Heywood had a lot of everything, some housing, a little retail shopping, a few bars and the well-known Apple Valley Corporate subdivision, a primarily Biotechnica dominated Beaverville in South Heywood. But most of Heywood's rolling hills were

dotted with large, sprawling factories, industrial complexes, including an Arasaka Arms factory, several Biotechnica research stations, two EBM storage and research stations, and many other facilities. These bland, mass-designed industrial parks dotted the hills of Heywood, some underground, some above, some small, some sprawling over acres. At some point, there were so many of them that even the Heywood City Council didn't know all of their names or what they did.

► South Night City ◀

This area was chiefly a heavily industrialized port city with a battered old oil refinery terminal, a container shipping port, the Night City Municipal Sewage Treatment Plant, and miles and miles of cheap, shabby housing constructed at the turn of the century by Mob-controlled contractors. South Night City was known in the 2020s as an especially dangerous place. If you weren't waylaid and dragged into a dark alley by one of the many gangs that roamed the South Night City sprawl, it was just as likely you would be shot by some trigger-happy local mistaking you for a member of one of the aforementioned gangs. It was always a



BY MAKSYM HARAHULIN

good idea to travel here during the day. At night, the fireworks started, and usually the ambulances didn't make it into the area 'till the next morning. The largest employer in South Night City was the San Morro Bay Cargo & Container Port. The main loading and unloading terminal for container ships entering the central California area. From here, fruit, vegetables, processed foods, and manufactured goods flowed out of both Nor and SoCal in a steady stream, while imported goods flowed back in.

► Westbrook ◀

Westbrook was always a fortress, built on a naturally occurring set of hills overlooking Night City from across the Bay and North Oak below. It was just a very genteel and well-manicured fortress. Many of the Corporate rich had expensive homes there, and their expensive security made sure that nothing disturbed them. An Arasaka services contract made sure of it. All Westbrook residences also boasted specially coded, skin-implanted identity chips with at least three checkpoints on the road into the hills and several surface-to-air missile sites to make sure all air vehicles also had the proper IFF codes.

Almost all the Execs working for the largest corporations in Night City lived in Westbrook, including VPs and Execs from Arasaka, EBM, and Petrochem, as well as many prominent Night City personalities. Admission to Westbrook was only limited in one way: the ability to afford it.

In general, Westbrook was also well-known as a very safe place for Corporations to place their high extraction-risk employees. There was only one extraction attempt in the history of Westbrook, and that left three AV-4s destroyed and 24 Militech soldiers dead; it was the first—and last—attempted extraction at Westbrook through the entire 2010s. Of course, at the time, some people in the know opined that this incident was what had started the long-running rivalry between the Night City branches of Arasaka and Militech.

THE BADLANDS

Beyond the Night City hub and surrounding suburbs, there was a wide-open space of endless dry California scrub, punctuated by the occasional

abandoned town or dry lake bed. Known as the Badlands, this was an area that few Night City inhabitants willingly ventured out into, save for the hardy Nomads who crossed the Badlands in their huge and well-protected caravans.

Oh yeah. And the gogangers. Did we forget to mention the gogangers?

NIGHT CITY, HAPPY AT LAST?

All in all, by 2020, Night City had evolved into a busy, successful, and dangerous urban zone. The government managed to keep the lid on, and when they failed the Corps could be depended on to re-screw the lid down with their own brand of violent and implacable savagery. Deals got made, money changed hands, some people got killed, but other people managed to avoid getting killed in turn. Night City wasn't the utopian city of Richard Night's futurist dreams, but in the main, Night City in 2020 worked.

Then came the 4th Corporate War.

NIGHT CITY AND THE 4TH (2022)

The full story of Night City in the 4th Corporate War has, by now, been the subject of many dozens of books, movies, and even a few braindances (recorded from captured fighters under extreme duress). What's more important is Night City's unique position in the chaotic, unstable world of the early 2020s.

Because of its Free State status, Night City was home to units on both sides of the 4th Corporate War. The War was not kind to Night City. There was constant street-to-street, building-to-building fighting throughout the City, especially around the Corporate Zone where both factions maintained substantial office complexes. Even before the nuclear event that wiped out the center area, people were abandoning the city in droves, doing whatever they could do to avoid getting sniped by drones, crushed by tanks, or just gunned down by Corporate kill squads. A big chunk of the City was wrecked, and people were climbing all over themselves to get to safer spots like Heywood and Pacifica.

Then both sides went over the line and some bright boy dropped a bomb.

THE BOMB (2023)

In retrospect, it was just Night City's bad luck that it was a Free City in an area not controlled by a larger power like a nation. Neither of the Corporate combatants was stupid enough to drop a nuke in the middle of some place where the remnant U.S. or the still powerful EuroTheatre cared about. In fact, probably the only thing that kept then-President Kress from wiping out every Arasaka stronghold on earth was the fact that Night City wasn't technically *part* of the U.S.

So, they dropped a bomb.

The power of the bomb detonated in the Arasaka Towers was about a tiny fraction of the Hiroshima bomb; basically a tactical nuke a bit larger than a "suitcase bomb;" it was designed to utterly demolish Arasaka's Reliquary Database Project and make it unusable to a rival Megacorp. Similar to a 1950s Davy Crockett backpack nuke, with an overall **yield of .1** kiloton, the Nuke was prematurely detonated at floor 120 (366m/yds.), in Kei Arasaka's apartment bunker where the Soullkiller lab was located.

The blast instantly obliterated the Arasaka Towers, splitting them in half and causing them to collapse outward. The entire central city became rubble in seconds with almost everyone in the immediate area dying instantly. And, as much of Night City was built on fill, because the elevation (5m/yds.) was originally so low, the Arasaka nuke caused a minor earthquake that liquefied parts of the fill and flooded the inner city.

THE TIME OF THE RED

The explosion was technically an air blast, as the detonation went off at roughly 366m/yds. (Little Boy, in comparison, had a detonation height of about 579m/yds.). While this lessened overall long-term radioactivity, most of what remained penetrated only the huge skyscraper towers surrounding the blast (they were later scraped off and buried as fill in the Bay). The high blast area and the tons of raw concrete and steel instantly converted into particulate debris covering the entire NorCal region and far out to sea for many months, as well as igniting a fierce firestorm that covered thousands of acres beyond the City.

This combined dust cloud spiraled up into the sky and turned it red with particulate matter for almost two years. Even several years after the blast, suspended particles caused the skies at dawn and dusk to glow a lurid red, inspiring people who lived through that era to call it the Time of the Red.

SURVIVAL MODE

AFTER THE BOMB (2023-2025)

Night City was barely habitable within 24 hours of the detonation. Many people were unaffected by the initial fallout as they were mostly cybered up or had radioactivity filters installed in their bodies already. However, the firestorm destroyed a large part of Night City's housing, forcing people to move over to either the suburbs on the other side of the bay, or to areas further out. Worse, Night City was largely built on layers of fill: sand and earth which, triggered by the explosion of the Bomb, liquefacted and turned to jello. The shaking soil broke gas mains, water pipes, and electrical grids. Streets became twisted chunks of asphalt strewn with wrecked ground cars, while fallen AVs littered the sides of broken skyscrapers. Night City was in ruins—although still not as bad as other cities like Rio and Hong Kong.

Most of the areas around Night City had been abandoned during the Collapse. But now, people started moving East as soon as they could. Neighborhoods found a new unity and purpose, even if it was grudgingly and with little trust. They weren't looking for rebuilding yet. They were looking for food.

DATA

Trace is talking about his father, "Nomad" Santiago, ex-partner to Rogue and leader of the Aldecaldos Nomad nation.

**THE OLD MAN SAYS THAT IF THE
NUKE HAD BEEN DETONATED
WHERE THEY PLANNED, THE HEAVILY
SHIELDED COMPLEX WOULD HAVE
ABSORBED THE MAIN BLAST
AND SAVED THE REST OF THE
CITY. I DON'T KNOW IF HE WAS
RIGHT, BUT I AIM TO FIND OUT.**

— TRACE SANTIAGO

In a wasteland of ruins, gangs, renegade Corporate fighters, and radioactive wreckage, Night City was in survival mode.

And survival is what the inhabitants of Night City do best.

THE RECOVERY

AFTER THE BOMB (2030-2040)

President Kress blamed the Night City attack on Arasaka, although she was soon able to determine that the actual weapon used had been supplied by a Militech strike team. The Big Lie was that Arasaka blew up the Corporate Center in an area denial attack to stop Militech from seizing the Arasaka's Night City office. In point of fact, Arasaka did actually have a much larger thermonuclear device buried in the foundations of the Towers for just that reason, but the explosion of the Militech pocket nuke rendered this plan inoperable. No one knows where the Arasaka Bomb actually wound up after the Fall of the Towers, and since only a few of the upper echelon of the zai-batsu (such as Kei and his father Saburo) even knew about this fallback, the knowledge of the Arasaka weapon has since passed into the realm of rumor.

THE REALM OF CONSPIRACY & RUMOR

Very few people knew anything about the Militech-backed strike team or its composition. Rumor has it that Morgan Blackhand, operating as a hidden government asset, passed the information about the failed raid on to President Elizabeth Kress independently; this is still only in the realm of rumor, as no one has seen Morgan Blackhand alive or dead since the Fall of the Towers. In any case, Kress used this (and the reactivation of General Lundee's commission) to gain leverage over Militech, bringing it to heel and nationalizing its assets as part of a resurgent U.S. government. Bringing the full force of her military and propaganda resources to bear, Kress painted a lurid picture of Arasaka as an evil foreign Megacorp run by a madman who wantonly destroyed an American city in the pursuit of personal power. Arasaka's charters to operate in the United States were immediately revoked, its members and board declared terrorists, and their assets either seized or driven offshore.

Yet, for all this political theater, Kress showed little or no interest in helping Night City recover. Much as several previous Presidents during the Collapse had done, she wrote the city off as unrecoverable and offered sanctuary in a new United States to the surviving refugees. There were two reasons for this: First, with the resources of the United States already stretched to the breaking point, there were exceedingly few options left for Kress. Second, the flinty and farsighted American President saw this as the perfect way to bring the wayward "Free State of NorCal" (and its lucrative technology base) back into the government's control.

But stubborn to the end, Night City fought back.

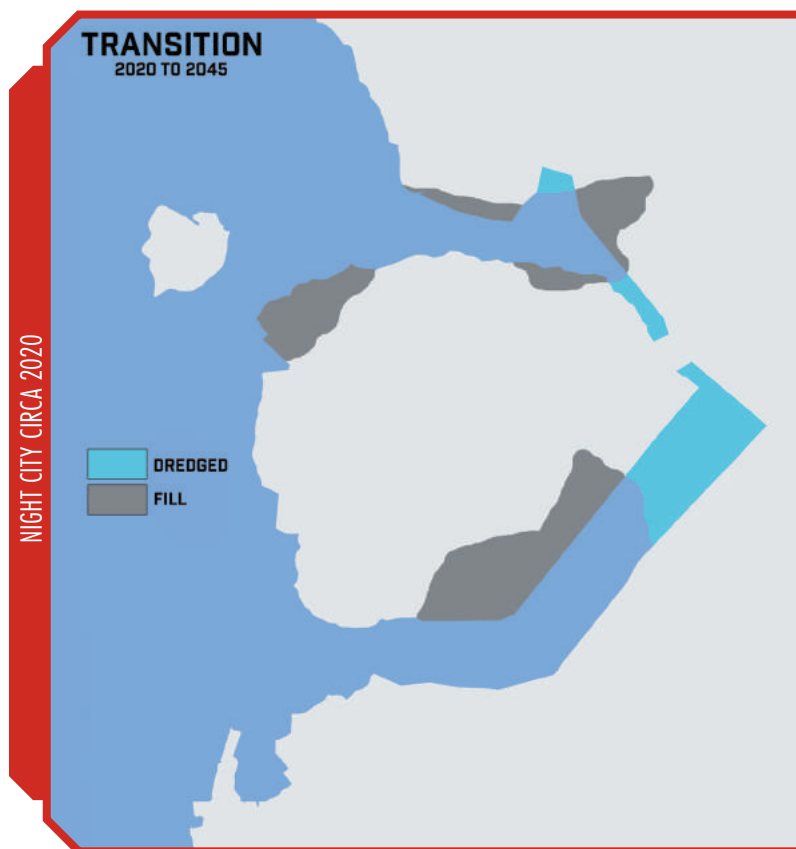
NIGHT CITY REBUILDING

AFTER THE BOMB (2040-2045)

While its impact on the United States outside of the Boston Washington (BosWash) Corridor was negligible, roughly 2 million people in the greater Night City region were homeless from direct effects of the Bomb,

DATA

There are dozens, if not hundreds, of conspiracy theories surrounding the Night City holocaust. Feel free to make a few up for your game.



WELCOME TO NIGHT CITY

as well as from flooding by the liquefaction of the City's foundations (which were built on fill and sand). Survivors fled into overcrowded tent cities in the surrounding suburbs of North Oak, Westbrook, Pacifica, Heywood, and South Night City. But it was soon obvious that something needed to be done *fast*.

The remnants of the Night City government turned to outside resources, calling in old markers and favors from a wide variety of Edgerunner allies. Recovery was led by the Nomads of the Aldecaldos Clan and their allies in the StormTech Corporation. With a lot of experience in city rebuilding since the Chicago rebuild, StormTech and the Aldecaldos were uniquely equipped to build extensive temporary housing from shipping containers and later formcrete modules brought in by rail and sea.

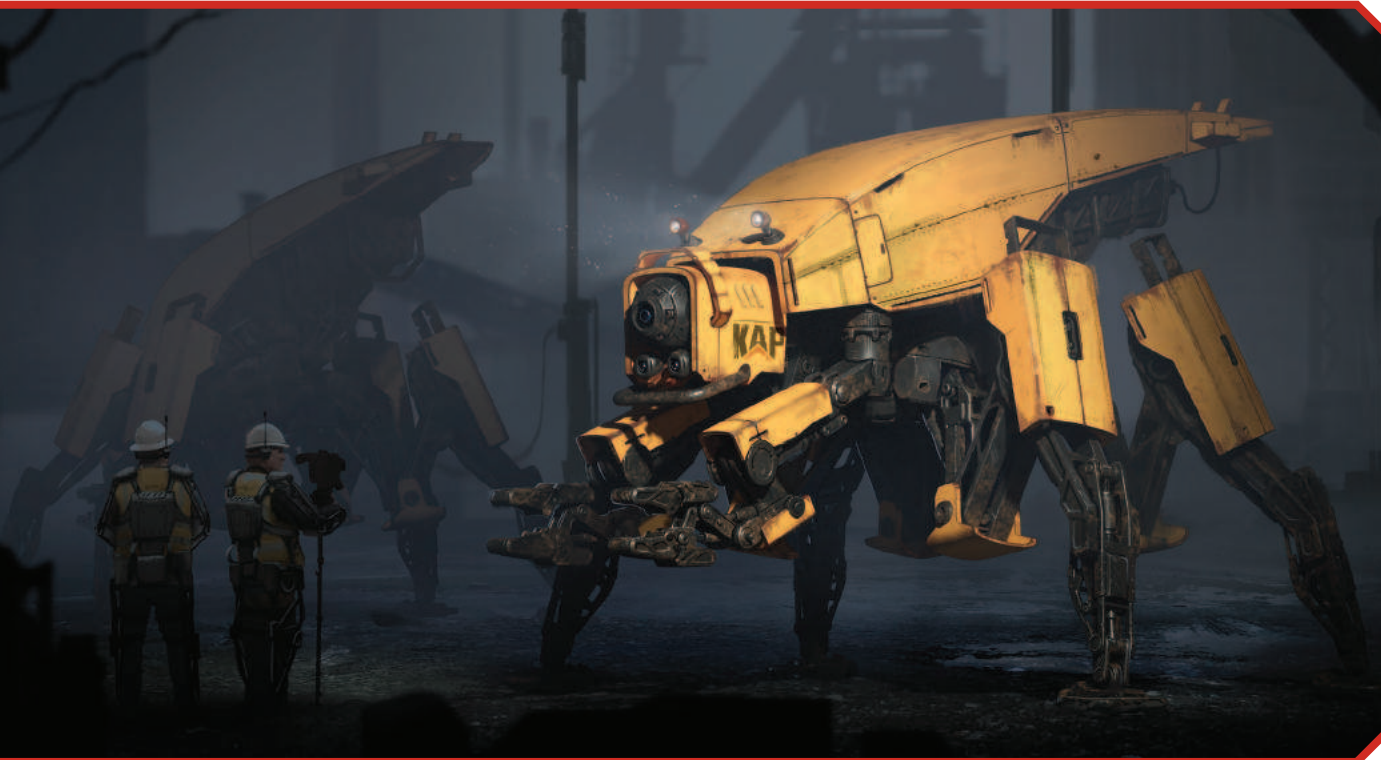
But first, the ground needed to be cleared to put up even these rudimentary structures. Most of central Corp Zone had been destroyed. The wreckage was far too vast to move out of the area, so the survivors used bulldozers and jury-rigged main battle tanks (abandoned by both sides) to shove the debris into the Bay. Most of Night City's inner neighborhoods had already been razed to the ground in the ceaseless battles preceding the Fall of the Towers. Now, the wreckage became the fill that new mega-buildings and old cityscapes used to rise again and challenge the smog-filled skies. And the building keeps going on, despite gogangs, plagues, riots, and all those other inconveniences that are just part of the Time of the Red.

This ongoing rebuilding period has also cemented Night City's relationship to the outer world. Abandoned by President Kress and her "New" United States, Night City has no intention of ever yoking itself to that tottering governmental shibboleth again. Kress's successors are going to be in for a really long and ugly war if they want to take this particular Free Zone back into the fold; frack, they might even ask Arasaka for help if it comes to that. As for the European Theater, the Euros can go their own way just as long as they don't mess with Night City's particular path. Like a cyberfighter who's been hit, knocked down, and rises again with a scream of heavy metal rage, Night City has dreams. Dreams of becoming the biggest, baddest, most important city on the planet one day soon.

And it's a big dreamer.

DATA

Among the structures lost by the end of the War was the New Harbor Mallplex, a shopping mall/arcology.



BY MAKSYM HARAHULIN

NIGHT CITY IN THE TIME OF THE RED

BACK BEFORE HE RETURNED TO THE HIGH ROAD, MY DAD USED TO HANG OUT IN NIGHT CITY A LOT. HE SAID THAT FOR ALL THE GRUNGY DANGEROUSNESS OF THE PLACE (AND TRUST ME, I'VE GOT NO ILLUSIONS THAT MY DAD WASN'T IN THE MIDDLE OF THE MOST GRUNGY, MOST DANGEROUS PARTS) THERE WAS A GLITTERING, GORGEOUS CENTER THAT WAS THE FLIP SIDE OF THE EUROBUCK COIN. BACK THEN, IF YOU HAD THE MONEY AND THE CONNECTIONS, NIGHT CITY COULD BE THE BEST PLACE ON EARTH—FILLED WITH THE BEAUTIFUL, CYBERED-UP, AND POWERFUL. OF COURSE, IF YOU WERE (LIKE HE WAS IN THOSE DAYS) A YOUNG HIRED GUN LOOKING FOR A JOB, IT COULD BOUNCE FROM SUPER SLICK AND GLAM ALL THE WAY TO MISERABLE AND HOMICIDAL JUST LIKE THAT.

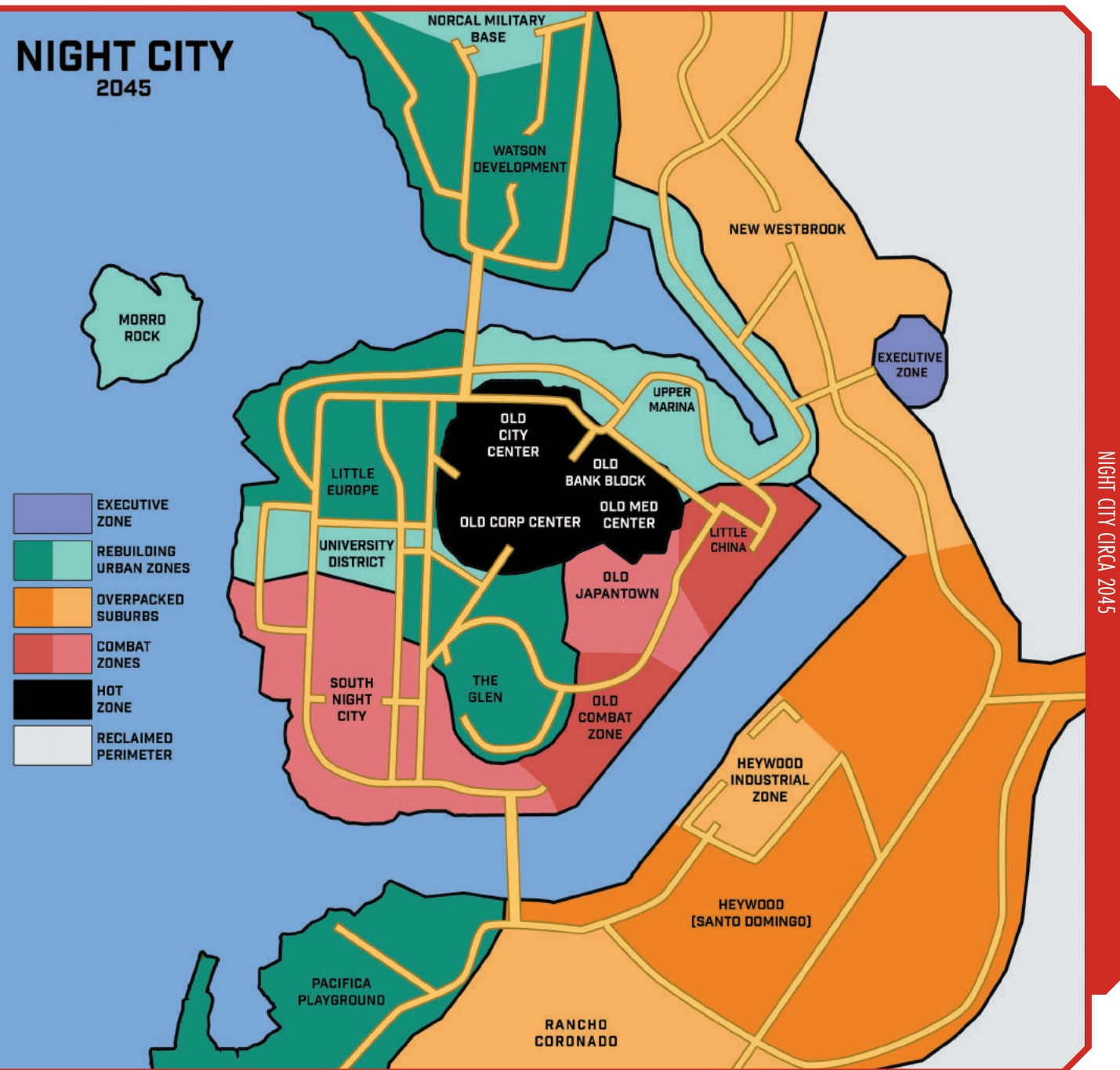
TODAY, JUST LIKE IN MY OLD MAN'S DAY, WHAT LIFE IN NIGHT CITY'S LIKE DEPENDS ON WHERE YOU ARE. NEIGHBORHOODS AND ZONES VARY WILDLY, DEPENDING ON WHAT FACTION/GANG/CORPORATION CONTROLS THE LOCAL TURF, AND EVEN THEN, CONDITIONS CAN CHANGE ON THE FLIP OF A EURO. BUT OVERALL, SEVEN ZONES NOW PRETTY MUCH DEFINE THE NIGHT CITY REGION

—TRACE SANTIAGO

Night City is a city in the process of rebuilding even now. The old Neighborhood Zones of the 2020 period have been rearranged, renamed, or even scraped off into the Bay if they're still too radioactive. Instead of neighborhoods, locals now refer to these new areas based on the type of environment they're dominated by: Hot Zone, Rebuilding Urban Center, Executive Zone, Overpacked Suburbs, Reclaimed Perimeter, and The Open Road.

Zone Type	Description
Hot Zone	The area most affected by the Night City Nuke, this is blasted terrain full of wrecked, twisted skyscrapers, burned-out vehicles, and entombed bodies of the unlucky.
Rebuilding Urban Center	These are parts of the city that escaped the worst of both the War and the bomb. In the Rebuilding Center, cranes and construction gear are everywhere, building new Corporate towers and crowded urban megabuildings.
Executive Zone	This is a special area of the City that has been cordoned off and gated for the use of High-Level Corporate executives and their families only.
Combat Zone	The most dangerous and lawless part of the city which grew out of the original Combat Zone in the wake of the 4 th Corporate War. The only justice here comes from the barrel of a gun.
Overpacked Suburbs	Now filled with sprawling tent cities and unregulated refugee camps crammed with the displaced of the War, this is a place on the edge of disaster, where once safe and secure "Beavervilles" stood.
Reclaimed Perimeter	This is the area just outside the City's sprawl. On the edge of lawlessness, save for the areas controlled by the Nomad Families.
The Open Road	This is the open highway, populated only by people in transit or roving boostergangs on spiky ground cars and motorcycles.

WELCOME TO NIGHT CITY



In addition to this urban re-designation, each new area has now been given a Threat Rating by the City Council: a designation of just how dangerous the area is and what kind of threats might be encountered there. You can find more about these Threat Ratings below.

THREAT RATINGS

In Night City, Threat Rating are used to profile armed opponents and levels of overall danger that may be encountered within major areas of the City. Here's a brief rundown on each:

Threat Rating	Description
Executive	This is a secure gated neighborhood which is only accessible to the ultra-rich and powerful, who live there, playing golf and tennis under the protection of armed security. This is connected to the Rebuilding Urban Center via maglev so you can go to work.
Corporate	These are parts of the city patrolled by Corporate security which are safe from the carnage of the Combat Zone. However, they have their own kind of danger. Danger with a much higher budget.
Moderate	These are the parts of the city that exude out of Corporate Zones, where the people who can't afford to live there do so here in <i>relative</i> safety... that is compared to the carnage of the Combat Zones. Unfortunately, what happens in the Combat Zones doesn't always stay there, and sometimes it leaks into the Moderate Zone.
Combat	These are the worst places in the city, where people die, and nobody cleans it up afterwards.
Outskirts	This is the area just outside the City's sprawl.. The only laws here are the ones you make for yourself. Likely, you'll only run into road gangers and Nomads if you're out here.

Note that while the majority of a region might fit into a specific Threat Rating that doesn't mean a region may not have other Threat Ratings in and around the main classification. An area undergoing reconstruction or gentrification may have several Threat Ratings, or even be transitioning from one Rating type to another.

Remember that treasure map idea we mentioned back on PAGE 288?

► The Hot Zone ◀

Threat Rating: Combat

This is the area that used to be the central city Corporate Zone. While much of this area has been bulldozed into the Bay as fill, the remainder is still a haunted landscape of wrecked, twisted skyscrapers, burned-out vehicles, and entombed bodies of the unlucky. Although the radiation has subsided, it's still present, and most people have abandoned the area to the worst of the gangs. If you go here, you probably are either a ganger, suicidal, or driven there to find something that's hidden in the endless wreckage.

Old Neighborhood Zones included in the Hot Zone Wasteland are:

The Old Bank Block: Housing all of the old banks of Night City, the Bank Block is mostly rubble but it was never cleared out officially.

The Old City Center: Only radioactive ruins remain of the once-bustling City Center.

The Old Corporate Center: Once the heart of the Corporations of Night City, the Corporate Center is a ruin of its former glory.

The Old Medical Center: Largely irradiated, the Old Medical Center houses many hospitals buried under rubble.

► The Rebuilding Urban Center ◀

Threat Rating: Corporate/Moderate

Not all of Night City was obliterated in the holocaust. Already heavily built up with skyscrapers and densely packed urban construction, a considerable amount of the urban center has survived. But the detonation and subsequent destruction has damaged the seawalls and breakwaters that kept the Bay and the outer Pacific Ocean from overwhelming the fill the majority of the Central City stood on. Periodic flooding is a regular occurrence, and power and water are chancy at best. The NCART subway still runs, when it isn't flooded by the tide; the City planners are working to raise the majority of the track into a new monorail configuration, but that will take time and money the City scarcely has.

WELCOME TO NIGHT CITY

DATA

For a listing of locations in Night City during the Time of the Red, skip ahead to

PAGE 310.

In the Rebuilding Center, cranes and construction gear (like the ubiquitous Zhirafa mechanoids) are everywhere. The looming skeletons of new corporate towers rise from the ruins of the Old City, patrolled by vigilant private armies and mechanical sentry drones. The work never stops, and the Center is always alight with the slam of heavy machines and brilliant with construction arc lights. Chief among these new constructions are the rising mega-buildings of the Watson Urban Reconstruction Zone; all-in-one mini-arcologies designed to house the millions of people who were forced to leave their homes when the Nuke went off.

Neighborhood Zones included in the Rebuilding Urban Center are:

The Glen: A burgeoning new district which contains most of the important governmental buildings of Night City.

Little Europe: A divided district composed of tightly knit neighborhoods made up of old brick buildings and tall sky scrapers alike.

NorCal Military Base: A heavily fortified military base north of Night City, staffed primarily by Militech soldiers. Mostly shut off from the rest of the City.

Pacifica Playground: A largely Corporate-sponsored district built around the Playland by the Sea amusement park, which is in the midst of massive development.

Upper Marina: A bustling urban district with a mix of old industrial zones and gentrified "International" style neighborhoods built around a well-maintained marina.

University District: A slim district on the edge of the Combat Zones which houses the city's only still functioning university.

Watson Development: A developing district where megabuildings and arcologies are being built to house the thousands of homeless from the War. Much of Night City's Asian population has moved to the Watson neighborhood colloquially known as Kabuki.

► The Executive Zone ◀

Threat Rating: Executive.

This area is a special gated and heavily defended community reserved for High Ranking Corporate Execs and their families. As well as luxury homes, this area has its own shopping and recreational facilities, including golf courses, private spas, and clubs.

The Executive Zone: A new Zone with only one district for the safety and pleasure of the Corporate elite, carved out of the open hills surrounding the City.

► The Combat Zones ◀

Threat Rating: Combat

Gangs are the absolute rulers of the Combat Zones. Moving between the slums, tenements, and ruins of abandoned city blocks, the gangs and their allies divide up turf, control the limited resources, and kill anyone or anything that gets in the way. There's no reconstruction going on in the Combat Zones, although sometimes Corporate or City Lawmen drop down on the area like a ton of ferrobricks and start killing the gangers wholesale, a process the City likens to trimming back kudzu.



BY NEIL BRANQUINHO

Neighborhood Zones included in the Combat Zones are:

Old Japantown: A once, popular Japanese cultural center that fell into chaos and disrepair during the 4th Corporate War. Much of the population has moved to Watson and the area is now mostly empty save for the gangs.

Little China: A sprawling, dangerous Chinatown with many small communities fighting to stay alive and fend off the gangs of the Combat Zones.

Old Combat Zone: A district of the City long ago abandoned to the gangs and psychos, the Old Combat Zone is the seed that the rest of the Combat Zones grew from.

South Night City: An industrial sprawl, filled with trigger-happy gangs and abandoned warehouses repurposed into hide-outs and headquarters.

► The Overpacked Suburbs ◀

Threat Rating: Moderate/Combat

In the aftermath of the War, most of central Night City was uninhabitable, not because of residual radiation, but from the loss of power, sewer, and water services. The suburbs became host to a huge number of tent cities and unregulated refugee camps smack in the middle of what had previously been safe suburban corporate "Beavervilles." While huge mega-buildings are under construction to house the refugees, this region is crowded, crime-ridden, and on the edge of disaster all the time.

Neighborhood Zones included in the Overpacked Suburbs are:

Heywood: A truly overpacked sector of the City, housing a large percentage of the City's population and already starting to divide based on wealth and power—The rich in the north, the poor in the south (who call the area Santo Domingo instead).

Heywood Industrial Zone: The largest industrial zone in the City, overflowing with warehouses, construction equipment, factories, and even some derelict cargo ships.

New Westbrook: An urban sprawl built in the remains of the original Executive Zone, still gleaming with glitz and glam, but now packed with homeless

citizens who either fled other areas of Night City because of the War or who were pushed out more recently by the ongoing gentrification of the Rebuilding Urban Center.

Rancho Coronado: A vast stretch of old Beaverville style housing, taken over by tent cities and industrial zones that have grown out of the corpses of previous mini-malls.

► The Reclaimed Perimeter ◀

Threat Rating: Outskirts

While Night City was the regional hub, it was surrounded by a constellation of smaller towns and suburbs. Most of these were abandoned during the 2000-2020 period, as they were too far out to protect from the roving gogangs that plagued the area.

Now, supported by Nomad Families and private security, the Reclaimers are attempting to make new homes for the dispossessed of the City in many of these abandoned places.

Neighboring Cities included in the Reclaimed Perimeter are: Atascadero, Avila Beach, Cambria, Los Osos, Paso Robles, Pismo Beach, San Luis Obispo, and San Simeon

► The Open Road ◀

Threat Rating: Outskirts

In the 2020s, the Open Road was home to roving gogangers and well-defended Nomad caravans. But as the Nomad Families take greater control of the world's commerce and shipping, they're using surplus military hardware to drive out the gogangs and make the roads safe for travel.

The roads are still open, wide, and dusty, with dead and burned-out vehicles littering some areas, but more and more the Open Road is looking a bit more like Route 66 than *Mad Max*.

Old Highways included in the Open Road Zones are: California State Route 41, California State Route 46, California State Route 58, California State Route 99, California State 828, Interstate Highway 5, and Interstate Highway 101

DATA

For more information on the Corps with influence in the Time of the Red see **PAGE 267.**

CHANGE IS COMING

In the Time of the Red, Night City is a city in the midst of massive change. Areas are constantly being rebuilt. The first temporary housing is rapidly being replaced by a new generation of gigantic mega-buildings. Modeled after the old New Harbor Mall Arcology (which was destroyed by shellfire in 2022), these towering structures encompass living spaces, entertainment, food courts, and shopping malls all in their centralized hubs. As time goes on, these will probably evolve to be the main habitable space in the Night City.

THE NEW UN-NORMAL

Services are spotty, the law is chancy, and you can't run the NET to the edge of space anymore, much less grab an Orbital Air luxury flight up to the Crystal Palace. But in general, things still work in Night City. You may not be able to get the latest digital Agent or the best weapons on the market (there's still a major problem with supply chains that were disrupted by the War), but thanks to the explosion of rooftop and green-wall gardens, bandit solar collectors, and refabbed hardware from your friendly neighborhood Tech, you're actually eating better (when you eat), have access to more reliable power and gear, and can even count on the local Fixer setting you up with new drugs and new cyberware right off the (illicit) Streets.

It's not the Golden Age of the 2020s, choomba. But The Street still works.

THE PARTICULARS

POLITICAL POWER GROWS OUT OF THE BARREL OF A GUN.

—MAO TSE-TUNG

POLITICAL POWERS

Politically, the current Night City is more or less run (and we use the term loosely indeed) by a junta of old city government, Edgerunner and Nomad factions, and the few Corporations whose assets have survived the War. This City Council is dominated by the most

aggressive or charismatic members of these disparate factions, including:

- The Nomad Families
- The Edgerunners, including Netrunners, Solos, Rockerboys, and other "cyberpunk" types
- The old City government
- The Corporate interests of Biotechnica, Continental Brands, Danger Girl, Militech, Network 54, Petrochem, Rocklin Augmentics, SovOil, Trauma Team, Ziggurat, Zhirafa and (recently and covertly) Arasaka.

Since Night City is far too chaotic post-War to have a centralized City government, the Night City Council is made up of City Managers from the different districts and neighborhoods of the City. Even the Combat Zones have City Managers, though they have effectively no control over the gangs of the Zones. A City Manager chosen by their fractious group is nominally in charge of each area of the City—as opposed to a mayor, which is a purely ceremonial title that still remains in some areas like San Francisco. The Council and City Managers are theoretically in charge of:

- The local sections of the Data Pool.
- Zoning designations for Corporations and neighborhoods.
- Road and infrastructure taxes (collected from Corps, factions, and neighborhoods).
- Freelance PI and Police licensing.
- City contracts for construction and justice services.

There is no mayor or central leadership, and fights between factions are frequent and often settled on The Street with weapons over negotiation. No one faction holds the upper hand, but between shifting alliances and agendas, somehow things generally get done without descending into open warfare on The Streets.

Although badly underfunded and strapped for supplies, Night City has its own Police, Fire, and Emergency Service Departments. Maintained by a levy on the local Corps and neighborhoods, these small units are heavily armed and operate Citywide.

DATA

There's a list of powerful people in Night City starting on **PAGE 304.**

PUBLIC SERVICES

► Hospitals ◄

The two public hospitals established in the 2020 years (City Medical Center and Crisis Medical Center) are still in existence in the Central Night City area, but they suffer from lower-level flooding and regular disruption of services such as water, power, and communications. The hospitals are, however, the last stand for major surgery and the ability to handle the periodic plague outbreaks that were common in the period right after the Fall. There are now a number of constantly shifting clinics which have become the Time of the Red's main source of medical care; outgrowths of the often-covert ripperdocs of the 2020s, they're where most people go to get medicine, emergency care, and moderate level cyberware installations. The City also maintains a large cryobody bank, a holdover from the days immediately following the Fall when corpses were choking the streets; these cavernous, refrigerated chambers are packed with racked cold slabs filled with bodies.

► Information ◄

Data Terms, established in the 2010s, are still located on the corners of many (30%) City Streets, and can be used to access information, computer services, fax-mail, and NET input. It's a testament to how indestructibly they were constructed that they still operate even under the most rudimentary conditions. However, enterprising Netrunners, Techs, and Fixers have taken to rewiring some terms to require a pass card or other payment system in order to access their chosen 'Terms. Most Data Terms are also patched into the local Data Pool system, allowing them to be used to phone booths, message services, news readers, and Pop Media access points.

► The NET ◄

Overall, the War has totally wiped out most NET traffic outside the City; what has survived the destruction of NET nodes and wiring infrastructure was severely compromised by a deadly cyber virus that ravaged the Ihara-Grubb protocol systems at the War's end. This "DataKrash," rumored to be

the creation of deranged master Netrunner Rache Bartmoss shortly before his death in 2021, has made running the greater NET an almost suicidal proposition; the remnants of Netwatch (the global police of the NET), have pretty much banned Netrunners from large sections of the Architecture to keep the Krash from spreading.

This is implemented by literally destroying key NET nodes in the system and taking still others offline. What NET traffic still exists in the Time of the Red is limited to heavily secured VPN or "airgapped" systems limited to on-site traffic within a single building or campus.

► The Data Pool ◄

The Data Pool is a Citywide information network built on the backbone of the earlier Data Term systems of the pre-Red era. Information servers and exchange systems designed for open use within the limits of a city, Data Pools produce free, open content created through the collaborative efforts of a community of users. In design, they're similar to the hyper-stack "page" system attempted and then abandoned for the NET in the early '90s.

LAW AND ORDER

Between the War and the Fall of the Towers, law enforcement in Night City literally fell apart. Gradually, random Solos and Law Enforcement Officers began to reassert control over the roving gangs and looters on a neighborhood-by-neighborhood basis.

The more money the locals had to throw at the problem, the better these ad hoc police units were, with Corporate "rent-a-cops" getting the best vehicles and hardware overall. With their limited assets, Lawman bribery is common and corruption the standard.

The only real survivors of the old Night City PD are the members of the C-SWAT aka MAX-TAC aka "The Cyberpsycho" Squad. Incorruptible to the last and still led by their commander, Max Hammerman, this lone bastion of the NCPD maintains an iron-fisted control over any and all suspected cyberpsychotic elements in the City.

DATA

Data Terms also make great cover in case you were wondering. They count as Thick Concrete (25 HP).

WELCOME TO NIGHT CITY

► I Don't Need No Stinking Badges ◀

While Night City (and most Reclaimed City Zones) maintain their own Citywide police forces, other areas just hire a Security force to protect key city buildings like the local Records Hall and Council Offices. For these guys (and others) law enforcement services are instead licensed to a variety of professional, Neocorporate, private police, and local forces deputized to patrol/control a specific area by the owners of that area. These include:

► MAX-TAC ◀

Once a part of the Night City Police Department, MAX-TAC is now a fully independent organization in its own right. It contracts with neighborhoods, governments, and even private citizens to take care of the most egregious assaults on the public: hostage situations, cyberpsychos, military class weapons, terrorists, etc. MAX-TAC is run by the incorruptible Commander Max Hammerman, late of the original Night City Police Forces. Hammerman is a man on a mission: to maintain law and order and protect the innocent. MAX-TAC has an impartial code that

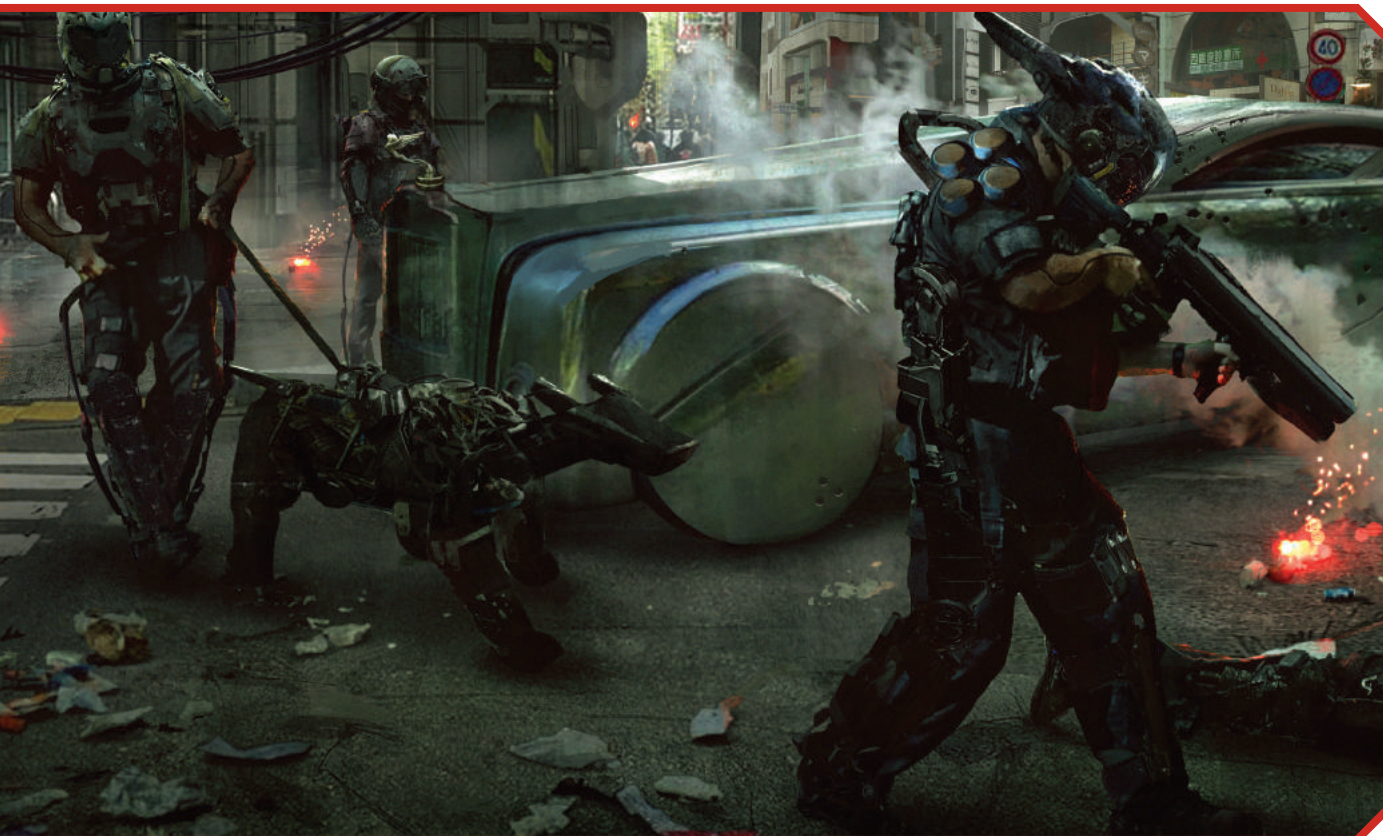
it follows to the letter—it ends fights, no matter who starts them. If you're a security service guy fighting a bunch of boosters, you'd better put your weapons down when MAX-TAC shows up or they'll open fire on you too. MAX-TAC doesn't hold prisoners; arrestees are remanded to the local Hall of Justice/Security Facility.

► Security Services ◀

These are represented by the thousands of uniformed "rent-a-cops" hired to patrol urban areas, office blocs, and upscale living areas. The largest of these is Lazarus Security, the heir to the 2020s' ubiquitous Arasaka and Militech. These Security Services have arrest authority, but maintain no jails; prisoners are remanded to whatever local Justice/Security Facility is in the area.

► Corporate Security ◀

Similar to Security Services, these are forces directly related to a Corporation. They often do not have arrest authority or the right to maintain jails, but rumors abound of covert prisons beneath Corporate HQs.



BY EDDIE MENDOZA

► Personal Bodyguards ◀

These are personal security forces that have been licensed and bonded by the local City government, much like getting a Private Investigator's license in the old days. Personal bodyguards are licensed to use maximum force only in the event their clients are in immediate physical danger. Without arrest authority they must call local Private Police Forces or Security Forces to take prisoners.

► Freelance Police ◀

A variation of personal bodyguards, these are Solos hired to provide security and protection for a neighborhood. Protectors "patrol the beat" of their area, dealing with threats as they turn up. Freelance Police have arrest authority, as granted by the neighborhood they work for. They sometimes have holding cells, but more often as not remand prisoners to the local Hall of Justice/Security Facility.

► Transport: NCTC ◀

The Night City Transit Corporation (NCTC) provides bus services on most major city thoroughfares. NCART (Night City Area Rapid Transit), a public corporation with some private (read: Corporate) funding, has mostly been submerged under several hundred feet of salt water with the collapse of the Night City water table, but there are plans to rebuild the flooded sections above ground and extend the new monorail to cover the growing suburban areas of: North Oak, New Westbrook, Pacifica, Heywood, and Watson.

► Transport: Night City Metro ◀

The local airport, handling both domestic and international flights. If there were any. Once again, the chaos of the War disrupted most regular transit—private jets and aerodynes exist only for the wealthy. As part of the reclamation of the City, plans are underway to establish an orbital spaceplane/delta massdriver launch site on Morro Rock (A volcanic batholith, it is the most geologically stable area in the entire region).

► Transport: Freeways ◀

Night City is on State Highway 828, which runs east to connect to I-5. Ground transit to San Francisco is about 4 hours (due to road gang activity and bad roads); to LA is about 6 hours.

► Transport: The Nomads ◀

The most reliable transportation in or out of Night City comes via the services of the Nomad Clans. Individual Clans sponsor heavily armed convoys to cities along the Coast, the West, and even to the edges of the New United States. These convoys, often made up of over a hundred vehicles ranging in size from giant multifamily Kombis to small armed escort cycles, are capable of fending off even the most determined road-gangs and rogue mercenary groups. Sea-based Clans have commandeered everything from abandoned luxury liners to gigantic container ships and pressed them into service; these are also a reliable way to get out of Night City via the sea lanes.

► Transport: By Air and Even Space ◀

Need to travel faster? Nomad Clans now control a sizable percentage of the Aerozep (modern cargo blimps) traffic around the region and overseas, usually backed up by satellite snub fighters and AVs. There are few actual commercial jets or other winged aircraft available (too expensive to operate), but if you're really in a hurry, there are an assortment of ex-ESA (European Space Agency) or Orbital Highrider pilots commanding their own suborbital scram-jets—like the legendary Han Solo, these "Deltajocks" go out of their way to avoid legal entanglements and will move any cargo (including you) for the right price.

DATA

Of course, there's already a working high-security monorail that runs in a loop from the Executive Zone to Little Europe and the Watson Development. Money talks.



BY ALEXANDER DUDAR

WELCOME TO NIGHT CITY

PEOPLE OF NIGHT CITY

Who to know, who to avoid, and who to get jobs from in Night City.

POWER PLAYERS OF NIGHT CITY

THE MOVERS AND SHAKERS

WHO RUN THE CITY.

DATA

In a former life, Bes Isis was a member of Samurai, the band fronted by Johnny Silverhand.

Bes Isis (Media): Bes Isis is a well-known freelance Media who has a reputation for being slightly off-balance when it comes to scooping other Medias. More than once, she's broken a few rules to get the inside scoop on a big story, sometimes at significant personal cost. She has one chrome leg and a similar replacement for half of her chest. These were necessary after she faked injury to get a story on "meat jumping."

DATA

Fiona Hayes isn't the only journalist around who might not be the original. A lot of Medias use the nom de plume "Thompson" when they want to publish a particularly dangerous story without having it traced back to them.

Blacklist (Tech): A onetime renegade chemical/cyber-engineer from the Biotechnica Corporation, Blacklist makes his presence known in Night City in several ways. He is the man that boostergangs see to get "personalized" cybernetics, the man that Corporations see to get viruses synthesized, and the man who the police talk to when they need help in identifying and analyzing chemicals used in crimes. After a dispute with Biotechnica he made peace with Niccolo Loggaglia and found new employment as a designer for Biotechnica's bio-engineered replacement fauna.

David Ling Po (Exec): Born in Hong Kong, David Ling Po emigrated with his family to the United States in 2014. A graduate, (Summa Cum Laude) of Stanford University, in every respect Ling Po appears to be a model businessman and pillar of the community. But behind his mask of respectability, Ling Po is head of the Weng Fang Tong, the largest and most powerful Chinese criminal organization in the western United States. The Weng Fang Tong controls all gambling, loan sharking, and prostitution in much of Night City. Almost all the boostergangs operating in Little China are on Ling Po's payroll and he uses them as enforcers for his various dealings. Operating from the top floor of his export business, he monitors the district

via his numerous hirelings, each equipped with a telescopic video micro-camera replacing one eye. Their information is sent via scrambled signal to Mr. Ling Po.

Dr. Edward Michaels, PhD (Exec): Dean of Night City University (because no one else wants the job). Anyone who wants anything from the University will eventually meet him. He's balding and in his late seventies, but still runs every morning to keep in shape, aided by his new Rocklin Augmentics cyber-legs. Dr. Michaels is a distinctly open and honest man, and made his reputation for excellence in the academic circles during his term on the Pacifica school board. He has made deals with various groups of Edgerunners in the interest of defending his university in the Time of the Red. Michaels also believes that everyone at NCU should be treated equally, while many of his colleagues believe that total Corporate sponsorship is the way to go.

Fiona Hayes (Media): Where one finds scandal, graft, or corruption, one can also be fairly sure of finding Net 54 star, Fiona Hayes. A Night City institution, she's in the habit of turning up where she is most definitely unwanted, usually accompanied by a hand-picked, seasoned camera crew and a battery of tough questions. Her investigations have uncovered political and corporate crime, scandal, and conspiracy. Many a once-powerful person lives in jail or retired shame due to a Fiona Hayes' investigation. Naturally, Fiona's journalistic exploits have made her a marked woman, and she sometimes lives like a fugitive for months at a time to avoid assassination by the targets of her investigations. She'll turn up only when her report is complete and her evidence solid, cornering her mark with a camera crew somewhere nice and public. Even if the only response is a "no-comment" the report she logs is usually enough to snowball matters to their inevitable conclusion. There's a rumor on the streets that she's not the first Fiona Hayes and she won't be the last.

Fireman (Fixer): Fireman is the most well-known of the many local arms dealers. His main distinction comes from the fact that he supplies many of the legitimate businesses with security systems in addition to the weapons their bouncers/hired

Solos use. Fireman was initially a cyber-soldier in the SouthAm War who used his contacts after leaving the service to supply his modest business. In addition to his arms dealing, Fireman is also involved in information dealing, something that makes him very popular with Edgerunners in the city. A regular in the Afterlife, he is well-known in the Solo community.

Franklin M'bolu (Tech): As a developer of many of Orbital Air's leading technologies, M'bolu is in charge of building the company's forthcoming massdriver. Constructed within the Morro Rock, the massdriver will allow space planes to be launched into LEO. Franklin M'bolu is the hard-bargaining man originally responsible for managing OA's contracts and purchases in the U.S. He is rumored in some circles to supplement his income by dealing some of this technology and information on the black markets.

Garven Haakensen (Fixer): Once the Assistant Mayor, "Councilman" Haakensen can always be found in his office. He has contacts with all the special interest groups, as well as the Corporations and organized crime. Or, to be more specific, they all have contacts with *him*. So far, he has been able to juggle all this for years without anyone being the wiser, and, given the fact that there's no longer an official Mayor of Night City, he's the closest thing the Council has to a favor-granting power broker.

Hornet (Fixer): A self-made man with a score of enemies, Hornet has become a well-known and respected Fixer in the City in the last several years. Originally a small-time forger from Heywood, Hornet made his bones working with Arasaka during the tail end of the 4th Corporate War, providing deadly chemical weapons, at least some of which were of his own design. Post-War, Hornet has edged his way into most markets in the City, making alliances with many of the Nomad Pack on the outskirts and snapping up talented Techs and Medtechs to work for him. If you need cybertech, biotech, or drugs, Hornet is the man to talk to. He travels often, maintaining several offices throughout the City and is never without his bodyguard: a masked, monokatanawielding Solo named Fox.

Lucius Rhyne (Rockerboy): A community organizer in the newly forming Watson Development, Lucius is a rare idealist working to make the world a better place. He is well-known for his inspiring speeches and calls to action.

Mister Kernaghan (Fixer): Before the 4th Corporate War, Mister Kernaghan worked IT for the Night City Port Authority. When the Nuke went off and the port shut down, he grabbed as much data as he could and ran. Once he was secure and away from the radiation, Mister Kernaghan used those shipping manifests and filed route plans to build his empire. At first, he hired teams to retrieve essentials like food, water, and medicine and sell them to local gangs and Nomad Packs but as Night City began to recover, Mister Kernaghan moved up the chain to rarer, and more profitable, goods. Now a wealthy man, Mister Kernaghan and his cat, Kosmos, hold court over quarterly Midnight Markets where the elite come to buy luxury items like Aerozepts, Cryo-Max suits, and one-of-a-kind collectibles.

Nostradamus (Media): Unlike the Nostradamus of the 1400s, this one specializes not in the future, but in the past and present. He is somewhat of a recluse, living in a converted warehouse that has many defenses. Inside the warehouse lies the biggest collection of real books that are left in the City. Nostradamus uses these books along with a gigantic mainframe to compile all the information that he can. To facilitate this collection, he often hires Netrunners to acquire the saleable information he's known for brokering.

The Other Dr. Bob (Medtech): One of the few surgeons in the City who didn't get his training from the military. The Other Dr. Bob does a lot of cybernetic implants for boostergangs, but he won't do facial reconstruction for posers. Years ago, this was just a limit of his skill but since losing his hands to one of the many John F. Kennedy Juniors of Night City The Other Dr. Bob has harbored a deep hatred of poser gangs. To make matter's worse, people keep mistaking him for Dr. Bob Jones, one of the Faces of Trauma Team.

Phoenix Redwyne (Medtech): When Phoenix quit her job at Trauma Team, she had a plan: do some jobs, raise some money, and open a clinic of

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A sure-fire way to piss off Hornet is to ask him about his house. Rumor has it he had a nice place in the 'burbs once. With a white picket fence and everything!

her very own. Then the 4th Corporate War came and blew her plans all to hell. Instead of earning enough cash to open a fancy new clinic Phoenix made do with whatever she could find. She opened the first version of her clinic, 'From the Embers' in a tent on the outskirts of the city. Over the years the clinic's moved from tent to storage container to abandoned storefront to its current location: a converted garage. These days, Phoenix keeps the lights of her clinic on thanks to community donations and a complicated network of contacts. After over two decades of patching up the people of Night City, pretty much anyone who is anyone owes Phoenix a favor or two.

Queen Morosha (Solo): A rising star in the Solo community, Queen Morosha is a mysterious figure who fought her way out of the Combat Zone to become one of the most well-known Solos in Night City in just a few years. Already, she's made a name for herself as the "Queen of Solos", running a small but astonishingly effective organization of freelancer killers and bodyguards. Unlike many other Solos, Queen Morosha has an extremely visible persona, taking interviews about her work, her organization, and making appearances from time to time. It's safe to say her meteoric rise and her self-proclaimed title have ruffled some feathers but as of yet no challenger has managed to take down the Queen.

Rex Royale (Fixer): For those who live on the edge of the Combat Zones, safety is a primary concern. Where do the Combat Zones stop? Rex says it's where he stops it. That's why you pay him to protect you from it. It's not like the police will. Straddling the line between protection racket and public service, Rex's Community Solos keep the Fixer popular enough with his neighbors to keep them paying him. To his credit, Rex actually cares about the community, occasionally organizing pancake breakfasts and the like. He's just not a charity.

Rogue (Solo): Once upon a time Rogue and her ex-partner Santiago were the best hit men and bodyguards in the business. After traumatic events of the Night City holocaust, Rogue retired and took over operation of the Afterlife. Now, she holds court with the local Solos and occasionally acts as a go between with potential contacts.

William Joseph "Billy Joe" Brentwood (Exec):

To most of the people he meets, Billy Joe Brentwood is still the congenial, backslapping, loudmouthed executive in charge of the Dallas-based Petrochem's Night City office; a spinner of good-natured fish stories and tall tales of a rowdy youth in the Texas Free State. Those a little closer know the truth. Behind the high-profile, free-spending exterior is a ruthless, ambitious Exec who cares little who he cuts down on his way to the top, as long as he doesn't besmirch his public image. Brentwood is rumored to have his fingers in many pies, including local and national politics. His lifestyle has made him no stranger to scandal—he's a favorite target of blackmailers and investigative reporters, but many of the people trying to coerce him, or expose his shadier side, have turned up face down in the harbor or disappeared completely.

Dr. Wu Chii Lee (Medtech): Now ensconced in the Watson Development, the elderly Dr. Lee is a healer, priest, fortune-teller, and herbal pharmacist to the people. Lee is also well known and respected by his peers for having his finger on the pulse of Night City's Asian communities. Information flows like a stream through his hands, often directed by him to where it will do the most good. To most people, he seems to be a simple herbalist who speaks only his native Cantonese. But if faced with an interesting problem, or shown proper respect, this facade is quickly done away with, and he can be of great help.

BADASSES OF NIGHT CITY

**A few notable people you
never want to cross.**

Dillon Murphy (Solo): Dillon is a soft-spoken, middle-aged Solo who built a solid reputation on The Street for a cool head and a fast .44. He speaks with a thick Irish accent and bears a resemblance to a certain Rory McGuire, an I.R.A. gunner from Belfast who escaped from a maximum-security prison several decades back. Behind his back, he is known as the "White Knight of Night City" because of a chivalrous streak that causes him to protect women and children—sometimes without pay. Rumor has it, he married a pretty red-head

and settled down to raise a horde of children. But he can still be found on The Street from time to time, especially around Father Kevin's church.

Eran Malour (Tech): A decorated veteran of the brushfire wars of South America, Eran Malour decided he had seen enough. After eight years in the Marines, Malour returned to the United States, and using his veteran's benefits started up his own business. A skilled armorer, he began building custom weapons for his friends and soon gathered a following among many Solos in Night City. In 2016, Malour convinced some of his best customers to invest in plans to expand his business. He purchased a small robotics factory that had been rendered obsolete by recent innovations in zero-gee manufacturing. He then modified the factory with his own specifications to design, produce, and modify any firearm to the desires of the customer. He's mostly retired now, but he'll do you up a weapon if he especially likes you. One of his more notable clients has been Johnny Silverhand for whom he's built a succession of personalized handguns.

Father Kevin (Solo): To no one's surprise, Father Kevin of Holy Angels Church was a Solo in his younger days and saw action in a dozen or more countries. When he grew sick of wholesale destruction and human intolerance, he came to the conclusion that only charity and divine grace could save humanity. He and his church will provide sanctuary and mediate disputes for anyone who asks (and is willing to turn over their weapons). Father Kevin's record for peacefully settling gang or Corporation problems is exceptional even in the chaos of the Time of the Red.

Fox (Solo): Fox is a tall slender woman, at least as far as one can tell from her voice. When she was younger she cultivated an intimidating presence, always wearing stylish black from head to toe, her face barely visible behind a net inset in her hood, speaking little. As Hornet's bodyguard for many years she made her bones disappointing an almost constant stream of people wanting to kill her colorful principal during his rapid climb through the power structures of Night City. At this point she is well known and respected in Night City but continues her affectations just because she's used to it. She prefers killing people in quiet but effective ways.

Rumor has it that she has taken to training young Solos in her quiet but effective ways but, of course, no one knows for sure.

Green Thumb (Solo): Born in Night City to a family of Nigerian immigrants, Green Thumb signed up with Militech when the War really broke out. He served 'til the end of the conflict and returned to a partially obliterated home. With his family and many of his friends dead, his home destroyed, and his body heavily augmented with borgware, Green Thumb was left with nothing but the will to build something from the ashes. Post-War, Green Thumb is one of the many rooftop gardeners of Night City's Rebuilding Urban Center. Still heavily augmented and well trained from years of combat, he has formed a loose coalition of rooftop gardeners and farmers whom he protects from gangers and Corps like Continental Brands.

Kenshiro Saeba (Lawman): A one-time Solo who served in the SouthAm War, Kenshiro works as a private investigator in Little Europe, where he picked up the nickname "The Night Hunter." Years ago, when he cracked a kidnapping case involving Yasume Kanzaki and a rival Mob boss, he was temporarily forced to pull up stakes and hide out in Japantown for several years. A hellacious hand with a gun and a good man to have backing you in a fight, Kenshiro has many contacts in local law enforcement but not all approve of his methods.

"The Knife" (Solo): A Yakuza assassin now operating in the Night City area. A master of disguise, no one knows what The Knife looks like, or who they might be. And when they could be anyone you meet, you'll never see them coming. It's rumored that "The Knife" may actually be a code name for a number of assassins. If you need to reach them—think twice—you can send the message "Katana" to a ZChat account known to a few select Fixers.

Recluse (Netrunner): Very little is known about the hermitic Netrunner living in the heart of the Combat Zone's Old Japantown district. But everyone in the Combat Zone knows you don't go into the old Kaifū Corner shopping complex unless you're looking for trouble or you need a top-tier Netrunner. For the last several years, Recluse has lived in the abandoned

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Kenshiro is known for taking cases most PI firms, including Danger Girl, won't touch.

mini-mall, installing expensive, covert defenses and complex NET Architectures that most Edgerunners could only dream of acquiring. She only speaks with clients who can shell out big time cash and never meets anyone in person. Recluse prefers to meet clients in the lobby of her NET Architecture, where she appears in the form of her Icon, a tremendous brown recluse spider with an icy voice. Some say she's an ex-Netwatch agent, hiding out from her former employers; some say she's really an A.I.; and some people even say Recluse is a Net Ghost who lives in the Old NET. But there's one thing everyone in the Combat Zone knows: if you need a NET cracked, no matter how airtight, you go to Recluse.

Woodchipper (Nomad): The rise of the Nomads during the Time of the Red has led to a steady increase in conflicts between Nomad Families. When they seek mediation, Woodchipper's garage on the outskirts of Night City is often their destination. From squabbles over reclaimed land to interpersonal conflicts, they throw it all to the Woodchipper. For her clients, she is equal parts extralegal judge, private investigator, and marriage counselor. In her garage, weapons are not allowed and all seeking violence are removed violently by 270 lbs. of peace-loving, subdermally armored Nomad and her internal linear frame.

GANGS OF NIGHT CITY

The streets of Night City are alive and crawling with gangs. By day, The Street may still be the province of Corporate Execs and commuting Beavers. But at night, the predators slither out from under their rocks and trash heaps, and the City howls. Call them gutter-rats, night crawlers, trash, or street scum; the gangs are the ultimate rulers of the City's night. Whether it's a small pack of a dozen, or an army of two hundred, each gang in Night City is as diverse as The Street itself; guardians, chromers, dorpers, and freaks all thrown together in a lethal cocktail, mixed and sprinkled liberally with blood.

Meet the gangs.

Meet your worst nightmares.

6th Street: Born from the many veterans of the 4th Corporate War, the 6th Street is a vigilante gang which protects various neighborhoods around

Night City. Members of the 6th Street are generally well-armed and heavily cybered-up with armament from their days in the field. Recently, they have been forced to move into extortion and smuggling in efforts to pay their bills. While they operate all throughout the city, the 6th Street all are welcome protectors of the Holy Angels Church.

The Bozos: When they first appeared, the Bozos were a prankster gang. Biosculpted to look like circus clowns with red bulbous noses, wild red hair, and long flat feet (no, not shoes) and costumed to the part, the Bozos became impromptu slapstick. But soon the Bozos became the ultimate killer clown gang. People living on Bozo turf learned the hard way that if you see a pack of Bozos, just run. Bozos enjoy playing on people's greatest fears: lurking in apartments in the dark, locking victims in small spaces filled with rats, stopping elevators midway and filling them with water. They are *not* funny.

Inquisitors: The Inquisitors are a cult gang; like the hate gangs, they center on a specific ideology, in this case, religious. The Inquisitors think cyberware is blasphemous, and think nothing of tearing it right out of your body. They consider this "saving" your soul. Not only do they believe that cybernetics are "evil," but they also have a war going on with every other gang in the city. *Everyone* hates these guys.

Iron Sights: The Iron Sights are a relatively small, but surprisingly tough, combat gang of borderline cyberpsychos. Once funded by Arasaka, they fell on hard times after the War. But word on The Street is that they have a new benefactor and are once more flexing their Rippers.

Maelstrom: This combat gang formed around the remnants of the old Metal Warriors; a gang virtually wiped out in one night by the Inquisitors. It later drafted members of the Red Chrome Legion and Iron Sights who also had violent personal grudges against the Inquisitors. Post-War, Maelstrom settled another long running feud with a smaller gang of cyberpsychos and began to adopt some of their old rival's meat-hating philosophies, leading to an almost exponential increase in visible and extreme cyberware among gang members. This, in turn, has only increased the number and intensity of the battles between Maelstrom and the Inquisitors.

DATA

Despite years of rumors, no one has ever confirmed the existence of "the Great Bozo", the supposed leader of the Bozos.

DATA

You never know who might be an Inquisitor. They often hide their gang robes when they're doing their day job.

Philharmonic Vampyres: The Vamps are a prankster gang who were dubbed the "Philharmonic Vampyres" a few decades ago when five members clad in tuxedos, capes, and vampire teeth flew up on wires behind the Night City Symphony on Halloween night. Are they artists, hoodlums, or social commentators? Are those teeth part of the costume or not? Who knows?

Piranhas: The Piranhas are a typical party gang. They party, drink Smash, take and deal drugs, and mug people, all as part of a "just because" lifestyle. To these guys, the Party is everything.

The Prime-Time Players: The Players are a poser gang who use biosculpting to look like members of old sitcoms and TV shows from bygone eras. They are an extended family gang which protects their neighborhood and longs for a bygone time. The Players are broken up into a number of different factions based on various shows. They are territorial and fiercely protective of their members.

Reckoners: The Reckoners are one of several apocalyptic cults that sprung up after the War. They roam the streets, preaching the coming Harvest of Souls, recruiting from the homeless, and looking for donations, often taken from your unconscious body. A few are serious crazies who want to evoke the End Times right now with blood and C4.

Red Chrome Legion: The Legion is a neo-fascist hate gang; young people united around various hate group ideologies. Uniforms and militaristic slogans are the rule. The Red Chromers will attack anything that they think isn't "right."

Scavvers: Scavengers aren't a gang per se, but the desperate homeless who squat in the ruined City Zones

left behind by the War. They scour the treacherous debris for salable items such as copper, platinum, old tech, and even abandoned weapons. Many die doing so. Not least of all because these urban battlegrounds have been pretty picked over in the last seventeen years, and scavvers are constantly forced to dig deeper and deeper into unsafe terrain for anything of value.

Steel Vaqueros: A Nomad pack out of Salinas, their ragtag convoys make the coastal highway run from the Santa Cruz agriplots to the southern cities. They take in anyone who displays skill, dependability, and who can keep up. Smart and relatively honest, they have supply deals with several Reclaimer groups in Night City.

Tyger Claws: Once under the thumb of Arasaka, the Tyger Claws have broken away and become a dangerous protector gang for the Asian community of Night City. They have had a significant role in rebuilding the sections of Japan Town after the 4th Corporate War. The Tyger Claws are known for their fast bikes, enhanced reflexes, and killer martial arts.

Voodoo Boys: Major crime contacts in Florida and the Caribbean may have been the beginning of the Voodoo Boys, a terrorist gang with ritual magic overtones, feeding their bizarre tastes by dealing primarily non-synthetic drugs. But that's been changing recently, as real Haitians and other refugees from the decimated Dominican Republic have started to move into the area. These immigrants have taken offense at the so-called Voodoo Boys and have taken to expressing their displeasure by maiming victims and dissecting the dead with machetes, leaving body parts as warnings. Stay tuned.

WHERE'S [GANG X]?

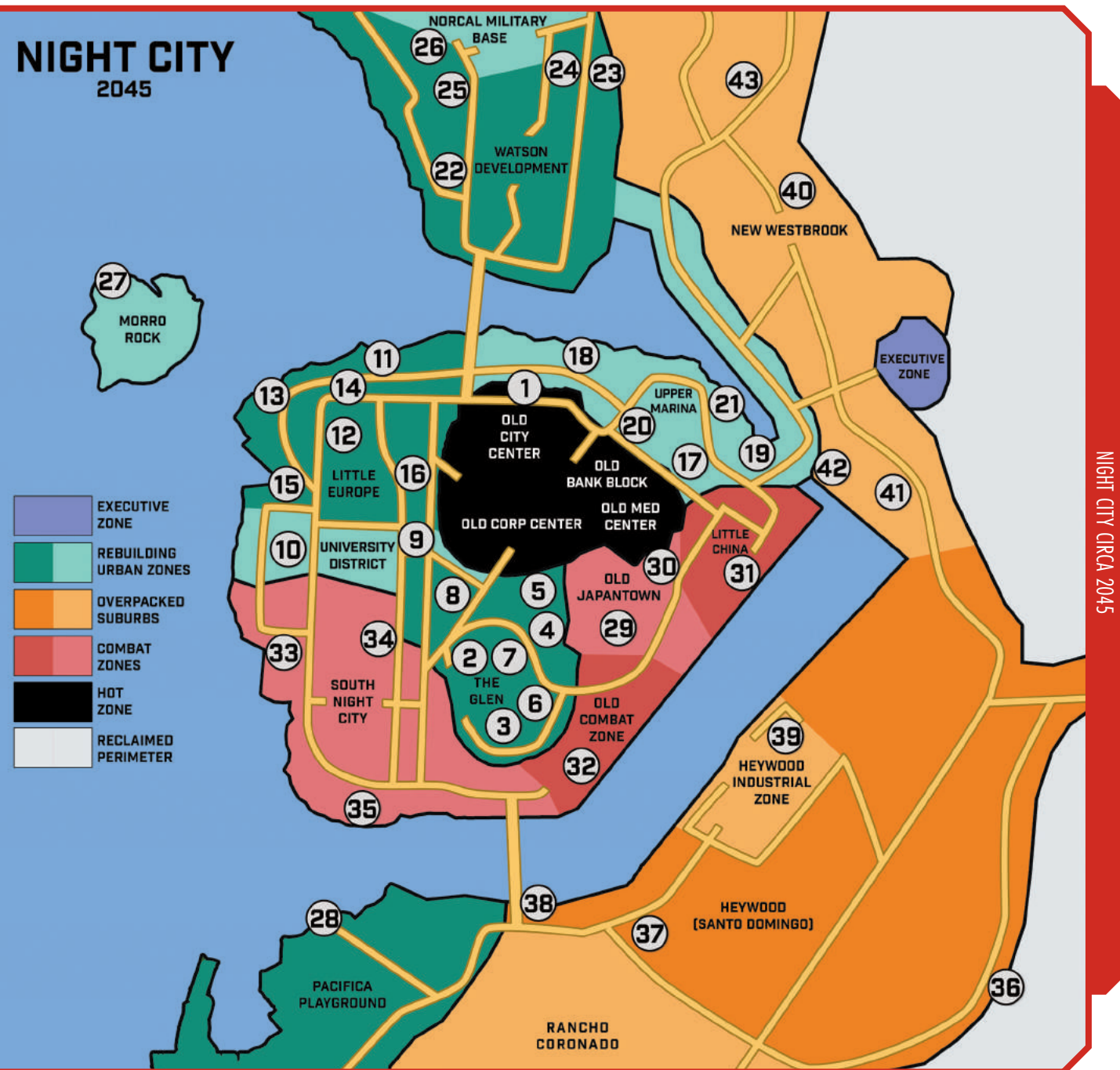
Even before the 4th Corporate War, gangs lived and died in a cycle of bloody violence. It wasn't uncommon for a gang to die after a single orgy of destruction, at the hands of a rival, or as a result of Corporate reprisal.

In the aftermath of the Night City holocaust, a lot of gangs just fell apart in the chaos. The DJs scattered to the wind, a lot of Brainiacs fell victim to R.A.B.I.D.S, and most of the Wild Things died fighting Militech soldiers.

Of course, there's always a chance a survivor's alive to start over again, or a new ganger decides to pick up some cred by adopting an old name and motif.

If you've got a favorite gang from previous editions and you don't see them on this list, feel free to throw them into the mix. Night City's a big place and there's plenty of room for a new gang or two.

WELCOME TO NIGHT CITY



KEY PLACES IN AND AROUND NIGHT CITY

Following are some of the major attractions and locations of Night City.

HOT ZONE

1. **Totentanz:** This bar at the edge of the Hot Zone is well-known as a place to find boostergangs. They all seem to congregate here, but they don't come to dance. It's considered a bad night if the body count is under twenty.

REBUILDING URBAN CENTER

► The Glen ◀

2. **1st Night City Bank:** The main artery of business in Night City. The first floor of the building is a publicly accessible old-school, marble-floored banking institution, complete with friendly bank tellers, and red velvet queue lines. The real money is stored in the vault on the second floor, and between these floors there is restricted access.
3. **City Hall:** The seat of local government in Night City. Despite everything, the number of lobbyists, special interest groups, and government employees buzzing in this location has not decreased.
4. **City Police Precinct #1:** Straddling the line between the Glen and the Combat Zones, Precinct #1 is the first line of defense against the boosters and cyberpsychos of the Combat Zones and they watch that border with an eagle eye and a quick trigger.
5. **Club Atlantis:** A glamorous, multi-level club popular with Execs for its flashy, avant-garde, and disorienting style, highlighted by moving staircases, mirrored walls, and cool cerulean lighting.
6. **Hall of Justice:** The courthouse and jail, an imposing brutalist structure, designed to intimidate with its oversized towers and black steel doors complete with portcullis, was opened to the public on the same day as the neighboring City Hall.
7. **Merrill, Asukaga & Finch Offices:** The Merrill, Asukaga & Finch offices are located in the top floors of a centrally located skyscraper. Access to these floors is restricted to those with an appointment. Generally, they aren't taking new clients, except by referral.
8. **Raven Microcybernetics:** Raven Microcyb's new offices are located in a relatively unadorned corporate skyscraper. While they own the building, their offices only make up the top 10 floors. The rest is dedicated to housing their close business partners.

► University District ◀

9. **Biotechnica Campus:** Biotechnica's offices are found on the edge of the University District. Geodesic dome greenhouses dot the property and its rooftop terraces give it a unique look. One dome is open to the public, as a living museum of natural and company history. Strange sounds can be heard from the campus at night.
10. **Night City University:** A college campus built up into more of a fortified monastery after many assaults by Boosters, NCU is the center of higher learning in the City and the only opportunity for non-Corpo kids to get a higher education.

► Little Europe ◀

11. **Camden Court:** A highly reinforced, ritzy apartment complex on the north side, the Court is favored by Solos for its truly staggering physical and NET security—only a madperson would try to break into Camden Court without a full Corporate assault team.
12. **Continental Brands Offices:** The Continental Brands offices are located in one of Night City's newest skyscrapers. The first few floors house the Oasis Megamart, where you can shop for the most obscure flavors of Kibble, tour the Oasis Test Kitchen, or attend a Cooking with Kibble class. The upper floors are exclusively drab offices and the occasional chemical lab.
13. **Danger Girl Offices:** The Danger Girl offices are found in a stately thirteen story art deco building capped by a decorative clock tower. Inside, you'll find thirteen floors of hot pink shag flooring, stuffed mascot characters, smiling cat girls, model robots, shrines to J-pop groups, and brightly colored guns.

DATA

Some of the Corps are working hard towards a day when Night City has a full central government again. That's why they funded the Glen's construction.

WELCOME TO NIGHT CITY

I KNOW IT'S HARD TO UNDERSTAND
IN A PLACE LIKE NIGHT CITY, KID,
BUT THIS IS A HOLY PLACE. SO,
EITHER RESPECT THE SANCTITY OF MY
CHURCH OR YOU'LL BE RESPECTING THE
SANCTITY OF MY FISTS. YOUR CHOICE.
— FATHER KEVIN

- 14. **Holy Angels Church:** A three story, Roman Catholic church run by Father Kevin, which provides sanctuary and spiritual guidance to anyone who is willing to lay down their weapons and talk peacefully.
- 15. **Night City Firestation #2:** A large, fortified fire station which deploys cybered-up firefighting teams to deal with accidental fires in the Rebuilding Urban Zone and arson cases at the edge of the Combat Zones.
- 16. **Short Circuit:** A favorite haunt of Techs and Netrunners, it's not uncommon to find patrons of this bar hauling wrecked tech in from the Hot Zone to tinker with in the booths—Zhirafa drones at the door keep people from hauling in anything too dangerous.

► Upper Marina ◀

- 17. **City Medical Center:** The City Medical Center is a large research hospital with multiple Corporate ties. Aside from offering medical care to the citizens of Night City, the hospital is also known for offering therapy and biosculpting, assuming you've got the eb of course.
- 18. **McCartney Field Stadium:** A Corporate-sponsored, 75,000-seat stadium home to Night City's many local teams: The Night City Slammers (Baseball), The Night City Rangers (Football), The Night City Heat (Basketball), and The Night City Death Dealers (Combat Soccer).
- 19. **REO Meatwagon Offices:** REO Meatwagon, a small time rival of Trauma Team, has its offices near the Combat Zones. They still practice the questionable business model of "meat jumping", attempting to show up to a Trauma Team call before them to steal the client, charging them out the nose for medical treatment should they survive.
- 20. **The Afterlife:** The premiere Solo bar in Night City, built in the remains of an old morgue on the outskirts of the Hot Zone, and run by the legendary Solo, Rogue. Every Solo in the city dreams of getting a drink at the Afterlife named after them—even if it only happens post-mortem.
- 21. **Ziggurat Offices:** The Ziggurat offices are located in a impressive, curved skyscraper designed to soar above the bay and command attention. Public access is limited to the occasional press conference.

► Watson Development ◀

- 22. **City Police Precinct #3:** A large, well-armed (and often paranoid) precinct, staffed by veteran officers and armed with Militech weaponry to help them keep the peace in the northside of Night City.
- 23. **Petrochem Offices:** Petrochem's offices are located across the street from their bitter corporate rival, SovOil. Aside from a small museum where you can learn about the storied history of petroleum and a gift shop, the compound is heavily defended and inaccessible to the public.

DATA

You can order
a Johnny
Silverhand at
the Afterlife
but, oddly, you
can't order
a Morgan
Blackhand.

24. **SovOil Offices:** SovOil's offices are located across the street from their bitter Corporate rival, Petrochem. While entirely inaccessible to the public, just beyond the gates of the compound, a variety of gaudy gilded statues and monoliths can be seen.
25. **Trauma Team Tower:** The Trauma Team Tower contains their own hospital exclusively for Trauma Team Executive clients, an AV-4 repair bay, and an air traffic control tower to manage the logistical chaos of it all.

► NorCal Military Base ◀

26. **Militech Offices:** Militech's offices in Night City are located on the Norcal Military Base. Access to non-government personnel is restricted. Any meeting held with outsiders is in a secure building that sits between the two security checkpoints.

► Morro Rock ◀

27. **Orbital Air Massdriver:** A tremendous construction site on the Morro Rock, put in place to build the first orbital massdriver in Night City.

► Pacifica Playground ◀

28. **Playland by the Sea:** A Corporate-sponsored amusement park/vacation destination, which features thrilling braindance adventures, amazing theme park rides, Continental Brands food courts, and lots of Corporate security. Much of the park is in constant renovation.

COMBAT ZONES

► Old Japantown ◀

29. **Crisis Medical Center:** A no-questions asked medical center supplied with the most advanced technology and frequented by Edgerunner, Solos, and boosters alike, Crisis Medical is neutral ground for all factions.
30. **Highcourt Plaza Hotel:** A decidedly classy and well-defended hotel nestled between Old Japantown and Little China featuring glass elevators, excellent service, and 1920s decor.

► Little China ◀

31. **The Forlorn Hope:** A small, exclusive Solo bar that caters primarily to veterans from the SouthAm and 4th Corporate Wars, serving as a home away from home to many of the City's most dangerous retired Solos.

► Old Combat Zone ◀

32. **Jesse James' Kosher Deli:** A popular hangout for Nomads and Boosters alike, the deli's really more of a saloon with a nightly body count to rival the Totentanz—but for a small fortune you can get a pretty good corned beef on rye.

► South Night City ◀

33. **Medical Technologies:** A small body bank on the waterfront that has avoided being pushed into the bay by specializing in growing replacement limbs to order as well as supplying cyberware to various boostergangs.

YOUR CITY

There's no rule saying you need to play a game of **Cyberpunk RED** in Night City. You can set your game in Atlanta, Barcelona, Melbourne, Rio de Janeiro, or anywhere else in the world. Your game. Your choice. Make it your own.

There's also no rule saying you have to play in our version of Night City. If you've got an idea for a big Mediacorp to replace Net54, go for it! If you want there to be a popular noodle bar and hot springs in the Upper Marina, grab a marker and doodle it onto the map.

The City you play in, be it Night City or somewhere else, should be a living, breathing place. It should be just as much a Character as any NPC in the game. The best way to do that is to make that city, whatever it is, your own. Use our stuff, sure, but populate it with your own people, your own gangs, your own locations.

Make it your City.

WELCOME TO NIGHT CITY

- 34. **Savage Docs:** A decently sized ripperdoc joint run by the 5 apprentices of the late Savage Doc and protected by the Yakuza and the Tyger Claws.
- 35. **The Slammer:** A popular ganger bar on the southside docks, known for its cinder block arena where boosters from all across the Combat Zones come to settle disputes with heavy fire power and bloody rippers.

OVERPACKED SUBURBS

► Heywood (Santo Domingo) ◀

- 36. **Aldecaldos Camp:** A large, multi-cultural encampment at the edge of the city where the Aldecaldos Nomads run an expansive trade and transport network, hiring themselves out to guide people across the badlands and transport goods just about anywhere.
- 37. **City Police Precinct #2:** A large and overworked police precinct which has to devote more than half its forces to dealing with gangs of scavvers and has come to rely on Zhirafa drones to patrol the vast expanse of the Overpacked Suburbs.
- 38. **MetalStorm:** A nearly indestructible bar, built under the bridge to central Night City, MetalStorm caters to chromers of all shapes and sizes, including a bunch of full body conversions who come to the bar to thrash and get plastered. Almost everything in this bar is solid metal, even the customers.

► Heywood Industrial Zone ◀

- 39. **Zhirafa Office Park:** The Zhirafa offices were built on an existing factory park, building new floors right on top of the existing architecture and breathing new life into old interiors to make room for cozy cafeterias, innovation nooks, and at least one laser tag arena. Drones and animal mecha are often seen patrolling the office park.

► New Westbrook ◀

- 40. **Network 54 Offices:** Even from across the bay, Network 54's public offices are an easily identifiable part of the skyline thanks to the neon 54 on the side of the building. The home of many popular shows taped before live studio audiences, the building is also home to its own clinic, restaurants, rec-center and housing exclusively for its stars, which aren't a part of the tour.
- 41. **Night City Firestation #1:** A well-supplied fire station at the edge of the bay which deploys AVs and firetrucks to fires across the Northern and Southern side of the City.
- 42. **Rocklin Augmentics Campus:** The Rocklin Augmentics offices are on a campus comprised of offices, meeting spaces, a cafeteria, and a hospital, connected via several skybridges to a second much larger concrete building home solely to research and development.
- 43. **WorldSat Offices:** The WorldSat Communications offices are located in New Westbrook atop a ridge which boosts the range of their main communications tower, located on-site. Being located relatively close to the outskirts of Night City, the compound is heavily defended.

THAT'S THE **THIRD** CORP MURDER THIS WEEK!
WHO'S **BRIGHT** IDEA WAS IT TO PUT **SOV OIL**
AND **PETROCHEM** RIGHT **NEXT** TO EACH OTHER?
— OFFICER SURI NAVARRO

DATA

Nomads control a number of points of entry into Night City but the Aldecaldos Camp is where they like to do business.

BY PEDRAM MOHAMMADI



EVERYDAY LIFE IN THE TIME OF THE RED

So, you're just in from the Open Road, neh? You're a Family member and I wouldn't be a good member of the Pack if I didn't take care of a brother. So, let me fill you in on how they do things in Big Bad Night City.

Trace Santiago

STAYING OUT OF TROUBLE

THE LAW

Let's start with the cops (which is the first thing you're gonna need to know in the City). First of all, most are now called Lawmen, since their ambit covers a lot more than the old school City Beat. The Lawmen of the Time of the Red are organized much as they were during the 20th century with Homicide, Vice, Burglary, and Traffic Squads; about 5 men each. The most recent addition to police organization has been the addition of the Cyberpsycho Squad (also known as the Psycho Squad), whose main job is to deal with cybernetic criminals. While the average beat cop hits The Street in an armored squad car, wearing an armor jacket, helmet, and carrying a smart-chipped Minami-10 sidearm, the Psycho Squad detail employs aerogyros, AV-4s, miniguns, assault weapons, and Stinger missile launchers.

City cops can patrol all areas of the city. Corporate Cops are deputized to patrol only corporate facilities. However, in areas where a large number of office areas are huddled together, this effectively can turn an entire downtown region into Corporate Cop territory. Corporate Cops are usually better armed and armored, and often have full Trauma Team medical coverage. They are also more vicious, sadistic, and likely to shoot first—after all, they know the Corporation can cover up any incidents.

There are also Lawmen on the open highways as well. Since a lot of new Reclaimed Cities don't have police forces set up yet, these wandering marshals are much like the range-riding Wyatt Earps of the Old West—hard riding, fast shooting—part of why they are colloquially all lumped under the Old Western/Roaring '20s tag of "Lawmen."

THE LEGALITIES

Skyrocketing crime rates in the 1990s proved the existing legal structure was falling apart. Following the Purge of 1996 (when citizens' groups lynched hundreds of criminal defense lawyers), the government declared martial law throughout the United States for a period of three years. During this time, justice was dispensed by local military courts.

JUSTICE, ARMY STYLE

During the martial law period that began in the late 1990s, the U.S. government looked to military regulations to replace the laws that had previously governed the nation. As a result, the Military Justice Code became the main rule of U.S. law.

The Code's draconian standards of crime and punishment served so well, in the eyes of those in power, that when martial law was suspended the government established a Uniform Civilian Justice Code in its place.

Some loosening of restrictions was seen in the early 2020s but, in the aftermath of the 4th Corp War, the Uniform Civilian Justice Code is once again the law of the land.

Even Night City, which isn't part of the New United States, still bases what laws it actually has on the Uniform Civilian Justice Code. Of course, how much the laws get enforced depends entirely on what part of the City you're in and what your annual income is. Funny how, no matter how harsh the laws get, the rich still manage to get away with murder. Sometimes literally.

CRIME...

Theft, Fraud, and Stealing

If theft is defined as taking something that isn't yours, there's a lot of thieving going on in Night City. Too much to account for, in fact. Stealing gets you food when you're starving, weapons when you're under attack, safe places when you're living in a dumpster, and money to pay other people to cover you when you're not powerful enough to do it for yourself.

If the Lawmen really buckled down and tried to bust every person in Night City who stole something, they'd be at it 24-7. And there just aren't enough Lawmen out there for that.

No, in general, The Street deals with theft in its own way. If you get caught, the only question becomes how bad can the victim mess you up. Sometimes you just get a beating. Sometimes you get hunted down like a dog and flat out killed (assuming the victim doesn't fit in a bit of torture just for laughs before they kill you). If you steal from a Corp, chances are you'll

just end up back on The Street with your frontal lobes burned out or parted out into the local body bank. These things have a way of working out long before any Lawman comes on the scene.

Fraud? Between the bunko rackets and scams, the confidence schemes and creative bookkeeping, fraud is a way of life on The Street. But remember that if your Corp finds out their new Exec is cooking the books or stealing under the table, you're going to only wish you were dead. The Corps are actually pretty legal about these things; they'll hand what's left of you to the authorities ... eventually.

Assuming you get lucky and stand trial for what The Street considers to be a non-issue, you'll be lucky to get off with a little electroflogging, long term exile, or a year or two of braindance. Just sayin'...

► Drugs ◀

Theoretically, narcotics may not be possessed within the premises of the United States. However, bio-engineered plant diseases developed through the 1990s by the Drug Enforcement Agency wiped out 96% of the coca and opium plants in existence, making the point moot. The law also does not cover "designer drugs" such as endorphins, which are defined as medicinal. Besides, you're in Night City. It's not part of the United States anymore, choomba. Smoke 'em if ya got em.

► Rape and Assault ◀

In the Time of the Red, there's not much difference between rape and other physical assaults—at least as far as The Street sees it. If you can't take vengeance on your attacker yourself, there are plenty of Solos or other guns for hire who will gladly find you some Street justice. Most of the time, there's no trial other than what you and your allies can put together, although the Laws will usually take a hand if you ask them; they figure some scav who harms others is probably going to move up to even more heinous crimes sooner or later, so they might as well slam their ass into a cell on the way to a legally sanctioned punishment now.

On the other hand, don't even think about assaulting or raping a Nomad. They usually just drag you behind the nearest vehicle until you're hamburger. You don't even want to guess where they tie the rope.

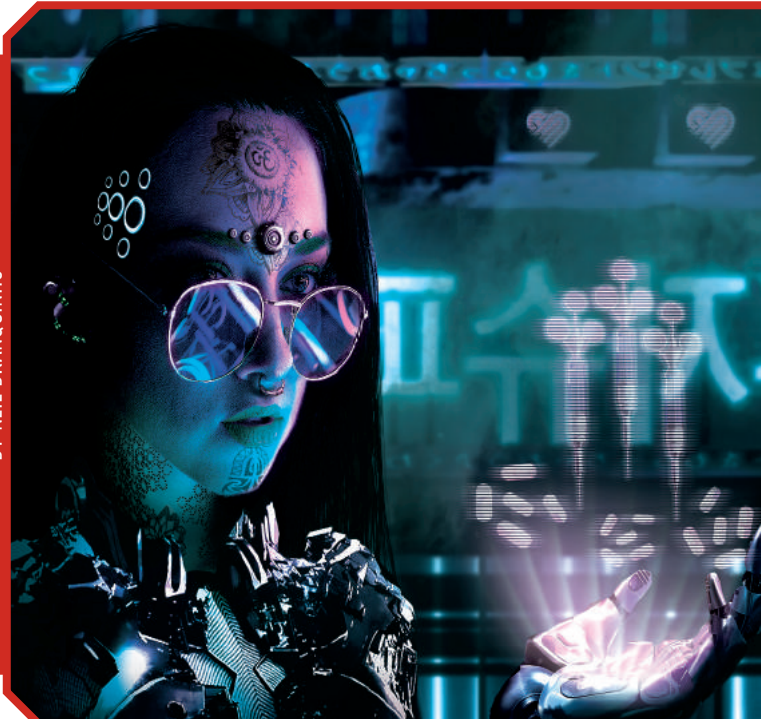
► Murder vs. Self-Defense ◀

Self-defense is defined as "any instance in which the assailant can show just cause that his or her life, or the life of another party, was threatened in circumstances where a duly-appointed officer of the law could not be summoned, or where it was impossible to restrain the injured party by any other means." There is a lot of murder on The Street. Sometimes the Lawmen get involved. Sometimes you can get someone to investigate someone else's murder. But in general, if you have a weapon and they had a weapon, The Street considers it self-defense and whoever died probably deserved it.

...AND PUNISHMENT

Nailed for a Crime? The punishment for criminal actions under the Uniform Justice Code of 1999 are swift, certain, and draconian. Plea bargaining (pleading guilty to a lesser charge to speed up a trial) has been eliminated. Probation is almost unheard of. The death penalty is standard for murder cases—there is a 3-month appeal process during which new evidence can be produced. Most felonies have mandatory prison terms of five to ten years. Lesser crimes are covered by a number of unpleasant forms of punishment that make prison sound pretty good.

BY NEIL BRANQUINHO



► Personality Adjustment ◀

The simplest punishment is personality adjustment—a process which implants an aversion to committing the crime ever again. Adjustment has some nasty side effects, including exaggerated fears of situations and events related to the crime (such as a terror of money based on an anti-robbery adjustment).

► Electroflogging ◀

Unless you're into serious S&M action, you're not going to enjoy this one. Being tied to a large X-shaped cross while the State Executioner (or the local equivalent) tears your back apart with an electrified metal whip is probably something you're not going to enjoy. Ten lashes are usually enough to kill most people. But for minor crimes, you'll probably get off with only three.

► Exile ◀

Exile implants are keyed to a transmission signal broadcast through the city phone NET. If the offender enters the city, the implant causes excruciating pain. The offender is effectively exiled from ever entering that specific city again. Repeat offenses in other cities simply cause additional city codes to be added to the implant. After enough crimes in enough cities, the offender will be unable to enter civilization again.

► Prison Blues ◀

Prisons of the 2000s are horrendously overcrowded and deadly. After the riots of the '90s, prison authorities couldn't care less about rehabilitation—they're mostly interested in penning up society's "mad dogs" and keeping the streets clear. Most prisoners are relegated to Low Security Blocks.

Low Security Blocks are containment facilities for petty criminals and those convicted of moderate offenses. Prisoners often share cells with one or more other prisoners.

In many ways, Low Security facilities are very similar to prisons of the late 20th century. They're staffed by prison guards, either private or Corporate, who will not hesitate to shoot criminals who become a nuisance. Most prisoners are short-term; long-term prisoners can become Trustees and may even

be deputized and allowed access to non-lethal weapons if their psych reports permit this. Low Security inmates are often required to work diligently at menial tasks. This can be likened to the chain gangs of long ago, where prisoners were worked so hard that they didn't have the energy to cause trouble. Some Low Security facilities maintain dormitories instead of cells.

Then there's Top Security. Top Security provides containment facilities for the baddest offenders. Most are locked down almost all of the time. Interpersonal interactions between inmates is forbidden. You do time in Top and you're on your own—for the duration. Automated sentries guard perps around the clock and no infringement of security is allowed—under penalty of death. Inmates come into contact with guards and other authorized personnel only when undergoing treatment of some kind.

► Braindance ◀

To cope with overcrowding, many prisons force inmates into "braindance"—they are placed in cryotanks, wired to interface loop programs, and "shut down" for periods of two or three years. Continuous braindance creates a nightmare of unending, bland horror, making it the thing cons fear most. Although Braindance therapy is often a common component of a criminal's sentence, most will do *anything* to avoid it.

Although the body is cooled and no physical exertion is possible, the perp's mind is fully active for the duration of the session. All they can really "see" is the endless blackness of total sensory deprivation. Fifteen years or more of this will cause even the most hardened perp to beg for a different sentence. But guards are on hand to deal with any difficulties that may arise from this.

Braindance is also seen as an excellent way of getting difficult prisoners out of the way in lieu of executions (which are not always good for public relations).

► Bang—You've Got Justice ◀

The simplest method of punishment is still execution. Most states have a State Executioner who administers justice with one well-placed .44 slug at point-blank range. They are also empowered to hunt down escapees from Death Row.

DATA

All this is assuming you even make it to prison. A lot of security forces shoot first and fill out fatal incident reports later.

HOW YOU STAY IN TOUCH

MEET YOUR AGENT

In the Time of the Red, the cell phone of the 2000s has been replaced by a device a generational step beyond its predecessors. Even back in 2013, cellphones could make calls, record information, take pictures, and record music. Some could even download movies and TV. But the Agent is the new tech solution and goes a lot further than simply taking your calls.

► Agent AI ◀

What makes your Agent unique is its Self-Adaptive AI (SAAI)—the programming that operates your Agent. It's not a true AI, but rather a set of interlocking programs that manage data and "learn" how to do things by interacting with its owner. This allows the Agent to manage your life—to make sure you have the time to do what you need instead of going to the store or washing the laundry.

► What Your Agent Can Do ◀

Let's start with basic "phone" functions. Sure, you can use your Agent to make phone calls in voice, or flatscreen. You can record your calls, forward them, or even put them on answer mode. But why stop there? Like a real agent, your Agent can also manage your calls. If you're trying to locate a person, your Agent will not only scan the local Data Pool to get their location from their Agent but can also place the call for you. If you don't have time to talk, it can generate a realistic talking headshot of you compiled from the times you've used it; the headshot can deliver messages or act as an answering machine. Your Agent can also screen your calls, tailoring the headshot's response to each caller as needed (nice for a client, nasty for a solicitor) and telling you what's been done in each case, using one of the hundreds of possible downloadable "voices" it can access for itself.

Finally, your Agent can send or receive text messages as well as download screamsheet (news) updates keyed to particular subjects you want to keep track of.

DATA

Need to buy an Agent? Check out **PAGE 351.**

A lot of people also use old-fashioned flip phones. They're cheap, making them easy to dump if you're worried about being traced.

BY RICHARD BAGNALL



► Getting Personal ◀

Your Agent is also your backup memory. Not only can it keep appointments for you like an organizer, but it can act on them. Let's say you have an anniversary. Tell the Agent the person and date. Not only will it remind you, but you can set it up to scan its personal data base on the person in question and use the data to pick out a gift. It'll ask you ahead of time if the gift would be acceptable; if it is, the Agent orders the gift, pays for it out of your cred account, and has it delivered to the recipient—all via the Data Pool. Your Agent also acts as a portable "farley file"—compiling information about the people you associate with, either by noting your interactions with them, or by interrogating their Agents to ask for data (like phone numbers or personal preferences).

► Let's Get Even More Personal ◀

Your Agent doesn't have to be a lifeless tool. With upgrades, you can give it a surrogate personality with a name, voice, and even a avatar in the form of a face and body. You can call it by name, ask it to do things, or even set it to call you and talk to you as though it were a real person. Some lonely souls stationed on distant transport runs or orbital stations have been known to reprogram their Agents to act as surrogate lovers as well as personal assistants (with the aid of specific cybernetically driven "enhancements" to meet very specific needs).

► Database ◀

Need information? Forget using a Data Term. Your Agent has autonomous search functions that let it do research for you. Ask your Agent to find you information on a topic, and it cruises the Data Pool looking for facts. It can compile those facts into a simplified report format (you choose the report parameters) that can be delivered through text, graphics, or voice. Your Agent can also scan the Data Pool to locate a person, place, or thing. You can tell it to display the result as a map, a GPS guide, or a vocal file.

► Lifestyle Manager ◀

Your Agent can be linked to most of the appliances in your Conapt. It talks to your fridge and your cupboards to ask them if you need food; if you're running out of items on your shopping list it can be set to order

more supplies and have them delivered to your door. It even talks to the toilet paper roller to make sure you never run out. You can hook your Agent up to talk to your clothes—the digital fabric tells your Agent when it's getting worn out, lets the Agent know what it is, where it was purchased, and from where to order a replacement. You can hook your Agent into most of the devices in your life: if your fancar needs maintenance, it'll schedule an appointment with the mechanic; if your weapons need cleaning or repairs, it'll tell you that, too. The Agent even monitors your body signs if you ask; if you're wounded, it can scan your body and call the Trauma Team if you link it to a Biomonitor.

► Entertainment ◀

Your Agent is also your main entertainment conduit. Forget about lugging around those old-school music players, MPEG pods, or entertainment dataslivers. Your Agent can store thousands of hours of programming: music, video, movies, games. It can display them on its own onboard LCD or automatically seek out any unused video/audio screen in the area and project its programming through that. With digital fabrics, it can even project your favorite entertainment onto your clothes.

Your Agent takes note of the entertainment programs you watch; after the second time you watch, your Agent will automatically download future episodes for you from the DP. It'll also keep track of similar kinds of programs and flag a sample episode for you to watch. And if its storage memory gets overloaded, it can automatically download unused data into backup memory modules (which it can buy and have delivered to your Conapt) where it can access them at any time.

► What Your Agent Can Carry ◀

While not fully functional computers, Agents do have access to many computer program functions as well. They can word process using voice or a Virtuality keyboard, downloading the output to Data Pool or a hardcopy printer. They can record images in 2- or 3D (depending on the model) and upload the images to the Data Pool. Onboard programs can be used to mix music, create special effects, even generate CGI imagery. With links to flop-screens and music synths, you can even use an Agent to play a gig.

DATA

Feel free to assign your Agent a name and even a personality. They can make fun NPCs during a game!

DATA

Ziggurat's Ask Alex Anything app is specially designed to work with Agents for Data Pool searches.

In short, having an Agent is like having a personal secretary equipped with a phone, TV, recording studio, entertainment system, computer, medical alert button, personal organizer, and online shopping service all in a box about the size of a pack of cigarettes.

► Agency and Data Pool Links ◀

But all this power isn't much use without a hookup, neh? And that means Agency. You'll need a service provider to sell you that Agency-connectivity. No one company owns connectivity; there are millions of providers and new ones rezzing in every day. They put up a few wireless nodes and link cheater software into the existing nodes that are already active. No one owns all the nodes, but since every new node simply increases the reach, existing providers are happy to let new guys link in. The cost of your Agency is included in any Lifestyle.

WHAT YOU'RE PACKING

By 1997, even the most well-intentioned gun-control statutes were buried under a wave of public protest as crime rates made America a siege state. Self-defense soon became an American lifestyle, and there was an explosive increase in light personal protection weapons.

By 1999, most gun-control statutes involved 1) filling out a "carry application" allowing you to carry a concealed handgun; 2) waiting four days for an extensive background check and approval, which could be refused on the basis of a criminal record or history of mental illness; and 3) paying the 25eb fee and having a serial number laser etched into the butt of the gun. This number is cataloged with the ballistics firing pattern of your weapon at FBI/CIA Headquarters in Washington D.C.

Everyone pretty much ignores all of the above.

THE RULES

The Federal Weapons Statute of 1999 states that if a gun with your ID number is used in the commission a crime, you are liable for that crime unless you have previously reported the weapon as lost or stolen and have had this report filed with your local police agency.

Under the provisions of the Federal Weapons Statute, it is not legal to carry submachine guns and other fully automatic weapons; possession carries a stiff five- to seven-year mandatory prison sentence. Not that this stops anyone.

GETTING THE GOODS

Where do you get weapons? There aren't any Militech showrooms these days. But any decent Fixer can hook you up at the local Night Market. There are a ton of options—after all, there was a war just a few years ago—but you'll have to take potluck. Who knows? You might score an old Malorian, or a classic wheellock.

OLD GUNS STILL WORK

There are still more than enough used models of venerable Berettas and Webleys for sale (particularly in Night Markets), and large numbers of "obsolete" weapons can be found at reasonable prices in any pawn shop. The tough part is finding ammunition; most modern guns are now caseless and if you have an old gun, you're going to have to load your own.

MILITARY SURPLUS

One result of massive conventional war spanning five continents is that in the end there's going to be a lot of surplus and abandoned hardware just lying around. Handguns, rifles, fully automatic weapons, handheld missile launchers, flamethrowers—you're going to be spoiled for choice. If your Fixer can find it, you can probably buy it—and get the caseless ammo that fits it to boot.

MODERN STUFF

While there's a certain panache in using an old model sidearm like a Colt .357 or .45, the sensible Cyberpunk knows that a modern pistol makes a good backup. Since the introduction of the Glock 17 automatic in the mid-1980s, most major handgun manufacturers now produce polymer resin pistols in a variety of calibers.

POLYMER ONE-SHOTS

The most ubiquitous of these weapons are the various models of polymer plastic handguns (Poor Quality Pistols). Easily created using 3D printing, they're cheap

and available even from some Vendit machines. Manufactured in a variety of bright, designer colors, these so-called "Polymer One-Shots" come with easy-to-load caseless ammunition, retail at cheaper prices and are available in most Oasis Convenience stores. They combine practicality, durability, and style in potent little packages. The now dated Cyberteen™ line includes airbrushed casings with colorful shapes and artwork molded right in—the perfect gift for the young consumer interested in personal defense.

AMMO

No matter the type, most modern guns are primarily designed to use a specific class of ammunition based on the size of the gun. These are grouped by firepower: Light (equivalent to 6mm), Medium (9mm), Heavy (11mm), and Very Heavy (12mm) types. Generally, rifles fire a standardized round (based on the 7.62x39mm), allowing almost any local Tech to produce ammunition as needed.



BY HUNTANG

HOW YOU GET AROUND

Surprise, surprise. Contrary to expectations, the Dark Future has not yielded any staggering new developments in transportation. Years of economic strife and civil unrest have discouraged research into new ways to travel—in fact, the very act of travel has become very restricted. Don't expect the inner-city world of the Time of the Red to be much like the 20th century—a network of crowded freeways, packed trains, and swarming airports. Instead, think of it as a patchwork of badly up-kept roads, abandoned airports, and trains plagued by gangs and intermittent service.

GROUND TRANSPORT

► GROUND CARS

Various manufacturers

- **Powerplant:** CHOOH^2 or methane-fueled internal combustion
- **Top Groundspeed:** 100 to 300 MPH, depending on model
- **Structural Damage Points:** 50
- **Cost:** Varies depending on model

There haven't been any major changes in automobiles since the 1980s—externally. Most cars are still basically a box on wheels, with smooth or hard edges. The Cyberpunk ethos being, "If it works, keep it til it doesn't work." In the cash poor environment of the 2000s, auto manufacturers have kept to conservative, unimaginative designs, so that by today the average family car is little changed from its practically antique roots.

With the extremely high price of petroleum, almost all cars of the 2000s are powered by tanks of liquefied methane or meta-alcohol fuels such as CHOOH^2 . Electric cars are the exception, not the rule, simply because the infrastructure for rapid charging is non-existent.

► CYBERCARS

Cybercar control systems are roughly like those of the late 20th century but employ a few more digital displays and push-button controls. In addition to

control, most cars offer cybernetic control systems. These systems employ servos at the wheels, throttle, and transmission, which are controlled by a modified cybermodem in the dash.

The driver simply "studs" their Interface Plugs into the cybermodem and thinks the car through the motions. Vehicles without external controls are relatively uncommon, as the removal of external controls renders the vehicle useless to anyone but a cybered driver. So far, no major manufacturer has produced a purely cyber-driven automobile, although there are several after-market firms which will convert a car purely to cyber control.

► CYBERBIKES

Various manufacturers

- **Powerplant:** CHOOH² or hydro-fueled internal combustion
- **Top Groundspeed:** 100 to 300 MPH, depending on model
- **Structural Damage Points:** 35
- **Cost:** Varies depending on model

There's a huge number of bikes and trikes out there these days as well. Most are hydro or CHOOH² fueled. Models include Kundalini, Harlon-Dawson, Zondo, and Toyo-Tomo.

SEA TRANSPORT

► SPEEDBOATS

Various manufacturers

- **Powerplant:** CHOOH² or hydro-fueled internal combustion
- **Top Surface Speed:** 60 MPH
- **Structural Damage Points:** 50
- **Cost:** 30,000eb (Super Luxury)

Any one of a number of small, light, mono-hulled performance craft designed for smuggling, rescue, law enforcement ops, piracy, or (rarely) water-skiing. Hulls are made primarily of a flexible dense polymer with titanium reinforcement. Common upgrades include onboard machine guns and other heavy weapons.

► OTEC HAMMERHEAD MULTIPURPOSE MINISUB

- **Powerplant:** Battery, CHOOH² propulsion
- **Top Surface Speed:** 15 MPH (10 MOVE)
- **Top Submerged Speed:** 60 MPH (20 MOVE)
- **Structural Damage Points:** 100
- **Crew:** 3-8

The Hammerhead is an example of most "taxi" subs used throughout the oceans. Employed as a long-range shuttlesub, it was never intended for combat and has a notoriously "dirty" silhouette which makes it easy to spot on sonar. Still, it is functional and flexible, with two onboard Pseudo-AIs to assist the pilot and crew in their tasks.

Despite its apparent lack of combat utility, some have been armed with twin rocket pods and pushed into the fray as stop-gap patrol subs. Those who pilot these "torp-tubs" have developed a standard tactic of firing their torpedoes at any hostile bogey as soon as it enters their weapon's maximum range. They then turn and run back to their bases, avoiding any possible close encounter with undoubtedly better-equipped foes.

AIR TRANSPORT

► GYROCOPTERS

Various manufacturers

- **Powerplant:** CHOOH²-powered rotary aircraft engine
- **Operational Radius:** 50 Miles
- **Top Airspeed:** 100 MPH
- **Structural Damage Points:** 35.
- **Cost:** 20,000eb (Super Luxury)

The riots of the late '90s required new tactics for operating in urban areas. Chief among these was the introduction of light, low passenger helicopters or "gyrocopters."

Currently used by police units, Corporate defense teams, Solo assault operations teams, and drug-running gangs. Unarmed versions are popular as recreational vehicles.

DATA

To find out how
Vehicle Combat
works see
PAGE 189.

► HELICOPTERS

Various manufacturers

- **Powerplant:** CHOOH²-powered turboshaft engine gas turbine
- **Operational Radius:** 600 Miles
- **Top Airspeed:** 200 MPH
- **Structural Damage Points:** 60
- **Cost:** 50,000eb (Super Luxury)

Most helicopters mount two large, wide-propped engine nacelles at the ends of long, high-lift wings. The engines can be tilted from a forward-facing direction to a vertical position, allowing the aircraft to take off and hover vertically. The wings can also be folded back along the body for easy storage, making them a perfect vehicle to launch from rooftop helipads and airstrips.

A revolutionary concept when it was unveiled in 1988, the tilt rotor aircraft has become a standard vehicle throughout the 2000s. The military version served with distinction throughout the riots of the '90s and the Central American Conflicts. Various civilian manufacturers have licensed the tilt-rotor design and applied it to smaller commercial and business applications.

Helicopters are used as commuter vehicles for trips between city centers and hub airports, or as Corporate aircraft operating from rooftop pads atop starscrapers. Small versions such as the AE-800 Featherlite are popular light aircraft throughout the world, allowing flight operations in even the most remote and unprepared sites.

► AV-4 MULTIPURPOSE AERODYNES

Various manufacturers

- **Powerplant:** Single vectored thrust turbofan
- **Operational Radius:** 400 Miles
- **Top Airspeed:** 200 MPH
- **Structural Damage Points:** 100
- **Price:** 50,000eb (Super Luxury)

The nearest thing to a science-fiction jet-car, the AV-4 was originally developed as a light assault aircraft capable of operation in close urban areas where

rotary and tiltwing aircraft cannot penetrate. Short, bulbous, and equipped with only rudimentary maneuver wings, the AV-4 has the aerodynamic characteristics of a rock, relying on the brute force of its huge jet engine to keep it aloft (the original engine lifted a 19,550 lb. jumpjet, while a fully loaded AV-4 weighs about 8,600 lbs).

The AV-4 is used by police or Corporate troops for urban assault after being upgraded with a belly-mounted onboard machine gun. They are also used as emergency vehicles by the Trauma Team, and as Corporate vehicles for making special deliveries. The most common upgrade made to an AV-4 is to armor its chassis.

► AV-9 SUPER AERODYNES

Various manufacturers

- **Powerplant:** Twin vectored thrust turbofans
- **Operational Radius:** 400 Miles
- **Max Airspeed:** 300 MPH
- **Structural Damage Points:** 60
- **Cost:** 100,000eb (Super Luxury)

A relatively recent development of the AV class, these are smaller aerodynes designed to fulfill the role of a sports car, with twin vectored thrust turbofans mounted in heavily armored side housings. In addition to the increase in thrust provided by the second fan, the reduction in weight gained from its minimal cabin allows the AV-9 to scream through the air at extreme speeds. They are primarily purchased for recreation by the wealthy, but a select few on the street have found their own uses for them.

ORBITAL TRANSPORT

► DELTA 4 SPACEPLANE

- **Powerplant:** Batteries, Hi-Lox fuel cells
- **Top Airspeed:** Mach 6
- **Structural Damage Points:** 40
- **Crew:** 1-2

A holdover from the 4th Corp War, Deltas are high-speed, suborbital spaceplanes designed for combat and interception. They usually have two engines: a

normal supersonic jet for reaching an altitude of 35,000 m/yds, and a solid-fueled rocket engine for boosting into orbit. Occasionally, deltas are carried piggyback by larger jet aircraft, or boosted into orbit by using disposable rockets. They can also be carried aboard deep space craft.

Once in orbit, deltas use maneuver thrusters to move in on orbital targets. Well-armed with twin smart rocket pods, deltas must strike quickly and then use their remaining fuel to reenter safely. Deltas are exceedingly rare; the EuroSpace Agency only had around 24, but recently discoveries of hidden space-plane attack wings stashed in remote airbases in the U.S. and the EuroTheatre have made them available to the most well-heeled Execs and Nomad Families through world-class Fixers.

MEGA VEHICLES FOR MAXIMUM TRANSPORT

► LIGHT RAIL LEV TRAIN

Various manufacturers

- **Powerplant:** Electric third rail inductance field
- **Top Groundspeed:** 300 MPH (60 MOVE)
- **Structural Damage Points:** 100 per train car

Superconductor magnets have made it possible to build extremely cheap and durable "levitation trains." Riding on magnetic cushions, these "levs" have become one of the major transportation resources in the 2000s. Financed by Corporations or city governments, they are present in most major cities.

Levs are usually built underground within city limits, and run on high pillars out in the suburbs. Usually one line, headed out to the Executive Zone, is sealed off and requires an entry pass to get onto. Corporate lev stations are always clean, well-lit, and well-guarded by Corporate security. City lev stations are usually not up to these standards, although most cities run police patrols on the line to control crime and vandalism.

Lev tickets are charged at a rate of 1eb per station passed; a trip passing through three stations, for example, would cost 3eb. Tickets may be purchased from automatic ticket machines using cash. These machines are located in the stations themselves and in local convenience store outlets.

► CINO RELACS CARGO SUB

- **Powerplant:** Battery, CHOOH² propulsion
- **Top Surface Speed:** 15 MPH (10 MOVE)
- **Top Submerged Speed:** 60 MPH (20 MOVE)
- **Structural Damage Points:** 300
- **Crew:** 6-36

This cargo sub is perhaps the closest thing that any Nomad group will ever own that could hope to compare to the big governmental "boomers." Over one hundred m/yds long and more than ten decks high, the CINO cargo sub is the largest cargo submersible currently in production, and is always operated by a full Nomad clan. Designed by the Russians of the Neo-Sov, and affectionately known as the Really Exceptionally Large Cargo Sub (RELaCS), it is a fifty-year-old design that was refitted for the 2040s and beyond. A smooth hull layered with sound absorption tiles and oversized caterpillar drives makes the RELaCS an amazingly quiet sub (considering its size). Despite the ship's mass, it has a small crew and can be operated by only 6 people (depending heavily on its automated systems). Features include quad rocket pods and a Minisub bay, which these days typically houses a Hammerhead.

► K151 AEROZEP

- **Powerplant:** CHOOH² or hydro-fueled internal combustion
- **Top Airspeed:** 100 MPH (20 MOVE)
- **Structural Damage Points:** 300
- **Crew:** 2-36

Based on the pre-War U.S. Army's popular Overlord design, this Aerozep is now used primarily as a cargo hauler, redesigned to move up to ten cargo modules between staging areas. They are the primary heavy lift transports for aerial-based Nomad Families, and do not operate anywhere near a potential Combat Zone; they are always kept as far away as operationally possible, guarded by several fast-strike combat AVs or air-superiority fighters. The K151 can be piloted with a crew of 2, although this is rare; usually a K151 is the primary workhorse of a single Nomad Family with upwards of 30 people onboard, or sometimes more when cargo is not being carried.

HOW YOU GET THE WORD

DATA TERM

The **Data Term** is a street corner computer terminal, built into a heavily armored concrete post. Data Terms have a direct NET link to a central Data Term service in their home city and can provide maps of the area, information, news updates, phone numbers, current events, entertainment information, and shopping services. Data Terms may also be used to jack into the Data Pool. Rates are about 10eb (Cheap) per minute. Most Data Terms are operated by Ziggurat or a local DT service, which is often a subsidiary of a local newspaper or screamsheet publisher.

SCREAMSHEETS

To stay competitive with television, most newspapers now use digital technology. Entire pages are typeset and laid out by computer, photos scanned into place, and the entire newspaper reduced to digital code. This code is transmitted to hundreds of newspaper boxes all over the area. The newsboxes reassemble the code and print the paper (using high speed replication) on the spot. The result is a slick, flimsy newspaper known in streetslang as a **screamsheet**.

Screamsheets have many advantages over previous newspapers. You can dial the newsbox to print only the sections of the paper you want, paying 0.1eb per page printed. New editions can be compiled in hours, allowing the public to keep abreast of a story even as it happens (although most screamsheets are updated at 6:00 a.m., 12:00 p.m., 5:00 p.m. and 10:00 p.m.).

In addition, you can download a screamsheet to your Agent.

Top of the News Screamsheet Headline Generator

Top of the news gives you the biggest screamsheet headlines in a four-hour time period:

1d6	1	2	3	4	5	6
Category	International	National	State	Local	Financial	Gossip
Screamsheet Headlines (roll 1d10, or choose, on each column)						
1	(Pick A Corp)	Offers		Corporations		
2	Senator	Threatens		City		
3	President	Compromises		Compromise		
4	Corporation(s)	Murders		Warning		
5	City Council	Killed		Plan		
6	Cyberpsycho	Dies		Scandal		
7	Killer	Praises		Woman		
8	Slayer	Announces		Man		
9	Tragic	Reveals		Accident		
10	Investigators	Continues		Hope		

DATA

You can find examples of screamsheets (and the missions that come with them) starting on PAGE 425

NEW MEDIACORPS

Mediacorps provide CGI or live action "shows" featuring variety, drama, comedy, etc. A New Mediacorp can be a huge multi-city operation, or as small as a dozen talented artists, techs, and producers.

INDEPENDENTS AND MEDIAS

Independents and Medias provide news, gossip, vid and braindance shows, investigative reporting, and commentary on current events. They also provide the format for most "talk" shows, as well as documentaries and informational programming—equivalent to the news anchors of the past.

THE DATA POOL

What makes PopMedia possible is the Data Pool—a Citywide LAN network that links the Red world together in lieu of the old NET. Usually built and maintained by Ziggurat, each City has its own version of a Data Pool, requiring the user to set up an account in order to log on and use its facilities.

Data Pools are also limited with their LAN structure, a requirement in a world where rampant NET sabotage is the rule—a hardwired system just doesn't have the same flexibility.

Since the Data Pool is an open-ended database, anyone can readily drop new PopMedia programming into it, with new entries easily found by Agent search functions. Getting a new PopMedia download is as easy as clicking a link—and once you've loaded it into your Agent once, it'll keep downloading that media (or similar ones) until you say stop. PopMedia is also flexible and viral—since the Data Pool has integrated feedback, this means that it can track how many times a program is accessed and react accordingly.

A PopMedia program may start out only occupying one time slot, but as subscribers mount and word gets around, it may end up dominating a huge percentage of the overall possible bandwidth. This also means that competing shows often find themselves battling for bandwidth, with small outfits going toe-to-toe (and gun-to-gun) with the giant Mediacorps that still remain.

WHAT YOU WEAR

Digital fabric integrates micro-circuitry into the weave of material, allowing the material to have other properties than mere adornment and protection. Others have heating or cooling abilities to alleviate the summer heat or winter chill. Most buttons and zippers incorporate microcomputers to control these functions.

CLOTHES IN THE DARK FUTURE

- Know if they are ripped or dirty and can report this information to Agents or other readouts. Their "tags" not only contain cleaning and wear data, but also manufacturer's codes, order numbers, and sizes. The Agent can then order replacement clothing based on this data.
- Can adapt themselves to minor temperature changes by monitoring your body temp and tightening /relaxing the weave to let air in or out.
- Can change color or project 2D images on the cloth itself.

DATA

To learn more about Ziggurat, check out their Corporate listing on

PAGE 280.

BY NEIL BRANQUINHO



STYLES OF THE DARK FUTURE

In the Time of the Red, clothing is wildly varied. You take what you can get and sometimes even the biggest bankroll can't score you that cool cyberjacket (with the lighted collar) that you're drooling over. Even so, fashion tends to follow trends, most of which we have listed here; each style tells other people on The Street about the kind of image you project.

Fashion Trend	Style and What it Says About You
Bag Lady Chic	Homeless Ragged Vagrant
Gang Colors	Dangerous Violent Rebellious
Generic Chic	Standard Colorful Modular
Bohemian	Folksy Retro Free-Spirited
Leisurewear	Comfort Agility Athleticism
Nomad Leathers	Western Rugged Tribal
Asia Pop	Bright Costume-like Youthful
Urban Flash	Flashy Technological Streetwear
Businesswear	Leadership Presence Authority
High Fashion	Exclusive Designer Couture

WHAT YOU EAT

Pollution, toxic waste, and wanton resource stripping has left many croplands barren and many food staples are either endangered or outrageously expensive. America's response has been to create processed substitutes for whatever it needs. The patents for much of this technology are owned by Continental Brands.

SYNTHFOOD

Kibble

Kibble is the standard base-line food product. It is a mass-produced nutrient made primarily of kelp, plankton, and soy proteins (none of this "Kibble is people!" drek) that fulfills most nutritional requirements, but smells and tastes about as good as its canine namesake. Neocorps often dispense this to laborers as part of their "support" programs (of course, the cost is deducted from their pay). Most people in the urban zones have at least one meal a day of kibble, but try to have something with more variety as their main meal, if they can afford it.



BY EVE VENTRUE

► Prepack ◀

The next step up is Prepack: meals that can be microwaved or self-heated. They still tend to be largely soy and grain-based "faux food," but they are usually flavored more effectively and may have a few bits of real meat or veggies in there. Good Prepack has a higher percentage of natural food and is rather like restaurant fare, just in a bag. You press the tab and it's "heat and eat." A Prepack diet is significantly more expensive than kibble with Good Prepack pushing up the price still higher. Prepack is far more common in Executive and wealthy homes; if you want Prepack in Edgerunner turf, you'd better head out to a restaurant, choomba.

FRESH FOOD

Fresh food had always been standard fare for the City elite and a rare luxury for the average person, although some groups had an advantage in this area as they were living in environments where the food was processed.

► Guerrilla Gardening ◀

But right after the War, getting any kind of food into the Cities (and past the raiding gangs, the warring Megacorps, and the issues of just plain transportation) was nearly impossible. Faced with starvation, many Edgerunners suddenly developed green thumbs—tearing up previously abandoned lots and revealing the soil beneath—and transporting the materials to make rooftop gardens and water sprinkler systems powered by the intermittent rains. Within a couple years post-War, there were a lot of gardening sites that were small, carefully tended, and feeding the populations of local Conapts and neighborhood squats. It was actually good food for a change (if you didn't mind the radioactivity and toxic waste traces).

► Killing for Cabbages ◀

This didn't go unnoticed by the non-farming communities ... like the Boosters, gogangers, and anyone else not particularly interested in raising crops. Savage wars broke out over food-growing areas, with the body counts growing (only to be reprocessed into fertilizer when possible). Whole neighborhoods armed up and started patrolling their Upper Forties, ready to maim and kill anyone who had a hankering to steal a tomato.

► Meet the Meat ◀

Things got even more heated when some enterprising farmers began raising real chickens, dwarf pigs, and even goats (cows are still rare). Herds were shipped under Nomad protection with a heavy Solo element, creating a new form of "cattle drive." Needless to say, there were attempts to rustle the range that ended up with many of the rustlers buried in the Night City equivalent of Boot Hill.

► The Market Price ◀

In the Time of the Red, things have died down a little. A tentative detente was reached, especially between the Growers and certain Neocorps. In exchange for some heavy security, the Growers traded fresh food, and both sides profited. This does not always hold up, however and there are still raids on individual city farms and rooftop gardens that come too close to the Oasis Markets operated by Continental Brands.

HOW YOU HAVE FUN

BROADCAST

No longer as pervasive a force in the Time of the Red, television has moved into the lowest level of mass entertainment. Far fewer channels crowd the airwaves, and most are various cable and subscriber channels limited to a single city or to small audiences of cities within a few hundred miles of each other. These cover everything including sports, news, music videos, old movies, foreign shows, religious programming, debate, erotic and adult programming, business news, and weather. In addition, there are still many single-band pirate radio stations scattered throughout the post-War world.

NETWORK PROGRAMMING

In the Euro and Asian theaters, most programming is still state-controlled—the BBC in Great Britain and NGK TV in Japan—for example. In the United States, three privately owned entertainment networks dominate: recent arrival New Century Broadcasting (NCB), World Broadcasting Network (WBN), and Network News 54. These networks are the broadcast divisions of three massive entertainment conglomerates, each

DATA

Cloning is still too expensive a process to make cloned meat a viable food for the masses.

DATA

For data on Network 54, one of the biggest broadcasters around, see **PAGE 274**

producing data chips, games, streaming content, videos, movies, and books for the masses. The product is bland, mindless, and caters to the lowest possible denominator. With the collapse of the NET and the Sat Nets, however, network programming faces fierce competition from new entertainment forms, such as the Data Pool and PopMedia.

SATFEEDS

In addition to network programming, there are still a few satellite feeds, featuring programming from around the world (many of the SatFeeds of the late 2020s were casualties of the War). There are also a large number of "pirate" TV stations, operating out of hidden stations and through cable and pirate Highrider satellite patch-ups. These are often a major source of news and information untainted by Corporate or government interference.

In addition to the standard high definition flat screen TV of the pre-War era, experimental (and expensive—up to 10,000eb per set) 3-D holographic TV systems are available.

POP MEDIA

By the mid-2020s, most media in America was controlled by one or more gigantic multimedia Megacorps, such as the ubiquitous Network 54 or its most aggressive rival, DNS. Even news was channeled through a Megacorporate filter, with World News Service (WNS) dominating the airwaves through its 22-channel, 24/7 news programming (heavily laden with subliminals and talking head commentary). The problem was that as the 21st century wore on, these mighty media megaliths became little more than house organs for their parent Corporations, or mouthpieces for the dominant political party of the time. With a corrupt FCC controlling access to the airwaves, there wasn't much chance that a dissenting voice could break through, so for most of the early Cyberpunk Age, people were resigned to a diet of insipid reality shows, mind-numbing entertainment vids, bad movies, and Corp-sponsored sports shows.

Then came the 4th Corporate War and the DataKrash. The Mediacorps were the hardest hit by these events, since they depended on the NET's instantaneous communication and access to huge TV/

radio transmitters to broadcast their programming. But as established media outlets fell apart, new ways to disseminate information and programming arose to fill the gap. And the main format to make the cut was PopMedia.

PopMedia is entertainment and news programming created by independent producers instead of huge Mediacorps. Combining audio, data, and visual images in a podcast-like format, PopMedia provides most of the Red Era's programming (as well as an ungodly amount of trash), most coming from five main sources: New Mediacorps, Rockers, Idols, Independents, and Medias.

ROCKERBOYS

Named after the famed rebel rock star of the late '90s with the stage name of Rockerboy Manson, today's Rockerboys are performers or agitators who operate without the support of a New Mediacorp. They provide performance shows: concert footage, music tracks with visuals, personal observations, even braindance experiences. Idols are similar to Rockers, but their programming tends to be equivalent to an old-style "reality" show of the 2000s—it's all about the Idol.

BRAINDANCE

An offshoot of the same neural interface technology that spawned the cyberware revolution (see above), braindance is considered the purest form of entertainment around. The braindance unit consists of a memory chip playback unit and a cable that can access an interface plug or convert to surface trodes. It plays chips which contain recorded experiences—not just visual and auditory info—but complete emotional and tactile info, as well.

Braindance chips let you feel what the performer was feeling at the time (albeit heavily edited so as not to discomfort the buying public). As with most tech, braindance is a double-edged sword: it's been used to pacify prisoners almost as much as to entertain the masses. In the 2010s, it looked as if braindance technology was to be the next great step in entertainment. However, psychological addiction and the expense of producing quality braindance chips has made this format less popular.

DATA

A lot of PopMedia is consumed via the Garden, an "all you can eat" content platform run by Ziggurat. Setting up your own "Garden Plot" is free!

BODY LOTTO

The Night City "Body Lottery" is a regular nightly lottery where six winning numbers are chosen depending on how many corpses are found in areas of Night City. The numbers of the Body Lotto are taken from six random districts within the Night City Greater Metro Area. Numbers are derived from the locations that cadavers are found, not necessarily from where they were murdered.

All numbers are accumulated by the Night City Police Department (or what remains of it) and verified by the investment firm of Merrill, Asukaga & Finch. People holding a winning ticket must contact the downtown offices of MA&F by 10a.m. the next morning. If no one claims the winning ticket, the next night's winnings go up by 1,000eb.

WHERE YOU GET STUFF

When you need to make big purchases, there are very few stores around in the Cyberpunk future. And if you're looking for an old-fashioned grocery store for a bag of soy chips (or to hold it up for a few bucks), forget it.

VENDITS

In the Time of the Red, most low-cost, day-to-day purchases are done via Vendits: self-contained vending machines that dispense everything from meals to clothing to weapons. All you have to do is swipe a cred-card over the scanner (Vendits do not trade in hard currency), press a few buttons or say a few words, and within moments your desired purchase drops out the slot.

A Vendit can be placed almost anywhere; they are self-powered using a small thermal battery good for five years, and use an onboard datalink to call for repairs, refills, or even protection (although most don't need much protection, a Vendit typically counts as Thick Steel cover and has an installed Automated Turret with a Flamethrower (SEE PG. 214).

DATA

The contents of a Vendit can range in price from 10eb (Cheap) to 100eb (Premium). Generally, a fresh meal or a living creature is on the more expensive side.

▶ WHAT'S IN THE NEAREST VENDIT?

Roll 1d6 (or choose) to determine the Vendit type and 1d10 (or choose) to determine the Vendit contents.

1d10	Food (1d6: 1 to 3)	Personal (1d6: 4 to 5)	Just Plain Weird (1d6: 6)
1	Ramen noodles	Canned T-shirts	Pet Wigs
2	Pizza	Sex Toys	Bug Snacks
3	Hamburgers	Umbrellas	Balls of Lettuce
4	Smash	Ties	Flying Fish Soup
5	Sushi	Surgical Masks	Vat-Grown Seafood
6	Hot Meat	Underwear	Canned Smells
7	1kg bags of kibble	Floral Arrangements	Live Rhinoceros Beetles
8	Canned Coffee	Guns & Ammo	Paper Cosplay Costumes
9	Canned Juice	Braindance Chips	Bizarre Capsule Toys
10	Canned Soft Drinks	Video Games	Used Panties

BODEGAS

DATA

If your Players are getting bored, send them down to the corner bodega to get a carton of soy milk. That should un-bore them real fast.

DATA

Continental Brands doesn't much like bodegas. They'd much rather have an Oasis on every corner. And they're willing to kill to get it!

A **bodega** is a small corner store or market that sells groceries and wine. A bodega is kind of like an off-brand convenience store, just smaller and more convenient than a supermarket. This isn't the 7-11. This is Bob's Dollarama. Thing is, bodegas are always a source of action in the City. They're open all night, they have alcohol and other things gangers really like, and the clientele are almost always colorful characters.

► THE BODEGA'S CLIENTELE

Roll	Owner or Cashier	Colorful Character #1	Colorful Character #2
1	Maternal granny who treats you like one of her own kids and fusses over you.	The customer who mumbles a lot, then pauses to stare at you.	The yo-ganger who is casing the place trying to work up the nerve to rob it.
2	Bad-tempered retiree who hates everyone. Especially you.	The customer who obnoxious and drunk.	The ganger who is going to try and bust the place up in 1d6 turns.
3	Bored yo-ganger who got shackled to the register by their parents.	The stoned customer who "sees things" and keeps trying to bat them out of the air.	The small-time ganger who tries to rough the Owner up for "protection" money.
4	Overly friendly type that keeps trying to hit on you—badly.	The joygirl/boy who is short on cash but will "do you a favor" if you buy them some Smash.	The adorable runaway 4-year-old who has inexplicably wandered in looking for "Mommy."
5	The total stoner who just waves you through and says, "Whatever, man..."	Off-duty Lawman looking for a quick bite to eat and not in a chatty mood.	The couple who are having a loud fight as they enter the store, and it just gets louder.
6	Middle-aged person whom you can't understand, but who seems to always be arguing with you anyway.	The customer who is terrified to be down on The Street and is about to jump (and maybe pull a gun) on anyone who approaches them.	Wealthy couple wearing too much expensive stuff wandering in to pick up some booze after a night of high-class partying.



BY EDDIE MENDOZA

BY RICHARD BAGNALL



THE NEW STREET ECONOMY

"The quintessential 'punk needs quintessential warez. It's a necessity, chombatta."

Gil Myxx

***It's not post-holocaust, kids.
It's economic scarcity.***

The cyberpunk writer and sage William Gibson once said, "The future is already here—it's just not evenly-distributed." And that's a pretty good way to describe the situation of life on The Street in the Time of the Red. All the cool tech and advancements of the Golden 2020s are still around; but thanks to a nasty global war and a total disruption of supply chains, it's just really hard to get your hands on it. You can't even go down to the store because the store has been blasted by an anti-tank round, the company that owned the store has gone belly-up, and the shelves would be empty anyway because no one's been able to get their inventory stocked since the cargo ship carrying it was sunk and the delivery truck was looted.

BEFORE THE WAR

In the time before the War, almost 90% of all raw materials and completed goods moved, not by train or by truck as many assumed, but by the use of huge "container" ships plying the world's extended sea lanes. These ships allowed a kind of economics that had previously been unknown (save perhaps in the Late Bronze Age of the Mediterranean). Raw materials were gathered in one place where they were common, then shipped to another place that would turn those raw materials into finished components, which then might be shipped to another distant location where a factory would install the components into a finished product, which would then be shipped to receiving ports all over the world and sold in local stores near those ports. This system was further enhanced by the lightning-fast communications of the NET, which allowed producers and consumers to coordinate production so that there was little or no waste—a system known as "just in time" inventory.

Before the War, there were literally thousands of these huge ships, all over the world, plying the sea lanes loaded with raw materials, partially finished materials, and completed, salable product. Each ship held thousands of identical metal transport containers called TEU's (twenty-foot equivalent unit) in the parlance of world shipping companies. Large container ships were able to transport up to 20,000

of these cargo containers, which would be loaded or offloaded in huge marshaling port yards by titanic giraffe-like cranes.

A WAR OF SUPPLY

Then came the Fourth Corporate War. This conflict was unique in that it occurred on both land and sea. Save for the Second Corporate War in which SovOil and Petrochem faced off in the South China Sea, previous Corporate wars were primarily land-based. But with AHAG and CINO being nautical-based Corps, the war took on an added dimension finally focusing on denial of supply lines; this meant stopping soldiers and material from getting to where they were needed. Most of the early war supplies were carried by cargo subs controlled by individual companies. However, as the War became hotter, the Corps were forced to use the same transport methods as the rest of the developed world: the huge container ships.

As part of their overall strategies, both sides in the War began to attack the supply lines of the other; starting with sabotage (and later full-on military attacks) of key ports. The conflict then escalated to attacks on individual ships suspected of carrying war materiel, which in turn led to both sides deploying both well protected convoys and hunter/killer submarine packs.

By the end of the war, literally all inter-ocean transshipping was halted. Ships were trapped in harbors or abandoned at sea, unable to get through the submarine blockades to safe harbors. By the end of the War, there were literally millions of TEUs of cargo, in raw and finished states, scattered all over the planet; some still sitting unloaded in blockaded ports, some drifting in container ships abandoned by their crews, still others left loaded onto trucks and trains that never left for their final destinations.

And they're still out there, waiting for someone to get their hands on them.

THE SPECIALISTS

So, here's the scoop. In a post-holocaust world, there's nothing left. Looters have stripped away all the food and gear they can get their hands on, or it's otherwise

lost to the rest of civilization. But in the Time of the Red, there's literally millions of tons of perfectly usable stuff out there, if you can just figure out where it is and get a salvage team to it. But a salvage team is going to need a few elements:

Netrunners: When the DataKrash started, almost every record of shipping manifests or bills of lading was obliterated by the virus. But a determined Netrunner might be able to track down the records in the architecture of their local Data Pool or in the storage archives of a local branch of a larger Megacorp. And a *truly* crazy Netrunner might even put their brain/life on the line to sneak into the remnants of the Old NET (assuming they can find a connection point) and seek out what scattered records could be assembled from the hash of false data and Black ICE. But if that risk netted you the location of a million brand new, unused Agents or a few dozen TEUs of raw lithium ore, you could become a billionaire overnight. If you could find someone to sell it to, that is.

Fixers: Selling the contents of these abandoned TEUs is one of the things Fixers excel at. With their wide network of clients and contacts, Fixers are the people to go to when you need something or want to sell something. Fixers also are great at hiring people to get the stuff from one customer to another, hiring Solos to protect the stuff, Techs to assess or break into a TEU to get to the stuff, Lawmen to clear the stuff that needs to get past the local authorities (who'll want their cut), and various other entities (Execs who want to buy it, Rockerboys and Medtechs who want to use it, etc.). About the only people that Fixers don't have a grip on are the **Nomads**.

RISE OF THE NOMADS

From their position as the refugees and riffraff of the Cyberpunk Golden Age, the fortunes of the Nomads have reversed, suddenly making them one of the most powerful groups around in the Time of the Red. They can be found in almost every environment and are

BY DARIUSK



involved in the transshipping and protection of almost all of the goods that keep things running in the Time of the Red. You need something? Chances are a Nomad will be the one who gets it to you.

NOMADS IN THE WET

Before the War, many Nomads were pirates, especially in the waters of the South China Seas, the Straits of Magellan, and the Red Sea. These bands were often nationally based but made up of loose coalitions of families from the same area. In prime positions to hijack abandoned or lightly defended shipping, these Nomads went for it, thinking, *"Well, there's half the Lawmen in the South China Sea after us already, so we might as well get paid for it."*

Shipping companies also hired other Nomads to defend ships against pirates. These too were family groups. Nomads were the perfect groups for this: familiar with transportation tech and weapons, and with a strong family loyalty. The battles between the Pirates and the "Ship Rats" were often long and personal feuds. As the 4th Corp War progressed, these Ship Rat Nomads came under attack by forces from rival Corps as well as Pirates. They were subsequently supplied with arms and gear by the shipping companies, who, while not optimized for combat, were quite capable of paying for the hardware that their Ship Rats needed to defend their cargoes. Many Ship Rat crews had no choice but to take over the ships they protected and act as free agents, especially as many worldwide shipping companies had collapsed during the War.

Gradually, the Ship Rats began to unite as family combines controlling more than one ship. Modeling themselves off the smuggling Families they interacted with on land, they created scattered shipping groups to replace the defunct world transshippers of the late 2020s. So, if you need to get to a ship, or get a ship into port, you're going to probably need a Ship Rat.

NOMADS ON THE DRY SIDE

Meanwhile, on land, Nomads often picked up where their Ship Rat cousins left off at the beach. They took up truck and delivery convoy work all over the U.S. and the Americas. These convoys were heavily defended and capable of moving vast amounts of

cargo. They often went up against Road Gangers and other land pirates, as well as whatever local "bosses" tried to extort fees from them for crossing their territories. Already familiar with their enemies, the land-based Nomads were the best equipped group to tackle these raiders or rivals, eventually establishing well-defended convoys and monitored roadways (nicknamed "Nomad High Roads") that allowed cargo to spread out from the reclaimed marshaling yards at the major seaports. Once the ports were secured, still other Families established heavily armed, long-haul trucking lines that carried smaller loads throughout the old highway system. Finally, several Nomad packs took over the long-abandoned maglev and other train systems, which they armored up and used to transport huge amounts of TEU, spreading out several rail corridors that reach distant Chicago and St. Louis.

SKY PIRATES

The Nomads have also taken to the air, hijacking the few remaining large Aerozeps from the 2020s and pressing them into intermittent service as cargo and passenger ships. These also require Nomad protection in the form of armed small aircraft, aerodynes, and auto-gyros. There are still other Nomads who prey on these passenger ships, but no matter what their business all of these aerial Nomads are generally nicknamed "Sky Pirates" by those outside of their close-knit Family groups.

The appellation of Sky Pirates is also applied to the Nomad Deltajocks who use the remaining military high orbital scramjets to deliver small, expensive and high value cargoes like medicine, tech parts, or even important passengers. These Deltajocks have a passing accommodation with the Highriders of the Low Earth Orbit Zone, but since they rarely stay in orbit for long, are considered to be a better type of "groundpounder" by the space-living group.

WHY IT ISN'T POST-HOLOCAUST

When people outside of the un-United States think of the Time of the Red, they invariably think of a post-holocaust world—guys wearing hockey masks and assless chaps storming down desert roads in a convoy of spike-covered hot rods. But the reality of

this period is far different. It's not like there isn't anything out there for people to live on. There's plenty of water, food, weapons, and CHOOH² for anyone who wants them. But they have to have the money to buy the goods, and someone (usually a Fixer) to locate them.

Or to put it another way: although the huge Sammtung factories in Korea have fallen silent from a current lack of silicon microchips and lithium batteries, that just means no one in the Time of the Red is making new phones or Agents (it's going to take some time before the supply lines allow those factories to start up again). But in thousands of TEUs and storage warehouses (as well as abandoned stores) all over the planet, there are hundreds of millions of perfectly good phones and Agents stored away in bright shiny store packaging, complete with operators' manuals. You just have to link up with someone who knows where they are, and is willing to provide a place for you to buy one. You need a Fixer—and a **Night Market**.

NIGHT MARKETS

Night Markets spring up all over the City, often without warning; whenever a good shipment comes in off a transport or something really useful is uncovered by the Nomads or Fixers. Similar to the old swap meets held in the 20th century, Night Markets are mobile shops mounted on trailers, vehicles, shipping containers, and whatever else has mobility and some spare volumetric to display stuff. Getting to a Night Market is as much about connections as it is about money. Some of the best markets are top secret affairs, which require connections or access codes just to find them. Night Markets can pop up for a few hours, then vanish forever, or regularly show up at specific sites where they can depend on enough security and space to set up shop over time.

DATA

To find a Night Market, you can start asking around or find your local Fixer to see if they'll hook you up.

BY RICHARD BAGNALL



THE NEW STREET ECONOMY

NIGHT MARKET GENERATOR

WHAT KIND OF NIGHT MARKET IS IT?

Use the following tables to generate a Night Market on the spot.

First, roll 1d6 twice on the table below to determine what is found at the Night Market. If you roll the same result twice, reroll until you get a different result.

Roll	Type of Goods Sold	Description
1	Food and Drugs	Processed foods, fresh vegetable, live animals, and sometimes fresh street drugs.
2	Personal Electronics	Gizmos and gadgets galore. You can even find Black ICE if you hit the shadier stalls.
3	Weapons and Armor	Everything you need to cause some chaos on The Street.
4	Cyberware	The best cybertech on Street; probably not stolen or harvested. If you roll a Cyberware Option, any Foundational Cyberware (for example, a Cybereye or Neural Processor) required to install that Option is also available at the Night Market. Cyberware bought at a Night Market is not installed at the Night Market but the seller will send you to their preferred local Ripperdoc for a free installation.
5	Clothing and Fashionware	All the hottest street fashion in one place plus some chrome to accent. Fashionware can be installed at the Night Market.
6	Survival Gear	All the practical gear you need to survive the Time of the Red.

► On the Shelves ◀

Next, roll 1d10 for each category included in the Night Market to determine how many types of items are available. Then roll d100 that many times on the appropriate columns below to see what's there. If you roll the same result twice, reroll until you get a different result. If you roll an item that has multiple Quality Ratings, all Quality Ratings are present in the Night Market. This is not the total inventory, but a general listing of types of things available in the Market.

DATA

d100: Roll two d10s. Use one for the 1s place and one for the 10s place to get a number between 1 and 100.

Roll d100	Food and Drugs	Personal Electronics	Weapons and Armor	Cyberware	Clothing and Fashionware	Survival Gear
0-5	Canned Goods 10eb (Cheap)	Agent 100eb (Premium)	Medium Pistol 50eb (Costly)	Cybereye 100eb (Premium)	Bag Lady Chic	Anti-Smog Breathing Mask 20eb (Everyday)
6-10	Packaged goods 10eb (Cheap)	Programs or Hardware of 100eb or less	Heavy Pistol or Very Heavy Pistol 100eb (Premium)	Cyberaudio Suite 500eb (Expensive)	Gang Colors	Auto Level Dampening Ear Protectors 1,000eb (Very Expensive)
11-15	Frozen Goods 10eb (Cheap)	Audio Recorder 100eb (Premium)	SMG 100eb (Premium)	Neural Link 500eb (Expensive)	Generic Chic	Binoculars 50eb (Costly)
16-20	Bags of Grain 20eb (Everyday)	Bug Detector 500eb (Expensive)	Heavy SMG 100eb (Premium)	Cyberarm 500eb (Expensive)	Bohemian	Carryall 20eb (Everyday)
21-25	Kibble Pack 10eb (Cheap)	Chemical Analyzer 1,000eb (Very Expensive)	Shotgun 500eb (Expensive)	Cyberleg 100eb (Premium)	Leisurewear	Flashlight 20eb (Everyday)

THE NEW STREET ECONOMY

Roll %	Food and Drugs	Personal Electronics	Weapons and Armor	Cyberware	Clothing and Fashionware	Survival Gear
26-30	Bags of Prepak 20eb (Everyday)	Computer 50eb (Costly)	Assault Rifle 500eb (Expensive)	External Cyberware of exactly 1,000eb	Nomad Leathers	Duct Tape 20eb (Everyday)
31-35	Street Drugs of 20eb or less	Cyberdeck 500eb (Expensive)	Sniper Rifle 500eb (Expensive)	External Cyberware of 500eb or less	Asia Pop	Inflatable Bed & Sleep-bag 20eb (Everyday)
36-40	Poor Quality Alcohol 10eb (Cheap)	Disposable Cell Phone 50eb (Costly)	Bows or Crossbow 100eb (Premium)	Internal Cyberware of exactly 1,000eb	Urban Flash	Lock Picking Set 20eb (Everyday)
41-45	Alcohol 20eb (Everyday)	Electric Guitar or Other Instrument 500eb (Expensive)	Grenade Launcher or Rocket Launcher 500eb (Expensive)	Internal Cyberware of 500eb or less	Businesswear	Handcuffs 50eb (Costly)
46-50	Excellent Quality Alcohol 100eb (Premium)	Programs or Hardware of exactly 500eb	Ammunition of 500eb or less	Cybereye Option of exactly 1,000eb	High Fashion	Medtech Bag 100eb (Premium)
51-55	MRE 10eb (Cheap)	Medscanner 1,000eb (Very Expensive)	A Single Exotic Weapon of GM's choice	Cybereye Option of 500eb or less	Biomonitor 100eb (Premium)	Tent and Camping Equipment 50eb (Costly)
56-60	Live Chicken 50eb (Costly)	Homing Tracer 500eb (Expensive)	Light Melee Weapon 50eb (Costly)	Cyberaudio Option of exactly 1,000eb	Chemskin 100eb (Premium)	Rope (60m/yds) 20eb (Everyday)
61-65	Live Fish 50eb (Costly)	Radio Communicator 100eb (Premium)	Medium Melee Weapon 50eb (Costly)	Cyberaudio Option of 500eb or less	EMP Threading 10eb (Cheap)	Techtool 100eb (Premium)
66-70	Fresh Fruits 50eb (Costly)	Techscanner 1,000eb (Very Expensive)	Heavy Melee Weapon 100eb (Premium)	Neuralware Option of exactly 1,000eb	Light Tattoo 100eb (Premium)	Personal CarePak 20eb (Everyday)
71-75	Fresh Vegetables 50eb (Costly)	Smart Glasses 500eb (Expensive)	Very Heavy Melee Weapon 100eb (Premium)	Neuralware Option of 500eb or less	Shift Tacts 100eb (Premium)	Radiation Suit 1,000eb (Very Expensive)
76-80	Root Vegetables 20eb (Everyday)	Radar Detector 500eb (Expensive)	Armor of 100eb or less	Cyberlimb Option of exactly 1,000eb	Skinwatch 100eb (Premium)	Road Flare 10eb (Cheap)
81-85	Live Pigs 100eb (Premium)	Scrambler/ Descrambler 500eb (Expensive)	Armor of exactly 500eb	Cyberlimb Option of 500eb or less	Techhair 100eb (Premium)	Grapple Gun 100eb (Premium)
86-90	Exotic Fruits 100eb (Premium)	Radio Scanner/ Music Player 50eb (Costly)	Armor of exactly 1,000eb	Fashionware of GM's Choice	Generic Chic	Tech Bag 500eb (Expensive)
91-95	Exotic Vegetables 100eb (Premium)	Braindance Viewer 1,000eb (Very Expensive)	Weapon Attachments of 100eb or less	Borgware of GM's Choice	Leisurewear	Shovel or Axe 50eb (Costly)
96-100	Street Drugs of exactly 50eb	Virtuality Goggles 100eb (Premium)	Weapon Attachments of 500eb or higher	Any Cyberware of GM's Choice	Gang Colors	Airhypo 50eb (Costly)

MIDNIGHT MARKETS

Besides Night Markets, there's another, even more secretive level of Market—the Midnight Market. Midnight Markets are flash markets open, only by invitation, to a select clientele: the extremely wealthy, powerful, or influential. That velvet painting of the cats playing poker? That's a Night Market find. That Mona Lisa you wanted? Midnight Market. Only the very top Fixers host Midnight Markets, and it's the dream of every ambitious Fixer to one day reach the exalted realms where they can host their own. A Midnight Market contains 1d10 + 5 rare and sought-after items of the GM's choice. Additionally, a Midnight Market gathers the leadership of the criminal underworld to make deals, discuss operations, and recruit new blood.

NIGHT MARKET APPENDIX

Here's a list of everything you could possibly buy at a Night Market. It even includes options not shown during in *Fitted for the Future* (PG. 71) but available to Characters during Character Generation if they can afford it.

Looking for a specific section? Here's a handy index.

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MELEE WEAPONS

Melee Weapon Type	Example Melee Weapons	# of Hands Required	Damage	ROF	Can be Concealed?	Cost
Light Melee Weapon	Combat Knife, Tomahawk	Varies by type	1d6	2	YES	50eb (Costly)
Medium Melee Weapon	Baseball Bat, Crowbar, Machete	Varies by type	2d6	2	NO	50eb (Costly)
Heavy Melee Weapon	Lead Pipe, Sword, Spiked Bat	Varies by type	3d6	2	NO	100eb (Premium)
Very Heavy Melee Weapon	Chainsaw, Sledgehammer, Helicopter Blades, Naginata	Varies by type	4d6	1	NO	500eb (Expensive)

DATA

You must be at least a Rank 9 Fixer to set up a Midnight Market. You need to be a real bonafide badass to earn an invitation to one.

RANGED WEAPONS

Weapon Type	Weapon Skill	Single Shot Damage	Standard Magazine	Rate of Fire (ROF)	Hands Required	Can be Concealed?	Cost
Medium Pistol	Handgun	2d6	12 (M Pistol)	2	1	YES	50eb (Costly)
Alt. Fire Modes & Special Features: None							
Heavy Pistol	Handgun	3d6	8 (H Pistol)	2	1	YES	100eb (Premium)
Alt. Fire Modes & Special Features: None							
Very Heavy Pistol	Handgun	4d6	8 (VH Pistol)	1	1	NO	100eb (Premium)
Alt. Fire Modes & Special Features: None							
SMG	Handgun	2d6	30 (M Pistol)	1	1	YES	100eb (Premium)
Alt. Fire Modes & Special Features: Autofire (3) • Suppressive Fire							
Heavy SMG	Handgun	3d6	40 (H Pistol)	1	1	NO	100eb (Premium)
Alt. Fire Modes & Special Features: Autofire (3) • Suppressive Fire							
Shotgun	Shoulder Arms	5d6	4 (Slug)	1	2	NO	500eb (Expensive)
Alt. Fire Modes & Special Features: Shotgun Shell							
Assault Rifle	Shoulder Arms	5d6	25 (Rifle)	1	2	NO	500eb (Expensive)
Alt. Fire Modes & Special Features: Autofire (4) • Suppressive Fire							
Sniper Rifle	Shoulder Arms	5d6	4 (Rifle)	1	2	NO	500eb (Expensive)
Alt. Fire Modes & Special Features: None							
Bows & Crossbows	Archery	4d6	N/A (Arrow)	1	2	NO	100eb (Premium)
Alt. Fire Modes & Special Features: Arrows							
Grenade Launcher	Heavy Weapons	6d6	2 (Grenade)	1	2	NO	500eb (Expensive)
Alt. Fire Modes & Special Features: Explosive							
Rocket Launcher	Heavy Weapons	8d6	1 (Rocket)	1	2	NO	500eb (Expensive)
Alt. Fire Modes & Special Features: Explosive							

JUSTICE COMES FROM THE BARREL OF A **GUN**, AND MY **MILITECH URBAN MISSILE LAUNCHER'S** BIGGER THAN YOUR PEA SHOOTER, **PUNK**.

— GENERAL EXEC C. LANCE

STAR OF THE MILITECH ACTION HOUR

WEAPONS OF EXCELLENT OR POOR QUALITY

Melee and Ranged Weapons often vary by the quality of their construction. You can find cheaper versions of more weapons that are prone to jamming. But you can also find high quality version that improve your capabilities.

Poor Quality Weapon

Poor Quality Weapons malfunction whenever you roll a Critical Failure (a 1 on your Attack Check), requiring you to use an Action to reverse the malfunction before they can be used again. Unjamming your weapon doesn't require a Check. Cost varies based on the weapon's base cost.

Excellent Quality Weapons

When attacking with an Excellent Quality Weapon you add a +1 to your Attack Check with it. Cost varies based on the weapon's base cost.

DATA
Exotic Weapons
are always
Average
Quality
unless their
description says
otherwise.

Standard Quality Weapon Cost	Poor Quality Weapon Cost	Excellent Quality Weapon Cost
50eb (Costly)	20eb (Everyday)	100eb (Premium)
100eb (Premium)	50eb (Costly)	500eb (Expensive)
500eb (Expensive)	100eb (Premium)	1,000eb (Very Expensive)

RANGED WEAPON BRAND EXAMPLES

Ranged Weapon Type	Poor Weapon Quality Example	Standard Weapon Quality Example	Excellent Weapon Quality Example
Medium Pistol	Dai Lung Streetmaster	Federated Arms X-9mm	Militech "Avenger"
Heavy Pistol	Dai Lung Magnum	Mustang Arms "Mark III"	Nova "Cityhunter"
Very Heavy Pistol	Federated Arms "Super Chief"	Sternmeyer P-35	Militech "Boomer Buster"
Bow	GunMart "Sherwood"	Eagletech "Tomcat"	Eagletech "Bearcat"
Crossbow	GunMart "Hunter"	Eagletech "Striker"	Eagletech "Scorpion"
SMG	Federated Arms Tech-Assault III	Militech "Mini-Gat"	Arasaka "Minami 10"
Heavy SMG	Chadran Arms "City Reaper"	Sternmeyer SMG-21	Militech "Viper"
Shotgun	GunMart "Home Defender"	Arasaka "Rapid Assault"	Militech "Bulldog"
Assault Rifle	Chadran Arms "Jungle Reaper"	Militech "Ronin"	Militech "Dragon"
Sniper Rifle	GunMart "Snipe-Star"	Nomad "Long Rifle"	Arasaka WSSA Sniper System
Grenade Launcher	Towa Manufacturing Type-G	Militech "Mini-Grenade"	Tsunami Arms Type-18
Rocket Launcher	Towa Manufacturing Type-R	Militech "Urban"	Militech "Hotshot"

WEAPON ATTACHMENTS

Each Non-Exotic Ranged Weapon has 3 Attachment Slots that can be upgraded with attachments. You can combine multiple attachments that take up the same physical location, but you must pay the slot cost of both attachments independently. Equipping the same attachment twice does nothing. Attachments are made for specific weapon types and cannot be easily retrofitted for other weapon types.

Attachment	Cost
Bayonet	100eb (Premium)
Drum Magazine	500eb (Expensive)
Extended Magazine	100eb (Premium)
Grenade Launcher Underbarrel	500eb (Expensive)

Attachment	Cost
Infrared Nightvision Scope	500eb (Expensive)
Shotgun Underbarrel	500eb (Expensive)
Smartgun Link	500eb (Expensive)
Sniping Scope	100eb (Premium)

► BAYONET

Cost: 100eb (Premium) • **Eligible:** All Non-Exotic Ranged Weapons fired with the Shoulder Arms Skill.

When wielded, this weapon can also be used as a Light Melee Weapon. While this is attached to a weapon, it cannot be concealed under clothing.

► DRUM MAGAZINE

Cost: 500eb (Expensive) • **Eligible:** All Non-Exotic Ranged Weapons except Bows/Crossbows.

The weapon holds a maximum number of shots equal to its Drum entry on the Clip Chart below. Only one clip can be attached to a weapon at a time. While this is attached to a weapon, it cannot be concealed under clothing.

► EXTENDED MAGAZINE

Cost: 100eb (Premium) • **Eligible:** All Non-Exotic Ranged Weapons except Bows/Crossbows.

The weapon holds a maximum number of shots equal to its Extended entry on the Clip Chart chart below. Only one clip can be attached to a weapon at a time. While this is attached to a weapon, it cannot be concealed under clothing.

► GRENADE LAUNCHER UNDERBARREL

Cost: 500eb (Expensive) • **Eligible:** All Non-Exotic Ranged Weapons fired with the Shoulder Arms Skill.

When wielded in two hands, the weapon can also be used as a Grenade Launcher, with only 1 grenade in its magazine. While this is attached to a weapon, it cannot be concealed under clothing. **Requires 2 Attachment Slots.**

► INFRARED NIGHTVISION SCOPE

Cost: 500eb (Expensive) • **Eligible:** All Non-Exotic Ranged Weapons.

Reduces penalties imposed on your firing at a target obscured to you by darkness, smoke, fog, etc. to 0. Looking through the scope, you can distinguish hot meat from cold metal, but not more specifically than that. You can't tell the brand of their Cyberarm from a distance, or see any of its internal surprises, for example.

► SHOTGUN UNDERBARREL

Cost: 500eb (Expensive) • **Eligible:** All Non-Exotic Ranged Weapons fired with the Shoulder Arms Skill.

When wielded in two hands, the weapon can also be used as a Shotgun, with only 2 shots in its magazine. While this is attached to a weapon, it cannot be concealed under clothing. **Requires 2 Attachment Slots.**

▶ SMARTGUN LINK

Cost: 500eb (Expensive) • **Eligible:** All Non-Exotic Ranged Weapons.

Installing or uninstalling a Smartgun Link takes an hour. A weapon is a Smartgun only when it has a Smartgun Link attached to it. Special Cyberware is required to take advantage of a Smartgun. A Smartgun Link must be connected to you with Interface Plugs or a Subdermal Grip in order to operate, both of which require you to have a Neural Link. A Subdermal Grip connects a Smartgun held in it automatically. You can plug in Interface Plugs as part of drawing a Smartgun into a free hand, as long as your Interface Plugs aren't already plugged into something else. Being disarmed of your Smartgun doesn't snap your cables, it just unplugs them from the Smartgun. Plugging them back in isn't an Action should you have the Smartgun in your hand, as their ports are designed for ease-of-use. *Why go through all this trouble? Because when making Ranged Attacks with one, you add a +1 to your Check.* **Requires 2 Attachment Slots.**

▶ SNIPING SCOPE

Cost: 100eb (Premium) • **Eligible:** All Non-Exotic Ranged Weapons.

Looking through the scope, user can see detail up to 800m/yds away. When attacking a target 51m/yards or further away with either a weapon's single shot firing mode or an Aimed Shot, you can add a +1 to your Check. Does not stack with TeleOptics Cyberware.

▶ CLIP CHART

Type	Standard	Extended	Drum
Medium Pistol	12	18	36
Heavy Pistol	8	14	28
Very Heavy Pistol	8	14	28
SMG	30	40	50
Heavy SMG	40	50	60
Shotgun	4	8	16
Assault Rifle	25	35	45
Sniper Rifle	4	8	12
Grenade Launcher	2	4	6
Rocket Launcher	1	2	3

DATA

Grenade ammunition can be either thrown or loaded into a Grenade Launcher.

AMMUNITION

- Ammunition comes in many varieties: Bullet (Medium, Heavy, & Very Heavy Pistol, Slug, or Rifle), Shotgun Shell, Arrow, Grenade, and Rocket and must be bought for the ammunition type of the weapon.
- Grenades and Rockets are purchased individually. All other ammunition is purchased in increments of 10.

Ammunition Type	Cost
Basic Ammunition	10eb (Cheap)
Armor-Piercing Ammunition	100eb (Premium)
Biotoxin Ammunition	500eb (Expensive)
EMP Ammunition	500eb (Expensive)
Expansive Ammunition	100eb (Premium)
Flashbang Ammunition	100eb (Premium)
Incendiary Ammunition	100eb (Premium)
Poison Ammunition	100eb (Premium)
Rubber Ammunition	10eb (Cheap)
Sleep Ammunition	500eb (Expensive)
Smart Ammunition	500eb (Expensive)
Smoke Ammunition	50eb (Costly)
Teargas Ammunition	50eb (Costly)

► BASIC AMMUNITION

Cost: 10eb (Cheap) • **Ammo Types Available:** All except Grenades and Rockets.

This is the standard ammunition for the weapon. It has no special features.

► ARMOR-PIERCING AMMUNITION

Cost: 100eb (Premium) • **Ammo Types Available:** All except Shotgun Shells

When using this ammunition, you ablate armor by 2 instead of 1 whenever you would ablate armor.

► BIOTOXIN AMMUNITION

Cost: 500eb (Expensive) • **Ammo Types Available:** Arrows and Grenades only.

When using this ammunition, you deal no damage with your attack. Anyone meat hit by your attack must instead attempt to beat a DV15 Resist Torture/Drugs Check. Anyone who fails is dealt 3d6 damage directly to their HP. Their armor isn't ablated because it wasn't interacted with.

► EMP AMMUNITION

Cost: 500eb (Expensive) • **Ammo Types Available:** Grenades only.

When using this ammunition, you deal no damage with your attack. Anyone hit by your attack must instead attempt to beat a DV15 Cybertech Check. If they fail, the GM chooses 2 pieces of their Cyberware or carried electronics to become inoperable for 1 minute. Cyberlimbs that are rendered inoperable act as their meat counterparts do when they have been dismembered, but they still hang loosely. See Critical Injuries on [PG. 187](#).

► EXPANSIVE AMMUNITION

Cost: 100eb (Premium) • **Ammo Types Available:** Arrows, Bullets, and Slugs.

When using this ammunition, whenever you cause the Foreign Object Critical Injury, the victim rolls again on the Critical Injury table ([SEE PG. 187](#)) until they roll a Critical Injury that isn't Foreign Object. The victim then suffers that Critical Injury as well. This second injury deals no Bonus Damage.

► FLASHBANG AMMUNITION

Cost: 100eb (Premium) • **Ammo Types Available:** Grenades only.

When using this ammunition, you deal no damage with your attack. Anyone hit by your attack must instead attempt to beat a DV15 Resist Torture/Drugs Check. Anyone who fails suffers the Damaged Eye and Damaged Ear Critical Injuries (**SEE PG. 188**) for the next minute. You do not take the Bonus Damage from the Critical Injuries.

► INCENDIARY AMMUNITION

Cost: 100eb (Premium) • **Ammo Types Available:** Arrows, Bullets, Grenades, and Shotgun Shells.

When using this ammunition, whenever you deal damage to a target through their armor, you ignite the target. Until your target spends an Action to put themselves out, they take 2 damage directly to their HP whenever they end their Turn. Multiple instances of this effect cannot stack.

► POISON AMMUNITION

Cost: 100eb (Premium) • **Ammo Types Available:** Arrows and Grenades only.

When using this ammunition, you deal no damage with your attack. Anyone meat hit by your attack must instead attempt to beat a DV13 Resist Torture/Drugs Check. Anyone who fails is dealt 2d6 damage directly to their HP. Their armor isn't ablated because it wasn't interacted with.

► RUBBER AMMUNITION

Cost: 10eb (Cheap) • **Ammo Types Available:** Arrows, Bullets, and Slugs.

Damage dealt using this ammunition cannot cause a Critical Injury. Additionally, attacks made with this ammunition cannot ablate armor. If damage dealt by this ammunition would reduce a target with more than 1 HP to less than 0 HP, they are instead left at 1 HP.

► SLEEP AMMUNITION

Cost: 500eb (Expensive) • **Ammo Types Available:** Arrows and Grenades

When using this ammunition, you deal no damage with your attack. Anyone meat hit by your attack must instead attempt to beat a DV13 Resist Torture/Drugs Check. Anyone who fails is now Prone (**SEE PG. 169**) and Unconscious for 1 minute or until they are woken by taking damage, or by someone else using an Action that touches them.

► SMART AMMUNITION

Cost: 500eb (Expensive) • **Ammo Types Available:** Arrows, Bullets, and Rockets

Targeting Scope Cyberware is required in order to make use of Smart Ammunition. When fired by a User without Targeting Scope Cyberware, Smart Ammunition won't fire even when the trigger is pulled, as a safety feature. When using this ammunition, whenever you miss a shot by 4 or less when using a weapon's single shot firing mode, your missed shot immediately has a second chance to hit your target. This second chance to hit is made by rolling again to hit the exact same shot DV on the range table which you missed, except that you add 10 to the d10 instead of anything you would typically add to the Check, with the only exception being LUCK. A target that can dodge bullets can choose to dodge this ranged attack as normal.

► SMOKE AMMUNITION

Cost: 50eb (Costly) • **Ammo Types Available:** Grenades only.

Obscures a 10m/10yd by 10m/10yd area with smoke for a minute on impact. The typical penalty for trying to perform a task obscured by smoke is -4.

► TEARGAS AMMUNITION

Cost: 50eb (Costly) • **Ammo Types Available:** Grenades only.

When using this ammunition, you deal no damage with your attack. Anyone with meat eyes hit by your attack must instead attempt to beat a DV13 Resist Torture/Drugs Check. Anyone who fails suffers the Damaged Eye Critical injury (**SEE PG. 188**) for the next minute. You do not take the Bonus Damage from the Critical Injury.

EXOTIC WEAPONS

Exotic weapons are weapons that are overly specialized or too unique to be easily described. They are typically variants of existing weapon types. **All Exotic Weapons are Average Weapon Quality and are incompatible with all Weapon Attachments and Non-Basic Ammunition unless otherwise noted.**

Weapon	Cost
Air Pistol	100eb (Premium)
Battleglove	1,000eb (V. Expensive)
Constitution Arms Hurricane Assault Weapon	5,000eb (Luxury)
Dartgun	100eb (Premium)
Flamethrower	500eb (Expensive)
Kendachi Mono-Three	5,000eb (Luxury)
Malorian Arms 3516	10,000eb (Super Luxury)

Weapon	Cost
Microwaver	500eb (Expensive)
Militech "Cowboy" U-56 Grenade Launcher	5,000eb (Luxury)
Rhinemetall EMG-86 Railgun	5,000eb (Luxury)
Shrieker	500eb (Expensive)
Stun Baton	100eb (Premium)
Stun Gun	100eb (Premium)
Tsunami Arms Helix	5,000eb (Luxury)

► AIR PISTOL

Cost: 100eb (Premium)

An Exotic Medium Pistol. Fires paint balls, which are typically filled with paint, and thus deal no damage. If you filled the paint balls with Acid however, each Acid Paintball still deals no damage, but lowers the SP of the target's armor (worn in the location shot) by one with each successful hit. Great for trying to capture someone alive. Damage dealt by this weapon cannot cause a Critical Injury. Ammunition costs the same as for a normal Medium Pistol, even if filled with Acid.

► BATTLEGLOVE

Cost: 1,000eb (Very Expensive)

A heavy gauntlet covering the hand and forearm. Contains three option slots for Cyberarm or Cyberlimb options. When worn, the options stored in the glove's slots can be accessed. Putting on a Battleglove and taking one off is an Action. The cost to purchase and install a Cyberarm option into the Battleglove is the same cost as doing so in a Cyberarm. Any options stored in a Cyberarm or meat arm the Battleglove is being worn over are inaccessible while the Battleglove is being worn. Cannot be concealed.

► CONSTITUTION ARMS HURRICANE ASSAULT WEAPON

Cost: 5,000eb (Luxury)

An Exotic 2 ROF Shotgun. It cannot make Aimed Shots. Its drum holds 16 shots. Reloading this weapon requires using two Actions, and thus can only be done over the course of two turns. Firing this weapon requires BODY 11 or higher unless it is mounted.

► DARTGUN

Cost: 100eb (Premium)

An Exotic Very Heavy Pistol that can only load Non-Basic Arrow Ammunition. Unlike other weapons that fire Arrows, a Dartgun has a clip of 8 Non-Basic Arrows and must be reloaded just like a typical Very Heavy Pistol.

► FLAMETHROWER

Cost: 500eb (Expensive)

An Exotic Shotgun fired with the Heavy Weapons Skill instead of the Shoulder Arms Skill. Mechanically, the flamethrower is a Shotgun that can only fire incendiary shotgun shells (ammunition cost is also the same as Incendiary Shotgun Shells), except that while your targets are ignited, until they spend an Action to put themselves out, they take 4 damage to their HP at the end of their turns. If they were already on fire, this fire effect replaces one that would deal less damage. Damage dealt by this weapon cannot cause a Critical Injury, and it cannot be used to make Aimed Shots.

► KENDACHI MONO-THREE

Cost: 5,000eb (Luxury)

An Excellent Quality Two-Handed Exotic Very Heavy Melee Weapon. With the correct biometric key, damage dealt by this weapon ignores the target's armor entirely if it is lower than SP11. Armor with a higher SP is still interacted with as normal. A high-tech katana with a nearly transparent crystal blade. Orbital crystal reinforces its redesigned microscopically serrated edge which vibrates four thousand times a minute when its handle is gripped by a user with a correct biometric key. In the hands of a user without the correct biometric key, the blade will not vibrate, leaving it only an Excellent Quality Two-Handed Exotic Very Heavy Melee Weapon. At no additional cost, any color of laser can be installed into the hilt to refract within the crystal blade, giving it a flaring neon glow. The most popular color is red.

► MALORIAN ARMS 3516

Cost: 10,000eb (Super Luxury)

An Excellent Quality Exotic Very Heavy Pistol. It deals 5d6 damage with a single shot, and comes permanently installed with the Smartgun Link weapon attachment which must be connected (via Interface Plugs or a Subdermal Grip) in order for the weapon to operate. Extremely rare and sought after, this weapon is even more expensive today than it was in the past, when one even can be found for sale.

► MICROWAVER

Cost: 500eb (Expensive)

An Exotic Very Heavy Pistol. Instead of dealing damage, on a hit it forces the target to try to beat a DV15 Cybertech Check. If they fail, the GM chooses two pieces of their cyberware or carried electronics to become inoperable for a minute. Cyberlimbs that are rendered inoperable act as their meat counterparts do when

DATA

Kendachi is a Japanese Corp specializing in glass and crystal production. Most of their weapons were made in orbital factories.

DATA

To learn more about the Tech who designed the 3516, go to **PAGE 307**

they have been dismembered, but they still hang loosely. See Critical Injuries. Ammunition is costless, as it runs off easily rechargeable (1 hour) battery packs that need to be replaced after 8 shots. Extra battery packs are 50eb (Costly).

► MILITECH "COWBOY" U-56 GRENADE LAUNCHER

Cost: 5,000eb (Luxury)

An Exotic 2 ROF Grenade Launcher. Its magazine holds four grenades. Despite being an Exotic Weapon, it is capable of firing all forms of Grenade Ammunition. Reloading this weapon requires using two Actions, and thus can only be done over the course of two turns. Firing this weapon requires BODY 11 or higher unless it is mounted.

► RHINOMETALL EMG-86 RAILGUN

Cost: 5,000eb (Luxury)

An Exotic Assault Rifle that is incapable of Autofire and Aimed Shots. It is fired with the Heavy Weapons Skill instead of the Shoulder Arms Skill. The weapon holds 4 shots. Damage dealt by this weapon ignores the target's armor entirely if it is lower than SP11. Armor with a higher SP is still interacted with as normal. Reloading this weapon requires using two Actions, and thus can only be done over the course of two turns. Firing this weapon requires BODY 11 or higher unless it is mounted.

► SHRIEKER

Cost: 500eb (Expensive)

An Exotic Very Heavy Pistol. Whenever a user fires this weapon without some form of ear protection, they suffer the Damaged Ear Critical Injury. Instead of dealing damage, on a hit it forces the target to try to beat a DV15 Resist Torture/Drugs Check. If they fail, they suffer the Damaged Ear Critical Injury. Ammunition is costless as it runs off of easily rechargeable (1 hour) battery packs that need to be replaced after 8 shots. Extra battery packs are 50eb (Costly).

► STUN BATON

Cost: 100eb (Premium)

A One-Handed Exotic Medium Melee Weapon. If damage dealt by it would reduce a target to under 1 HP, they are instead Unconscious at 1 HP. Damage dealt by this weapon cannot cause a Critical Injury and doesn't ablate armor.

► STUN GUN

Cost: 100eb (Premium)

An Exotic Heavy Pistol. If damage dealt by it would reduce a target to under 1 HP, they are instead Unconscious at 1 HP. Damage dealt by this weapon cannot cause a Critical Injury and doesn't ablate armor. Ammunition is costless as it runs off easily rechargeable (1 hour) battery packs that need to be replaced after 8 shots. Extra battery packs are 50eb (Costly).

► TSUNAMI ARMS HELIX

Cost: 5,000eb (Luxury)

An Exotic Assault Rifle, fired entirely with the Autofire Skill. It can only be fired using Autofire and it cannot make Aimed Shots or fire in single shot. It holds 40 bullets. When fired, the Helix consumes 20 bullets with every attack. If you hit, you roll 2d6 for damage, and multiply it by the amount you beat the DV to hit your target, up to a maximum of 5. Reloading this weapon requires using two Actions, and thus can only be done over the course of two turns. Firing this weapon requires BODY 11 or higher unless it is mounted.

DATA

Weapons like the Cowboy and the EMG-86 were designed to be used by heavily cybered individuals.

DATA

Tsunami Arms is a bespoke weapons manufacturer based out of Japan.

MASTER ARMOR LIST

Armor Type	Damage Stopping Power (SP)	Armor Penalty (Minimum 0)	Cost
Leathers	4	None	20eb (Everyday)
Kevlar®	7	None	50eb (Costly)
Light Armorjack	11	None	100eb (Premium)
Bodyweight Suit	11	None	1,000eb (Very Expensive)
Medium Armorjack	12	-2 REF, DEX, and MOVE	100eb (Premium)
Heavy Armorjack	13	-2 REF, DEX, and MOVE	500eb (Expensive)
Flak	15	-4 REF, DEX, and MOVE	500eb (Expensive)
Metalgear®	18	-4 REF, DEX and MOVE	5,000eb (Luxury)
Bulletproof Shield	10 HP which is reduced by damage	None, but always takes up one arm	100eb (Premium)

Leathers: Thin leather with reinforced pads at shoulders, hips, and gut. Favored by Nomads and other 'punks who ride bikes. This also includes all those road-warrior wannabes wearing open-butt chaps and random sports equipment.

Kevlar®: The favored protection for the past 90 years. To quote DuPont: Kevlar® is a heat-resistant, synthetic, lightweight fiber that delivers high tensile strength that brings improved protection and performance across a range of industries and applications. Like when people are trying to stab or shoot you. Can be made into clothes, vests, jackets, business suits, and even bikinis.

Light Armorjack: A combination of Kevlar® and plastic meshes inserted into the weave of the fabric. Armorjack provides superior protection, especially against high-velocity bullets.

Bodyweight Suit: Skinsuit with impact absorbing, sintered armorgel layered in key body areas. Surprisingly, they are also breathable and quite comfortable. Besides giving you a measure of protection, a Bodyweight Suit also has a place to store your Cyberdeck and supports your Interface Plugs so they stay out of the way while you're busy brain-burning that fool who just dared to pop a Hellhound on you. Many Netrunners wear clothing over their Bodyweight Suits, but plenty don't. It's a matter of personal style. **Unlike other armor, a Bodyweight Suit isn't bought in two pieces, and must always be worn on both your body and head location.** Each location has its own SP11. When repaired, both pieces are repaired at the same time. You can't wear more than one Bodyweight Suit. **Wearing a Bodyweight Suit adds one Hardware only Option Slot to a Cyberdeck connected to it.** Hardware installed in the Bodyweight Suit cannot be accessed if the armor isn't worn and can only take up 1 Option Slot.

Medium Armorjack: Heavier Armorjack, with solid plastic plating, reinforced with thicker Kevlar® mesh. Typical Street wear, this combines decent protection with a decent ost.

Heavy Armorjack: The thickest Armorjack, combining denser Kevlar® and a layered mix of plastic and mesh weaves. It stops all but the heaviest attacks, but costs a pretty eb.

Flak: This is the 21st century version of the time-honored flak vest and pants with metal plates designed to provide protection from high explosive weaponry, artillery, grenades, shotguns, and anti-personnel mines. Modern flak will also stop many of the higher caliber rounds from automatic rifles.

Metalgear®: You know how Evil Empire Storm Troopers just seem to stand there and take the hit? Metalgear® is the Dark Future equivalent of that type of armor: solid metal and plastic plates on a mesh body cover. Metalgear® will stop almost anything, but you're going to be easier to hit than a one-legged bantha in a potho race.

Bulletproof Shield: A transparent polycarbonate shield that can protect you in a firefight. See Using a Shield in the Friday Night Firefight Section (PG. 183)

MASTER GEAR LIST

Item	Cost
Agent	100eb (Premium)
Airhypo	50eb (Costly)
Anti-Smog Breathing Mask	20eb (Everyday)
Audio Recorder	100eb (Premium)
Auto Level Dampening Ear Protectors	1,000eb (Very Expensive)
Binoculars	50eb (Costly)
Braindance Viewer	1,000eb (Very Expensive)
Bug Detector	500eb (Expensive)
Carryall	20eb (Everyday)
Chemical Analyzer	1,000eb (Very Expensive)
Computer	50eb (Costly)
Cryopump	5,000eb (Luxury)
Cryotank	5,000eb (Luxury)
Cyberdeck (Excellent Quality)	1,000eb (Very Expensive)
Cyberdeck (Poor Quality)	100eb (Premium)
Cyberdeck (Standard Quality)	500eb (Expensive)
Disposable Cell Phone	50eb (Costly)
Drum Synthesizer	500eb (Expensive)
Duct Tape	20eb (Everyday)
Electric Guitar or another Instrument	500eb (Expensive)
Flashlight	20eb (Everyday)
Food Stick	10eb (Cheap)
Glow Paint	20eb (Everyday)
Glow Stick	10eb (Cheap)
Grapple Gun	100eb (Premium)
Handcuffs	50eb (Costly)
Homing Tracer	500eb (Expensive)

Item	Cost
Inflatable Bed & Sleep-bag	20eb (Everyday)
Kibble Pack	10eb (Cheap)
Linear Frame β (Beta)	5,000eb (Luxury)
Linear Frame Σ (Sigma)	1,000eb (Very Expensive)
Lock Picking Set	20eb (Everyday)
Medscanner	1,000eb (Very Expensive)
Medtech Bag	100eb (Premium)
Memory Chips	10eb (Cheap)
MRE	10eb (Cheap)
Personal CarePak	20eb (Everyday)
Pocket Amplifier	50eb (Costly)
Radar Detector	500eb (Expensive)
Radio Communicator	100eb (Premium)
Radio Scanner/ Music Player	50eb (Costly)
Road Flare	10eb (Cheap)
Rope (60m/yds)	20eb (Everyday)
Scrambler/ Descrambler	500eb (Expensive)
Smart Glasses	500eb (Expensive)
Tech Bag	500eb (Expensive)
Techscanner	1,000eb (Very Expensive)
Techtool	100eb (Premium)
Tent & Camping Equipment	50eb (Costly)
Vial of Biotoxin	500eb (Expensive)
Vial of Poison	100eb (Premium)
Video Camera	100eb (Premium)
Virtuality Goggles	100eb (Premium)

Agent: Self-adaptive-AI powered smartphone; that "learns" how best to fit your needs simply by interacting with you. While not a true AI, it is more than capable of replacing any need for a secretary. When you sit back and allow your Agent to manage your life, everything is easier, including making sure you have time to do what you need to do (crimes, killing people, getting away with it, and so forth) instead of going to the store to get something you forgot. There are many reasons why almost everyone has one.

Things your Agent can do:

- Make phone calls in voice or video and record them, forward them, or send them to voicemail, which pretty much only Agents actually end up listening to nowadays.
- Surf the Data Pool.
- Scan the Data Pool to locate a known location and bring up directions.
- Keep your schedule for you and act independently on events, like ordering a gift and having it delivered to the recipient.
- Maintain a personality complete with name, voice, and virtual body. Some particularly lonely individuals reprogram their Agents to act as surrogate lovers or friends.
- Suggest clothes for you to buy.
- Record audio and video to the Agent's standard Memory Chip.
- Link to your Cyberware to share data storage with them and the Agent's Memory Chip.
- Link to most appliances in your living space.
- Monitor your use of easily acquired resources (Cheap, Everyday, or Costly) and automatically reorder them when you get low at market price.
- Recommend a future course of action based on your personal goals. AI may suggest unwise actions.

In addition to all this, **an Agent gives the user +2 to their Library Search Skill and +2 to their Wardrobe & Style Skill**, but only if you wear the clothes your Agent suggests for you, which change every season. Multiple Agents don't multiply these bonuses.

Airhypo: Easy to use drug distribution platform which uses a quick burst of compressed air to force a drug through the skin. Allows user to use an Action to administer a single dose of a desired drug to a willing target, or try to make a Melee Weapon Attack to administer a single dose to an unwilling target on a hit instead of dealing damage. Reloading the Airhypo with a dose of your desired drug isn't an Action. (**SEE PG. 357** to score some street drugs).

Anti-Smog Breathing Mask: Useful for filtering out toxins and smoke from the local environment. User is immune to the effects of toxic gasses, fumes, and all similar dangers that must be inhaled to affect the user.

Audio Recorder: Device records up to 24 hours of audio before its output fills up a standard Memory Chip stored in the device.

Auto Level Dampening Ear Protectors: Compact ear protection. When worn, user is immune to deafness or other effects caused by dangerously loud noises, like those produced by a flashbang.

Binoculars: You look through them. They double or triple the size of what you are seeing.

Braindance Viewer: Allows the user to experience braindance content. Braindances are digital recordings of an experience which you view through the eyes of the actor. The experience includes all the subject's senses, and you feel every emotion felt, for better or worse.

Bug Detector: Device beeps when user is within 2m/yds of a tap, bug, or other listening device.

Carryall: Heavy ripstop nylon bags of varying sizes, from messenger to nearly man-sized duffel bags.

Chemical Analyzer: Can test substances as an Action to find their precise chemical composition, identifying most substances instantly from a wide database of samples.

Computer: Laptop or desktop computer, used mostly for comfortable word processing and surfing the Data Pool.

Cryopump: A Cryopump is a briefcase-sized tool containing a body bag hooked up to a powerful pump. Once willing/unconscious targets have been placed into the bag and hooked up to the pump as an Action, the pump forces a hyper-cooled chemical fluid into the bag, draining one of the Cryopump's charges per target put in stasis (one per person, if the Cryopump can accept multiple people). While in stasis, targets are unconscious and no longer roll any Death Saves for up to a week, as long as they remain inside the bag and the bag has at least 1 HP. A Character in a cryopump bag is considered to be behind a piece of cover that has 15 HP. The bag's transparent top and gloves molded into the lining allow the target to undergo surgery and be stabilized while in stasis, which is much less dangerous to the patient. A standard Cryopump has only 1 charge and can only hold a single roughly human-sized target. Refueling a Cryopump costs 50eb (Costly) per charge. **A Character who is not a Medtech cannot operate a Cryopump.**

Cryotank: A Cryotank is a human-sized container which can hold a fully grown adult. Assuming the Medtech succeeds at a DV13 Medical Tech Check, the Cryotank keeps 1 person in stasis as long as desired. While in the Cryotank, they are considered to be unconscious, but they heal at double the normal rate as long as they remain inside the tank and the tank has at least 1 HP. A Character in a Cryotank is considered to be behind a piece of cover that has 30 HP. **A Character who is not a Medtech cannot operate a Cryotank.**

Cyberdeck (Excellent Quality): A high-end modular platform that Programs and Hardware are installed on for the purpose of Netrunning. **This cyberdeck has 9 slots to install Programs and Hardware.** Requires Interface Plugs and Neural Link for a Netrunner to operate. See Netrunning Section on **PG. 195.**

Cyberdeck (Poor Quality): A cheap modular platform that Programs and Hardware are installed on for the purpose of Netrunning. **This cyberdeck has 5 slots to install Programs and Hardware.** Requires Interface Plugs and Neural Link for a Netrunner to operate. See Netrunning Section on **PG. 195.**

Cyberdeck (Standard Quality): Modular platform that Programs and Hardware are installed on for the purpose of Netrunning. **This cyberdeck has 7 slots to install Programs and Hardware.** Requires Interface Plugs and Neural Link for a Netrunner to operate. See Netrunning Section on **PG. 195.**

Disposable Cell Phone: There are still billions of the things around. A good choice for Fixers and other people who don't want to be tracked.

Drum Synthesizer: Flat plastic pads of varying sizes, linked by cables to a central processor. Can simulate almost any kind of drum. Requires some type of amplification to be heard.

Duct Tape: Comes in many colors and optionally can glow in the dark. Glowing duct tape is often used to mark tunnels, dead drops, or caches. It glows in the dark even if there has been no light exposure.

Electric Guitar or another Instrument: Use your imagination. But remember that you will need an amp to be heard with any electronic-based instrument.

Flashlight: Rechargeable. 100m/yard beam, lasts up to 10 hours on a charge.

Food Stick: Grainy, dried food bar that comes in a variety of (awful) flavors. One meal.

Glow Paint: Glow in the dark paint for marking locations and creating art. Comes in a spray can. Also good for tagging.

Glow Stick: Light tube to illuminate a 4m/yard area for up to 10 hours. One use only.

Grapple Gun: When wielded in a hand, user as an Action can fire a rocket propelled grapple that will attach securely to any "thick" cover up to 30m/yards away. Line can only support two times the user's body weight, and has 10 HP. The user negates the normal movement penalty for climbing when they climb this line, and can retract the line without an Action, including as they climb. When used as a grapple, user can't hold anything in the hand used to wield the grapple gun. Ineffective as a weapon, and cannot be used to make the Grab Action.

Handcuffs: Book 'em, Danno. Can be broken easily if your BODY is higher than 10.

Homing Tracer: Device can follow a linked tracer up to 1-mile away. Comes with a free button sized linked tracer. Replacement linked tracers are 50eb.

Inflatable Bed & Sleep-bag: It's a self-inflating air mattress than comes packed with a thin sleeping bag. The whole thing folds to a 6"x6" package for easy storage.

Kibble Pack: One foil package of dry, pet food-like cereal or wafers equivalent to a single meal. Usually identified by number rather than the fake appetizing label and description.

Linear Frame B (Beta): Powered exoskeleton, giving the user even more tremendous strength.

- User increases their BODY to 14 while plugged into the frame. This cannot increase the user's BODY to 15 or higher. This increase in BODY **does not** increase the user's HP or change their Death Save.
- Requires 2 installation of Interface Plugs to operate.

Linear Frame Σ (Sigma): Powered exoskeleton, giving the user tremendous strength.

- User increases their BODY to 12 while plugged into the frame using two installations of Interface Plugs. This cannot increase the user's BODY to 13 or higher. This increase in BODY **does not** increase the user's HP or change their Death Save.
- Requires 1 installations of Interface Plugs to operate.

Lock Picking Set: A small pouch of tools for cracking mechanical locks.

Medscanner: Scanner with external probes and contacts that diagnoses injury and illness, assisting user in medical emergencies not requiring Surgery. User adds +2 to their First Aid and Paramedic Skills. This doesn't stack with itself.

Medtech Bag: Medical toolkit that includes everything from dermal staplers to spray skin applicators to sterile scalpels. All you need to save lives using your skills and training.

Memory Chips: Thin wafers of doped plastic that store information in all forms. Some of these are larger than others.

MRE: Self-heating plastic and foil meal bag. Add water, snap the tab on the top, and in 2 minutes you have something that resembles a single hot, nourishing meal.

Personal CarePak: Toothpaste-loaded toothbrush, all body wet-wipes, depilatory paste, comb, etc.

Pocket Amplifier: About the size of a large book, this rechargeable amplifier delivers sound up to 100m/yd for up to 6 hours. Can support two instruments.

Radar Detector: Device beeps if an active radar beam is present within 100m/yds.

Radio Communicator: Earpiece allowing user to communicate via radio, 1-mile range.

Radio Scanner/Music Player: Music player can link to the Data Pool to listen to the hottest music, or play directly from a Memory Chip. User can also scan all radio bands within a mile that are currently being used and tune into them, though some channels might require a Descrambler to understand.

Road Flare: Lights an area of 100m/yards for 1 hour. Different colors. One use.

Rope (60m/yds): Nylon rope. Can come in colors if desired. Holds up to 800lbs (360kg).

Scrambler/Descrambler: Allows user to scramble outgoing communications so they cannot be understood without a descrambler, which is also included at no extra charge.

Smart Glasses: Contains two option slots for Cybereye options. When worn, Smart Glasses give the user access to the benefits of these options. When cybereye options are installed into the glasses, they always count as if they were paired, and it costs the same as installing the option once in a cybereye. You can only wear a single pair at a time. Enthusiasts often replace the frames of their Smart Glasses with nicer ones, as they aren't the prettiest out of the box.

Tech Bag: Small bag of tools for fixing electronics and machines. Includes a Techtool, electrical parts like tape and wire wraps, asst. screws and bolts, plug in modules for repairs, heat torch, 2 small prybars, and hammer.

THE NEW STREET ECONOMY

Techscanner: Scanner diagnoses a wide variety of machinery and electronics, assisting the user in repairs, or other technical work. User adds +2 to their Basic Tech, Cybertech, Land Vehicle Tech, Sea Vehicle Tech, Air Vehicle Tech, Electronics/Security Tech, and Weaponstech Skills. This doesn't stack with itself.

Techtool: Small bag of tools for fixing electronics and machines. Includes a Techtool, electrical parts like tape and wire wraps, asst. screws and bolts, plug in modules for repairs, heat torch, 2 small prybars, and hammer.

Tent and Camping Equipment: Small one-person tube tent with plastic stakes, one self-heating, rechargeable pot to boil water (takes 5 min to recharge, lasts 2 hours) and a cheap metal spork that couldn't hurt a fly.

Vial of Biotoxin: An entire vial of biotoxin can be smeared on any Light Melee Weapon as an Action. For the next 30 minutes after application, instead of dealing the weapon's typical damage, anyone meat hit by the biotoxin-coated Light Melee Weapon must instead attempt to beat a DV15 Resist Torture/Drugs Check. Anyone who fails is dealt 3d6 damage directly to their HP. Their armor isn't ablated because it wasn't interacted with.

Vial of Poison: An entire vial of poison can be smeared on any Light Melee Weapon as an Action. For the next 30 minutes after application, instead of dealing the weapon's typical damage, anyone meat hit by the poisoned Light Melee Weapon must instead attempt to beat a DV13 Resist Torture/Drugs Check. Anyone who fails is dealt 2d6 damage directly to their HP. Their armor isn't ablated because it wasn't interacted with.

Video Camera: When held in a hand, user can record up to 12 hours of video and audio before its output fills up a standard Memory Chip stored in the device.

Virtuality Goggles: Headset that projects cyberspace imagery over your view of the world around you. Highly advised for Netrunners. See Netrunning Section on **PG. 195** for more info.

DATA

Virtuality isn't just for Netrunners. Many people with Interface Plugs use Virtuality to better visualize control panels and displays for the machines they connect to.

BY NEIL BRANQUINHO



FASHION

	Bottoms	Top	Jacket	Footwear	Jewelry	Mirrorshades	Glasses	Contact Lenses	Hats
Bag Lady Chic <i>Homeless Ragged Vagrant</i>	20eb (Everyday)	10eb (Cheap)	20eb (Everyday)	20eb (Everyday)	20eb (Everyday)	20eb (Everyday)	10eb (Cheap)	10eb (Cheap)	10eb (Cheap)
Gang Colors <i>Dangerous Violent Rebellious</i>	50eb (Costly)	20eb (Everyday)	50eb (Costly)	20eb (Everyday)	50eb (Costly)	20eb (Everyday)	20eb (Everyday)	10eb (Cheap)	10eb (Cheap)
Generic Chic <i>Standard Colorful Modular</i>	50eb (Costly)	20eb (Everyday)	50eb (Costly)	20eb (Everyday)	50eb (Costly)	20eb (Everyday)	20eb (Everyday)	10eb (Cheap)	10eb (Cheap)
Bohemian <i>Folksy Retro Free Spirited</i>	50eb (Costly)	20eb (Everyday)	50eb (Costly)	50eb (Costly)	100eb (Premium)	50eb (Costly)	50eb (Costly)	10eb (Cheap)	10eb (Cheap)
Leisurewear <i>Comfort Agility Athleticism</i>	100eb (Premium)	20eb (Everyday)	100eb (Premium)	50eb (Costly)	100eb (Premium)	50eb (Costly)	50eb (Costly)	20eb (Everyday)	50eb (Costly)
Nomad Leathers <i>Western Rugged Tribal</i>	100eb (Premium)	20eb (Everyday)	100eb (Premium)	100eb (Premium)	100eb (Premium)	50eb (Costly)	50eb (Costly)	20eb (Everyday)	100eb (Premium)
Asia Pop <i>Bright Costume-like Youthful</i>	100eb (Premium)	20eb (Everyday)	100eb (Premium)	100eb (Premium)	100eb (Premium)	100eb (Premium)	100eb (Premium)	100eb (Premium)	100eb (Premium)
Urban Flash <i>Flashy Technological Streetwear</i>	100eb (Premium)	20eb (Everyday)	100eb (Premium)	100eb (Premium)	100eb (Premium)	100eb (Premium)	100eb (Premium)	100eb (Premium)	100eb (Premium)
Businesswear <i>Leadership Presence Authority</i>	500eb (Expensive)	50eb (Costly)	500eb (Expensive)	500eb (Expensive)	5,000eb (Luxury)	500eb (Expensive)	500eb (Expensive)	100eb (Premium)	500eb (Expensive)
High Fashion <i>Exclusive Designer Couture</i>	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	500eb (Expensive)	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	5,000eb (Luxury)	50,000eb (Luxury)	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	5,000eb (Luxury)

STREET DRUGS

Drug	Primary Effect Duration	Secondary Effect DV	Cost per Dose
Black Lace	24 Hours	17	50eb (Costly)
Blue Glass	4 Hours	15	20eb (Everyday)
Boost	24 Hours	17	50eb (Costly)
Smash	4 Hours	15	10eb (Cheap)
Synthcoke	4 Hours	15	20eb (Everyday)

► BLACK LACE

Cost per Dose: 50eb (Costly)

Primary Effect

- Lasts 24 Hours.
- User takes 2d6 Humanity Loss upon taking a dose, which is returned if the user isn't affected by Black Lace's Secondary Effect.
- For the duration of the Primary Effect, the user ignores the effects of the Seriously Wounded Wound State.

Secondary Effect (DV17)

- Humanity Loss from Primary Effect isn't returned.
- If the user wasn't already addicted to Black Lace, they are now. While addicted, unless the user is currently experiencing the Primary Effect of Black Lace, their REF is lowered by 2 points.

► BLUE GLASS

Cost per Dose: 20eb (Everyday)

Primary Effect

- Lasts 4 Hours.
- For the duration of the Primary Effect, The GM will occasionally tell you when you are "flashing out," meaning you are hallucinating swirls of vibrant colors in short, powerful bursts. You lose your ability to do an Action on a Turn while in this state.

Secondary Effect (DV15)

- If the user wasn't already addicted to Blue Glass, they are now.
- While addicted, The GM will occasionally tell you when you are "flashing out," hallucinating

in short powerful bursts that cause you to lose your ability to do an Action on a Turn while in this state.

- A Blue Glass Junkie will typically "flash out" once every hour, but this can vary heavily from person to person.
- While addicted to Blue Glass, its Primary Effect changes: Instead of causing you to "flash out", you are instead immune to "flashing out" while experiencing the Primary Effect of Blue Glass. Now, you take it for stability.

► BOOST

Cost per Dose: 50eb (Costly)

Primary Effect

- Lasts 24 Hours.
- For the duration of the Primary Effect, the user's INT increases by 2 points. This can raise your INT above 8.

Secondary Effect (DV17)

- If the user wasn't already addicted to Boost, they are now. While addicted, their INT is lowered by 2 points.

► SMASH

Cost per Dose: 10eb (Cheap)

Primary Effect

- Lasts 4 Hours.
- Yellow, foamy, and sold in cans everywhere.
- For the duration of the Primary Effect, the user feels euphoric, loose, happy, and ready to party. In game terms this gives the user +2 to the following Skills: Dance, Contortionist, Conversation, Human Perception, Persuasion, and Acting.

DATA

Lawmen in Night City usually won't hassle you over drugs unless they're looking for an excuse to mess up your day.

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Secondary Effect (DV15)

- If the user wasn't already addicted to Smash, they are now. While addicted, the user feels a loss of interest in normally enjoyable activities and has -2 to the following Skills: Dance, Contortionist, Conversation, Human Perception, Persuasion, and Acting.
- While addicted to Smash, your GM will occasionally tell you when you crave more Smash, and you should do your best to roleplay accordingly.

► SYNTHCOKE

Cost per Dose: 20eb (Everyday)

Primary Effect

- Lasts 4 Hours.
- For the duration of the Primary Effect, the user's REF increases by 1 point. This can raise your REF above 8. In addition, they are prone to paranoid ideation.
- For the duration of the Primary Effect, your GM will occasionally tell you when you feel paranoid, and you should do your best to roleplay accordingly.

Secondary Effect (DV15)

- If the user wasn't already addicted to Synthcoke, they are now. While addicted, their REF is lowered by 2 points, unless the user is currently experiencing the Primary Effect of Synthcoke.
- While addicted to Synthcoke, your GM will occasionally tell you when you crave more Synthcoke, and you should do your best to roleplay accordingly.

CYBERWARE

► FASHIONWARE [7 FASHIONWARE OPTION SLOTS AVAILABLE]

DATA

A piece of Cyberware only takes up one Option Slot unless otherwise noted.

Name	Install	Description & Data	Cost	HL
Biomonitor	Mall	Subdermal implant which generates a constant LED readout of pulse, temperature, respiration, blood sugar, etc. You can link your Biomonitor to your Agent to allow it to track your wellness.	100eb (Premium)	0 (N/A)
Chemskin	Mall	Dyes and pigments infused into the skin to permanently change its hue, the applications of which can range from hiding blemishes to the desire for neon-green skin. Pigments can optionally be temperature-sensitive or reactant to hormone changes in the body. A user with Chemskin and Techhair adds +2 to their Personal Grooming Skill for having both. (This bonus only applies once)	100eb (Premium)	0 (N/A)
EMP Threading	Mall	Popularized by the media sensation UR, these thin silver lines run in circuit-like patterns across the body. Many people believe they act as a "Faraday cage" to protect you from radiation and EMP effects but so far there's no scientific backing to these claims. But they sure do look cool. Most people wear EMP Threading as a fashion statement.	10eb (Cheap)	0 (N/A)
Light Tattoo	Mall	Subdermal patches store light and project colored tattoos under the skin. The larger the piece, the more installations of this fashionware you need to complete it. A user with a three or more Light Tattoo installations adds +2 to their Wardrobe & Style Skill. (This bonus only applies once.)	100eb (Premium)	0 (N/A)
Shift Tacts	Mall	Color-changing lenses implanted into the eye. Several patterns are also available. Lenses can optionally be temperature-sensitive or reactant to hormone changes in the body. Only one choice of color and pattern can be made, but the user can deactivate the color change at any time desired without an Action.	100eb (Premium)	0 (N/A)

Name	Install	Description & Data	Cost	HL
Skinwatch	Mall	Subdermal implant generates a constant LED readout of the current time and date visible through the skin.	100eb (Premium)	0 (N/A)
Techhair	Mall	Color-light-emitting artificial hair. Hair can optionally be temperature sensitive, motorized to extend/retract, or reactant to hormone changes in the body. A user with Chemskin and Techhair adds +2 to their Personal Grooming Skill for having both. (This bonus only applies once.)	100eb (Premium)	0 (N/A)

► NEURALWARE (FOUNDATIONAL CYBERWARE: NEURAL LINK)

Name	Install	Description & Data	Cost	HL
Neural Link	Clinic	Wired artificial nervous system, required to use Neuralware, and Subdermal Grips. System has 5 Option Slots for Neuralware options.	500eb (Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Braindance Recorder	Clinic	Neuralware Option. Share your story from your point of view! Records braindance content to a standard Memory Chip or a linked Agent. Braindances can be viewed using a Braindance Viewer. Requires Neural Link.	500eb (Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Chipware Socket	Clinic	Neuralware Option. A single socket installed in the back of the neck that allows quick installation of a single piece of Chipware, of which there are many varieties. Installing or uninstalling a single piece of Chipware from a Chipware Socket is an Action. The first time you install a piece of Chipware you've never used before, you always accrue Humanity Loss. Re-installing Chipware you've already used doesn't do this. Chipware does not take up a Neural Link Option Slot. Multiple sockets may be installed, but each must be paid for individually. Requires Neural Link.	500eb (Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Interface Plugs	Clinic	Neuralware Option. Plugs in the wrist or head that allow user to jack into and make use of Smartguns, Cyberdecks, heavy machinery, and drive vehicles with no hands! Multiple installations allow user to be plugged into multiple things at the same time. Requires Neural Link.	500eb (Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Kerenzikov	Clinic	Neuralware Option. Always-on Speedware that provides consistently improved reaction time. User adds +2 to their Initiative Rolls. Only a single piece of Speedware can be installed into a user at a time. Requires Neural Link.	500eb (Expensive)	14 (4d6)
Sandevistan	Clinic	Neuralware Option. Speedware that provides short boosts of highly improved reaction time. When activated as an Action, the user adds +3 to any Initiative Roll they make in the next minute, after which Sandevistan cannot be activated again for an hour. Only a single piece of Speedware can be installed into a user at a time. Requires Neural Link.	500eb (Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Chemical Analyzer	N/A	Chipware. While installed into a Chipware Socket, allows user to test substances to find their precise chemical composition as an Action, identifying most substances instantly from a wide database of samples. Requires Chipware Socket.	500eb (Expensive)	3 (1d6)
Memory Chip	N/A	Chipware. The standard for data storage. While installed into a Chipware socket, the user's cyberware can store data on it or access data stored on it. Requires Chipware Socket.	10eb (Cheap)	0 (N/A)
Olfactory Boost	N/A	Chipware. While installed into a Chipware Socket, the user's sense of smell is boosted, allowing them to use the Tracking Skill to track scent in addition to visual clues. Requires Chipware Socket.	100eb (Premium)	7 (2d6)

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Name	Install	Description & Data	Cost	HL
Pain Editor	N/A	Chipware. While installed into a Chipware Socket, a Pain Editor shuts off the user's pain receptors dynamically, allowing them to ignore the effects of the Seriously Wounded Wound State. Requires Chipware Socket.	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	14 (4d6)
Skill Chip	N/A	Chipware. While installed into a Chipware Socket, a Skill Chip makes the Skill it was made for trained for the user at +3, unless the user's Skill was already trained higher than +3, in which case it does nothing. Skill Chips for (x2) cost Skills are 1,000eb, chips for all other skills are 500eb. Requires Chipware Socket.	500eb (Expensive) or 1,000eb (V. Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Tactile Boost	N/A	Chipware. While installed into a Chipware Socket, it boosts the user's sense of touch, allowing them to detect motion within 20m/yds of them, as long as their hand is touching a surface. While in use as a motion detector, that hand can't be used to do anything else. Requires Chipware Socket.	100eb (Premium)	7 (2d6)

► CYBEROPTICS (FOUNDATIONAL CYBERWARE: CYBEREYE)

Name	Install	Description & Data	Cost	HL
Cybereye	Clinic	All following options are installed in an artificial eye that replaces a meat one. Each Cybereye has 3 Option Slots for Cybereye Options. Some options must be paired to work properly (purchased twice and installed in two different Cybereyes on a user. Humanity Loss is calculated separately for each purchase).	100eb (Premium)	7 (2d6)
Anti-Dazzle	Mall	Cybereye Option. User is immune to blindness or other effects caused by dangerous flashes of light, like those of a flashbang. Requires two Cybereyes and must be paired.	100eb (Premium)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Chyron	Mall	Cybereye Option. Projects a tiny subscreen into user's normal field of vision for messages, video, etc. from a user's other cyberware or electronics. Picture in a picture for real life. Requires a Cybereye.	100eb (Premium)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Color Shift	Mall	Cybereye Option. Cosmetic upgrade allows unlimited color and pattern changes to be made as an Action. Eye can optionally be temperature sensitive or reactant to hormone changes in the body. Requires a Cybereye.	100eb (Premium)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Dartgun	Clinic	Cybereye Option. Dartgun Exotic Weapon, with only a single shot in the clip, concealed inside the Cybereye. Requires a Cybereye and takes 3 Option Slots.	500eb (Expensive)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Image Enhance	Mall	Cybereye Option. User adds +2 to their Perception, Lip Reading, and Conceal/Reveal Object Skills for Checks which include sight. Requires two Cybereyes and must be paired. Multiple installations of this option provide user no additional benefit.	500eb (Expensive)	3 (1d6)
Low Light/ Infrared/ UV	Mall	Cybereye Option. Reduces penalties imposed by darkness and other intangible obscurement, like smoke, fog, etc. to 0. User can distinguish hot meat from cold metal but cannot see through anything that could provide cover. Requires two Cybereyes, must be paired, and takes 2 Option Slots per Cybereye.	500eb (Expensive)	3 (1d6)

Name	Install	Description & Data	Cost	HL
MicroOptics	Clinic	Cybereye Option. Microscope providing user up to 400x magnification. Requires a Cybereye.	100eb (Premium)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
MicroVideo	Clinic	Cybereye Option. Camera in eye records video and audio to a standard Memory Chip or a linked Agent. Requires a Cybereye and takes 2 Option Slots.	500eb (Expensive)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Radiation Detector	Clinic	Cybereye Option. Radiation readings within 100m/yds of the user are displayed in user's vision hovering over their source in the form of a blue glow. Requires a Cybereye.	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	3 (1d6)
Targeting Scope	Clinic	Cybereye Option. User gets a +1 to their Check when making an Aimed Shot. Multiple installations of this option provide user no additional benefit. Requires a Cybereye.	500eb (Expensive)	3 (1d6)
TeleOptics	Clinic	Cybereye Option. User can see detail up to 800m/yds away. When attacking a target 51m/yds or further away with either a weapon's single shot firing mode or an Aimed Shot, you can add a +1 to your Check. Multiple installations of this option provide user no additional benefit. Does not stack with Sniping Scope Weapon Attachment. Requires a Cybereye.	500eb (Expensive)	3 (1d6)
Virtuality	Mall	Cybereye Option. Projects cyberspace imagery over user's view of the world. Never forget your Virtuality Goggles again. Requires two Cybereyes and must be paired.	100eb (Premium)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)

► CYBERAUDIO (FOUNDATIONAL CYBERWARE: CYBERAUDIO SUITE)

Name	Install	Description & Data	Cost	HL
Cyberaudio Suite	Clinic	Cyberaudio Suite is installed invisibly in the inner skull. System has 3 Option Slots for Cyberaudio Options. User can only have one Cyberaudio Suite installed.	500eb (Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Amplified Hearing	Mall	Cyberaudio Option. User adds +2 to their Perception Skill for Checks which include hearing. Requires a Cyberaudio Suite. Multiple installations of this option provide user no additional benefit.	100eb (Premium)	3 (1d6)
Audio Recorder	Clinic	Cyberaudio Option. Records audio to a standard Memory Chip or a linked Agent. Requires a Cyberaudio Suite.	100eb (Premium)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Bug Detector	Mall	Cyberaudio Option. Beeps when user is within 2m/yds of a tap, bug, or other listening device. Requires a Cyberaudio Suite.	100eb (Premium)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Homing Tracer	Clinic	Cyberaudio Option. Can follow a linked tracer up to 1 mile away. Comes with a free button-sized linked tracer. Replacements are 50eb. Requires a Cyberaudio Suite.	100eb (Premium)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)

Name	Install	Description & Data	Cost	HL
Internal Agent	Mall	Cyberaudio Option. Fully functional Agent (See Gear Section PG. 352), controlled entirely via voice commands. Images are described, but output can be linked to a Cybereye with Chyron or a nearby screen if visual output is desired. The implanted Agent's Memory Chip cannot be removed without surgery. Requires a Cyberaudio Suite.	100eb (Premium)	3 (1d6)
Level Damper	Mall	Cyberaudio Option. Automatic noise compensation. User is immune to deafness or other effects caused by dangerously loud noises, like those produced by a flashbang. Requires a Cyberaudio Suite.	100eb (Premium)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Radio Communicator	Mall	Cyberaudio Option. User can communicate via radio, 1-mile range. Requires a Cyberaudio Suite.	100eb (Premium)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Radio Scanner/ Music Player	Clinic	Cyberaudio Option. User can use an Action to scan all radio bands within a mile that are currently being used and tune into them. Music player can link to the Data Pool to listen to the hottest music or play directly from a Memory Chip. Understanding scrambled channels requires a Scrambler/Descrambler. Requires a Cyberaudio Suite.	Costly (50eb)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Radar Detector	Clinic	Cyberaudio Option. Beeps if active radar beam is present within 100m/yds. Requires a Cyberaudio Suite.	500eb (Expensive)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Scrambler Descrambler	Mall	Cyberaudio Option. Allows user to scramble outgoing communications so they cannot be understood without a descrambler, which is also included at no extra charge. Requires a Cyberaudio Suite.	100eb (Premium)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Voice Stress Analyzer	Mall	Cyberaudio Option. User adds +2 to their Human Perception and Interrogation Skills User can activate a special lie-detecting function for a minute with an Action, during which time the GM rolls all your Character's Human Perception and Interrogation Checks privately, beeping once whenever it detects a lie, or whenever they desire after a failed roll. Beware of false positives and negatives. Requires a Cyberaudio Suite. Multiple installations of this option provide user no additional benefit.	100eb (Premium)	3 (1d6)

► INTERNAL BODY CYBERWARE (7 INTERNAL BODY OPTION SLOTS AVAILABLE)

Name	Install	Description & Data	Cost	HL
AudioVox	Clinic	Vocal synthesizer. User adds +2 to their Acting skill and also adds +2 to their Play Instrument Skill while singing. Multiple installations of this option provide user no additional benefit.	500eb (Expensive)	3 (1d6)
Contraceptive Implant	Mall	Implant prevents undesired pregnancy.	10eb (Cheap)	0 (N/A)
Enhanced Antibodies	Mall	After stabilization, the user heals a number of Hit Points equal to twice their BODY for each day they spend resting, doing only light activity, and spending the majority of the day taking it easy until returning to full HP, instead of at their typical rate.	500eb (Expensive)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)

Name	Install	Description & Data	Cost	HL
Cybersnake	Hospital	Horrifying throat/esophagus-mounted tentacle weapon. A Very Heavy Melee Weapon (4d6, 1 ROF) that can be successfully concealed without a Check.	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	14 (4d6)
Gills	Hospital	User can breathe underwater.	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Grafted Muscle and Bone Lace	Hospital	User increases their BODY by 2. This increase in BODY changes a Character's HP and Death Save. This cannot increase the user's BODY to 11 or higher.	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	14 (4d6)
Independent Air Supply	Hospital	Contains 30 minutes of air, before the user needs to refill the tank from the ambient air, which takes an hour. Alternatively, replacing an empty tank with a full one (50eb), takes an Action.	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Midnight Lady™ Sexual Implant	Clinic	Be a Venus, be the fire. Be desire.	100eb (Premium)	7 (2d6)
Mr. Studd™ Sexual Implant	Clinic	All night, every night. And they'll never know.	100eb (Premium)	7 (2d6)
Nasal Filters	Clinic	User is immune to the effects of toxic gasses, fumes, and all similar dangers that must be inhaled to affect the user. User can deactivate nasal filters, if desired, without an Action.	100eb (Premium)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Radar/Sonar Implant	Clinic	Constantly scans terrain within 50m/yds of user, including underwater, for new threats. Scan does not include anything behind cover, like the contents of a room behind a closed door. User receives a beep from the GM along with the direction of its source whenever a new moving object is detected on the scan. Multiple installations of this option provide user no additional benefit.	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Toxin Binders	Clinic	User adds +2 to their Resist Torture/Drugs Skill. Multiple installations of this option provide user no additional benefit.	100eb (Premium)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Vampyres	Clinic	Fangs implanted in the user's mouth. An Excellent Quality Light Melee Weapon (1d6 damage, 2 ROF) that can be successfully concealed without a Check. A Vial of Poison or Biotoxin (purchased separately, see Gear List on PG. 355) can be safely stored and concealed in a compartment in the roof of the mouth near the fangs without a Check. The contents of the stored vial can then be applied to the Vampyres silently anytime without an Action. Each application uses an entire vial and lasts for 30 minutes. Installation of Vampyres includes a complete rework of the user's mouth which prevents the possibility of poisoning yourself accidentally with your fangs halfway through a slice of pizza or due to a bad Check.	500eb (Expensive)	14 (4d6)

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There's full data
on Weapon
Quality on
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► EXTERNAL BODY CYBERWARE (7 EXTERNAL BODY OPTION SLOTS AVAILABLE)

Name	Install	Description & Data	Cost	HL
Hidden Holster	Clinic	Holster inside the user's body can store a weapon already capable of concealment so that it can be successfully concealed without a roll. Weapon can be drawn from the hidden holster without an Action, as long as it is implanted in an easily accessible place on the user's body. You don't want one in your thigh unless you don't wear pants.	500eb (Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Skin Weave	Hospital	User's body and head are armored at SP7. Your SP in any location is determined by your highest source of SP in that location. Additionally, whenever your armor is ablated in a location, all your sources of SP in that location are ablated at the same time. Whenever the user successfully completes a day of natural healing, nanomachines present in the Skin Weave repair both the body and head location of the Skin Weave for one point of its lost SP.	500eb (Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Subdermal Armor	Hospital	User's body and head are armored at SP11. Your SP in any location is determined by your highest source of SP in that location. Additionally, whenever your armor is ablated in a location, all your sources of SP in that location are ablated at the same time. Whenever the user successfully completes a day of natural healing, nanomachines present in the Subdermal Armor repair both the body and head location of the Subdermal Armor for one point of its lost SP.	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	14 (4d6)
Subdermal Pocket	Clinic	2"x4" (5cm x 10cm) space with a Realskinn™ zipper. Contents can be successfully concealed without a Check.	100eb (Premium)	3 (1d6)

► CYBERLIMBS (FOUNDATIONAL CYBERWARE: CYBERARM OR CYBERLEG)

Name	Install	Description & Data	Cost	HL
Cyberarm	Hospital	Replacement arm. Does not have to be paired. A Cyberarm has 4 Option Slots for Cyberarm or Cyberlimb Options , and each comes pre-installed with a Standard Hand that doesn't cost any Humanity Loss or take up a Cyberarm Option Slot.	500eb (Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Standard Hand	Clinic	Resembles a normal hand. If installed into a meat arm, a standard hand doesn't count towards the number of pieces of cyberware installed in a meat arm. Doesn't take up a Cyberarm Option Slot.	100eb (Premium)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Big Knucks	Clinic	Cyberarm Option. Armored knuckles. A Medium Melee Weapon (2d6 damage, 2 ROF) that can be successfully concealed without a Check. When wielded as a weapon, user can't hold anything in this arm's hand. Can be installed as the only piece of Cyberware in a meat arm.	100eb (Premium)	3 (1d6)
Cyberdeck	Clinic	Cyberarm Option. Cyberdeck permanently installed into the user's Cyberarm. A Cyberdeck must be provided by the user at the time of installation. In addition to never accidentally misplacing your Cyberdeck, integration into a Cyberarm gives any Cyberdeck 1 extra slot that can be used for either Programs or Hardware. This is a permanent upgrade. Attempting to uninstall the Cyberdeck from the Cyberarm breaks it beyond repair, but any Programs or Hardware on it could be easily recovered. Requires a Cyberarm and takes 3 Option Slots. Cyberdeck still requires Interface Plugs and Neural Link to be operated by the user.	500eb (Expensive)	3 (1d6)

Name	Install	Description & Data	Cost	HL
Grapple Hand	Clinic	Cyberarm Option. User, as an Action, can fire a rocket propelled grapple that will attach securely to any Thick cover up to 30m/yds away. Line can only support two times the user's body weight, and has 10 HP. The user negates the normal movement penalty for climbing when they climb this line, and can retract the line without an Action, including as they climb. When used as a grapple, user can't hold anything in this arm's hand. Ineffective as a weapon and cannot be used to make the Grab Action. Requires a Cyberarm.	100eb (Premium)	3 (1d6)
Medscanner	Clinic	Cyberarm Option. Scanner with external probes and contacts diagnoses injury and illness, assisting user in medical emergencies not requiring the Surgery Skill. User adds +2 to their First Aid and Paramedic Skills. Requires a Cyberarm and takes 2 Option Slots. Multiple installations of this option provide user no additional benefit.	500eb (Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Popup Grenade Launcher	Clinic	Cyberarm Option. A One-Handed Grenade Launcher with only a single grenade in its magazine that is incompatible with all Weapon Attachments except Smartgun Link is installed into the Cyberarm. Launcher can be successfully concealed without a Check and can be drawn and stowed without an Action. While the weapon is "popped up," the user can't hold anything in this arm's hand. Requires a Cyberarm and takes 2 Option Slots.	500eb (Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Popup Melee Weapon	Clinic	Cyberarm Option A One-Handed Light, Medium, or Heavy Melee Weapon (that need not be concealable before its installation) is installed in a Cyberarm so that it can be successfully concealed without a roll, and can be drawn and stowed without an Action. While the weapon is "popped up," the user can't hold anything in this arm's hand. Requires a Cyberarm and takes 2 Option Slots.	500eb (Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Popup Shield	Clinic	Cyberarm Option. A Bulletproof Shield which is concealed while it is folded inside the Cyberarm. It can be drawn or stowed without an Action, provided that the shield has more than 0 HP. When extended, you can't use the Cyberarm to do anything else other than serve as a shield, and you can't hold anything in that Cyberarm's hand other than the shield. The Bulletproof Shield installed inside your Cyberarm is easily removable and replaceable with another Bulletproof Shield, for ease of cleaning and repair. Requires a Cyberarm and takes 3 Option Slots. See Using Shields in the Combat Section on PG. 183.	500eb (Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Popup Ranged Weapon	Clinic	Cyberarm Option. A One-Handed Ranged Weapon (that need not be concealable before its installation) provided by the user is permanently installed into the Cyberarm (along with any weapon attachments attached to it) so that it can be successfully concealed without a Check, and can be drawn and stowed without an Action. While the weapon is "popped up," the user can't hold anything in this arm's hand. Requires a Cyberarm and takes 2 Option Slots.	500eb (Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Quick Change Mount	Clinic	Cyberarm Option. Cyberarm can be installed in an open socket or uninstalled with an Action. The first time you install a brand new Cyberarm, whether using a Quick Change Mount or otherwise, you always accrue Humanity Loss. Reattaching one you've already used before with a Quick Change Mount does not do this. Requires a Cyberarm.	100eb (Premium)	7 (2d6)
Rippers	Clinic	Cyberarm Option. Extendable Carbo-glass fingernails. A Medium Melee Weapon (2d6 damage, 2 ROF) that can be successfully concealed without a Check. When wielded as a weapon, user can't hold anything in this arm's hand. Can be installed as the only piece of Cyberware in a meat arm.	500eb (Expensive)	3 (1d6)

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Name	Install	Description & Data	Cost	HL
Scratchers	Mall	Cyberarm Option. Carbo-glass artificial fingernails that cut on a diagonal slice. A Light Melee Weapon (1d6 damage, 2 ROF) that can be successfully concealed without a Check. When wielded as a weapon, user can't hold anything in this arm's hand. Can be installed as the only piece of Cyberware in a meat arm.	100eb (Premium)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Shoulder Cam	Clinic	Cyberarm Option. Camera in a popup in the user's shoulder that tracks independently of the user and records video and audio to an onboard Memory Chip or a linked Agent. Camera can be successfully concealed without a Check and can be drawn and stowed without an Action. Requires a Cyberarm and takes 2 Option Slots.	500eb (Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Slice 'N Dice	Clinic	Cyberarm Option. Monofilament whip implanted in the user's thumb. A Medium Melee Weapon (2d6 damage, 2 ROF) that can be successfully concealed without a Check. When wielded as a weapon, user can't hold anything in this arm's hand. Can be installed as the only piece of Cyberware in a meat arm.	500eb (Expensive)	3 (1d6)
Subdermal Grip	Clinic	Cyberarm Option. Neuralware Option. Subdermal plate under the palm allows user to make use of Smartguns. A cost-effective alternative to Interface Plugs. Can be installed as the only piece of Cyberware in a meat arm. Requires Neural Link and takes up a Neuralware Option Slot.	100eb (Premium)	3 (1d6)
Techscanner	Clinic	Cyberarm Option. Scanner diagnoses a wide variety of machinery and electronics, assisting the user in repairs or other technical work. User adds +2 to their Basic Tech, Cybertech, Land Vehicle Tech, Sea Vehicle Tech, Air Vehicle Tech, Electronics/Security Tech, and Weaponstech Skills. Requires a Cyberarm and takes 2 Option Slots. Multiple installations of this option provide user no additional benefit.	500eb (Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Tool Hand	Clinic	Cyberarm Option. Fingers contain screwdriver, wrench, small drill, etc. Never be without your Techtool! Can be installed as the only piece of Cyberware in a meat arm.	100eb (Premium)	3 (1d6)
Wolvers	Clinic	Cyberarm Option. Extendable Carbo-glass claws in the knuckles. A Heavy Melee Weapon (3d6 damage, 2 ROF) that can be successfully concealed without a Check. When wielded as a weapon, user can't hold anything in this arm's hand. Can be installed as the only piece of Cyberware in a meat arm.	500eb (Expensive)	7 (2d6)
Cyberleg	Hospital	Replacement leg. Does not have to be paired. A Cyberleg has 3 Option Slots for Cyberleg or Cyberlimb Options and each comes pre-installed with a Standard Foot that doesn't cost any Humanity Loss or take up a Cyberleg Option Slot. Most Cyberleg options must be paired to work properly (purchased twice and installed in two different Cyberlegs on a user. Humanity Loss is calculated separately for each purchase).	100eb (Premium)	3 (1d6)
Standard Foot	Clinic	Resembles a normal foot. If installed into a meat leg, a Standard Foot doesn't count towards the number of pieces of cyberware installed in a meat leg. Doesn't take up a Cyberleg Option Slot.	100eb (Premium)	2 (1d6/2 Round up)
Grip Foot	Clinic	Cyberleg Option. Feet are coated with state-of-the-art traction material. The user negates the normal movement penalty for climbing. Requires two Cyberlegs and must be paired.	500eb (Expensive)	3 (1d6)
Jump Booster	Clinic	Hydraulics in legs. Negates movement penalty when jumping. Requires two Cyberlegs, takes up 2 Option Slots, and must be paired.	500eb (Expensive)	3 (1d6)
Skate Foot	Clinic	Inline skates built into feet. Can be concealed. Increases movement by 6m/yds when using Run Action. Requires two Cyberlegs and must be paired.	500eb (Expensive)	3 (1d6)

Name	Install	Description & Data	Cost	HL
Talon Foot	Clinic	Blade mounted in foot. Light Melee Weapon. Can be concealed without a Check. Can be installed as the only piece of Cyberware in a meat leg.	500eb (Expensive)	3 (1d6)
Web Foot	Clinic	Thin webbing between toes. Negates movement penalty when swimming. Requires Two Cyberlegs and must be paired.	500eb (Expensive)	3 (1d6)
Hardened Shielding	Clinic	Cyberlimb Option. Cyberlimb and installed options cannot be rendered inoperable by EMP effects, like Microwaver pulses, or Non-Black ICE Program effects. Requires Cyberarm or Cyberleg.	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	3 (1d6)
Plastic Covering	Mall	Cyberlimb Option. Plastic coating for Cyberlimb. Available in wide variety of colors and patterns. Requires a Cyberarm or Cyberleg but does not take an Option Slot.	100eb (Premium)	0 (N/A)
Realskinn™ Covering	Mall	Cyberlimb Option. Artificial skin coating for Cyberlimb. Requires a Cyberarm or Cyberleg but does not take an Option Slot.	500eb (Expensive)	0 (N/A)
Superchrome® Covering	Mall	Cyberlimb Option. Shiny metallic coating for Cyberlimb. +2 to Wardrobe and Style. This bonus only applies once. Requires a Cyberarm or Cyberleg but does not take an Option Slot.	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	0 (N/A)

► BORGWARE

Name	Install	Description & Data	Cost	HL
Artificial Shoulder Mount	Hospital	User can mount 2 Cyberarms under first set of arms. User can only have one Artificial Shoulder Mount installed.	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	14 (4d6)
Implanted Linear Frame Σ (Sigma)	Hospital	An enhanced skeleton and support structure with hydraulic and myomar muscles. - User increases their BODY to 12. - This increase in BODY changes a Character's HP and Death Save. - This cannot increase the user's BODY to 13 or higher. Installation requires BODY 6 and Grafted Muscle and Bone Lace.	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	14 (4d6)
Implanted Linear Frame Β (Beta)	Hospital	A heavily enhanced skeleton and support structure with even more hydraulic and myomar muscles. - User increases their BODY to 14. - This increase in BODY changes a Character's HP and Death Save. - This cannot increase the user's BODY to 15 or higher. Installation requires BODY 8 and Two Grafted Muscle and Bone Lace.	5,000eb (Luxury)	14 (4d6)
MultiOptic Mount	Hospital	User can mount up to 5 additional Cybereyes into the MultiOptic Mount. Cybereyes sold and installed separately. User can only have one MultiOptic Mount installed.	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	14 (4d6)
Sensor Array	Clinic	Twin flattened antennae protruding from the user's head improving their Cyberaudio Suite, sometimes referred to as "Rabbit Ears." User can install up to 5 additional Cyberaudio Options into their Cyberaudio Suite. User can only have one Sensor Array installed. Requires Cyberaudio Suite but doesn't take up a Cyberaudio Option Slot.	1,000eb (V. Expensive)	14 (4d6)

THE NEW STREET ECONOMY

CYBERDECK HARDWARE

DATA

A piece of Cyberdeck Hardware only takes up one Option Slot unless otherwise noted.

Name	Data	Cost
Backup Drive	While installed on a Cyberdeck, a Backup Drive "saves" Non-Black ICE Attacker, Defender, or Booster Programs that are destroyed by pulling them into the Backup Drive the instant before they meet their end. As a Meat Action, a Netrunner can re-install all Programs "saved" by the Backup Drive onto their deck, if they have the Slots for them. If removed from a Cyberdeck, the Backup Drive erases its contents automatically. Restored Programs with once-per-Netrun restrictions and the like are restored in the exact state they were saved in, so you can't kill your own Armor to refresh it. Yeah, that means you. Takes 2 Hardware Option Slots.	100eb (Premium)
DNA Lock	A Cyberdeck with a DNA Lock can be locked and unlocked using a thumbprint, iris scan, blood sample, or any other biometric method desired. The method varies depending on the model of the DNA Lock. A locked Cyberdeck cannot be accessed without either its biometric key or a DV 17 Electronics/Security Tech Check. Takes 2 Hardware Option Slots.	100eb (Premium)
Hardened Circuitry	A Cyberdeck with Hardened Circuitry cannot be rendered temporarily disabled, rendered inoperable, or destroyed by EMP effects like pulses, or Non-Black ICE Program Effects.	100eb (Premium)
Insulated Wiring	A Cyberdeck with Insulated Wiring cannot catch fire or cause the user's clothing to catch fire as the result of a Program effect.	100eb (Premium)
KRASH Barrier	A Cyberdeck with a KRASH Barrier is immune to any Program Effect that force the Netrunner to Jack Out, safely or unsafely. Takes 2 Hardware Option Slots.	100eb (Premium)
Range Upgrade	A Cyberdeck with a Range Upgrade can connect to an access point from up to 8m away.	100eb (Premium)

PROGRAMS

▶ BOOSTERS

Name	Class	ATK	DEF	REZ	Effect	Cost
Eraser	Booster	0	0	7	Increases all Cloak Checks you make by +2 as long as this Program remains Rezzed.	20eb (Everyday)
Icon: A pink glob exuding tiny soap bubbles.						
See Ya	Booster	0	0	7	Increases all Pathfinder Checks you make by +2 as long as this Program remains Rezzed.	20eb (Everyday)
Icon: Shimmering silver magnifying glass spinning slowly in place.						
Speedy Gonzalvez	Booster	0	0	7	Increases your Speed by +2 as long as this Program remains Rezzed.	100eb (Premium)
Icon: A trail of dust appearing behind the Netrunner as they move.						
Worm	Booster	0	0	7	Increases all Backdoor Checks you make by +2 as long as this Program remains Rezzed.	50eb (Costly)
Icon: A golden mechanical worm with neon green eyes.						

DEFENDERS

Name	Class	ATK	DEF	REZ	Effect	Cost
Armor	Defender	0	0	7	Lowers all brain damage you would receive by 4, as long as this Program remains Rezzed. Only 1 copy of this Program can be running at a time. Each copy of this Program can only be used once per Netrun.	50eb (Costly)
Icon: Transparent golden armor worn by the Netrunner.						
Flak	Defender	0	0	7	Reduces the ATK of all Non-Black ICE Attacker Programs run against you to 0 as long as this Program remains Rezzed. Only 1 copy of this Program can be running at a time. Each copy of this Program can only be used once per Netrun.	50eb (Costly)
Icon: A cloud of blinding, glowing, multi-colored lights swirling around the Netrunner.						
Shield	Defender	0	0	7	Stops the first successful Non-Black ICE Program Effect from dealing brain damage. After stopping this damage, the Shield Derezzes itself. Only 1 copy of this Program can be running at a time. Each copy of this Program can only be used once per Netrun.	20eb (Everyday)
Icon: Flickering silver energy barrier surrounding the Netrunner.						

ATTACKERS

Name	Class	ATK	DEF	REZ	Effect	Cost
Banhammer	Anti-Program Attacker	1	0	0	Does 3d6 REZ to a Non-Black ICE Program, or 2d6 REZ to a Black ICE Program.	50eb (Costly)
Icon: A giant glowing white sledgehammer wielded by the Netrunner.						
Sword	Anti-Program Attacker	1	0	0	Does 3d6 REZ to a Black ICE Program, or 2d6 REZ to a Non-Black ICE Program.	50eb (Costly)
Icon: Glowing energy katana appearing from the Netrunner's hand.						
DeckKRASH	Anti-Personnel Attacker	0	0	0	Enemy Netrunner is forcibly and unsafely Jacked Out of the Architecture, suffering the effect of all Rezzed enemy Black ICE they've encountered in the Architecture as they leave.	100eb (Premium)
Icon: Cartoon stick of dynamite thrown by the Netrunner.						
Hellbolt	Anti-Personnel Attacker	2	0	0	Does 2d6 Damage direct to the enemy Netrunner's brain. Unless insulated, their Cyberdeck catches fire along with their clothing. Until they spend a Meat Action to put themselves out, they take 2 damage to their HP whenever they end their Turn. Multiple instances of this effect cannot stack.	100eb (Premium)
Icon: Bolt of crimson fire launched from the Netrunner's hand.						
Nervescrub	Anti-Personnel Attacker	0	0	0	Enemy Netrunner's INT, REF, and DEX are each lowered by 1d6 for the next hour (minimum 1). The effects are largely psychosomatic and leave no permanent effects.	100eb (Premium)
Icon: Chrome ball thrown by the Netrunner that sparks with electricity.						

THE NEW STREET ECONOMY

Name	Class	ATK	DEF	REZ	Effect	Cost
Poison Flatline	Anti-Personnel Attacker	0	0	0	Destroys a single Non-Black ICE Program installed on the Netrunner target's Cyberdeck at random.	100eb (Premium)
Icon: Beam of neon green light shot from the Netrunner's finger.						
Superglue	Anti-Personnel Attacker	2	0	0	Enemy Netrunner cannot progress deeper into the Architecture or Jack Out safely for 1d6 Rounds (enemy Netrunner can still perform an unsafe Jack Out, though). Each copy of this Program can only be used once per Netrun.	100eb (Premium)
Icon: A mass of sticky red goop fired from the Netrunner's hand.						
Vrizzbolt	Anti-Personnel Attacker	1	0	0	Does 1d6 Damage direct to a Netrunner's brain and lowers the amount of total NET Actions the Netrunner can accomplish on their next Turn by 1 (minimum 2).	50eb (Costly)
Icon: A double helix comprised of flickering neon light appearing from the Netrunner's finger.						

► BLACK ICE

DATA

Black ICE takes up 2 Option Slots in a Cyberdeck. All other Programs take 1 Option Slot.

Name	Class	PER	SPD	ATK	DEF	REZ	Effect	Cost
Asp	Anti-Personnel Black ICE	4	6	2	2	15	Destroys a single Program installed on the enemy Netrunner's Cyberdeck at random.	100eb (Premium)
Icon: Golden Egyptian cobra, spitting beams of neon green light.								
Giant	Anti-Personnel Black ICE	2	2	8	4	25	Does 3d6 damage direct to an enemy Netrunner's brain. The Netrunner is forcibly and unsafely Jacked Out of their current Netrun. They suffer the effect of all Rezzed enemy Black ICE they've encountered in the Architecture as they leave, not including the Giant.	1,000eb (V. Expensive)
Icon: A massive pair of feet and ankles towering above the enemy Netrunner.								
Hellhound	Anti-Personnel Black ICE	6	6	6	2	20	Does 2d6 damage direct to the Netrunner's brain. Unless insulated, their Cyberdeck catches fire along with their clothing. Until they spend a Meat Action to put themselves out, they take 2 damage to their HP whenever they end their Turn. Multiple instances of this effect cannot stack.	500eb (Expensive)
Icon: A huge, black metal wolf. Its eyes glow white and fire runs in ripples all over its body. It speaks in a grating, metallic voice, repeating the enemy Netrunner's name.								
Kraken	Anti-Personnel Black ICE	6	2	8	4	30	Does 3d6 damage direct to an enemy Netrunner's brain. Until the end of the Netrunner's next Turn, the Netrunner cannot progress deeper into the Architecture or Jack Out safely (The Netrunner can still perform an unsafe Jack Out).	1,000eb (V. Expensive)
Icon: A mass of thrashing, orange tentacles protruding from the walls. Their suckers are covered in sticky red goop.								

Name	Class	PER	SPD	ATK	DEF	REZ	Effect	Cost
Liche	Anti-Personnel Black ICE	8	2	6	2	25	Enemy Netrunner's INT, REF, and DEX are each lowered by 1d6 for the next hour (minimum 1). The effects are largely psychosomatic and leave no permanent effects.	500eb (Expensive)
Icon: Metallic skeleton draped in black robes. Its hands are studded with blackened rings that spark with electricity.								
Raven	Anti-Personnel Black ICE	6	4	4	2	15	Derezzes a single Defender Program the enemy Netrunner has Rezzed at random, then deals 1d6 damage direct to the Netrunner's brain.	50eb (Costly)
Icon: Raven adorned in plate armor wielding a glowing white lance.								
Scorpion	Anti-Personnel Black ICE	2	6	2	2	15	Enemy Netrunner's MOVE is lowered by 1d6 for the next hour (minimum 1). The effects are largely psychosomatic and leave no permanent effects.	100eb (Premium)
Icon: A tiny black scorpion that hisses very loudly whenever the enemy Netrunner speaks.								
Skunk	Anti-Personnel Black ICE	2	4	4	2	10	Until this Program is Derezzed, an enemy Netrunner hit by this Effect makes all Slide Checks at a -2. Each Skunk Black ICE can only affect a single Netrunner at a time, but the effects of multiple Skunks can stack.	500eb (Expensive)
Icon: Cartoon skunk that walks on its hind legs, following the Netrunner much too closely.								
Wisp	Anti-Personnel Black ICE	4	4	4	2	15	Does 1d6 damage direct to the enemy Netrunner's brain and lowers the amount of total NET Actions the Netrunner can accomplish on their next Turn by 1 (minimum 2).	50eb (Costly)
Icon: Orb of light with a single minuscule eye crackling with energy.								
Dragon	Anti-Program Black ICE	6	4	6	6	30	Deals 6d6 damage to a Program. If this damage would be enough to Derezz the Program, it is instead Destroyed.	1,000eb (V. Expensive)
Icon: Golden-scaled dragon robot wreathed in electrical discharges.								
Killer	Anti-Program Black ICE	4	8	6	2	20	Deals 4d6 damage to a Program. If this damage would be enough to Derezz the Program, it is instead Destroyed.	500eb (Expensive)
Icon: Robotic samurai with red eyes wielding a glowing katana.								
Sabertooth	Anti-Program Black ICE	8	6	6	2	25	Deals 6d6 damage to a Program. If this damage would be enough to Derezz the Program, it is instead Destroyed.	1,000eb (V. Expensive)
Icon: Immense hulking cat with glowing white tusks.								

THE NEW STREET ECONOMY

BUYING A NET ARCHITECTURE

► NUMBER OF FLOORS

Number of Floors	Maximum Control Nodes	Portable?	Cost per Floor
3 to 6	2	Yes	1,000eb (V. Expensive)
7 to 12	3	No	5,000eb (Luxury)
13 to 18	N/A	No	10,000eb (Super Luxury)

► ADDING PASSWORDS, CONTROL NODES, AND FILES

Netrunner DV to Beat Feature	Cost
DV6	500eb (Expensive)
DV8	1,000eb (V. Expensive)
DV10	5,000eb (Luxury)
DV12	10,000eb (Super Luxury)

► ADDING DEMONS AND OTHER BLACK ICE

You can place 2 or 3 Black ICE on the same Floor but the cost multiplies. If you have 2 Black ICE on a Floor, double the cost of both. If you have 3 Black ICE on a Floor, triple the cost of each. You cannot put more than one Demon on the same Floor and no more than one Demon per six floors of NET Architecture.

Name	REZ	Interface	NET Actions	Combat Number	Cost
Imp	15	3	2	14	1,000eb (Very Expensive)
 Icon: Small orange sphere of light with red horns.					
Efreet	25	4	3	14	5,000eb (Luxury)
 Icon: Tall, powerfully built Black man, dressed in elegant evening clothes completed with a fez and dagger.					
Balron	30	7	4	14	10,000eb (Super Luxury)
 Icon: Huge humanoid monster in futuristic black armor or covered with hissing green glowing tentacles.					

► ADDING DEFENSES TO CONTROL NODES

DV to Counter with Electronics/Security Tech	Price
DV9	500eb (Expensive)
DV13	1,000eb (V. Expensive)
DV17	5,000eb (Luxury)
DV21	10,000eb (Super Luxury)

► Active Defenses ◀

Type	Description	Default Trigger	Data
Air Swarm Drone Cloud	Tiny flying drones about the size of gnats, with nanowire cutting surfaces. Treat the cloud as a single entity wielding a Very Heavy Melee Weapon. DV17 Electronics/Security Tech, 5 min to counter.	Target enters area without wearing proper pass or badge.	8 MOVE • 15HP Perimeter of Defended Area
Ground Drone	Comes in various forms, including Rolling Ball, Tracked, Wheeled, or Snake Form. Ground Drones are equipped with 2 of the following: • Very Heavy Pistol with 8 Armor Piercing Bullets • Medium SMG with 30 Basic Bullets • Observation camera DV21 Electronics/Security Tech, 5 min to counter.	Target enters area without wearing proper pass or badge.	4 MOVE • 30HP Perimeter of Defended Area
Large Air Drone	Large Air Drones are equipped with 2 of the following: • Dartgun with 8 Poison Arrows • Very Heavy Pistol with 8 Armor Piercing Bullets • Observation camera DV21 Electronics/Security Tech, 5 mins to counter.	Target enters area without wearing proper pass or badge.	6 MOVE • 20HP Perimeter of Defended Area
Mini Air Drone	Mini Air Drones are equipped with 1 of the following: • Dartgun with 8 Poison Arrows • Very Heavy Pistol with 8 Armor Piercing Bullets • Observation camera DV17 Electronics/Security Tech, 5 min to counter.	Target enters area without wearing proper pass or badge.	6 MOVE • 15HP Perimeter of Defended Area
Spider Walking Drone	Spider drones may be equipped with 2 of the following: • Grenade Launcher with 2 Targas Grenades • Very Heavy Melee Weapon • Heavy SMG with 40 Basic Bullets • Observation camera DV21 Electronics/Security Tech, 5min to counter.	Target enters area without wearing proper pass or badge.	4 MOVE • 40HP Perimeter of Defended Area

► Emplaced Defenses ◀

Type	Description	Default Trigger	Data
Automated Blood Swarm	Automated weapon disperses a swarm of nanites into the room as a red fog. The nanites, when inhaled, attack their victim from within by binding the hemoglobin in their blood into clots. Anything that filters gas attacks blocks the Automated Blood Swarm. Everyone Meat within the Defended Area must succeed at a DV15 Resist Torture/Drugs Check. Anyone who fails is dealt 3d6 damage directly to their HP. Their armor isn't ablated. DV21 Electronics/Security Tech, 5 min to counter.	Target enters room without wearing proper pass or badge.	Single Attack on all targets Perimeter of Defended Area
Automated Melee Weapon	An automated Very Heavy Melee Weapon, typically attacking from one corner of a room. Often, it takes the form of an industrial-grade water cutter or spinning Monofilament wire. DV17 Electronics/Security Tech, 5 min to counter.	Target enters room without wearing proper pass or badge. Melee Weapon continues to attack until all targets are dead or no longer in range, or proper badge is presented.	Combat Number 14 25HP Perimeter of Defended Area
Automated Turret	This is an automated weapon, usually implanted in the ceiling of a room for best coverage. Most Ranged Weapons can be installed as an Automated Turret, although typically they will be equipped with 1 of the following: - Assault Rifle with 25 Basic Bullets - Flamethrower with 4 Incendiary Shotgun Shells - Dartgun with 8 Poison Arrows - Very Heavy Pistol with 8 Armor Piercing Bullets - Heavy SMG with 40 Basic Bullets DV17 Electronics/Security Tech, 5 min to counter.	Target enters room without wearing proper pass or badge. Turret continues to fire until target is dead, or no longer in range, or proper badge is presented.	Combat Number 14 25HP Perimeter of Defended Area

► Environmental Defenses ◀

Type	Description	Default Trigger	Data
Observation Cameras	These cameras can see in Low Light, Infrared, and UV, and report images for a Demon or security personnel to act on. DV9 Electronics/Security Tech, 1 min to counter.	Target enters room.	5HP Perception DV17 to spot Can see one entire room or corridor
Tanglefoot Flooring	This is a network of nanowire concealed in a seemingly normal carpet. When triggered, the wires extend and wrap around the feet and legs of the target, reducing their MOVE by 1d6 until the carpet is destroyed or they get off the carpet. DV13 Electronics/Security Tech, 1 min to counter.	Target steps onto the carpet.	20HP Perception DV17 to spot 1 ROF Perimeter of Defended Area
Electrical Flooring	This is a grid wired into a standard floor, which, when triggered, delivers a shocking 6d6 damage to the target's body, reduced by armor which it doesn't ablate. Target is shocked again at the end of their next Turn and each of their additional Turns until they get off the flooring. DV13 Electronics/Security Tech, 1 min to counter.	Target steps onto the grid area.	20HP Perception DV17 to spot Perimeter of Defended Area

Type	Description	Default Trigger	Data
Laser Grid	Laser grid projected from the ceiling and walls in a tight pattern. Treat touching one of the lasers like getting hit in the body with a Very Heavy Melee Weapon. If perceived, the Laser Grid can be crossed safely with a DV17 Contortionist Check, touching a laser on a failure. DV17 Electronics/Security Tech, 5 min to counter.	Target steps into the Defended Area or moves 2m/yds within the Defended Area.	Perception DV17 to spot Perimeter of Defended Area
Tip-floor	A section of this floor is counter-weighted to drop the target into a pit trap below the floor. Targets can attempt to save themselves from falling with a DV15 Athletics Check. No Check is required if target has a Grapple Hand or Grapple Gun easily accessible. The bottom of the pit may have a grid of nanowire or spikes delivering 6d6 damage to the target's body. DV13 Electronics/Security Tech, 1 min to counter.	Target steps onto the tip-floor.	Perception DV17 to spot Perimeter of Defended Area
Goop	This is a series of sprayers that when triggered project a thick goo around the feet and legs of the target, reducing their MOVE by 2d6 until the goop is destroyed or they otherwise escape the Defended Area. DV13 Electronics/Security Tech, 1 min to counter.	Target steps into the spray area.	10HP Perception DV17 to spot 1 ROF Perimeter of Defended Area
Ceiling/Wall Punchers	Steel rods that slam down in a grid from the ceiling, or out from the wall crushing targets beneath/between them with 6d6 damage to their body, which is reduced by armor. DV13 Electronics/Security Tech, 5 min to counter.	Target steps onto the grid area.	20HP Perception DV17 to spot 1 ROF Perimeter of Defended Area
Slip-floor	This is a series of sprayers that when triggered projects a super slick liquid across the floor of the area. Anyone who takes a Movement Action in this area must succeed at a DV15 Athletics Check or fall Prone. DV13 Electronics/Security Tech, 1 min to counter.	Target steps onto the spray area.	10HP Perception DV17 to spot Perimeter of Defended Area
Stun Panels	These are panels embedded in the walls and designed to look like art or whiteboards. When triggered, they deliver a stunning blast of blinding light and sound. Anyone caught in their area of effect must succeed at a DV 15 Resist Torture/Drugs Check or suffer the Damaged Eye and Damaged Ear Critical Injuries for the next minute. They do not take the Bonus Damage from these Critical Injuries. DV13 Electronics/Security Tech, 1 min to counter.	Target steps within 2m/yds of a panel. Area of Effect 10m/10m/10m square centered on the panel.	5HP Perception DV17 to spot Perimeter of Defended Area
Sleep Gas Elevator	When triggered, all openings in the space seal hermetically. Place the trap at the top of the Initiative Queue. On the trap's Turn, everyone in the space must attempt to beat a DV13 Resist Torture/Drugs Check. Anyone who fails is now Unconscious, but only until they are woken by taking damage, or by someone else using their Action to wake them. The trap can be defeated by reducing its HP to 0 before everyone falls unconscious or by disarming it through other means. DV17 Electronics/Security Tech, 5 min to counter.	Target steps into the enclosed space or area.	60HP Perception DV17 to spot Perimeter of Defended Area

SERVICES AND ENTERTAINMENT

Service/Entertainment	Cost
Bodysculpting (Standard)	500eb (Expensive)
Bodysculpting (Exotic)	1,000eb (Very Expensive)
Braindance	20eb (Everyday)
Drink, Dive Bar	10eb (Cheap)
Drink, Good Bar	10eb (Cheap)
Drink, Excellent Bar	20eb (Everyday)
Drink, Executive Bar	50eb (Costly)
Found Cyberware Installation (Mall)	100eb (Premium)
Found Cyberware Installation (Clinic)	500eb (Expensive)
Found Cyberware Installation (Hospital)	1,000eb (Very Expensive)
Hospital Treatment (DV10)	50eb (Costly)
Hospital Treatment (DV13)	100eb (Premium)
Hospital Treatment (DV15)	500eb (Expensive)
Hospital Treatment (DV17+)	1,000eb (Very Expensive)
Hotel, Per Night	100eb (Premium)
Hotel, Luxury, Per Night	500eb (Expensive)
Interactive Braindance	50eb (Costly)
Live Concert / Sporting Event	100eb (Premium)
Movie	20eb (Everyday)
Professional Services, Good, Per Hour	100eb (Premium)
Professional Services, Excellent, Per Hour	500eb (Expensive)
Professional Services, World Class, Per Job	5,000eb (Luxury)
Restaurant Meal, Fast Food	10eb (Cheap)
Restaurant Meal, Good	20eb (Everyday)
Restaurant Meal, Excellent	50eb (Costly)
Restaurant Meal, World Class	500eb (Expensive)
Taxi	20eb (Everyday)
Therapy (Standard Humanity Loss)	500eb (Expensive)
Therapy (Extreme Humanity Loss)	1,000eb (Very Expensive)
Therapy (Addiction)	1,000eb (Very Expensive)
Trauma Team (Silver), Per Month	500eb (Expensive)
Trauma Team (Executive), Per Month	1,000eb (Very Expensive)
Video Game	50eb (Costly)

LIFESTYLE AND HOUSING

Your Lifestyle determines how you live, what you eat, and how you have fun. **Whenever you live beyond the Lifestyle you paid for at the beginning of the month, the GM will charge you separately for your expenditures.**

If you don't pay for your lifestyle at the start of a month, you have one week to do so before you roll a Death Save at the start of each day you don't. A kibble lifestyle is only 100eb a month. You shouldn't starve ... but the only difference between some brands of Kibble and dog food is cheeseburger flavoring.

Lifestyle	What it Entails	Monthly Cost
Kibble	You eat horrible food that you might not buy for a dog you liked. Once a month, you can see a movie or braindance.	100eb
Generic Prepak	You eat food which tastes much better than kibble, by comparison. Each weekend, you can afford to go out to a good bar and party or have a sit-down meal at a good restaurant.	300eb
Good Prepak	Your food is the same quality as most restaurants, and while still artificial it tastes almost exactly the same as real food. You frequent excellent bars and restaurants when you go out. Once a month, you can see a Live Concert or Sporting Event.	600eb
Fresh Food	You eat real food. Once per month if you are tired and too far from home, you can get a nearby hotel room and not worry about your budget. You frequent an executive bar. Once a month, you can eat at a world class restaurant.	1500eb

HOUSING

You have to sleep sometime. A safe and comfortable place is preferable.

At the beginning of every month, you'll have to settle your Housing and Lifestyle Costs. If you must pick one or the other, it's better to be evicted than to starve to death.

Going without at least 6 hours of sleep a day will give you a -2 to everything you attempt for each day since you've last slept a full 6 hours.

Sleeping in an uncomfortable situation will leave you fatigued the next day, which will penalize you an additional -2 to everything you attempt while fatigued. This won't kill you, but it doesn't feel good, either.

What does sleeping uncomfortable mean?

1. **Being crammed:** sleeping in housing with a number of persons greater than 1 + the number of bedrooms. Persons unconscious in Cryo-stasis and corpses do not count toward this limit. A Cube Hotel is the only exception. Sleeping with more than one person in a cube is always sleeping uncomfortable and will leave you fatigued the next day.

2. **Sleeping on the street.** Unless you make a successful DV15 Endurance Check, sleeping on the street will leave you fatigued. Sleeping on the street is also asking for trouble.
3. **Sleeping in the wilderness.** Unless you make a successful DV15 Wilderness Survival Check, sleeping in the wilderness will leave you fatigued. Unlike sleeping on the street, other persons can roll this Wilderness Survival Check for you. Nomad friends are nice to have.

► The Big Money: Real Estate ◀

Likely, where you sleep will be your largest monthly expense. You may start out in a cargo container located outside of the city, but if you start saving up, you'll be able to move to a more secure arrangement in no time.

Or you could become an Exec, never have to pay rent, and live in comfortable security from the beginning ... just by selling your soul into Corporate slavery!

Just remember, the game is rigged.

Real Estate	Cost to Rent (per month)	Cost to Buy
Living on The Street	N/A	N/A
Living on The Street in a Vehicle	N/A	N/A
Cube Hotel	500eb	N/A
Cargo Container	1,000eb	15,000eb
Studio Apartment	1500eb	25,000eb
Two-Bedroom Apartment	2500eb	35,000eb
Corporate Conapt	Given to you by a Corp	N/A
Upscale Conapt	7500eb	85,000eb
Luxury Penthouse	15,000eb	50,000eb
Corporate Beaverville House	Given to you by a Corp	200,000eb
Corporate Beaverville McMansion	Given to you by a Corp	500,000eb

► LIVING ON THE STREET

Every night, unless you make a successful DV15 Endurance Check, sleeping on the street will leave you fatigued the next day (You have -2 to everything you attempt while fatigued). Sleeping on the street is also asking for trouble. You have no security, heating, or electricity to speak of, and you can't realistically have more things than you could carry at any given time. You wouldn't be doing this if you owned a car.

► LIVING ON THE STREET IN A VEHICLE

Living on the street is asking for trouble. Your vehicle requires fully enclosed glass to do this. You will have limited security unless your vehicle has a Security upgrade and Bulletproof windows. You have enough room to store your stuff, and with a bed, inflatable or otherwise, you can sleep comfortably. **Otherwise, unless you make a successful DV15 Endurance Check, sleeping in your car will leave you fatigued the next day (You have -2 to everything you attempt while fatigued).** You've got Electricity, but no Water unless your Vehicle is designed to be lived in. You can't sleep in your car in Corporate, Executive, or Moderate Zones without being forced to leave at gunpoint by security forces. Either you park in the Combat Zone to sleep, or you stick to the city's Outskirts.

► CUBE HOTEL

Cube Hotels are located in Zones with Corporate, Moderate, and Combat Threat Ratings. This is by far the cheapest way to live in the city. You live in a single windowless room with a nice strong lock where you can touch both walls if you spread your arms. Flatpack furniture folds out of the walls, converting your cell from a chair with a desk to a bed with a small television. Living here, you can't realistically have more things than you could carry at any given time, plus the contents of a backpack you can safely store behind the bed when it folds into the wall. **Sleeping with more than one person in a cube is always sleeping uncomfortable and will leave you fatigued the next day (You have -2 to everything you attempt while fatigued).** Down the hall, past all of your equally compacted neighbors, there is a common room that has running water and a bathroom with a shower. Even going near this common room is a bad idea unless you are properly gang affiliated. Most people keep three water bottles in their rooms just to avoid entering the common room. There's a single window on the opposite side of the cell block where these bottles are emptied. If you own a vehicle and you live here, you likely park it on the street.

► CARGO CONTAINER

Cargo Containers are located in the Suburbs, Reclaimed Perimeter, and the Combat Zone. You'll have plenty of places to store your things, a bed to sleep comfortably, a desk, electricity, a refrigerator, microwave, and sink, protected by the security of a strong lock. In the Combat Zone, you'll be in danger the second you step outside, but if you live in the Outskirts, you'll be much safer. Restrooms, Showers, and Laundry are located in facilities you'll share with the residents of other Cargo Containers stacked nearby your container. If you own a vehicle and you live here, you likely park it on the street. If you live in the Combat Zone, it will probably get broken into on occasion. If you chose the Outskirts, it will *probably* be fine.

► STUDIO APARTMENT

Studio Apartments are located in Zones with a Corporate, Moderate, or the Combat Threat Rating. The typical Studio is not spacious by any stretch of the imagination but is the first housing option that truly feels like your own private space. You'll have a bed to sleep comfortably, and a small kitchen, with range, oven, microwave, and a large refrigerator. You'll have your own private bathroom, with a shower where you can't be attacked. You'll have a tiny living room to decorate as you see fit. Laundry facilities are still shared with your neighbors, however. The Studio Apartment comes with a single space of protected parking, meaning your vehicle *will* be safe.

► TWO-BEDROOM APARTMENT

Two-Bedroom Apartments are located in Zones with a Corporate, Moderate, or the Combat Threat Rating. This comfortable apartment has enough space for two people to live together without ripping each other's cybereyes out. Two Bedrooms, a full-size kitchen, one bathroom you'll probably squabble over, a living room with enough space for a comfortable couch, and laundry in the unit make this apartment seem like luxury when compared to a cargo container or a disgusting cube. The apartment comes with two spaces of protected parking, meaning your vehicles *will* be safe.

► CORPORATE CONAPT

Corporate Conapts are located in the Zones with a Corporate Threat Rating, in buildings controlled by individual Corporations. You can't rent or buy a Corporate Conapt, but you might be able to live in one if you know an Exec. The Conapts are luxury accommodations; two bedrooms, two bathrooms, a full-size kitchen, dining room, and large living room that opens up into a small balcony that usually smells like smoke. Laundry is in the unit. Surveillance by the Corp that controls the building should be expected in every room except the bathrooms. Messing with Corporate employee surveillance equipment will lead to a 50eb (Costly) fine if discovered, but the sound of the laundry machine is well known to interfere with their ability to record audio. Plenty of Execs treat a monthly 50eb fine as a cheap price to pay for privacy, and nobody has ever really gotten fired for it. Every Corporate Conapt comes with two spaces of protected parking, meaning your vehicles *will* be safe.

► UPSCALE CONAPT

Upscale Conapts are located in the Zones with a Corporate or Moderate Threat Rating. These are spacious two floor apartments with two bedrooms and bathrooms, in addition to a luxurious master bedroom and master bathroom on the second floor. Other amenities include a full kitchen, dining room, two living rooms, and a balcony with a nice view of the city. An Upscale Conapt comes with three spaces of protected parking, one of which can be located on the roof, perfect for an Air Vehicle. Your vehicles *will* be safe.

DATA

The trend of using Cargo Containers as housing started with Nomads who used them to help shelter the refugees fleeing the 4th Corporate War.

► LUXURY PENTHOUSE

Luxury Penthouses are located on the tops of buildings in Zones with a Corporate Threat Rating. The height of luxury in city living. Two floor layout includes three bedrooms and two bathrooms on the first floor with a master bedroom and bathroom on the second floor. Other amenities include two living rooms, an entertainment room, facilities room, full kitchen, and palatial dining room. The Luxury Penthouse also spills out onto a private roof, on which is located an infinity pool, sitting area, and barbecue for entertaining, in addition to a private helipad. In addition to the helipad, the penthouse comes with four spaces of protected parking, accessible via private elevator. Your vehicles will be safe. Complementary maid service is also included, courtesy of the building management.

► CORPORATE BEAVERVILLE HOUSE

A Beaverville House is located in the Executive Zone, in an area known affectionately by many as Beaverville. You can't rent one, because renters drive down property values and introduce strangers into the community. The streets are patrolled by Lazarus Corp private security. Owning a home in Beaverville gives you four security badges that grant access to the bullet train connecting it to the Corporate Zone, as well as the freedom to not be harassed by security while jogging in Beaverville. Aside from the security presence, Beaverville is a charming community full of freshly mown lawns, white picket fences, and culs-de-sac. It's the perfect place for the Corporate elite to raise a family. These smaller homes in Beaverville are quaint and neighborly. Two floors, three bedrooms, two bathrooms, with a master bedroom and bathroom on the second floor. The bottom floor contains a sunken living room that connects sidelong into a full-size kitchen, which exits onto a charming patio, like the set of a sitcom. The backyard and lawn are synthetic, constructed of Realtree™ and Realgrass™, the latest from Biotechnica. Complementary maid service is also included. Your Beaverville security badges will also grant you access to the country club located in the more well-appointed district of Beaverville. That is, assuming you are invited by an existing member. The country club is replete with facilities, including a world class restaurant, bar, world class gym, paddleball and tennis courts, golf, croquet, heated indoor pool, dedicated lap pool, hot tubs, sauna, and steam room. The country club also contains a business lounge that's considered neutral ground in the Corporate world, a place where even rival companies can meet and discuss terms. These are the closed doors behind which business really gets done.

► CORPORATE BEAVERVILLE McMANSION

In addition to the benefits of living in Beaverville in the Executive Zone, **which are listed above in the description of a mere Beaverville House**, living in a Beaverville McMansion means living there in a suburban castle of splendorous proportions. You'll have three floors, four bedrooms, five bathrooms, a master bedroom and bathroom, a four-car garage and a helipad. Three living rooms with vaulted ceilings, a bar in the basement, a personal gym, and a poolside patio. Your lawn is real grass. Your backyard is meticulously landscaped every season of the year by staff paid by the Homeowner's Association. Beaverville can't have their best looking less. Complementary maid service is also included. Living in a Beaverville mansion isn't just about living there, it's also a way to declare that you've arrived in the community. You have either paid enough to earn this recognition, or instead demand it by having very powerful friends, and the greater community recognizes both as being equally impressive. You can expect preferential treatment in the Country Club, which you live within walking distance to, whether it be on the golf course, its world class restaurant, or behind the natural leather doors of the business lounge. Your McMansion comes with six Beaverville security badges, but if you live like this, you'll hardly ever need to flash them.

MAKING A LIVING IN A CYBERPUNK WORLD

It's not easy. Survival is a good starting goal, but you don't want to *just* live. You want to thrive and buy ammunition. The game is rigged against almost everybody, and the only way to win is to get rich, quickly. Everything has a price, and when you are just starting out you are going to have to snatch every last eurobuck you can get your hands on just to pay up when the rent is due to stay off the street.

WORKING FOR A EUROBUCK [WAYS TO MAKE MONEY]

An Edgerunner in the Time of the Red makes most of their scratch one of three ways:

- Doing jobs
- Hustling
- Buying and selling

► Doing Jobs ◀

You, like most, work for a living. Except, unlike most other people, your job can get you killed in messy ways. Often, the pay you can expect to receive for a job, after you fence everything and divide up the spoils, is roughly equal to the amount of mortal danger you signed up for. This is of course, assuming you don't take bad jobs that are way too dangerous for what they pay.

**Okay, let's stop pretending. You make this mistake all the time.
Treat this as a guideline for the best-case scenario.**

Job Type	Explanation & Example	Pay for Job (Per Person)
Easy Job	Armed resistance is not expected. But you never know. <i>Protect this VIP from a possible threat to their life.</i>	500eb
Typical Job	Armed resistance is expected, but you can be prepared for it. <i>Every four hours the guards change their patrols. I need that diamond.</i>	1,000eb
Dangerous Job	Armed resistance is overwhelming. Without heavy preparation, you die. <i>Sneak into the military facility and blow up the armory, then escape.</i>	2,000eb

► The Hustle ◀

Whenever you have a full seven days free (*this will often happen because the rest of your friends are healing from gunshot wounds*), you can work to earn a little eb. The amount you are paid is dependent on your Role, your Role Ability Rank, and the outcome of rolling 1d6.

**You'll notice that your pay seems pretty low. Don't worry.
As an Edgerunner, this isn't your primary stream of income.
The real way to get paid is to get a crew together to do a Job.**

WHAT IS A EUROBUCK, ANYWAY?

At the basic level, a eurobuck is the currency currently in use among the nations who are part of the European Union. It's blue, comes in various denominations and has embossed national symbols of all the member nations brightly shining on each bill.

It's also formally called a Eurodollar, but nobody in Night City ever calls it that.

But since the European Union is one of the most stable economies on the planet in the Time of the Red, the eurobuck (or eb for short) become the "gold standard" to which all other currencies are currently pegged (much as the American Dollar was before the Collapse). Even if you're not physically exchanging eurobucks for most transactions chances are your purchases or sales, whether handled via credit chips, downloads, or digital accounts, are measured in Eurodollars as they are the standard of exchange almost everyone can agree on.

THE NEW STREET ECONOMY

► ROCKERBOY HUSTLE

Roll	What you did to make bank that week	Role Ability Rank 1 to 4	Role Ability Rank 5 to 7	Role Ability Rank 8 to 10
1	Played a small local gig.	200eb	300eb	600eb
2	No gigs or jobs to be had this week.	0eb	100eb	300eb
3	Played a big gig for a rich Corporate or Local Personality.	300eb	500eb	800eb
4	Got some royalties in for your most recent Data Pool download.	300eb	500eb	800eb
5	Opening act for a Big-Name group.	300eb	500eb	800eb
6	Personal appearance netted you a large fee.	200eb	300eb	600eb

► SOLO HUSTLE

Roll	What you did to make bank that week	Role Ability Rank 1 to 4	Role Ability Rank 5 to 7	Role Ability Rank 8 to 10
1	Bodyguard work, low-end client.	100eb	200eb	500eb
2	Bodyguard work, high-end client.	200eb	300eb	600eb
3	Difficult hit or extraction.	200eb	300eb	600eb
4	Hired out as muscle to a Fixer, Corp, or Gang.	100eb	200eb	500eb
5	Attracted undue attention, had to lay low.	0eb	100eb	300eb
6	Basic enforcer or hitman work for a local Corp.	100eb	200eb	500eb

► NETRUNNER HUSTLE

Roll	What you did to make bank that week	Role Ability Rank 1 to 4	Role Ability Rank 5 to 7	Role Ability Rank 8 to 10
1	Cracked a small system and sold the data.	100eb	200eb	500eb
2	Cracked a major Corporate system and sold the data.	200eb	300eb	600eb
3	You got sidetracked and didn't hack anything this week.	0eb	100eb	300eb
4	Found a valuable data cache in an abandoned system and sold it.	200eb	300eb	600eb
5	Brought down a major system with ransomware and got paid off to uninstall it.	200eb	300eb	600eb
6	Sabotaged or otherwise disabled a major system for a faceless client.	200eb	300eb	600eb

TECH HUSTLE

Roll	What you did to make bank that week	Role Ability Rank 1 to 4	Role Ability Rank 5 to 7	Role Ability Rank 8 to 10
1	No jobs this week.	0eb	100eb	300eb
2	Rebuilt some tech you scavenged in the Combat Zone.	100eb	200eb	500eb
3	Helped a client break into some place or installed security systems for a client.	200eb	300eb	600eb
4	Did some modifications or repairs to some cybertech.	100eb	200eb	500eb
5	Did some modifications or repairs to some weapons.	100eb	200eb	500eb
6	Sabotaged or otherwise disabled something for a client.	100eb	200eb	500eb

MEDTECH HUSTLE

Roll	What you did to make bank that week	Role Ability Rank 1 to 4	Role Ability Rank 5 to 7	Role Ability Rank 8 to 10
1	Patched up someone after a firefight.	100eb	200eb	500eb
2	Sold cyberware from a "failed" medical case.	200eb	300eb	600eb
3	Helped Trauma Team on some backup work when they were overloaded.	100eb	200eb	500eb
4	Did some minor "free clinic" work for locals. You can't eat goodwill though.	0eb	100eb	300eb
5	Did a major medical procedure for a very well-heeled client.	200eb	300eb	600eb
6	Designed and delivered medicines or street drugs to a client.	100eb	200eb	500eb

MEDIA HUSTLE

Roll	What you did to make bank that week	Role Ability Rank 1 to 4	Role Ability Rank 5 to 7	Role Ability Rank 8 to 10
1	Wrote an expose that covered a major topic, made a big sale.	300eb	500eb	800eb
2	Wrote a popular "puff piece" that got you some notice and some cash.	200eb	300eb	600eb
3	Did some boring ad writing to pay the bills.	200eb	300eb	600eb
4	Exposed a big story that got you a few enemies and some cash.	200eb	300eb	600eb
5	No good stories or leads this week.	0eb	100eb	300eb
6	Wrote an expose that blew the lid off a major topic.	300eb	500eb	800eb

THE NEW STREET ECONOMY

► LAWMAN HUSTLE

Roll	What you did to make bank that week	Role Ability Rank 1 to 4	Role Ability Rank 5 to 7	Role Ability Rank 8 to 10
1	Made a few minor busts, business as usual.	100eb	200eb	500eb
2	Got a reward from a grateful citizen. Or was it a bribe?	200eb	300eb	600eb
3	Bust went bad, and it came out of your salary.	0eb	100eb	300eb
4	Nothing much happened this week. Collected a paycheck and that was it.	100eb	200eb	500eb
5	Pulled off a major drug or smuggling bust and gained a bonus from the boss.	200eb	300eb	600eb
6	Took down a big gang and got some of a "civil seizure" bonus.	200eb	300eb	600eb

► EXEC HUSTLE

Roll	What you did to make bank that week	Role Ability Rank 1 to 4	Role Ability Rank 5 to 7	Role Ability Rank 8 to 10
1	Landed a moderate success on a project, earned a reward bonus.	300eb	500eb	800eb
2	Nothing much happened, and Corporate was unimpressed. Lost a bonus.	0eb	100eb	300eb
3	Collected a paycheck and that was it.	200eb	300eb	600eb
4	Got some dirt on a rival and used it to score a bonus.	300eb	500eb	800eb
5	Pulled off a major project success and gained a bonus from the Head Office.	300eb	500eb	800eb
6	Took out a legitimate target that was threatening a job and took their funding.	200eb	300eb	600eb

► FIXER HUSTLE

Roll	What you did to make bank that week	Role Ability Rank 1 to 4	Role Ability Rank 5 to 7	Role Ability Rank 8 to 10
1	Got a Media some information for a good bribe.	200eb	300eb	600eb
2	Got a Rocker a good Gig for your 12% fee.	200eb	300eb	600eb
3	Helped a client locate a desirable item they needed and got a cut.	200eb	300eb	600eb
4	Deal went south; you're keeping your head down till it blows over.	0eb	100eb	300eb
5	Got a Solo or Netrunner a profitable "job" and took your agency fee.	200eb	300eb	600eb
6	Brought in a rare, illegal, or very hard to get item for a client.	300eb	500eb	800eb

► NOMAD HUSTLE

Roll	What you did to make bank that week	Role Ability Rank 1 to 4	Role Ability Rank 5 to 7	Role Ability Rank 8 to 10
1	Made a legit shipment.	100eb	200eb	500eb
2	Protected a shipment.	100eb	200eb	500eb
3	Smuggled some small contraband.	100eb	200eb	500eb
4	Smuggled a huge shipment.	200eb	300eb	600eb
5	Delivered a client safely to destination.	100eb	200eb	500eb
6	Couldn't find work this week, legit or otherwise.	0eb	100eb	300eb

► Buying and Selling ◀

Whenever you buy or sell something, you aren't doing it alone. First off, you're always selling it to someone, or buying it from someone, and you two aren't the only people in the city. All transactions happen in the context of an economy, which determines the current Market Price for an item. The economy of the Time of the Red is one of scarcity where more often than not supply is low, and demand is high.

Without the help of an experienced Fixer or one of their Night Markets, only items up to Premium can be purchased.

Everything you buy in **Cyberpunk RED** falls into one of eight Price Categories, which determines their Market Price. If you aren't a Fixer, forget about getting it cheaper. If it's Expensive and you don't know a Fixer, forget about getting it at all.

**EVERYTHING IS WORTH WHAT ITS
PURCHASER WILL PAY FOR IT, CHOOMBA.**

— PUBLILIUS SYRUS
FIXER

Price Category	Market Price
Cheap	10eb
Everyday	20eb
Costly	50eb
Premium	100eb
Expensive	500eb
Very Expensive	1,000eb
Luxury	5,000eb
Super Luxury	10,000eb and up



5:22 PM



popular keywords

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since you enjoyed *Never Fade Away* by Samurai...



The Ballad of Buck Ravers

by Samurai

402 copies available!

The Ballad of Buck Ravers isn't as well-known as *Never Fade Away* or *Chippin'*. In but many hardcore Samurai fans consider it to be the band's angriest and most cyberpunk song.



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by the Rubicones

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A classic somehow both chipper and violent. As Ripperjack said, "This is music I can shoot to!"



Heave Ho

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A piece of hip hop history. In *Heave Ho*, XerzeX paints an intense picture using pigments of pain, anger, and trauma to create an anthem for anyone locked in combat with their mental demons.



Not Ashamed

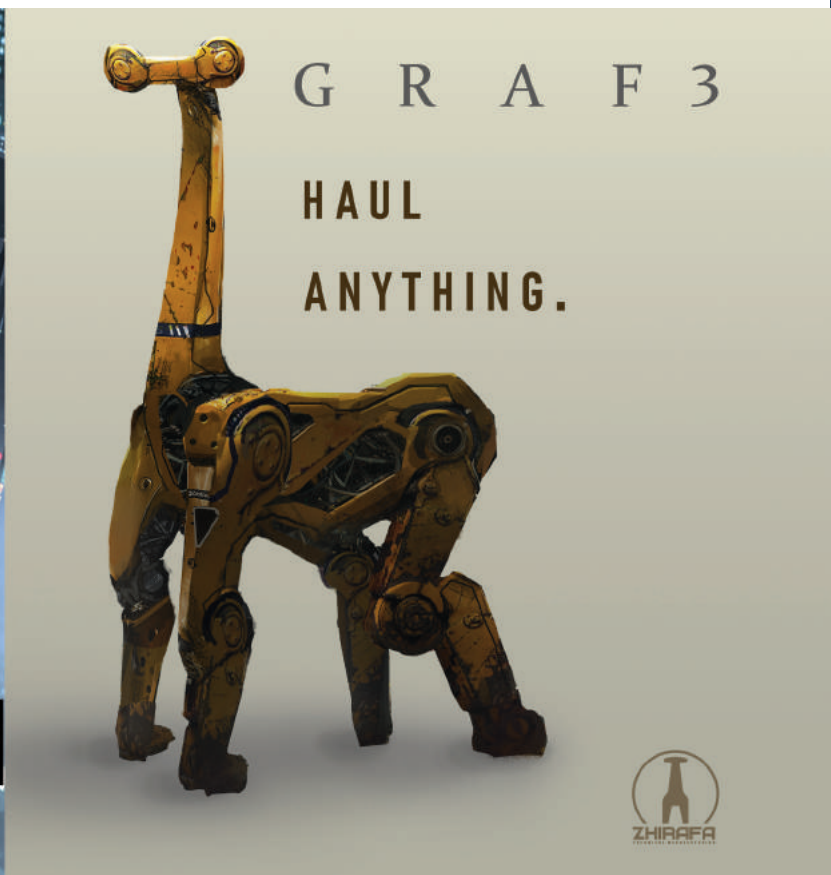
by Maz Despair

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In her comedy career, Maz Despair spoke truth to power no matter the cost. The same's true with her music.



LITTLE DETECTIVE. BIG GUN.
THE BAD GUYS NEVER SEE US COMING.



GRAF 3

HAUL

ANYTHING.



BY NEIL BRANQUINHO



RUNNING CYBERPUNK

SO... HOW DO I RUN THIS GAME, ANYWAY?

Glad you asked. Cyberpunk is a challenge for even an experienced Gamemaster, in that you must create the right atmosphere of grunginess, sleek technology, and pervasive paranoia throughout your entire game.

CYBERPUNK PLAYERS READ THIS!

This chapter's mostly about running **Cyberpunk RED** as the Gamemaster. If that doesn't interest you, we recommend you skip to the one part that pertains specifically to Players, the rules for "leveling up" your Characters via earning and spending Improvement Points. You can find those rules on **PAGE 408**.

You can also turn to **PAGE 435**, where you'll find *Black Dog*, a fictional story that shows what the world's like in the Time of the Red.

If you're not planning on running **Cyberpunk RED**, it is a good idea to avoid **PAGES 425 THRU 433**, as those contain adventures your GM might be using for your game.

You do want to be surprised, don't you?

The classic Cyberpunk environment is almost always exclusively urban. Its landscape is a maze of towering skyscrapers, burned out ruins, dingy tenements, and dangerous alleyways. In short, any major city in the world at about 2:30 in the morning when the lowlifes come out in force.

THE URBAN ENVIRONMENT

The urban environment is critical to your Cyberpunk world. Whether you use our Night City or create your own, remember that your setting has to have all the right elements. There should be garbage-strewn alleyways. There should be bodies lying in the gutters. There should be wild-eyed lunatics, staggering through pre-dawn streets, muttering darkly and clutching sharp knives. Taxis won't stop in the Combat Zones. There are firefights at the street corner as the local gangs slug it out. Players should find their apartments regularly broken into, their cars vandalized, their property stolen. Crossing town should be like crossing a battlefield, filled with looters, riots, crazies, and muggers.

But it doesn't always rain. At least, not since the Time of the Red messed up the upper atmosphere (this is what you get when you throw Lunar rocks into the Earth). Expect wild shifts in weather patterns as things are still settling down. The ozone layer decayed, the greenhouse effect took over, the sky is full of hydrocarbons and the ocean full of sludge. Nice place.

But what about those classic, rain-wet, neon streets we see in all good Cyberpunk movies? Yeah, it does rain a lot. Most days should be grim, gloomy, and overcast. When the sun does come out, it should be the overly bright gold of a smoggy Los Angeles day, with brilliant (heavily polluted) sunrises and sunsets. And the stars never come out, because of the smog.

There are no singing birds in a Cyberpunk world (the last unmodified bird died sometime around 2008), at least not in the city—but they're starting to creep back into the outer areas as some of Biotechnica's more ... experimental projects come to fruition (hint: some of those things are not birds—at least as we know them).

There are laughing children these days, but they may be laughing over things you and I would be kind of appalled at. Growing up in a nuclear bomb zone gives you an odd perspective on life. Kids don't get much raising on The Street, and what raising they do get usually involves drugs, guns, and unhealthy extracurricular activities. There are no day-cares other than kid gangs.

TRUST NO ONE

KEEP YOUR ... ER ... MINAMI 10 HANDY

Paranoia is important in a **Cyberpunk** run. Players shouldn't be able to tell who are the good guys and who are the bad just by looking at them. Choices between sides should be ambiguous—there should be no clear-cut sense of good and evil, much like real life. Sworn enemies may be thrown together without notice or preparation. Heroes may have to do something illegal or distasteful to accomplish something good; villains may have to do a little good once in a while. It's the breaks.

CONTRAST

Your world should have staggering contrasts. In the glittering citadels of the rich there should be fine food, expensive vices, and beautiful scenery. On The Street, things should be cold, hungry, and desperate. There's no middle ground between the haves and have-nots. It's all or nothing.

KNOW THE WORLD

First trick to running **Cyberpunk**: Immerse yourself in the genre. We've given you a start with the stories scattered throughout this book: **Never Fade Away** (ON PG. 5) sets the tone of a Cyberpunk world, **Fall of the Towers** (ON PG. 121) shows you how a good covert (and not so covert) op should feel, and **Black Dog** (ON PG. 435) should give you the differences in style between a purely urban setting and the new "death-road highway" settings the Time of the Red has brought to the game table. All of these should give you the style of speech, the feel, and the hard-edged realities of a Cyberpunk world. But you should also hit the local video-store, the library, and the record shops (or, you know, the Internet) for source material. We've included a bibliography of places to start in the sidebar.

PLAY FOR KEEPS

Second trick to running **Cyberpunk**: Play hard and fast. You should not be afraid to kill off Player Characters. You should constantly be getting them into fights, traps, betrayals, and other soap operas. There should be no one they can trust entirely, no place that's absolutely safe. Never let 'em rest. This doesn't mean you shouldn't play fair. But you should always play for keeps. If they

cache weapons somewhere, steal them. If they stop for a rest, mug them. If they can't handle the pressure, they shouldn't be playing **Cyberpunk**. Send them back to that nice roleplaying game with the happy elves and the singing birds. We've given you some great encounter tables which we suggest you use every time the action drags (SEE PG. 417).

SET THE MOOD

The third trick to running **Cyberpunk**: Atmosphere. Get out your heaviest rock tapes and play them during your run. Encourage your Players to wear leather and mirrorshades. Adopt the slang and invent your own. Replace all the lights in your room with dim blue bulbs. This is the Dark Future here; and it can't be accurately portrayed in a brightly lit room with milk and cookies on the table. We've listed a few tricks in the sidebars of this chapter.

TEAMWORK

THE MORE THE BLOODIER

Fourth and last trick to running **Cyberpunk**: Teams. You'll notice that **Cyberpunk** groups are not social. The Players will have no reason to trust anyone, and the conventional reasons (stop evil, kill bads) for a Crew won't work. A bar isn't a place to meet new Edgerunners—it's a place to scope out potential victims. Crews are more likely to kill each other in a firefight than divide the spoils fairly.

THE TEAM IS THE HOOK

For this reason, you'll need a more solid "hook" on which to hang a **Cyberpunk** adventure. Our hook is the team. A team is a group of people who are already

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The Artificial Kid & Islands in the Net by Bruce Sterling

Hardwired, Voice of the Whirlwind, & Angel Station by Walter Jon Williams

CYBERPUNK FILMOGRAPHY

Akira

Alien & Aliens

Appleseed

Altered Carbon

Blade Runner & Blade Runner 2045

The Expanse

Ghost in the Shell

Max Headroom

The Matrix Trilogy

Overdrawn at the Memory Bank

Robocop 1 & 2

Road Warrior (original and remake)

RUNNING CYBERPUNK

thrown together by Fate in some way that forces them to cooperate. They don't have to like each other, but they have to work together. Besides giving the Party a springboard from which to work, the team also makes the adventure easier to run. Players can be given assignments from a "higher power," or the entire group can be faced with a problem which requires cooperation to solve. The group stays together, or it dies. Simple.

MEET THE TEAMS

We've given you several Teams which might naturally evolve in the Cyberpunk world. Each proposes a good mix of Character Roles and offers many ways in which all the Players can become equally involved.

NEOCORPORATE TEAMS

Corporate teams are groups that are oriented around a specific Corporation, working together to accomplish the company's goals. The main base of operations is the Corporation's offices or security areas. A

good Corporate team might consist of one or more Execs (an executive and an assistant), a Netrunner (who runs the team's intrusion and computer systems), a Fixer (who deals with the team's Street contacts), a Tech (either medical or mechanical), and two to three Solos (who handle the combat).

BANDS

Bands are any group of Rockerboys who have gotten together to play music. The band travels from place to place, getting into trouble at each new gig, holding concerts and raising hell. Their main base of operations can be a practice hall, a club, or a road bus. There may be any number of Rockerboys in the band itself (although three to four is considered best). In addition, there will be at least one Fixer (who acts as manager), a possible Tech (to handle equipment needs), and several Solos (who are both bodyguards and roadies). Various other slots such as groupies and tour personnel can be Nomads, Execs (playing record execs), and Medias (as rock-reporters or reviewers).



BY HUNTANG

CULTS AND BOOSTERGANGS

Not just for NPCs these days, any group of Players can aspire to be in a boostergang or other cult. The Players may have ended up on The Street through job loss, personal tragedy, or just from a desire to find a socially acceptable outlet to kill, loot, and pillage.

RECLAIMERS

Reclaimers are a new thing in the Time of the Red. Pioneering sorts with a desire to carve homes out of the abandoned cities of Old America, Reclaimers come from all walks of life and have all kinds of reasons why they have banded together to rebuild their homestead. A Nomad leading the group on its journey to the new location is an excellent idea, and Solos and Fixers will be needed to protect the supplies and group while they work. Netrunners may want to exploit any abandoned NET nodes or Corporate/military systems lying in wait.

TRAUMA TEAMS

Trauma Teams are groups of licensed paramedics who patrol the city looking for accident victims. They operate from an AV-4 Urban Assault Vehicle, redesigned into an ambulance configuration and armed with a belly-mounted minigun. A typical Trauma Team would include a driver (Exec, Fixer or Solo, although Nomad is best), one or more Medtechs, and two or more Solos acting as "security." The team may also have a Dispatcher (Exec or Fixer) in charge of sending them on their missions. A Media might also tag along with the team, writing stories about their adventures.

MERCENARIES

Mercs are often hired throughout the Cyberpunk world when more powerful people don't want to get their hands dirty. A typical merc group could include at least one Fixer (to handle contracts), one Netrunner (to handle security systems, computer assault, etc.), one Tech (for weapons), one Medtech (for wounded), and any combination of Solos or Nomads (as grunt soldiers). It wouldn't be out of line to have a Media there, writing as a war correspondent. A merc group could operate out of a club, a bar, or a well-hidden paramilitary base camp.

GANGS

Gangs and countergangs are usually the enemy in **Cyberpunk**. But why not turn the tables? Gangs can also be created for positive purposes: neighborhood defense, to stop other more violent gangs, or to resist a major invasion by government or the Corps.

In this context, you could look at Robin Hood or the WWII Resistance as gangs. A typical gang would have lots of Solos, Nomads, and Fixers. There might be a Medtech or Tech around, and possibly even an Exec if the gang is one of those controlled by a covert organization. A Media could be covering the gang from The Street angle. Gangs operate out of clubs, bars, and deserted buildings.

SETTING THE MOOD

*In a lot of ways, setting up a good **Cyberpunk** game is like going on a date. You pick a time and a place to go to (yours?), you provide a sophisticated meal (okay, so it's soy chips and the brew of your choice), and your goal is to show your guests a good time. But what's missing? The answer is ambiance.*

You wouldn't start a date in a room lit by bright fluorescent lights, would you? Naw, you're going to want to set the mood. Swap out the bright room lamps for dimmer ones, or even a few colored bulbs (violet and blues are best). Scatter the occasional flashing strobe in the mix (make sure it isn't a health risk first, though) and you're golden.

*And play some romantic music; in **Cyberpunk**, this means jarring atonal rock, solid hip hop, heavy metal, or various types of techno and digital music (Kandinsky or Vangelis are among our faves).*

Last but not least, instead of spraying perfume around the room, open a bag of week-old garbage. That'll get them in the proper mood!

PLAY YOUR ENEMIES SMARTER

Don't think of your bad guys as mere obstacles for your players. Sit down a moment and put yourself in their heads. What do they fear? What are their desires? What do they value?

For starters, they fear getting killed. That means they will do just as much as any Character to prevent this from happening. If Characters wear armor, the bad guys will wear armor. If the Characters set traps, the bad guys will set traps.

If your NPCs are smart, they'll make the PCs work to kill them. They'll booby-trap doors instead of just locking them. They'll hide in ambush with long-range weapons. They'll crash AVs through the sides of the Crew's hideout. They'll send out decoys bioscupted to look like them. They'll find out who the players value most and use them as hostages. In short, they will never, ever just walk into a room without armor, carrying a big gun, and expect to survive.

Make your NPCs real, three-dimensional people. A few smart baddies will go a lot farther than a million dumb ones.

NOMAD PACKS

Nomad packs are natural teams; they're already together in one group and everyone knows each other. A good Nomad pack could include a few Fixers (to handle in-town negotiations), a Netrunner (who handles the pack's intelligence work), a mixture of Techs and Medtechs, and any number of Nomads and Solos. The pack operates from the caravan, an assemblage of RVs, trailers, buses, and cars moving across the blasted landscape of freeway America. The pack members could travel with the main caravan, or as scouts traveling ahead in their own vehicles.

LAWMEN

The Lawman team could operate out of a seedy, heavily fortified police station. They might include a few Fixers on the Vice Squad, a Netrunner on counter intelligence, a Captain (Exec) who handles connections with the City government, and a large number of grunt cops. Don't forget a few maddened Solos on the Psycho Squad. A Media might also choose to follow the cop team, looking for hot stories on the crime beat. But a Lawman team might also be a band of hard driving/riding marshals who scour the open road seeking out the gogangs and roadwarrior wannabes who infest the highway or a private investigation firm.

MEDIA TEAMS

Media teams go anywhere, and do anything to get the story. A Media team can operate out of a TV or radio station, a newspaper office, or even a major network news bureau. A good Media team might include two or three Medias (as hard-hitting reporters), a Netrunner (running communications, information gathering, and computer snooping), a Tech for the equipment, and a couple Solos or Nomads to provide muscle and protection. A good newsroom also has at least one harried Exec who has to cover the team with the bosses upstairs.

DON'T GIVE UP YOUR DAY JOB

Any one of these Teams can fit a Character role that isn't described. A low-level Rockerboy could moonlight as a Trauma Teamer while waiting for that big score. A Netrunner might do a little time with a Corporate team, while sneaking into the Company mainframe at night. A Nomad might do almost anything to earn money while his pack is in town. In these cases, the main Character role should be treated as an interest, which may become more important to the team as time passes.

A CYBERPUNK MASTERCLASS

OR HOW MAXIMUM MIKE BUILDS HIS MISSIONS AT RTG.

IT'S ALWAYS STREET LEVEL

A good **Cyberpunk** game isn't about saving the world: it's about saving yourself. This basic principle shows up throughout the genre. The heroes are not super heroic; at best they're low to medium successful professionals (Humphrey Bogart's portrayals

of Philip Marlowe and Sam Spade on the Silver Screen are good examples) who are often prone to having shady pasts and failures to live down. A good GM should assume the Players have basic skills but are not totally badass.

IT'S ALWAYS A CAPER

A "Caper" is a time-honored part of the crime genre, although sometimes (like in the venerable *Mission Impossible* franchise) it can be in the spy genre instead. The Caper involves getting a team of professionals with rather dubious skills together to steal, kidnap, sabotage, or even assassinate a particular person, place, or thing. Sometimes called "The Heist," a Caper is the best way to get a play group together, keep them focused, and make sure they all get a great payoff at the end.

Capers almost always involve a Caper Crew: a team assembled to pull off the Job. Often a Caper Crew will get a rep and be hired over and over by a succession of clients, with the terms worked out by their Fixer. A good Caper should use as many Character Roles as possible in their Caper Crew. Good Role choices include:

The Mastermind: This is the Player organizing the Job. Most often a Fixer as they have the cash to bankroll under the table jobs, but an Exec can fill this slot too. Either way, a Caper Crew often has someone paying to get the job done. The Mastermind may not be going along on the Job, but they have a stake and they're not going to be happy if it all goes sideways.

The Runner: This is the Player who provides your NET cover, opening remote doors, spying out cyberspace traps, taking control of security systems, and always scanning ahead of the Caper Crew for problems.

The Tech: This is the Player who brings the Gear. It can be specialized stuff, or off the rack—no matter; this is the Player who keeps it running and comes up with on the fly solutions when unexpected tech problems crop up.

The Medtech: Because sometimes things do go wrong, and you end up full of holes this Role needs to patch up. The Job may also involve kidnapping, extraction or some other element that will have a medical function. (Like how much sodium pentathol should we give this guy to find out where he hid the microchip we want?)

BY EDDIE MENDOZA



SIDE QUEST IDEAS

Here are a few good Side Quest concepts to get your brain churning.

Perhaps the Characters come into possession of a piece of experimental tech and quickly discover that the Corp—or Tech—who built it has hired a Crew of Solos to get it back. Now the PCs get to decide what to do with it.

Maybe the Crew gets hired by the NCPD to help hunt down a dangerous cyberpsycho who's been killing civilians across Night City. The problem? This psycho's stealthy and methodical.

If you happen to have a Nomad in the Crew, they could receive word from their Pack that a close family member's gone rogue and must be hunted down. Now the Nomad Character has to decide whether they're going to hunt down their packmate or try to figure out what happened.

A new musical act hits Night City and hires the PCs to act as muscle and support while they play their gigs. Build two or three interesting Rockerboys and their manager and let your Crew get to know them as they defend the band from the dangers of Night City.

The Ninja: This role is usually a variation of a Solo, but one who specializes in getting into places and silently taking out the opposition. They're also competent muscle, but they're usually sneakier about it.

The Face: This Role is the Player who deliberately puts themselves out in front of the target of a Job. Sometimes they're there as a distraction. Sometimes they're there to pump the opposition for info. Sometimes they're the one to smooth talk the bad guys into doing something advantageous for the team. Rockers are naturally good at playing the Face role; they can often rely on a guard or secretary to be too starstruck by their arrival to think clearly.

The Driver: This is the Player who provides the transport. Probably best as a Nomad, as that's the Role with the most vehicular options. You may also have to drive several types of vehicles in a single caper.

The Muscle: This Player provides raw strength and violence. Often whomever is best at hand-to-hand beatdowns. If a Player doesn't fit one of the other Roles on the Caper Crew, they can probably find something to do as the Muscle.

The Killer: This Role also deals with violence, but usually using guns, swords, or other types of weapons. They're the snipers, hit men, and drive-by guys who take out the guards or the rival gangs.

The Scrounger: This Player is there to come up with whatever the Caper Crew is going to need; a good place for a Fixer, a Tech, or an Exec. He always has a cousin who knows a guy who has a brother, who knows a guy whose uncle can turn up with something useful, no matter how obscure it is. How they got it? Don't ask.

ADD SOME TWISTS

A good adventure will have many twists, turns, and unexpected events. We use an ascending arc of danger/opportunity as the way to propel the Main Plot.

IT'S ALWAYS PERSONAL

The Main Plot should always be personal, but may eventually involve larger world threats. In other words, the Crew might find themselves involved in a major fight between two Corps but they should have an intimate and personal reason for getting involved. If you need a hook, don't forget their Lifepaths. Those are full of good ways to snag a Character.

The start of each "story spike" can begin based on orientation of individual Character roles.

Technical: New technology or using Tech Skills to fix a problem.

Combat: A threat or other physical danger (like in an action movie)

Persuasion: Conning or otherwise getting around danger without throwing fists or playing with gadgets.

DON'T LOSE THE MAIN PLOT

No matter how big the plot gets, Jabba the Hutt still wants his 5,000 credits.

And he will keep showing up with bigger and bigger threats to get it. (After all, it is personal.)

SOMETHING FOR EVERYONE

Side Quests are linked to main plots for each Player Type. However, you can also look at doing Side Quests that fall between two or more Types. Side Quests are a great way to add depth to a story and help it extend beyond a basic plotline. Who knows, you might even get some Character development out of it!

BEAT CHARTS

MAXIMUM MIKE'S SECRET WEAPON

You've got Edgerunners and an idea for your Cyberpunk RED campaign. Now it's time to write the Script.

SCRIPTING THE GAME

Whether for a show, movie, or RPG adventure, you need a script to tell you where the action's going. And pacing is the most important part of that script. You not only have to tell a story, but also break it up into manageable chunks for your Edgerunners. Each "chunk" of story should convey information, be entertaining, and help provide excitement by pushing the plot along in some visible way. One way to do this is by using a writing trick called a Beat Chart; a framework in which certain actions or scenes take place in a certain order. The order of the scenes helps both maintain dramatic tension and allows the storyline to make sense.

Each Beat Chart has five aspects, or Beats: the Hook, the Development, the Cliffhanger, the Climax, and the Resolution.

Some Beats, like the Hook, Climax, and Resolution occur only once. Other Beats, like the Development and the Cliffhanger, are used over and over, but in alternating order.

There are Three Rules for Setting up a Beat Chart

- 1. The story always begins with a Hook.** The Hook is a short piece of action or suspense that is used to involve the reader, viewer, or Edgerunner in the story.
- 2. The story always ends on a Climax, followed by a Resolution.** The Climax is the big finale of the story—the battle where the protagonists complete their mission (maybe), or where the murderer is revealed. The Resolution is the tag line: it's the part at the end that tells what happens as a result of the Climax. It's the part in the show or movie where we see the supposedly dead antagonist flying away in their AV, the Nomad

Pack driving off into the night, or the protagonists living (as much as anyone can in the Time of the Red) happily ever after.

- 3. Alternate Developments and Cliffhangers throughout the story.** Developments are basically non-action Beats that move the story along; they involve clues, revelations, conversations, and Character Developments. Cliffhangers are always action scenes: chases, dogfights, battles, and so on. Developments and Cliffhangers always appear in alternating order; you should never have two Cliffhangers or two Developments in a row. As a general rule, if your Hook has a lot of action and battle, you'll start the rest of the story with a Development; if the Hook was more cerebral and inactive, you'll want to start with a Cliffhanger to liven things up. You also want to make sure to end on a Development if your Climax is on active one, and a Cliffhanger if your Climax is more mental.

A BEAT CHART EXAMPLE

Let's take a look at a Beat Chart with the Beats in place, in this case, from the opening story of this book, *Never Fade Away*. You can reread it on **PG. 5**.

Hook: The story starts with a *Cliffhanger*, in which Johnny and Alt are attacked. Johnny goes down and Alt is *Kidnapped*.

Development: After he's patched up, Johnny meets Thompson who provides information in the form of a *Revelation*. Johnny learns who kidnapped Alt (Arasaka) and why (they want her to make a new Soukkiller).

Cliffhanger: Johnny and Thompson travel to the Atlantis to recruit Rogue and Nomad Santiago. The meet gets interrupted by Arasaka agents and a *Battle* breaks out.

Development: The focus switches to Alt, who wakes up in the office of Toshiro, an Arasaka exec who launches into a *Monologue* about why she was kidnapped.

Cliffhanger: While they fought off the first wave of attackers, Johnny and crew know they are the subject of a *Pursuit* by a force much bigger than

theirs. They run away and take refuge on a fire escape and try to figure a way out of their present predicament.

Development: Alt and Johnny hit the *Advantage Revealed Development* at the same time. He shows how his music can inspire and direct legions by raising a mob and unleashing them on Arasaka Tower. Alt, meanwhile, cooperates with Arasaka and creates a new Soullkiller, but ensures it will remain loyal to her.

Climax: The *Final Battle* happens on two fronts. Johnny and friends take advantage of the chaos to slip into the building and fight their way to where Alt's being held. Alt, meanwhile, uses Soullkiller to brain fry the Techs watching her and steal a whole lot of money.

Resolution: Johnny arrives, and; in the commotion, connections are cut. Alt can't return to her body and becomes a ghost in the machine. Johnny kills Toshiko but, in the end, this is a *Pyrrhic Victory*.

As you can see, the Beat Chart for a story is designed to make sure all the scenes happen in an orderly manner, and that things stay interesting throughout. If our protagonists moved from fighting one group of opponents in the Atlantis to fighting

another group of opponents on the street, you'd groan and ask, "Is that all they ever do?" Likewise, if Johnny spent the entire first half of the episode staring at a screen while he researched Arasaka, you'd get bored and wander off. A good Beat Chart keeps a balance of action to introspection and makes everything flow smoothly.

MAKING A BEAT CHART

Grab a scrap of paper (or the digital equivalent), and quickly jot down a rough idea of the Beat Chart for your adventure. You know you'll start with a Hook, and end on a Climax and a Resolution. But how many Developments and Cliffhangers are you going to need? One way to determine this is to decide just how long you want your adventure to be. A good rule of thumb is that each Beat in the chart should take about one half-hour of game play. Your Hook, Climax, and Resolution automatically account for one-and-a-half-hours; subtract this from the total hours of play, then divide this remainder between Developments and Cliffhangers.

1 Beat = ½ Hour of Real-World Time



BY NEIL BRANQUINHO

For example, say your typical one-night game is about six hours. Subtracting one-and-a-half-hours from this gives you four-and-a-half-hours remaining; enough for several Developments and/or Cliffhangers. Decide (in a general way, since you haven't started to plot things out yet), whether you want to start on a Development or Cliffhanger, and which type of Beat you want to end on. Number the list in order of appearance and you've got a Beat Chart.

A FEW GOOD BEATS

In this section, we've listed some of the all-time best Beats; Beats found in shows, movies, books, and plays throughout entertainment history. Start by picking the type of Beat (Hook, Cliffhanger, Development, Climax, or Resolution) that you'll need for each part of your Beat Chart. Next, read each Beat listed under that area for ideas and possible directions to take that Beat. With a little imagination, you'll be surprised at how fast you can construct an interesting story line!

► The Hook ◀

The Hook is how you get your Edgerunners involved. It can involve any type of situation which poses an immediate threat or interest to the Edgerunners. An ambush could be a Hook. So could finding a suitcase full of Eurobucks. Both situations get the Edgerunners involved and moving. A Hook need not be directly connected to the main plotline; it can be a self-contained scene, just as long as it does its job: wake the Edgerunners up. For example: in the movie *Raiders of the Lost Ark*, the opening scene where the hero breaks into the tomb is a Hook. It tells the audience that Indy does interesting things, that he has enemies, and that the pace of action will be fast and frenetic. No one ever leaves *Raiders* to get some popcorn in the lobby after this scene.

The Hook is what you'll use to get your Edgerunners into the adventure fast. Its sole reason for existence is to start the action rolling and make things interesting from the beginning of the Game. You don't want to waste time with all the Edgerunners fumbling around trying to decide what to do. Instead, you Hook them and reel in the line.

► CORONET BLUE

The name of this Hook is taken from an old '60s TV show in which the hero wakes up to find he cannot remember his identity, yet everyone he meets knows him and assumes he knows the score.

In this Hook, the Edgerunners awake in some type of dangerous or difficult situation. They have no memory of how they got there or who they are expected to be. Meanwhile, friends and enemies alike treat them as though the Edgerunners know the whole thing.

► CRISIS

The Edgerunners are immediately embroiled in an ongoing crisis; a disaster that extends beyond just their immediate sphere of influence to the whole city or maybe even the entire world. A war between Corps has spilled out onto the streets, booster gangs are spilling out of the Combat Zone in an orgy of destruction, an earthquake is shaking everything to the ground, or plague is killing everyone in sight.

The Crisis begins the moment the Edgerunners walk into the Game and doesn't let up for a moment until they either escape or set out to stop it. Once again, it's important that the Crisis Hook relate directly to the Game; the boostergangsters are being goaded by the Edgerunner's enemies, or the Antagonist has caused the earthquake using a new Corp-funded drilling device.

AN EXAMPLE BEAT CHART

My Beat Chart by CyberBob

HOOK: How about we start with a **Discovery**? The Edgerunners find an encrypted Memory Chip in a bar.

CLIFFHANGER: Oh no! An **Ambush**! Some booster gangsters attack!

DEVELOPMENT: Now, a **Warning**. An old but Skilled Netrunner joins the fight. Once the gangsters are mopped up, she tells the Edgerunners the Memory Chip contains information that'll take down the local branch of Biotechnica. They'll need to take it to a data specialist on the outskirts of the city to decrypt it. She's willing to pay them to accompany her.

CLIFFHANGER: Time for a good old **Pursuit**. The Edgerunners are chased by booster gangsters riding some sweet motorcycles.

DEVELOPMENT: Give the PCs an **Advantage** to help them out. Following instructions from the old Netrunner, the Edgerunners discover a pre-War cache full of supplies and weapons.

Continued on **PAGE 398**.

AN EXAMPLE BEAT CHART (CONTINUED)

CLIFFHANGER: *Doesn't a **Confrontation** sound good? A Biotechnica Operative contacts the Edgerunners and tells them to hand over the Memory Chip or something terrible will happen.*

DEVELOPMENT: *Now for the twist! Dun. Dun. Dun!!! **A Lie Revealed!** The Edgerunners overhear the old Netrunner talking to someone on her Agent. It turns out the Memory Chip is actually an electronic key to a buried vault where samples of a nasty bioweapon were stored during the 4th Corporate War. The Netrunner is a nihilist cultist and wants to release the bioweapon into the city.*

CLIMAX: Final Battle! *The Edgerunners fight the Netrunner and her drone army just outside the vault, defeating her and preventing the bioweapon from being released.*

RESOLUTION: A Happy Ending. *The Biotechnica Operative offers to pay the Edgerunners well for the Memory Chip and lets them watch as the vault's last-resort mechanism is activated, and the bioweapon is destroyed by an intense blaze.*

► DISCOVERY

This Hook marks an adventure started by an important discovery. The Edgerunners might find a lost piece of pre-War tech, or a datafile filled with dangerous information. In all cases, the Discovery Hook should directly link into some important element of the later Game (the datafile is the key to unlocking a vault that belonged to a Crew member's parent, or that long-lost tech they found is something their Corp Antagonist wants, badly).

► FALSE ACCUSATION

In this Hook, the Edgerunners are falsely accused of a heinous (or not so heinous) crime. A Fixer sends goons after them because "They stole from my Night Market!" A seemingly terrified Corp rushes up to one of the Edgerunners and points him out to a nearby NCPD officer as their attacker. A man falls dead in an Edgerunner's arms, a monoblade sticking out of his body. Anything that could get the Edgerunners into major trouble is laid (undeservingly) at their doorstep. The important part is that the accusation be unfounded and that the Edgerunner be given only a limited number of options: fight (against impossible odds) or flee (with everyone in the world after them).

► KIDNAPPED

In this Hook, the Edgerunners are either kidnapped by an unknown force, or one of their friends is kidnapped. The unknown force should be mysterious and far more powerful than the Edgerunners (the idea here is to begin the Game with the kidnapping, setting the Scene for the next actions).

► LOOMING THREAT

This Hook immediately places the Edgerunners in a situation similar to the Crisis Hook. However, in the Looming

Threat the actual danger hasn't broken over their heads yet. There are mysterious portents, and an aura of dread pervades the air. In the Looming Threat Hook, the Booster Gangs haven't hit the streets yet, but they're all massing in their strongholds, psyching themselves up. The Corps are massing armies in their headquarters, and everyone knows it's just a matter of time. The plague hasn't started yet, but dozens of people have all died from a mysterious and horrible disease. Once again, the Threat should be directly related to the Game's plotline.

► MURDER

This Hook begins with a murder, either of a friend/relative/ally of the Edgerunners, or of an obviously innocent victim. The murder can occur either near the Edgerunners, or the victim can be discovered by them. In no case may you allow the Edgerunners to actually capture the murderer in question; the aim is to link the murder into the subsequent Game.

► PLAY A CLIFFHANGER

A Hook can also begin with a furious action scene (most action shows begin like this). The best Cliffhanger Beats to play are Confrontation, Ambush, or Fist Fight. A Cliffhanger Beat should serve to propel the Edgerunners immediately into the Game's plotline, by introducing them to either their opposition or their allies.

► PLAY A DEVELOPMENT

You can also elect to play a Development Beat as a Hook (this is a common tactic in mystery and crime shows). The best options for this are: Secret Meeting, Mistaken Identity, Romance, or Treachery. Once again, your choice should immediately propel the Edgerunners into the Game's plotline and introduce major allies or opponents. For example, an Edgerunner could fall in love with a

Nomad they'll ally with later, be betrayed by a friendly force, or find themselves en route to a secret meeting with their opponent.

► REVELATION

The Revelation Hook represents a previously hidden fact that will dramatically change the Edgerunners' lives. A Revelation could include an unexpected inheritance, a secret past, mysterious parentage revealed, or an unpurgeable virus in their cyberware. In this Hook, the revelation will directly be linked to the Game in some way or another. ("You're probably wondering why I called you all here...")

► Cliffhanger ◀

A Cliffhanger is defined as: "A contest whose outcome is in doubt up to the very end." All Cliffhangers involve physical conflict or peril of some sort. A Cliffhanger can take many forms: a car chase, a dogfight, a sword duel, or even a fist fight. Cliffhangers serve two purposes in your script: they speed up the plotline by increasing the pace, and they wake up the audience by interjecting a note of danger. Sure, it may be important that the hero discover the secret mind control weapon in the basement, but the monster guarding the secret mind control weapon is a far more exciting problem. A problem only combat can resolve.

You don't want to pile Cliffhanger on top of Cliffhanger; your audience will get tired of unrelenting battles pretty fast. Also, Cliffhanger after Cliffhanger begins to dull the impact of danger and excitement. The best rule of Cliffhangers is to keep them short, deadly, and with the threat of defeat (or death) right up front.

Another ground rule of Cliffhangers is to save the best for last. At the start of a script, the Edgerunners are unknown quantities—a few short battles will tell both them and their opponents, their strengths and weaknesses. This is when you send out a reasonable force of bad guys that the Edgerunners can defeat unless they do something stupid. Once they've got the hang of it, you want to raise the ante enough to make the Edgerunners and the audience a little more worried; can they defeat this stronger foe? By the end of the script, you want to hit them with the toughest thing you've got; but hopefully, they've now defeated the Antagonist's henchmen and have the anti-FBC gun they need in order to defeat (barely) the Big Threat.

► AMBUSH

Generally, this Cliffhanger is much like a Battle: two sides meet and have a fight. But in an Ambush, one side always gets a first free shot before its opposition can respond. There are two ways to play this. If the intent is to have the Edgerunners stage an Ambush, the Gamemaster should set the stage so that it's obvious that their opposition is nearby and completely unaware of the Edgerunners' presence. Whatever happens after this is up to them. In most cases, however, when this Cliffhanger is played against the Edgerunners the opposition drops out of nowhere, and the Edgerunners must make a successful Awareness check against their opponent's Stealth to know the Ambush is coming.

► BATTLE

This Cliffhanger is played when a full-out, formal combat is staged. A Battle differs from an Ambush in that both sides are fully aware of the battle to come and meet openly. Unlike a Duel, all the participants can join in at any time: it's a combat free for all. When playing this Cliffhanger, you'll want to scale each subsequent Battle (you might have several in the course of a Game) at higher and higher levels.

For example, if you have three battles, the first one should be with mere Mooks, the next with Lieutenants, and the next one with the Mini Boss. To make this easier, we have set up the following examples of battles in order of appearance:

Battle 1: *Mooks.* These types are usually of lesser Skill than the Edgerunners and it's safe to throw an equal number of Mooks at the Crew (if there are 4 Edgerunners, there are 4 Mooks). If the Crew has several combat-oriented Characters, you can generally have the Mooks outnumber the Crew 2-to-1.

Battle 2: *Lieutenants.* These enemies are usually of equal or slightly greater Skill than the Edgerunners. For every 2 Edgerunners there should be 1 Lieutenant. If you need to make things interesting, have the Lieutenants round out their forces with Mooks so there's a number of antagonists equal to the number of Edgerunners (keep in mind that each Lieutenant counts as 2 Edgerunners).

Battle 3: *Mini Bosses.* The best the opposition can throw at the Edgerunners now makes their appearance. They are always substantially more powerful, skill-wise, than the Edgerunners. Each Mini Boss counts as 3 Edgerunners making them a very difficult fight. Generally, a Mini Boss will be accompanied by a number of Lieutenant and Mooks needed to make the opposition equal the Crew.

DATA

GMs, you
can find stats
for Mooks,
Lieutenants,
and Mini
Bosses on

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1 Mook = 1 Edgerunner
1 Lieutenant = 2 Edgerunners
1 Mini Boss = 3 Edgerunners

Keep in mind that sometimes the answer isn't throwing more enemies at your Players but giving the enemies you're using better gear. A Mook can be far more dangerous if they trade in their Poor Quality Pistol for a Malorian Arms 3516. This can also go in the other direction. When your Players start getting ahold of high powered gear they'll probably be able to punch above their weight. You may want to start treating Characters with powerful weapons or cyberware as 2 or even 3 Edgerunners for the purposes of building encounters.

► CHASE

The Crew engages in a hot pursuit of the opposition. Obviously, you aren't going to be able to get the Edgerunners to follow anyone unless they've got a good reason. This Cliffhanger is best used right after a Kidnapping or Revelation.

► CONFRONTATION

A Confrontation is a non-physical fight—a scene where the Edgerunners face the opposition on a verbal combat level. Threats are exchanged and intimidation resorted to. Either one side backs down or both do. The Confrontation Cliffhanger is a tough one to play; the opposition should have an overwhelming advantage over the Edgerunners yet choose not to exploit it in combat. A good example is the scene where the Antagonist's minions come to the Edgerunners and tell them to "Get outta town by sundown, or else." Unless the Edgerunners push it, the opposition isn't going to attack just then. The idea is

to simply lean on the Edgerunners and give them a reason to want to beat up their enemies when they finally get the chance.

► CONTEST

A contest is some type of ritualized confrontation, in which one side wins and one side loses. A Contest could involve riddles, feats of strength, feats of memory, or cleverness, or any other type of one-on-one competition. Note: You may not use a Gamemaster fiat to allow the NPC to win a Contest; this should come down to roleplay and the rolls and the Edgerunners should always have a chance at victory.

► DOGFIGHT

A Dogfight is any Cliffhanger that involves vehicular combat; this could be a battle of flying vehicles like the name suggests, but also motorcycles, cars, or even boats. A Dogfight Action gets played when you want to have the opposition attempt to shoot down the Edgerunners.

► DUEL

A Duel is a one-on-one combat between two participants. Weapons are usually of equal power and lethality (for example, a sword vs. a dagger would be considered a Battle, not a duel). Duels do not have to be to the death in most cases, the object is to prove who's the better combatant between the two parties. A Duel can also be used to ritually decide the outcome of a situation: if A wins, B agrees to do something A wants. In the world of Cyberpunk, some bars have combat pits to help settle things between individuals, so violence doesn't erupt in the streets.

► FIST FIGHT

In this Cliffhanger, the Edgerunners (or a single champion of the Edgerunners) meets the Opposition in hand-to-hand combat. This doesn't have to be an actual fist fight; it can be any contest where physical, weaponless combat can take place. Wrestling, kung fu, and fisticuffs are all acceptable. The rules of the combat are often ritualized in some way (inside a circle, one hand behind the back, salt thrown at the opponent).

► MONSTER

Monsters are a special type of Cliffhanger. Monsters are non-intelligent threats to the Edgerunners: the drone guarding the office building, the automated turrets on the wall, or the horde of mini drones in the hallway.

► OBSTACLES

Obstacles are traps, hazards, or other dangers the Edgerunners must physically overcome. The great part about obstacles is that they're pretty generic—you can move them from adventure to adventure with only a little window dressing.

Obstacles can be lethal or non-lethal. Non-lethal obstacles are usually deadfalls, snares, or another type of confinement designed to capture the Edgerunners or subject them to a situation in which they must either perceive and defeat the trap before it is sprung, or escape the trap after they have walked into it. Examples include a booby-trapped hallway with dropdown walls or a closed room filling with knockout gas. Lethal obstacles are similar but can cause real harm and even death. Lethal obstacles

include an electrified fence, the crumbling floor of an old building, and a timebomb that started ticking down the moment the Edgerunners entered the room.

It must be possible to overcome an Obstacle. In the case of traps set by enemies, clues to help the Edgerunners overcome them must be present, either in the scene in which the Obstacle is played or in an earlier scene.

► PURSUIT

The Edgerunners are chased by the opposition, who have superior force on their side. This Cliffhanger works best when you make it really obvious that the enemy has far superior numbers and will do bad things to the Edgerunners if they don't run.

► RACE

The Edgerunners must race the opposition to reach a goal first. The goal can be a person, place, or thing. This is best played after some type of Revelation or Discovery Development, which gives the Edgerunners a better sense of the stakes and a reason to win the race.

BY ADRIAN MARC



► SKIRMISH!

The Crew engages in a small battle with the opposition. If the Crew is winning, the opposition escapes via trickery (smoke bombs, leaping onto the back of a passing truck, etc.). If the Crew is losing, the opposition is content to capture them or leave them wounded but alive.

► Development ◀

A Development is a scene where the plot moves ahead without a physical conflict. Also known as the "bump," it is the part of the script that sets the direction of action until the next big Development. For example, in *Lord of the Rings*, Gandalf the Wizard's visit to Frodo to tell him about the Ring is a Development. The direction of action is set; Frodo and his companions must find a way to destroy the Ring or face the destruction of Middle Earth.

A Development can also be used to give the Edgerunners a clue, pass on information, warn of danger, or reveal a previously unknown aspect of the plot. For example, in the movie *Casablanca*, the return of Ilse Lund to Rick's Cafe is a Development that forces the cynical Rick to help the Resistance.

Another way Developments are used is to give the Edgerunners clues on how to gain advantage against their foes. In the movie *Star Wars IV: A New Hope*, meeting Obi Wan Kenobi is the Development Luke Skywalker must pass through in order to learn the ways of the Force, and thus be able to blow up the Death Star.

Developments can also lead to new Developments: Luke meeting Ben in order to learn about the Force leads him to eventually travel to Dagobah in order to train under Yoda, which in turn leads to his discovery that Darth Vader is indeed his father.

► ADVANTAGE REVEALED

The Edgerunners uncover a previously unknown ability, advantage, tool, or weapon in their quest. Examples are the piece of pile that is really a powerful weapon when assembled, a new, specialized piece of cyberware, or knowledge of a technique that didn't seem all that important at first (how to weave baskets under water).

► ALLIANCE

This Development represents gaining help from outside sources: an experienced Solo takes up your cause, the locals are swayed into giving you aid, etc.

The Alliance Development will always give the Edgerunners a new "manpower" resource to use in their mission. Allies should be powerful, but not enough to tip the battle's outcome by themselves.

► BACK FROM THE DEAD

An old opponent returns from a supposed death. Like the Second Chance, this is a tough Beat to play: you must devise a reasonable excuse for how the old enemy escaped their doom (the AV crashed in the water, the wound only looked like a death stroke, etc.).

Only use this once, and it's best used when the Edgerunners have overwhelmingly defeated the bad guys early in the game and you want the Final Battle to be a challenge.

► BETRAYAL

The Party's been betrayed! It could be a trusted ally, a lover, or their local bartender. A Betrayer can be anyone involved with the Party. What form will the Betrayal take? Maybe the Party's plans are revealed to the opposition. Maybe the betrayer helps the opposition set up an ambush (or drugs the Edgerunners so that they can be captured). Maybe they kidnap an important NPC and turn them over to the Antagonists as a hostage. Or even steal the gadget needed to defeat the enemy.

A Betrayal should always allow the Edgerunners a chance to catch the Betrayer in the act or find them soon afterward to enact revenge.

► CLUE

An ambiguous Revelation. One part of the puzzle is revealed, but not the whole thing. With a Clue, the Edgerunners learn only that "Someone is buying or stealing up all the loose radioactive material in the city," instead of "Inquisitors are acquiring all the radioactive material they can find because they've decided to cleanse the city in fire by building and detonating a nuclear device."

► FORESHADOWING

Like Warnings, the foreshadowing Development gives warning of events to come. However, the warnings are always ambiguous and hazy: instead of saying "Watch out for Corp agents," Foreshadowing says "Be wary of anyone with an expensive haircut." This Development can be played at almost any time but shouldn't be played immediately before the event (as you're going to want some time for the suspense to build). Foreshadowing can be used in a number of ways: the Antagonists may meet the Edgerunners in a non-threatening situation, or someone may warn the Edgerunners about the Antagonist. Foreshadowing is unique in that it can encompass messages from the NET and obscure hints. The nature of the threat is not obviously explained.

► FRAMED!

The Party (or a member of the Party) is set up for a crime they didn't commit. The frame should be obvious to everyone except the authorities (who will have convincing evidence to the contrary).

► GAIN MASTERY

This Development represents a period of learning or improvement: a long session with a teacher or master, special training from a skilled source, study, or long practice. The Edgerunners spend weeks in a training camp with an old Militech Drill Sergeant, or travel to a Nomad encampment to learn to drive from Nomad Santiago himself. At the end of the Mastery period, they will possess the skills needed to win the Game, if they use them wisely. It's best to compress time in this Development: don't cover each moment of every day, just the high spots (training montage!).

► HAZARDOUS QUEST

The Edgerunners are forced to embark on a journey of hazardous proportions to destroy, find, or recover something. The way will be long and arduous, with obstacles everywhere. There may be terrible storms or other deadly environmental conditions. In the Hazardous Quest Beat, any combat or attacks will be of a minor nature unrelated to their Opposition: wild animals, old drones, random gangers. A hazardous

BY RICHARD BAGNALL



journey can, however, start, be interrupted by, or end with a Battle, Ambush, Trap, or other combat-related Beat.

► HESITATION

The Hesitation Development is much like the Retreat; the opposition breaks off its attack without warning. However, they do not quit the field. Instead, they may pause to negotiate a temporary truce. A typical version of this is the old, "Hrrmm. You guys are a lot better than I expected. I'm impressed. Perhaps you would be willing to work with me." Note that in most cases, should the Edgerunners go along with them, the Antagonist will betray or backstab them at the earliest opportunity.

► LIE REVEALED

Something previously thought to be true turns out to be a lie! This could be a clue, a piece of information, the identity of an NPC, or any other vital fact. The Revealed Lie does not automatically reveal the truth; it just becomes clear to the Edgerunners that what they were originally told is untrue.

► MISTAKEN IDENTITY

One (or more) of the Edgerunners is mistaken for (or poses as) someone else. The identity will always be that of an important person; however, it may be a good or bad guy. "Aren't you the PopMedia celeb/the Boss's kid/my old lover?" With the mistaken identity can come problems, advantages, or information, which can be played as Developments after this is played. For example, if everyone thinks an Edgerunner is the Long-Lost, Presumed Dead Rache Bartmoss, this may provoke Rache's (many) enemies to attack as soon as possible. Later, Rache's romantic (?) interest may show up with information for the same Edgerunner. Use this Development carefully—it's dynamite.

► MONOLOGUE

The leader of the opposition is in a talkative mood. Like Antagonists everywhere, they have the need to brag about the Master Plan; what the Goal is, how it will be accomplished, etc. This Development is only played when the Edgerunners are totally in the Antagonist's

control, after a Kidnapping, Trap, or Confrontation. The bad guys feel like it won't matter: the Edgerunners are going to die or serve them anyway, so why not make them sweat?

► NOT WHAT IT SEEMS

An action in a previous Beat is not as it was originally perceived. Friends may turn out to be enemies, something harmful is actually good, etc. A classic example is the ally who changes sides in one Beat, then is discovered to be infiltrating the opposition as a double agent. This is a tough Development to play, as it requires that the Gamemaster knows the true meaning of the original action and makes it obvious that the change was intended all along.

► OBSESSION

A member of the Party is the target of another Character's obsession. This obsession may be for love, hate, or curiosity. The obsessed Actor will do their best to follow the object of obsession around, trying to stay close to them. They will not attack the Edgerunners and will avoid confrontation whenever possible.

► PERSONAL STAKE

This Development raises the ante of the Game by interjecting a Personal Stake into the action. Examples would include one of the Edgerunners being poisoned, with the only vial of the antidote being in the hands of the opposition; an Edgerunner's friend or lover being kidnapped by the Antagonist; the Edgerunners learning that their enemy set them up in some way and the only way to clear their names is to get the real culprit, etc.

► PUZZLE

A riddle is posed to the Edgerunners—something that must be solved before they can move on. It can be any type of riddle or puzzle. Unlike a Contest, a Puzzle does not involve two sides, it is merely placed before the Edgerunners, who must then solve it before they can escape, get into the Corp HQ, learn the Antagonist's secret, etc. Like a Trap, a Puzzle must always have a solution, and clues to that solution must either be present in the same Scene or in a Scene that has already occurred.

► RESCUERS!

The Edgerunners must save someone from capture, death, or confinement. The important part of this Beat is to provide a compelling reason for the rescue to take place. Maybe the victim is a friend or has information the party needs to succeed.

► RETREAT

Usually played after a Cliffhanger. For an unknown reason, the Edgerunner's opponents are suddenly forced to break off an Attack, Ambush, or other action, and retreat to their current stronghold. As a Gamemaster, it's up to you to decide the reasons for this sudden reversal. Perhaps there has been a setback or betrayal in the enemy camp, a hostile third party is on their way, or the opposition has realized that the fight will not serve its original purpose. When a retreat is played, the enemy will always seek to cover their tracks with some delaying tactic that makes it impossible for the Edgerunners to immediately follow: collapsing a stairway, dropping a cluster of grenades, or weaving into impossible to navigate traffic.

► REVEALED WEAKNESS

A Revealed Weakness shows the Edgerunners some previously unknown weakness of their opposition. The weakness could be physical, mental (a hidden fear or phobia), a special weapon or Tool which can be used against the opposition, or a traitor within the enemy's camp.

A Revealed Weakness is always clearly described: "The Dragoon Full Body Conversion unit is a combat monster but there's a flaw in the casing around the power core that can be penetrated by a solid shot."

► REVELATION

A Revelation is played when a key piece of information is uncovered. Revelations don't tell the Edgerunners the same things as a Hidden Weakness or Clue. Instead, in a Revelation, they discover the entire story—all of what's going on in one shot. It's not merely a clue, like "Someone is buying up or stealing all the radioactive material in the city," but rather, "The Inquisitors are acquiring all the radioactive material they can find because they've decided to cleanse the city in fire by building and detonating a nuclear

device." Revelations should only be used when you really want the Edgerunners to know the whole story and this knowledge won't affect the outcome in any critical way.

► ROMANCE

Ah, love! (We couldn't resist.) In this Development, Romance comes to one or more of the Edgerunners when someone takes a strong liking to them.

This doesn't have to be all hearts and flowers, though: a new lover can come complete with secret alliances to the Edgerunner's enemy, jealous suitors, angry parents, hidden secrets, or a lethal and incurable disease.

► SABOTAGE!

An important weapon, piece of cyberware, or vehicle of the Party's is disabled by sabotage. Like the Betrayal Development, the party should have a chance to detect the sabotage and avert/repair it.

► SECOND CHANCE

This represents another crack at the problem. The Edgerunners have suffered a major setback in some way (they were unprepared or just missed the clues). This Development can be played to "save" a disintegrating game; Allies appear with new information, new clues are revealed, or comrades previously thought dead may be brought back by an act of divine intervention (or scriptwriting; i.e.: "When Harry's AV crashed, he ejected at the last moment, but was knocked out and lost his memory, but then he recovered and has rejoined the Crew.").

This is a very powerful Development to play, and should be deployed with extreme care.

► SECRET MEETING

A secret meeting is called, in which the Edgerunners can gain new allies or information. Secret Meetings are usually played before a Clue, Revelation, or Alliance Development. A Beat can be played between the two Developments (the Meeting is broken up by an Ambush or some other type of conflict). Most of the action in this Development comes from setting up, reaching, and meeting people at the Meeting.

► STRANGE BEDFELLOWS

A common threat suddenly forces the Crew to ally with the opposition. This works best when the enemy suddenly shows up and says, "We have a common problem and need to work together." The common threat must be both compelling and convincing for this Beat to work.

► TURNABOUT!

One member of the opposition decides (for their own reasons), to aid the Crew. Classic examples of this would be the underling who betrays the Antagonist in order to get their job, or the opponent who joins the Edgerunners because they fall in love with one of them. This is a good way to balance the odds when the Crew has been reduced in strength and needs some support.

► VENGEANCE!

One member of the Crew becomes the target of the opposition's vengeance. Maybe it's something the Edgerunner did. Maybe the bad guy just doesn't like the Edgerunner's face. In any conflict, this enemy will make a point of attacking or challenging this Edgerunner, no matter what the risk.

► WARNING

The Warning Development tells the Edgerunners of something to come, or of a threat they may not be aware of. Warnings are mysterious voices in the NET, notes slipped under doors, or allies coming to the Edgerunners to tell them what's about to happen. The main difference between a Warning and a Foreshadowing is that a Warning is always explicit: it tells the nature of the threat or problem, while a Foreshadowing gives only vague hints.

► Climax ◀

Climaxes are scenes that happen near the end (or sometimes *at* the end) of the Game. Thus, they are played last. The only other Scene that can follow a Climax is a Resolution.

► FINAL BATTLE

This is the big megillah, the last showdown between the Edgerunners and the enemy. In this one, you can feel free to bring in the Antagonist, their Henchmen,

assorted Minions, and whatever Monsters or other Opposition forces you can muster. A Final Battle should be a dramatic free-for-all, with destruction meted out on a grand scale. Like the Final Revelation, the Final Battle wraps up the Game for the most part, the enemies are beaten, the love interest rescued, and the neighborhood saved.

► FINAL REVELATION

In the Final Revelation, the Edgerunners (and appropriate NPCs) are gathered together in one place, and, like the participants in an Agatha Christie novel, must decide what is going on and expose the true facts. What has been going on must finally be revealed in its entirety: the Edgerunner's learn about the Inquisition's nuclear bomb plot, the murderer is revealed, or the enemy's secret identity exposed. The outcome of this Revelation is already decided; once the killer is revealed, the police will arrest them, or once the Corp exec's illicit business affairs are uncovered, they will slink away in disgrace. The goal of the Final Revelation is to merely uncover the underlying mystery.

► FINAL ACT

Not every mission ends in a big reveal or a huge battle. Sometimes Edgerunners try for stealth and guile and actually succeed. This is especially true in heist adventures. In the Final Act Revelation, the Edgerunners enact their big plan to accomplish their goal. Example goals include stealing a piece of tech, planting a crippling virus in a Corp's network, or placing the bomb that'll wipe out an enemy gang's headquarters once and for all. While the Final Act might involve fights or obstacles, they aren't the main focus. Instead, the focus should be on how the pieces of the plan come together to help the Edgerunners complete the job.

► Resolution ◀

Resolutions are like the "tag line" of a show: they're a tiny denouement in which plot ends are neatly tied up (or the possibilities of a sequel revealed). They may only be played as the final Beat in your script and are the result of all the other Beats. But how can that be, you ask? Didn't the Final Battle Beat resolve things? Not necessarily. The Resolution Beat can overturn all other results of the Final Battle.

▶ ANTAGONIST ESCAPES

The Antagonist is Beaten, but not killed or locked away. They've got a secret bolt hole, or it really wasn't them at all—it was a bodysculpted double. If this Scene is played, the Antagonist gets clean away: the Edgerunners have no way of tracing them and no way of recapturing them. They're out there, waiting. A great way to re-use a major opponent, assuming that you don't do it all the time.

▶ ANTAGONIST IS KILLED

Take that, you slimy Corp Exec! Bang! Snicker-snack! The Antagonist is dead and the Gamemaster gets to hand out I.P.. A fairly common Resolution, especially if your Edgerunners are a bloodthirsty lot.

▶ ANTAGONIST TOPPLED

Another common resolution. The Edgerunners win and, while the Antagonist survives, the threat is neutralized. The murderer goes to prison, the Corp Exec gets transferred to a remote posting in shame, or the gang leader loses all their followers. This resolution offers a chance to use the Antagonist down the road but either as a minor threat (perhaps working for a new Antagonist) or as a different sort of challenge.

▶ EDGERUNNERS CAPTURED

This Beat is best played when the Edgerunners have really messed up, but you don't want to kill them outright. Instead, they're captured, and the adventure ends with them in durance vile, locked in a Corp jail or left adrift on the ocean. At this point, you have the option of starting a new Game or picking up where the old one left off. A hot Gamemaster tip: don't immediately start the next Game. Instead, put the PCs in limbo, make them create all new Edgerunners, and run a totally different game first. Not only does this make the Players sweat out the fate of their Edgerunners, it buys you time to decide how you want to proceed after their upcoming daring escape!

▶ EDGERUNNERS ESCAPE

This Beat is best used when your Edgerunners are on the ropes and you don't feel like killing them. Instead, you allow them to escape: an earthquake interrupts their losing battle, another force attacks and distracts

the opposition, or an AV lands on the battlefield and an unknown person motions for them to hop in. The object is to save the Edgerunners for another round, because they really did do a good job. Like the Edgerunners Captured Resolution, you should make the Players sweat out another game first. Not a commonly used option, and one to apply with great care.

▶ ENDING CLIFFHANGER

So, they beat the rival gang and kicked them out of their territory, huh? Just as the Edgerunners are about to break out the Smash and celebrate, a Nomad convoy rolls down the street and announces they're taking over the neighborhood!

The Ending Cliffhanger is another way to set up for a sequel but keep the tension on all the way. As with the Edgerunner Captured Resolution, you might consider spacing out the sequel with another, different game first.

▶ GREATER THREAT

So, you thought getting rid of the Antagonist ended the problem, eh? No; behind them stands a far greater threat! Sure, you took down the local Zhirafa head of security but that means you've attracted the attention of their boss or the gang leader you deposed was working for the Yakuza and now you have to deal with them.

In this Scene, you discover that this is only the beginning, and another game lurks in the offing.

▶ HAPPY ENDING

The Edgerunners win the day! In **Cyberpunk**, this could be a major victory like toppling a Corporation or minor victory like getting paid after finishing a mission. Any job you can walk away from, choomba.

▶ PYRRHIC VICTORY

The Edgerunners won, technically. They finished the job and they killed the Antagonist, but their victory came at a hefty price. Their HQ burned to the ground or an important NPC died during the final confrontation. Whatever the case, while they're walking away winners, the Edgerunners shouldn't feel like it. Be careful—while this victory feels very Cyberpunk it can be a tough act to follow.



BY ANSELM ZIELONKA

LOSING THE BEAT

In your average movie, the actors stick to the script and everyone knows what will happen next. Players in an RPG, on the other hand, are famous for surprising the GM. Just because you've set up a Beat Chart doesn't mean the Players will follow it step by step. And trying to force them to, usually called "railroading," isn't much fun for you or them. Not to mention, RPGs like **Cyberpunk** rely on a certain amount of random luck to adjudicate the action. All it takes is a few bad rolls and suddenly your carefully planned Beat Chart might fall apart. What do you do then?

Improvise.

A good Beat Chart should be flexible. Sure, your Players might have lost a fight and not gotten the briefcase filled with secrets they needed from the enemy, but that doesn't have to end the adventure. Ask yourself, can the Edgerunners find that information somewhere else? Is there a Fixer with the same data who'll sell it at a cost? Or did some gangers ambush the enemy with the briefcase after the fight and steal it? With a stroke of a pen (or a few clicks of a keyboard) you can change your Clue Development from "The Edgerunners find important documents in a briefcase they got from the baddies," to "The Edgerunners have to track down the gangster who stole the briefcase and negotiate (or fight) for it."

Just stay calm, be willing to change things up and, if you need it, call for a bio break to buy yourself time and rethink your Beat Chart. Who knows? Maybe the new direction will open up new possibilities as well! Remember, a **Cyberpunk** adventure isn't "GM Storytime" but a collaborative effort everyone contributes to.

GETTING BETTER

LEARNING NEW SKILLS AND IMPROVING OLD ONES

Assuming you live through everything the City has thrown at you, you're going to need to get better at what you do. Players can improve their Skills (or begin new ones) and Role Abilities by accumulating what we call Improvement Points (I.P.). As you gain more I.P., you'll record these points in the Improvement Point area of your character sheet. When you have collected enough Improvement Points you can raise the Level of a Skill or the Rank of your Role Ability.

STATISTICAL DATA-BASED IMPROVEMENT

- **Warriors:** Combat oriented Players like to engage in tests of skill against adversaries. They want to build the strongest fighter in the group, as well as have the best weapons or combat abilities.

- **Socializers:** Social-oriented Players are all about the overall game experience. They like to tell jokes, record stories, and contribute in ways that are not directly within the game. In and out of the game, they tend to take supportive roles.

- **Explorers:** Exploration oriented players like to find new things in the world. They like to make friends and alliances and find new places and things to experience. They also love to solve non-combat related puzzles and mysteries.

- **Roleplayers:** Roleplay oriented Players like to concentrate on playing their character as accurately to type as possible. They enjoy constructing elaborate backgrounds for the character, often including personal props, pictures and even special diaries. They enjoy "acting out" important scenes with speeches or elaborate descriptions.

▶ What Type of Player Am I? ◀

But what kind of playstyle is yours? We figure this out by having each Player take a small quiz after they finish character creation. This helps both the GM and the Player to determine what playstyle best approximates their type.

In the boxes below, the Player should choose the 5 things they find **most important** when playing. The box with the most circles is their **primary** play style. The box with the second most circles is their **secondary** play style.

WARRIORS	Defeat an enemy in battle. Gain a powerful tool or weapon. Prove your Skill in battle. The thrill of the hunt. Make the most powerful Character/tool. Establish a stronghold. Have a nemesis to beat.	Find a new place on the map. Meet someone new in the world. Solve a difficult puzzle. Learn about the world and its Lore. Establish a place or alliance. Contribute to the history of the world.	EXPLORERS
	Reminisce about a favorite game moment. Tell other people about the games you're in. Contribute to the success of the group. Team up to beat a challenge. Make friends outside of the game. Be part of the group.	Have a picture of your Character. Write up your Character's background. Create extended family around your Character. Know about pets, favorite things, friends, and enemies. Act out the accents and mannerisms of your Character.	

EARNING IMPROVEMENT POINTS

After each game session, the GM awards all Players Improvement Points based on how successful they were in their mission. If the mission was finished (successfully or unsuccessfully), the Players gain Improvement Points based on their Group's success (taking the value from the Group Column) unless they did something that the GM considers stand out from one of the other playstyles that would award them more points.

If the players didn't finish the mission, they are awarded I.P. based on either their Primary or Secondary Playstyle, unless they did something that the GM considers stand out from one of the other playstyles that would award them more points.

For instance, if Bob Jones is a Warrior Type and he manages to defeat all of the dreaded Team X by luring them into a crossfire trap, that would fall under the "very effective or clever use of combat skills, defeating several opponents in unexpected or unusual ways" category. So, Bob would get 50 Playstyle I.P. for that feat.

▶ PLAYSTYLE IMPROVEMENT POINT TABLE

I.P. Earned	Group	Warrior	Socializer	Explorer	Roleplayer
10	Group did not succeed in mission, but tried valiantly	Used combat Skills often, even if not to exceptional effective.	Was a supportive and helpful part of the party, in or out of game.	Attempted to investigate or explore the world/situation often, even if not to exceptional effect	Attempted to roleplay character often
20	Group barely accomplished mission goals	Used combat Skills often and effectively, often taking out important opponents.	Supportive actions were helpful in maintaining Player/party unity and cohesion (quote lists, game notebooks, etc)	Used exploration effectively to learn about the world/situation	Roleplayed in character all the time, often effectively
30	Group worked together well, accomplishing most of the mission goals with everyone taking part in the adventure.	Frequent and effective use of combat Skills, defeating the most dangerous opponents in a given combat challenge.	Frequent and effective use of supportive or helpful activities were beneficial in maintaining Player/party unity and cohesion (Character pictures, extensive diaries, etc.)	Frequent and effective use of exploration and investigation to further personal and party goals	Frequent and effective use of roleplaying to accomplish a goal (acted, not rolled to accomplish task)
40	Group accomplished most of the mission goals well, showing strong cooperative skills.	Did something out of the ordinary with use of combat Skills, defeating an opponent in an unexpected or unusual way.	Did something out of the ordinary that encouraged or helped the group overall (extensive diaries, special events)	Discovered something out of the ordinary or exceptional through exploration and investigation activities	Did something out of the ordinary roleplaying wise (a clever speech or interaction in game)
50	Group accomplished most of the mission goals extremely well, with a few stellar moments.	Very effective or clever use of combat Skills, defeating several opponents in unexpected or unusual ways.	Did something very effective or clever that encouraged or helped the group overall.	Very effective or clever use of investigation or exploration activities to uncover an important person, place, clue, or thing	Very effective or clever use of roleplaying (a clever interaction or important roleplaying moment)

I.P. Earned	Group	Warrior	Socializer	Explorer	Roleplayer
60	Group's mission was a strong success, accomplishing all of the mission goals set forth with several stellar moments in the adventure	Combat Skills were absolutely critical to the Character in this game session, allowing the Character to defeat a major opponent or long-term nemesis single-handedly	Player's participation in supporting the group was a very important part of helping the group work together to accomplish its goals	Player's use of investigation or exploration to uncover an important person, place, clue, or thing was critical to the Character in this game session	Roleplaying actions were critical to the Player in this game session (changed personal game outcome through convincing roleplaying)
70	Group's mission was a resounding success, accomplishing all of the mission goals set forth and also several side goals of the session. Group also showed strong cooperation and teamwork	Combat Skills were absolutely critical to entire party in this game session (without Character's help, party would have been totally defeated)	Player's participation in supporting the group was a critical part of helping the group work together to accomplish its goals	Player's use of investigation or exploration to uncover an important person, place, clue, or thing was critical to entire party in this game session	Roleplaying actions were critical to entire party in this game session (changed entire game outcome through convincing roleplaying)
80	Group's mission was legendary, accomplishing all of the mission goals set forth and also all side goals of the session. Group also showed exceptional cooperation and teamwork	Did something really incredible in a combat encounter (hole in one shot, took down impossible enemy or nemesis, saved entire party)	Did something really incredible to support the group and help it work together to accomplish its goals	Player's use of investigation or exploration uncovered something really incredible in this game session	Did something really incredible in roleplaying, such as a heroic speech, star moment, or amazing influence on game outcomes through roleplaying

SPENDING IMPROVEMENT POINTS

Players can spend their earned Improvement Points to better their Character. To raise a Skill or Role Ability, they must spend a number of Improvement Points based on the Skill or Ability's **next** Level/Rank.

► TYPICAL SKILL IMPROVEMENT

Level	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
I.P. Cost	20	40	60	80	100	120	140	160	180	200

► DIFFICULT [x2] SKILL IMPROVEMENT

Level	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
I.P. Cost	40	80	120	160	200	240	280	320	360	400

► ROLE ABILITY RANK IMPROVEMENT

Rank	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
I.P. Cost	60	120	180	240	300	360	420	480	540	600

DATA

Even if you have the Improvement Points, you can't skip Levels/Ranks. You should spend some time at your new Level/Rank before advancing to the next one.

BOOKS AND GRUNTS

DISPOSABLE BADDIES FOR EVERY OCCASION

Gamemasters, you can use the following NPCs to flesh out their encounters. Feel free to change them to suit you needs. The Skill Bases presented here combine STAT + Skill + any modifiers from cyberware, Role Abilities, and gear already. These NPCs do not have Roles, or Role Abilities, or LUCK, unless otherwise noted.

BODYGUARD

INT	3	REF	6	DEX	5	TECH	2	COOL	4
WILL	4	LUCK	—	MOVE	4	BODY	6	EMP	3
Hit Points				35				SERIOUSLY WOUNDED	
				18				DEATH SAVE	
				6					
Weapons						Armor: Kevlar®			
Poor Quality Shotgun				5d6		Head		7 SP	
Very Heavy Pistol				4d6		Body		7 SP	
SKILL BASES Athletics 9, Brawling 11, Concentration 6, Conversation 5, Drive Land Vehicle 10, Education 5, Endurance 9, Evasion 7, First Aid 4, Handgun 10, Human Perception 5, Interrogation 6, Language (Native) 5, Language (Streetslang) 5, Local Expert (Your Home) 5, Perception 9, Persuasion 6, Resist Torture/Drug 8, Shoulder Arms 10, Stealth 7									
CYBERWARE & SPECIAL EQUIPMENT Slug Ammo x25, Very Heavy Pistol Ammo x25, Radio Communicator									

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BOOSTERGANGER

INT	2	REF	6	DEX	5	TECH	2	COOL	4
WILL	2	LUCK	—	MOVE	4	BODY	4	EMP	3
Hit Points				20				SERIOUSLY WOUNDED	
				10				DEATH SAVE	
				4					
Weapons						Armor: Leather			
Poor Quality VH Pistol				4d6		Head		4 SP	
Rippers				2d6		Body		4 SP	
SKILL BASES Athletics 9, Brawling 9, Conceal/Reveal Object 4, Concentration 4, Conversation 5, Drive Land Vehicle 10, Education 4, Endurance 6, Evasion 7, First Aid 4, Handgun 12, Human Perception 5, Interrogation 6, Language (Native) 4, Language (Streetslang) 4, Local Expert (Your Home) 4, Melee Weapon 11, Perception 6, Persuasion 6, Resist Torture/Drugs 4, Stealth 7									
CYBERWARE & SPECIAL EQUIPMENT VH Pistol Ammo x30, Disposable Cellphone, Rippers, Techhair									

ROAD GANGER

INT	4	REF	6	DEX	4	TECH	4	COOL	3
WILL	3	LUCK	—	MOVE	3	BODY	3	EMP	3
Hit Points				25				SERIOUSLY WOUNDED	
				13				DEATH SAVE	
								3	
Weapons							Armor: Leather		
Very Heavy Pistol		4d6	Light Melee Weapon			1d6	Head	4 SP	
Crossbow		4d6					Body	4 SP	
SKILL BASES Archery 10, Athletics 10, Brawling 6, Concentration 5, Conversation 6, Drive Land Vehicle 12, Education 6, Endurance 5, Evasion 6, First Aid 6, Handgun 10, Human Perception 5, Land Vehicle Tech 10, Language (Native) 6, Language (Streetslang) 6, Local Expert (Your Home) 6, Melee Weapon 8, Perception 6, Persuasion 5, Stealth 8, Tracking 8, Wilderness Survival 8									
CYBERWARE & SPECIAL EQUIPMENT VH Pistol Ammo x20, Arrow Ammo x20, Rope, Flashlight, Neural Link (Interface Plugs)									

Bodyguards, Boostergangers, Road Gangers, and Security Operatives as presented here are considered Mooks (low level adversaries). In general a group of Player Character Edgerunners should be able to battle an equal number of Mook NPCs and have a good chance of coming up on top.

SECURITY OPERATIVE

▶ INT	3	▶ REF	7	▶ DEX	4	▶ TECH	2	▶ COOL	2
▶ WILL	3	▶ LUCK	—	▶ MOVE	3	▶ BODY	5	▶ EMP	3
▶ HIT POINTS				30				▶ SERIOUSLY WOUNDED	
				15				▶ DEATH SAVE	
				5					
Weapons						Armor: Kevlar®			
Poor Quality Assault Rifle		5d6		Medium Melee		2d6		Head	7 SP
Very Heavy Pistol		4d6		Weapon				Body	7 SP
▶ SKILL BASES Athletics 8, Autofire 10, Brawling 6, Concentration 7, Conversation 5, Education 5, Evasion 6, First Aid 4, Handgun 10, Human Perception 5, Interrogation 6, Language (Native) 5, Language (Streetslang) 5, Local Expert (Your Home) 5, Melee Weapon 6, Perception 5, Persuasion 4, Resist Torture/Drugs 5, Shoulder Arms 10, Stealth 6									
▶ CYBERWARE & SPECIAL EQUIPMENT Rifle x40, VH Pistol Ammo x20, Radio Communicator									

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NETRUNNER

INT	7	REF	5	DEX	4	TECH	7	COOL	4	
WILL	5	LUCK	—	MOVE	5	BODY	3	EMP	4	
Hit Points		30		SERIOUSLY WOUNDED		15		DEATH SAVE		3

Weapons	
Very Heavy Pistol	4d6

Armor: Bodyweight Suit	
Head	11 SP
Body	11 SP

SKILL BASES Interface 4, Athletics 9, Basic Tech 13, Brawling 6, Conceal/Reveal Object 11, Concentration 9, Conversation 6, Cryptography 11, Deduction 11, Education 11, Electronics/Security Tech 11, Evasion 6, First Aid 9, Forgery 13, Handgun 10, Human Perception 6, Language (Native) 9, Language (Street slang) 9, Local Expert (Your Home) 13, Library Search 9, Perception 11, Persuasion 6, Pick Lock 11, Resist Torture/Drugs 7, Stealth 8

CYBERWARE & SPECIAL EQUIPMENT VH Pistol Ammo x50, Flashlight, Virtuality Goggles, Neural Link (Interface Plugs)

CYBERDECK PROGRAMS Banhammer, DeckKRASH, Eraser, Hellbolt, Shield, Sword, Worm

The Netrunner, Reclaimer Chief, and Security Officer as presented here are considered Lieutenants (mid-level adversaries). A good rule of thumb is to throw out 1 Lieutenant for every 2 Edgerunners in the Crew.

RECLAIMER CHIEF

INT	3	REF	6	DEX	6	TECH	5	COOL	4	
WILL	5	LUCK	—	MOVE	4	BODY	6	EMP	4	
Hit Points		40		SERIOUSLY WOUNDED		20		DEATH SAVE		6

Weapons			
Shotgun	5d6	Light Melee Weapon	1d6
Heavy Pistol	3d6	Heavy Melee Weapon	3d6

Armor: L Armorjack	
Head	11 SP
Body	11 SP

SKILL BASES Athletics 12, Basic Tech 9, Brawling 8, Concentration 7, Conversation 6, Deduction 7, Drive Land Vehicle 10, Education 5, Electronics/Security Tech 9, Endurance 11, Evasion 8, First Aid 7, Handgun 10, Human Perception 6, Land Vehicle Tech 7, Language (Native) 5, Language (Street slang) 5, Local Expert (Your Home) 5, Melee Weapon 10, Paramedic 7, Perception 8, Persuasion 6, Pick Lock 7, Resist Torture/Drugs 10, Shoulder Arms 10, Stealth 10, Weaponstech 9, Wilderness Survival 7

CYBERWARE & SPECIAL EQUIPMENT Slug Ammo x25, H Pistol Ammo x25, Agent, Grapple Gun, Radio Communicator, Tent & Camping Equipment, Nasal Filters, Neural Link (Chipware Socket, Tactile Boost)

SECURITY OFFICER

INT	4	REF	8 (6)	DEX	6 (4)	TECH	4	COOL	6						
WILL	5	LUCK	—	MOVE	6 (4)	BODY	7	EMP	4						
HIT POINTS				40				SERIOUSLY WOUNDED		20		DEATH SAVE		7	
Weapons										Armor: M Armorjack					
Assault Rifle		5d6		Medium Melee		2d6		Head		13 SP					
Very Heavy Pistol		4d6		Weapon				Body		13 SP					
SKILL BASES Athletics 10 (8), Autofire 12 (10), Brawling 10 (8), Concentration 7, Conversation 6, Deduction 6, Drive Land Vehicle 12 (10), Education 6, Evasion 10 (8), First Aid 6, Handgun 10 (8), Human Perception 6, Interrogation 8, Language (Native) 6, Language (Streetslang) 6, Local Expert (Your Home) 6, Melee Weapon 10 (8), Perception 6, Persuasion 8, Resist Torture/Drugs 10, Shoulder Arms 10 (8), Stealth 6 (4), Tactics															
CYBERWARE & SPECIAL EQUIPMENT Rifle Ammo x50, VH Pistol Ammo x30, Bulletproof Shield (10 HP) Binoculars, Disposable Cellphone, Flashlight, Handcuffs x2, Radio Communicator, Radio Scanner/Music Player, Neural Link (Kerenzikov Speedware)															

The Outrider and Pyro as presented here are considered Mini Bosses (high level adversaries). A good rule of thumb is to throw out 1 Mini Boss for every 3 Edgerunners in the Crew.

OUTRIDER

INT	6	REF	8	DEX	8	TECH	3	COOL	5						
WILL	6	LUCK	—	MOVE	6	BODY	6	EMP	6						
Hit Points				40				Seriously Wounded		20		Death Save		6	
Weapons										Armor: L Armorjack					
Assault Rifle			5d6		Light Melee			1d6		Head		11 SP			
Very Heavy Pistol			4d6		Weapon					Body		11 SP			
Skill Bases															
Moto Family 4, Animal Handling 8, Athletics 14, Autofire 12, Basic Tech 5, Brawling 14, Concentration 10, Conversation 6, Criminology 10, Drive Land Vehicle 14, Education 8, Endurance 10, Evasion 14, First Aid 5, Handgun 14, Human Perception 8, Land Vehicle Tech 7, Language (Native) 8, Language (Streetslang) 8, Local Expert (Badlands) 10, Local Expert (Your Home) 8, Melee Weapons 12, Perception 14, Persuasion 7, Resist Torture/Drugs 12, Shoulder Arms 14, Stealth 12, Streetwise 9, Tracking 10															
Cyberware & Special Equipment															
Rifle Ammo x60, VH Pistol Ammo x40, Handcuffs x2, Homing Tracers, Radio Communicator, Cyberaudio Suite (Amplified Hearing), Cybereye (Targeting Scope, TeleOptics), Neural Link (Interface Plugs)															

PYRO

INT	5	REF	8	DEX	6	TECH	7	COOL	4
WILL	4	LUCK	—	MOVE	6	BODY	5	EMP	3
Hit Points				35		SERIOUSLY WOUNDED		18	
Death Save								5	

Weapons				Armor: L Armorjack	
Flamethrower	3d6	Heavy Melee	3d6	Head	11 SP
Heavy Pistol	3d6	Weapon		Body	11 SP

SKILL BASES **Combat Awareness 4**, Athletics 11, Basic Tech 12, Brawling 10, Concentration 8, Conversation 5, Demolition 13, Drive Land Vehicle 10, Education 7, Evasion 13, First Aid 9, Handgun 14, Heavy Weapons 14, Human Perception 5, Interrogation 10, Language (Native) 7, Language (Streetslang) 7, Local Expert (Your Home) 7, Melee Weapon 13, Perception 12, Persuasion 6, Resist Torture/Drugs 14, Science (Chemistry) 10, Stealth 10, Streetwise 8, Tactics 8

CYBERWARE & SPECIAL EQUIPMENT Flamethrower Ammo (Incendiary Shotgun Shells) x8, VH Pistol Ammo x50, Incendiary Grenade x1, Flashbang Grenade x1, Cyberaudio Suite (Level Dampners), Cybereye x2 (Anti-Dazzle x2), Nasal Filters

The Cyberpsycho is built to be a full on boss battle. Don't put them on the board unless you're sure your Edgerunners are up for the challenge!

CYBERPSYCHO

INT	5	REF	8	DEX	8	TECH	5	COOL	4
WILL	7	LUCK	—	MOVE	8	BODY	10	EMP	0
Hit Points				55		SERIOUSLY WOUNDED		28	
Death Save								10	

Weapons				Armor: Subdermal	
Popup Grenade Launcher	6d6	Cybersnake	4d6	Head	11 SP
Popup Heavy SMG	3d6	Wolvers	3d6	Body	11 SP

SKILL BASES Athletics 16, Autofire 14, Basic Tech 11, Brawling 15, Concentration 6, Conversation 2, Drive Land Vehicle 10, Education 7, Endurance 10, Evasion 13, First Aid 6, Handgun 12, Heavy Weapons 14, Human Perception 2, Interrogation 13, Language (Native) 7, Language (Streetslang) 7, Local Expert (Your Home) 7, Melee Weapon 17, Perception 9, Persuasion 6, Resist Torture/Drugs 15, Stealth 10, Tracking 10

CYBERWARE & SPECIAL EQUIPMENT Armor Piercing Grenade x2, Heavy Pistol Ammo x100, Cyberarm x2 (Popup Grenade Launcher x2, Popup Heavy SMG, Wolver), Cyberleg x2 (Jump Boosters x2), Cybersnake, Grafted Muscle & Bone Lace, Neural Link (Chipware Socket, Pain Editor), Subdermal Armor

ENCOUNTERS IN THE RED

Welcome to the mean Streets of the City. These encounter tables are fast and nasty ways to keep your Players moving, thinking, and living in **Cyberpunk RED**. Just roll a percentage (2d10, with one representing the tens' place) to determine the outcome. Each listing refers to one of the ten NPCs on the previous section, sometimes with modifications. Remember, just because we give you STATS doesn't mean each encounter should result in combat; use these as role-playing opportunities whenever possible. Feel free to alter the participants or the locale for extra variety.

REGIONAL VARIATION

When using these Encounter Tables it's important to keep in mind what part of the City you're in. If you're in a zone with a Moderate Threat Rating then it's free game and any of these encounters could happen. But in the safer Zone with a Corporate Threat Rating you're not gonna be running into gang wars and cyberpsychos. And if you wander into the Combat Zone or the Hot Zone you're far more likely to run into trouble.

When rolling for an encounter in a zone with a **Corporate Threat Rating** you'll want to avoid Encounters at the higher end of the scale (Above 50) unless you really want a shake-up. Also keep in mind that in most cases, if a fire fight breaks out in these zones the Corporate police will arrive shortly. When combat breaks out in one of these zones roll 1d10. In that many rounds a group of Corp cops will arrive to kill or detain everyone on the scene with a weapon (see the appropriate Corporate Guards encounter).

Likewise, when rolling for an encounter in the more lawless zones (**Combat and Hot Threat Ratings**) you may want to avoid using encounters from the lower end of the scale (Below 50) unless it's a slow day in the zone. Combat is more likely and a peaceful resolution is harder to come by.

The exception to these tables is the Executive Zone, which acts as a haven for high-level Corporates and their families. The Executive Zone is outside the City and locked off by the highest security money can buy. If your Players ever make it to the Executive Zone they

won't run into encounters and will instead have to deal with the constant, paranoid, surveillance of Corporate security. If you even draw a gun in the Executive Zone the Corp cops will be on you in seconds and they'll arrive in greater numbers, with better weaponry.

DAYTIME ENCOUNTERS IN NIGHT CITY

(1-5) Local Law: A number of patrol officers equal to half the Players, armed with Assault Rifles, Very Heavy Pistols, and heavy batons and armored in Kevlar®. If you're wearing visible weapons or armor, they stop you and demand identification. If you're argumentative, they call for backup (3 officers) to take you in. If you reach for a weapon, they'll shoot first, fill out the paperwork later. (Use **Security Operatives**.)

(6-11) Corporate Guards: A number of low-level Corporate guards equal to the Players patrolling the area, wearing Light Armorjack and carrying SMGs. Unless you work for their Corporation, they don't think you have any business hanging around where they're operating. Move it, punk. (Use **Security Operatives**; Replace Kevlar® with Light Armorjack and Poor Quality Assault Rifles with Poor Quality SMGs.)

(12-13) Techs: A number of Techs equal to half the Players, with Shotguns, wearing Kevlar® vests. Roll 1d10. 1-2, they're lugging a crate of tools into an AV-4. 3-5, they're working on a City system in your path. 6-10, they're walking toward you on their way to work. (Use **Bodyguards**; Add Tool Hand and a MicroOptics Cybereye.)

(14-17) Private Investigator: A PI armed with a Very Heavy Pistol and a heavy baton and wearing a Medium Armorjack. Roll 1d10. On 1-3, they are ahead of you, hassling an informant on the street corner for the whereabouts of a suspect. 4-7, they're shadowing someone ahead of you. 8-10, they stop you and ask you whether you've seen the person they're following. (Use **Security Officers**; Remove Assault Rifle and Bulletproof Shield.)

(18-20) Corporates: A number of Corporates equal to the Players from a local firm, trying to find a taxi. They are wearing suits woven with Kevlar® and carrying Medium Pistols. Roll 1d10. 1-4,

they're being followed by a number of gangers equal to the players intent on robbery. 5-8, they think you're boosters and open fire at any provocation. 9-10, they think you're trouble and call for Corporate backup (see Corporate Guards, above). (Corporates; use Boosters; Remove Rippers; Replace Leather with Kevlar® and Poor Quality Very Heavy Pistols with Medium Pistols; Add Cyberaudio Suite and Radio Scanner/Music Player. Gangers; use Boosters.)

(21-27) Locals: Two young people from the local neighborhood. (Use **Boosters**; Remove Rippers and Poor Quality Very Heavy Pistols.) Roll 1d10. 1-5, they are being held up by a number of gangers equal to the Players from the Red Chrome Legion gang. 6-10, they are being beaten severely by a number of Inquisitor cultists equal to the Players for the sin of having designer eyes. (**Red Chrome Legion**; use **Boosters**; Replace Leather with Heavy Armorjack. **Inquisitors**; use **Boosters**; Replace Rippers with Medium Melee Weapons; Remove Techhair.)

(28-32) Reclaimers: You run across a well-equipped group of reclaimers equal to the Players minus 2 with 1 chief trying to hot-wire an abandoned building into the local power grid. Roll 1d10. On 1-5, they ignore you. 6-8, the chief and one of the reclaimers come over to "Check those guys

watching us." 9-10, they blow out a local transformer and the entire block goes black. General panic ensues. (**Reclaimers**; Use **Road Gangers**. **Reclaimer Chief**; Use **Reclaimer Chief**)

(33-37) Medias: A 2-person camera and interviewer team, staking out a building on a hot assignment. Roll 1d10. On 1-5, they're spotted by their story-subject and a conflict ensues. You, of course, are right in the middle of it. (Media; use Boosters; Replace Leather with Kevlar® and Poor Quality Very Heavy Pistols with Heavy Pistols; Remove Rippers; Add MicroVideo Cybereye, Cyberaudio Suite, and Amplified Hearing. Story-Subject; Roll again on the Encounter Table.)

(38-41) Private Investigator: A PI armed with a Very Heavy Pistol and a heavy baton and wearing a Medium Armorjack. Roll 1d10. On 1-3, they are ahead of you, beating an informant on the street corner. 4-7, they are breaking into someone's car. 8-10, they stop you and demand answers regarding the whereabouts of their target. (use **Security Officers**; Remove Assault Rifle and Bulletproof Shield)

(42-46) Trauma Team: The AV-4 hits the ground in the middle of a recent fire and the medics start tending to the half-dozen wounded gangers. Roll 1d10. On a 1-5, the Team decides you're



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bystanders and ignores you. On 6-10, they figure you're part of the problem and the 2 security officers open up with Assault Rifles. (See **Trauma Team** on PG. 224 for Trauma Team Statistics.)

(47-57) Scavvers: A number of dirt-poor scavengers equal to the Players rooting through the ruins or garbage near one of the burned-out city blocks. All have filthy leathers and are armed with a variety of makeshift knives and Poor Quality Very Heavy Pistols. Roll 1d10. On a 1-6, they beg you for hard cash or anything you can spare. On 7-8, they ignore you. On 9-10, they try to rob you. At the GM's discretion, the scavvers may have up to a 6 fellow scavs nearby who come to assist if violence ensues. (Use **Boosters**; Replace Rippers with Light Melee Weapon.)

(58-63) Nomads: A group of Nomads equal to Players. Wearing Leather, carrying Crossbows, knives, and Very Heavy Pistols. Moderately drunk and looking for a fight. They hassle anyone they find attractive in your group. Face it: they want a fight. Give them one. (Use **Road Gangers**.)

(64-70) Boostergang: A number of low-level street punks equal to the Players from the Piranhas boostergang. If you look like easy prey and have money, they'll rough you up. They're armed with Very Heavy Pistols and Rippers. (Use **Boosters**.)

(71-76) Street Punks: A number of Smash-heads equal to the Players, looking for cash to feed their habit. If you're not wearing Corporate or gang colors, they try to rush you right on the street. Armed with knives and clubs; no armor. (Use **Boosters**; Replace Rippers with Light Melee Weapons, and remove Very Heavy Pistol and Leather Armor.)

(77-82) Culties: The Reckoners are out in force. A number of them equal to the Players, armed openly with knives, clubs, and Heavy Pistols, corner you to preach that the red sky is a sign of the End Times. If you just blow them off, they try to beat their truth into you. (Use **Boosters**; Replace Rippers with Big Knucks and Poor Quality Very Heavy Pistols with Poor Quality Heavy Pistols; Add a Light Melee Weapon.)

(83-88) Nomad Truck: A number of Nomads from the Steel Vaqueros equal to half the Players

(Minimum 2) are dealing with a broken-down truck. Most of them are facing off with a group of local gangers equal to the Players while the last one tries to fix the motor. If you ignore them, they ignore you, but the Nomads may take an offer to help (Roll 1d10: 1-6, Yes; 7-10, No). (Nomads; use Road Gangers; Replace Leather with Kevlar®. Gangers; Use Boosters.)

(89-94) Boostergang: A number of members of the Iron Sights gang equal to the Players, armed with SMGs, Rippers, Low Light Cybereyes, and Speedware. They hassle anyone in the Crew who stands out, shake you down for money, and generally are spoiling for a fight. (Use **Boosters**; Replace Poor Quality Very Heavy Pistols with Poor Quality SMGs. Add Low Light/Infrared/UV Cybereyes, Neural Link, & Kerenzikov.)

(95-00) Major Criminal: You've walked into a major operation of the ruthless Vilshenko syndicate. A number of Solos equal to the Players minus 2 armed with Very Heavy Pistols and Shotguns and wearing Heavy Armorjack are unloading contraband cargo out of a truck. They're led by a veteran Solo. Roll 1d10. 1-4, they don't notice you. 5-8, they notice you and one warns you off. 9-10, they decide you're witnesses and ought to be totaled right now. (**Solos**; Use **Security Operatives**. **Veteran Solo**; Use **Security Officer**; Replace Poor Quality Assault Rifles and Assault Rifles with Shotguns.)

EVENING ENCOUNTERS IN NIGHT CITY

(1-5) City Police: A number of patrol officers equal to half the Players, armed with Assault Rifles, armored in Medium Armorjack. If you're wearing visible weapons or armor, they'll stop you and demand identity papers. If you're argumentative, they call for backup (3 **Security Operatives**) to take you in. If you reach for a weapon, they'll shoot first, fill out the paperwork later. (Use **Security Officers**.)

(6-11) Corporate Guards: A number of Corporate guards equal to the players patrolling the area. Armored in Heavy Armorjack carrying Heavy SMGs. Unless you're a Corporate, they don't think you have any business running around their

territory. Move it, punk. (Use Security Operatives; Replace Kevlar® with Heavy Armorjack; Replace Poor Quality Assault Rifles with Poor Quality Heavy SMGs.)

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A lot of these entries refer to specific gangs in Night City. You can find out more on **PAGE 308**

(12-13) Corporate Techs: A number of Corporate Techs equal to half the Players with a number of heavily armed bodyguards equal to half the Players. Roll 1d10. 1-2, they are loading crates of parts into an AV-4. 3-5, they are working on a City system in your path. 6-10, they are fixing up a nice-looking car on the side of the road. (**Tech;** Use **Bodyguards;** Add Tool Hand and a MicroOptics Cybereye. **Bodyguards:** Use **Bodyguards;** Replace Kevlar® with Medium Armorjack and Poor Quality Shotgun with Shotguns; Add Targeting Scope Cybereye.)

(14-17) Private Investigator: A PI armed with a Very Heavy Pistol and a machete and wearing a Light Armorjack. Roll 1d10. On 1-3, they're ahead of you, hassling an informant on the street corner for the whereabouts of a suspect. 4-7, they're shadowing someone ahead of you. 8-10, they'll stop you and ask whether you've seen the person they're following. The PI is armed with a heavy caliber revolver and wearing an armor jacket. (Use **Reclaimer Chief;** Remove Tent & Camping Equipment, Shotgun; Replace Heavy Pistol with Very Heavy Pistol and Heavy Melee Weapon with Medium Melee Weapon.)

(18-20) Corporates: A number of Corporates equal to the Players from a large firm, headed for the lev train station. All of them wear suits woven with Kevlar® and carry polymer one-shots. Roll 1d10. 1-4, they're being followed by a number of gangers equal to the Players intent on robbery. 5-8, they think you're boosters and will open fire at any provocation. 9-10, they not only think you're trouble, but will call for Corporate backup (see Corporate Guards, above). (Corporates; use Boosters; Remove Rippers; Replace Leather with Kevlar®; Add Cyberaudio Suite and Radio Scanner/Music Player. Gangers; use Boosters.)

(21-25) Rockerboys: You start to overtake a group of Rockers equal to half the Players minus 1 on the way to a gig, backed by their Solo bodyguards (equal to half the Players) and their Fixer manager. Roll 1d10. On 1-4, they will invite you to join them. 5-8, they will send the Solos to "Deal with those guys following them." 9-10, they ignore you. (**Rockers;** Use **Boosters;** Add AudioVox, & Instruments. **Fixer;** Use **Boosters;** Add Cyberaudio Suite and Internal Agent. **Bodyguards;** use **Bodyguards.**)

(26-30) Medias: A 2-person camera and interviewer team, staking out a building on a hot assignment. Roll 1d10. On 1-5, they will be spotted by their story-subject and a firefight will ensue. You, of course, will be right in the middle of it. (Media; use Boosters; Replace Leather with Kevlar® and Poor Quality Very Heavy Pistols with Heavy Pistols; Remove Rippers; Add MicroVideo Cybereye, Cyberaudio Suite, and Amplified Hearing. Story-Subject; Roll again on the Encounter Table.)



BY ANSELM ZIELONKA

(31-33) Philharmonic Vampires: The Philharmonic Vampires gang are up to some trouble again. Roll 1d10. 1-2, three of them are setting up for some kind of prank involving three or four unusual household items (your choice), but a group of gangers equal to the Players have caught on and conflict ensues. 3-4, three of them have hacked into the local streetlights to flash to the beat of a popular pop song. 5-6, three of them have hacked into the Data Terms to show a warning of an impending missile strike and panic is spreading. 7-8, three of them have released the contents of several huge bags of Eurobucks from the window of a stolen police cruiser. People are scrambling for the cash only to find it's all fake. 9-10, three of them have hacked into the local video boards and are broadcasting fake news. Undoing the Vamp's pranks requires a DV14 Electronic/Security Tech Check. **(Philharmonic Vampires;** Use **Boosters;** Add an Electronic/Security Tech Skill Base of 10. **Gangers;** Use **Bodyguards.**)

(34-40) Locals: One teen from a Beaverville. Probably snuck out to see the city. Roll 1d10. 1-4, they're being held up by a number of gangers equal to the Players from the Piranhas gang. 5-8, they're being beaten severely by a number of Inquisitors equal to the Players for the sin of having fashionware. 9-10: they are being held up by a Fixer they don't have the money to pay. **(Piranhas;** use **Boosters;** Replace Leather with Light Armorjack. **Inquisitors;** use **Boosters;** Replace Rippers with Light Melee Weapons; Remove Techhair. **Fixer;** use **Bodyguard;** Add Cyberaudio Suite, Internal Agent, and Voice Stress Analyzer; Add a Trading Skill Base of 10.)

(41-46) Roaming Netrunner: Two Netrunners armed with Very Heavy Pistols and armored in Light Armorjack. They're lingering around a small Corporate office trying not to get spotted as they break into the building's NET Architecture. Roll 1d10. On 1-5, they're spotted by a group of security guards equal to the Players and a conflict ensues. You, of course, are right in the middle of it. On 6-10, the Netrunners assume you're security and use the building's 2 security turrets to attack you. **(Netrunners;** use **Netrunner;** Replace Bodyweight Suit with Light Armorjack. **Security;** use **Security Operatives. Security Turret;** use Automated Turret on **PG. 214**)

(47-52) Nomads: A group of Nomads equal to the Players from the Roadrunners Pack. Wearing Medium Armorjack, carrying fighting knives, and rifles. Moderately drunk and looking for a fight. They'll hassle any attractive looking people in your group. Face it; they want a fight. Give them one. (Use **Road Gangers;** Replace Crossbows with Assault Rifles and Leather with Medium Armorjack. Swap Archery Skill for Shoulder Arms Skill.)

(53-58) Street Punks: A group of Smash-heads equal to the Players, looking for cash to feed their habit. If you're not wearing Corporate or gang colors, they try to rush you right on the street. Armed with knives and clubs; no armor. (Use **Boosters;** Replace Rippers with Light Melee Weapons, and remove Poor Quality Very Heavy Pistol and Leather Armor.)

(59-63) Trauma Team: The AV-4 hits the ground in the middle of a recent firefight and the medics start tending to the half-dozen wounded gangers. Roll 1d10. On a 1-5, the Team decides you're bystanders and ignores you. On 6-10, they figure you're part of the problem and the 2 security officers open up with Assault Rifles. (See **Trauma Team on PG. 224** for Trauma Team Statistics.)

(64-69) Chromers: A group of hardcore fans of a local Chromatic Rock band decked out with metal spiked leathers and metal arms covered with chrome and cyberweapons. They equal the Players in number. Roll 1d10. 1-5, they're hyped up on Smash and try to pick a fight. 6-7, they pass you by, maybe making a few rude comments. 8-10, they take a liking to one or more members of the Crew and invite you to tag along with them to get smashed and hit the concert. (Use **Boosters;** Add 2 Cyberarms with Superchrome® Covering; Replace Rippers with Wolveres and Leather with Light Armorjack.)

(70-72) Solo Team: A group of Solos equal to half the Players, armored in Light Armorjack, carrying swords and a Heavy Pistol. They're cybered up with boosted reflexes, cybereyes with IR, and cyberlegs. Obviously, a team of assassins looking for someone. Roll 1d10. 1-5, they dodge you and move on; 6-10, they decide you're witnesses and

ought to be totaled right now. (Use **Security Officers**; Add Low-Light/Infrared/UV Cybereyes, and two Cyberlegs with Jump Boosters; Remove Assault Rifle; Replace Very Heavy Pistol with Heavy Pistol.)

(72-77) Boostergang: A group of Iron Sights gangers equal to the Players armed with automatic weapons, cyberweapons, Low-Light/Infrared/UV cybereyes, boosted reflexes. They will hassle any attractive people in the Crew, shake you down for money, and are generally looking for a fight. This group is tougher than the daylight crowd was. (Use **Bodyguard**; Replace Poor Quality Shotgun with Heavy SMGs; Add two cyberweapons of your choice; Add Low Light/Infrared/UV Cybereyes, Neural Link, and Kerenzikov.)

(78-83) Solo Team: A group of Solos equal to half the Players, carrying Smartgun Linked Assault Rifles. Boosted reflexes, boosted hearing, cybereyes with IR and targeting. Obviously up to some grey operation. If you are wearing a rival Corporate uniform or patch, they will: 1-5, dodge you and move on; 6-10, decide you're witnesses and ought to be totaled right now. (Use **Security Officers**; Add Smartgun Link, Interface Plugs, Cyberaudio Suite, Amplified Hearing, Low-Light/Infrared/UV Cybereyes, and a Targeting Scope in one eye.)

(84-90) Boostergang: A group of low-level street punks from the Piranhas equal to the Players plus 2. If you look like easy prey and have money, they'll rough you up. They're armed with Medium Pistols, knives, and boosted reflexes. (Use **Boosters**; Replace Poor Quality Very Heavy Pistols with Poor Quality Medium Pistols; Add Neural Link and Kerenzikov.)

(91-93) Major Criminal: You've walked into a major operation of the notorious Scagattalia Family. A number of cybered-up Solos armed with cyberweapons, Heavy Pistols, and Smartgun Linked Assault Rifles are unloading a drug cargo out of a truck. Roll 1d10. 1-4, they don't notice you. 5-8, they notice you and one warns you off. 9-10, they decide you're witnesses and ought to be totaled right now. (Use a number of **Security Operatives** equal to half the players and 2 **Security Officers**; Replace

Poor Quality Assault Rifles with Smartgun Linked Assault Rifles; Add Wolveres, Neural Link, Interface Plugs, Smartgun Link, and a Targeting Scope Cybereye.)

(94-100) Firefight: Great. You just walked into a major altercation between the Maelstrom and the Red Chrome Legion. Each side has a number of members equal to the Players who are wearing Light Armorjack and firing Very Heavy Pistols. Cyberweapons are everywhere. Each side is led by 1 leader armed with heavier weapons. Pick a side or pick a target. (**Grunts**; use **Boosters**; Replace Leather with Light Armorjack. Keep Rippers or replace with other cyberweapons as desired. **Leaders**; use **Security Officers**; Add a cyber-weapon of your choice.)

MIDNIGHT ENCOUNTERS IN NIGHT CITY

(1-10) City Police: A number of patrol officers equal to half the Players, armed with Smartgun Linked Assault Rifles. If you're wearing visible weapons or armor, they'll stop you and demand identity papers. You've got no business running around after midnight and they know it. They'll stop you and look for any pretext to make a bust. If you're wearing visible weapons, consider yourself detained. If you go for a weapon, they'll shoot first and forget the paperwork. (Use **Security Officers**; Add Interface Plugs and Smartgun Link.)

(11-22) Corporate Guards: A group of Corporate guards equal to the Players patrolling the area, carrying Smartgun Linked Heavy SMGs. "What are you doing on the property after midnight? Can't have a good reason!" (Use **Security Officers**; Replace Assault Rifles with Heavy SMGs, Add Interface Plugs and Smartgun Link.)

(23-24) Private Investigator: A PI armed with a Very Heavy Pistol and a machete and wearing a Light Armorjack. Roll 1d10. On 1-3, they're ahead of you, hassling an informant on the street corner for the whereabouts of a suspect. 4-7, they're shadowing someone ahead of you. 8-10, they'll stop you and ask whether you've seen the person they're following. The PI is armed with a heavy caliber revolver and wearing an armor jacket.

(Use **Reclaimer Chief**; Remove Tent & Camping Equipment, Shotgun; Replace Heavy Pistol with Very Heavy Pistol and Heavy Melee Weapon with Medium Melee Weapon.)

(25) Medias: A 2-person camera and interviewer team, looking for a story. Roll 1d10. On 1-5, they'll be spotted by their story-subject and a firefight will ensue. You, of course, will be right in the middle of it. On a 6-10, they'll decide you're the story and follow you. (Media; use Boosters; Replace Leather with Kevlar® and Poor Quality Very Heavy Pistols with Heavy Pistols; Remove Rippers; Add MicroVideo Cybereye, Cyberaudio Suite, and Amplified Hearing. Story-Subject; Roll again on the Encounter Table.)

(26-29) Chromers: A group of hardcore fans of a local Chromatic Rock band decked out with metal spiked leathers and metal arms covered with chrome and cyberweapons. They outnumber the Players by 2. Roll 1d10. 1-5, they're coming back from a concert, hyped up on Smash, and try to pick a fight. 6-7, they drunkenly pass you by, maybe making a few rude comments. 8-10, they take a liking to one or more members of the Party and invite you to tag along with them to the after party. (Use Boosters; Add 2 Cyberarms with Superchrome® Covering; Replace Rippers with Wolveres and Leather with Light Armorjack.)

(30-39) Edgerunner Team: A small team of Edgerunners. One Netrunner, 1 Solo, and a Nomad. They're on the street in an old Ground Car preparing to break into a small Corporate office. Outside, 6 security guards are on patrol. Roll 1d10. On 1-5, they're spotted by security and a conflict ensues. You, of course, are right in the middle of it. On 6-10, they spot you and offer you a piece of the action. (**Netrunner**; use **Netrunner. Solos**; use **Security Officer. Nomad**; use **Reclaimer Chief. Security**; use **Security Operatives**.)

(40-42) Trauma Team: The AV-4 hits the ground in the middle of a recent firefight and the medics start tending to the half-dozen wounded gangers. Roll 1d10. On a 1-5, the Team decides you're bystanders and ignores you. On 6-10, they figure you're part of the problem and the 2 security officers open up with Assault Rifles. (See **Trauma Team on PG. 224** for Trauma Team Statistics.)

(43-45) Ranger: A Lawman and their deputized partner are in town looking for a local gang of 6 scavengers hiding out in the City. Roll 1d10. 1-5, the gunfight has already broken out by the time you get there, blocking your path. The Lawman calls to the Players to join them. There's a high bounty on the 6 lowlives. 6-10, the Lawman and their deputy are about to go into the gang's hideout and flush them out. They've blocked off the street with the help of the local cops and the Lawman offers the Players part of the bounty to go in and help bring the scavengers out dead or alive. (**Lawman**; use **Outrider. Deputy**; use **Road Ganger. Scavengers**; use **Boosters**.)

(46-58) Nomads: A group of Nomads equal to the Players plus 2 from the Wildman Pack are currently beating a Corporate couple bloody for looking at them wrong. The Nomads are sporting light tattoos, and leather pants, carrying fighting knives, clubs, and rifles. As long as you stay clear of them and their bikes, they'll ignore you and concentrate on beating the Corporates to mush. (**Nomads**: Use **Road Gangers**; Add Light Tattoos, Replace Crossbows with Assault Rifles. Swap Archery Skill for Shoulder Arms Skill. **Corporates**: Use **Boosters**; Remove Rippers)

(59-63) Culties: It's Inquisition time! The Inquisitors are out in maximum force. A group of them equal to the Players, armed openly with nunchaku, handguns, and whips corner you. Two more Inquisitors armed with Air Pistols with Acid Rounds stand back, ready to pepper the more heavily armored Players. "Only a servant of the Metal Demons would be awake at this hour. Any decent citizen would be at home, asleep. Hack, slay, and maim the heretics!" (**Inquisitors**; use **Boosters**; Remove Leathers and Techhair; Replace Rippers with Medium Melee Weapons; Add Air Pistols with 20 Acid Paintballs to two of them.)

(64-73) Street Punks: A group of lace addicts equal to the Players plus 2, looking for cash to feed their habit. Even if you're wearing Corporate or gang colors, they try to rush you right on the street. They're boosted up on Black Lace and armed with knives and clubs; no armor. (Use **Boosters**; Replace Rippers with Light Melee Weapons and

remove Very Heavy Pistol and Leather Armor. They're all under the influence of Black Lace [SEE PAGE 227] and are unaffected by the Seriously Wounded Wound State.)

(74) Major Criminal: You've walked into a major operation of the notorious Scagattalia Family. A group of cybered-up Solos equal to the Players armed with cyberweapons, Heavy Pistols, and Smartgun Linked Assault Rifles are unloading a drug cargo out of a truck. Roll 1d10. 1-4, they don't notice you. 5-8, they notice you and one warns you off. 9-10, they decide you are a witness and ought to be totaled right now. (Use **Security Officers**; Add Wolverers, Interface Plugs, Smartgun Link, and a Targeting Scope Cybereye)

(75-79) Turf War: Great. You just walked into an all-out turf war between the two of the largest gangs in the area. Roll 1d10 for each of the sides. 1-2, it's the Tyger Claws, wearing light armored biker jackets, with Katanas and Very Heavy Pistols. 3-4, it's the 6th Street, armored in Medium Armorjack and carrying Heavy SMGs. 5-6, it's the Piranhas armed with Poor Quality Very Heavy Pistols and ripped leather jackets. 7-8, it's the Iron Sights, armed with various cyberweapons and SMGs. 9-10, it's NCPD Patrol Officers in Medium Armorjack uniforms with Assault Rifles. Each side has a number of members equal to the Players (Minimum 4) who have gear according to their affiliation. Cyberweapons are everywhere. Pick a side or pick a target. (**Tyger Claws**; use **Boosters**; Add Heavy Melee Weapons; Replace Leather with Light Armorjack. **6th Street**; use **Boosters**; Replace Leather with Medium Armorjack. Replace Rippers with Heavy SMGs. **Piranhas**; use **Boosters**. **Iron Sights**; use **Boosters**; Replace Poor Quality Very Heavy Pistols with SMGs; Replace Rippers with Cyberweapons as desired. **NCPD Patrol Officers**; use **Boosters**; Replace Leather with Medium Armorjack; Add Assault Rifles and a Shoulder Arms Skill Base of 10.)

(80-87) Arsonists: A small group of radical anarchists with a grudge against somebody local. One cybered up ganger wielding a Flamethrower, an Axe, and a Heavy Pistol, and leading a group of Boosters equal to the Players minus 3 (Minimum 2)

each armed with 1 Incendiary Grenade, Rippers, and a Poor Quality Very Heavy Handgun. They aren't looking for a fight but they're burning down the block and they'll kill anybody who gets in their way, or happens to be in the way. (**Flamethrower Ganger**; use **Pyro. Gangers**; use **Boosters**; Add 1 Incendiary Grenade)

(88-92) Turf War: Great. You just walked into an all-out turf war between two of the largest gangs in the area. Roll 1d10 for each of the sides. 1-2, it's the Bozos, decked out in polka dot Light Armorjack, with giant mallets and colorful Very Heavy Pistols. 3-4, it's the Maelstrom, armored in Medium Armor Jack and bristling with cyberweapons. 5-6, it's the Primetime Players armed with old school shotguns and leather jackets with fringe. 7-8, it's the Voodoo Boys, armed with Teargas Grenades and SMGs. 9-10, it's the Red Chrome Legion in Medium Armorjack uniforms with Assault Rifles. Each side has a number of members equal to the Players (Minimum 4) who have gear according to their affiliation. Cyberweapons are everywhere. Pick a side or pick a target. (**Bozos**; use **Boosters**; Replace Leather with Light Armorjack; Replace Rippers with Big Knucks; Add Very Heavy Melee Weapons. **Maelstrom**; use **Boosters**; Replace Leather with Medium Armorjack. Replace Rippers with Wolverers. **Primetime Players**; use **Boosters**; Add Shotgun with 20 Slugs and a Shoulder Arms Skill Base of 10. **Voodoo Boys**; use **Boosters**; Replace Poor Quality Very Heavy Pistols with SMGs; Add 1 Teargas Grenade. **Red Chrome Legion**; use **Boosters**; Replace Leather with Medium Armorjack; Add Assault Rifles and a Shoulder Arms Skill Base of 10.)

(93-99) Major Criminal: You've walked into a major operation of the notorious Scagattalia Family. Six cybered-up Solos armed with cyberweapons, Heavy Pistols, and Smartgun Linked Assault Rifles are unloading a drug cargo out of a truck. Roll 1d10. 1-4, they don't notice you. 5-8, they notice you and one warns you off. 9-10, they decide you're witnesses and ought to be totaled right now. (Use 6 **Security Officers**; Add Wolverers, Interface Plugs, Smartgun Link, and a Targeting Scope Cybereye.)

(00) Cyberpsycho Rage: A single cyberpsycho, gleaming with metal and taking their fury out on a pedestrian who pushed them a little too far. The cyberpsycho is cybered up to the teeth with four cyberlimbs, Jump Boosters, multiple Popguns, Wolveres, and more. They don't look like they're going to calm down and it will be a little bit (1d6 + 1 rounds) before Psycho can get on the scene. What's worse, they just noticed you. (Use **Cyberpsycho**.)

SCREAMSHEETS

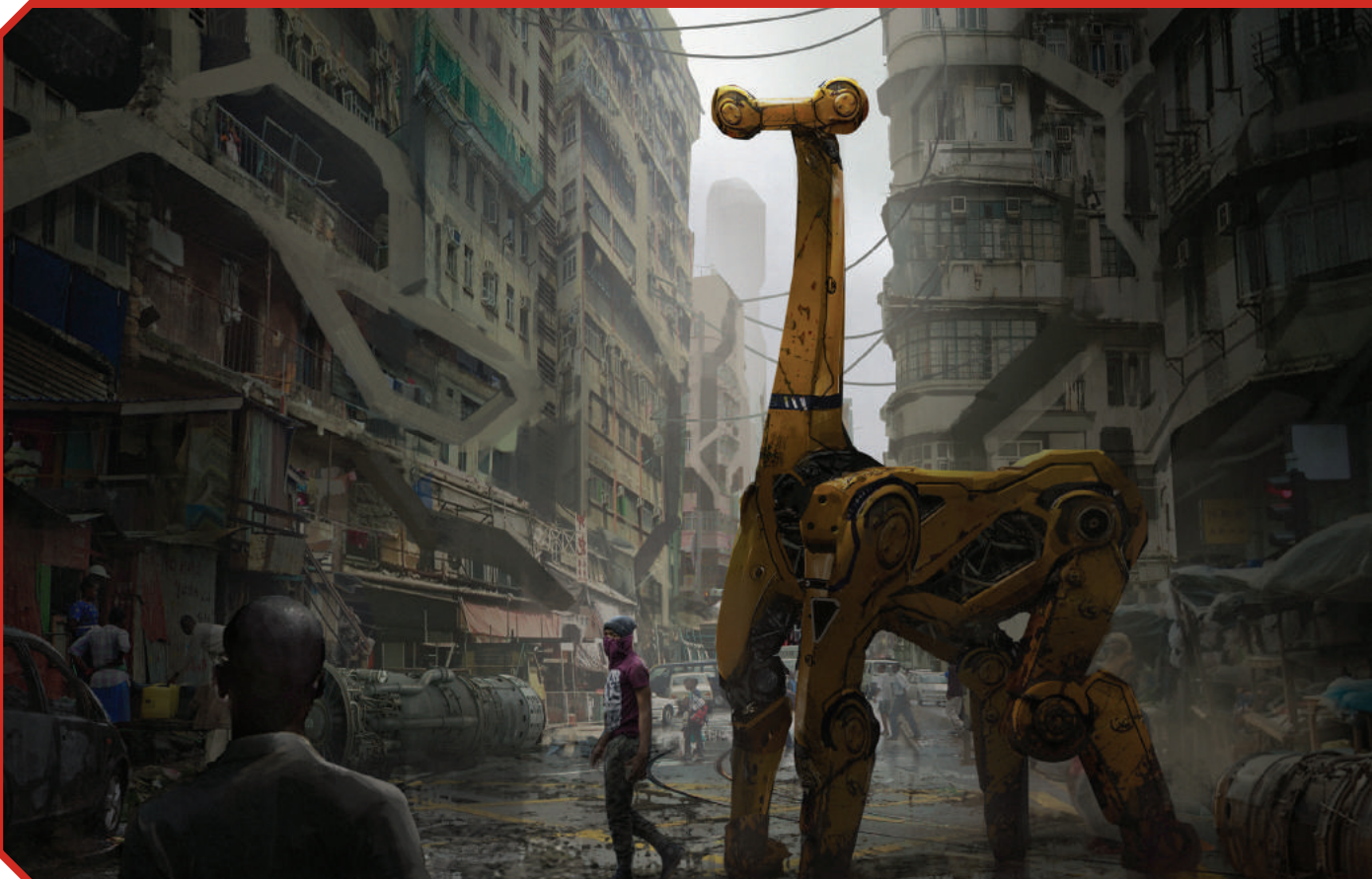
In the world of **Cyberpunk RED**, screamsheets are custom-designed newspapers either printed on flimsy paper or downloaded to an Agent via the local Data Pool.

Screamsheets are also what we call something that pair a page of in-world text (in the form of a Night City Today screamsheet) and a page or two of instructions for running a scenario during a game. These Screamsheets are simple to setup, easy to customize, and, with just a little work on the part of the Gamemaster, easily a full session's worth of adventure.

If you're a Player, we highly recommend you don't advance to the next few pages. Skip to **PAGE 435**, instead, and read *Black Dog*, a story about a group of Edgerunners who get a job that takes them from Night City to... well, we won't spoil the rest.

If you're a GM, read on. Don't be afraid to change things up to move a scenario to a different city, tie one into the Lifepaths of your Edgerunners, add in your own NPCs, throw in some random encounters from the previous section, or just make things more interesting for you and your Players. **Cyberpunk** really is what you make it.

BY EDDIE MENDOZA



NET

NIGHT CITY TODAY NEWS

YOUR NEWS YOUR WAY

3:55 PM

GOSSIP OPINION
LIFESTYLE LOCAL

Biotechnica Researcher Found Alive

By Jackie Miller

Biotechnica is no stranger to the headlines. In the last year, the company's 'Reference Forest' project, which aimed to rebuild the lumber industry and revitalize the local economy, has been the subject of numerous headlines. The project, which involved the use of genetically modified trees, was hailed as a breakthrough in sustainable forestry. However, the project was also the subject of controversy, with some environmental groups claiming that the use of GMOs was unsafe. The project was ultimately abandoned, and the company was forced to shut down. The company's founder, Professor Kigori Akagi, was presumed dead in a tragic plane crash that occurred while he was on his way to work. The crash occurred in the middle of a storm, and the plane was found in a field of tall grass. The company's stock price had plummeted, and the company was facing a crisis of confidence. The company's reputation was in tatters, and the company was facing a crisis of confidence. The company's reputation was in tatters, and the company was facing a crisis of confidence.

[Link: Science Insider: Biotechnica's Fate](#)
[Link: Science Insider: Biotechnica's Fate](#)

Land Grab in Washington

By Jackie Miller

A private group of investors has begun an massive land grab in the Free State of Washington. The group, which is led by a former member of the National Security Agency, has been accused of using insider information to acquire large tracts of land in the state. The group has been accused of using insider information to acquire large tracts of land in the state. The group has been accused of using insider information to acquire large tracts of land in the state. The group has been accused of using insider information to acquire large tracts of land in the state. The group has been accused of using insider information to acquire large tracts of land in the state.

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GOSSIP OPINION
LIFESTYLE LOCAL

Street Theatres Pop up in Suburbs

By Jackie Miller

As the global economy struggles to balance out, imports and exports have suffered. This has made it more difficult for film companies to get their movies made. This was made worse by the crash of the Old NET, but a new trend is popping up around the suburbs of Night City. Street Theatres, which are small, open-air theatres, have been popping up in the suburbs. These theatres are often used to perform plays, musicals, and other theatrical works. They are often used to perform plays, musicals, and other theatrical works. They are often used to perform plays, musicals, and other theatrical works. They are often used to perform plays, musicals, and other theatrical works. They are often used to perform plays, musicals, and other theatrical works.

[Link: Science Insider: Biotechnica's Fate](#)
[Link: Science Insider: Biotechnica's Fate](#)

REO Meatwagon

By Jackie Miller

Our armored ambulances are ready for almost any warzone situation. We'll get you, any lost limbs or organs, and deliver you to the nearest medical facility. Reusable cities. Link: REO Meatwagon: Call Back

Ghost NET

By Jackie Miller

When Netwatch closed down access to the Old NET, many Netrunners refused to let it be. Their infiltration into the Old NET has yielded valuable data and several 'ghost' stories. These are tales of NET phantoms who become trapped in the system when it was closed and those Netrunners that fall victim to R.A.B.D.s. The question then becomes, are these really ghosts or just data memory scans that exist in the NET but aren't sentient. Artificial Intelligence experts like Professor Kigori Akagi suggest that, 'In some sense these 'ghosts' are sentient because they feel the emotions that the Netrunner would have felt. This makes them living beings.' Theologians like Reverend Philip Longfellow argue that, 'The memory

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GOSSIP OPINION WEATHER TECH
LIFESTYLE LOCAL BUSINESS WORLD

New Arms Race: Construction?

By Jackie Miller

As Night City begins to rebuild, there's a new arms race hitting the streets. Construction. The sight of Zimola equipment is ubiquitous throughout the city as would-be architects and design engineers are scooping up high paying contracts to help rebuild. It's not just manpower either. Scientists have been jumping on the bandwagon. Petrochem has been working with companies to make better use of energy consumption from heavy construction machinery, while Militech has been working on a new form of blast-proof material. Even Biotechnica has been participating with their 'Reference Forest' project. Of course, it's not all flowers. This road rush for innovation and materials has led to an increase in construction site sabotage and theft which could jeopardize the progress being made in the Rebuilding Center. Director Ron Chaney, of the Night City Restoration Committee, put it this way, 'Each theft, each delay, keeps us from rebuilding residential blocks and helping get people back to some level of normalcy.'

With so many people displaced by the catastrophe and the amount of homeless occupying the suburbs, disease and famine are a serious concern. Director Chaney is calling for people to work together to rebuild, and points out there will be more than enough work for everyone. Will Night City have a new Golden Age? Only time will tell.

[Link: Night City Restoration Committee](#)
[Link: Night City Restoration Committee](#)

The Big Reopen is Here: HardGrind!

By Jackie Miller

Why worry about commitment or cheating when you can have a discrete and disease-free exotic dining experience. These breadbaskets are so good they feel like the real thing. We even provide a disposable towel for your convenience. So, avoid jealous partners and STDs and head on down to HardGrind Friday night for a little hard grinding!

[Link: Sunlighter Popular Businesses Day Club](#)
[Link: Sunlighter Popular Businesses Day Club](#)

M&F Employees Get Sick

By Jackie Miller

Several employees of Merrill, Auskage & Finch were diagnosed with radiation sickness after handling gold that was transferred to a Night City branch vault. Employees were unaware that the gold was radioactive. The depositor, one Mr. Kinski, could not be reached for comment in several years there has been an increase in radioactive valuable metals showing up across Night City and on the Black Market due to screens raising the Hot Zone. Several banks and financial institutions have begun mandatory testing for all valuable metals prior to allowing them into any branch office because of this made practice. Merrill, Auskage & Finch have offered a 5000 credit reward to anyone who can locate Mr. Kinski for questioning.

[Link: The Treasury Scares in the Hot Zone](#)
[Link: The Treasury Scares in the Hot Zone](#)

Faisal's Customs

By Faisal's Customs

Are you in need of that special gun? Looking for a vehicle that screams you? Well then you are in luck with Faisal's Customs. If you can imagine it, Faisal's team can produce it.

Disclaimer: Faisal's Customs is not legally responsible for death or injury as a result of using his products. Faisal's Customs cannot guarantee that they can indeed produce the product that customers can imagine. Faisal's Customs will not produce weapons of mass destruction. So, no asking for nukes.

[Link: Faisal's Customs, Entrepreneur of Night City](#)
[Link: Underground Fight Clubs Testing Faisal's Tech](#)

Health Warning

By Jackie Miller

A friendly reminder from the Night City Health Department: the Hot Zone is not safe for unprotected occupation or travel. Please make sure when entering the Zone to be properly equipped.

[Link: Hot Zone](#)
[Link: Hot Zone](#)

LITTLE DETECTIVE - BIG GUN

By Jackie Miller

THE BAD GUYS NEVER SEE US COMING.

[Link: Danger Girl](#)
[Link: Danger Girl](#)

WHEN YOU NEED TO KNOW...

- > THE LATEST BODY LOTTO NUMBERS...
- > WHAT STREETS TO AVOID BECAUSE OF UNSCHEDULED DEMOLITIONS...
- > A BLOW BY BLOW OF LAST NIGHT'S COMBAT BALL GAME...
- > AN ACCURATE THREE DAY BLOOD RAIN FORECAST...
- > STORIES ABOUT OTHER PEOPLE'S MISFORTUNES TO CHEER YOU UP...
- > OR EVEN ACTUAL NEWS ABOUT LOCAL AND WORLD EVENTS...

ON YOUR DATA TERM, ON YOUR AGENT,
OR DOWNLOADED DIRECTLY TO YOUR BRAIN



GOSSIP

OPINION

WEATHER

TECH

LIFESTYLE

LOCAL

BUSINESS

WORLD



Biotechnica Researcher Found Alive

by Jackie McGee

Professor Kōgan Akigo, head of Biotechnica's Project Orchard and presumed dead was found alive last week in the northeast woods of the BosWash. His current condition is unknown. Professor Akigo was hailed as an innovator in agricultural genetic engineering after his work with 'super crops.' It was his research that helped launch 'Reference Forests' in an attempt to repopulate diminished forests due to disease, harmful insect life, and pollution. Professor Akigo and his staff were presumed killed in a tragic dam break that wiped out a community only a half mile from the prototype 'Orchard.' The incident set Biotechnica back six months in launching other Orchards. When asked for comment, Biotechnica offered this: "We are grateful to have Professor Akigo back with us. He's currently recovering after his traumatic experience. He is looking forward to getting back in the labs once he is ready."

[Link: Famine Solved? Biotechnica Takes Lead](#)

[Link: Secret Nuclear Waste Facility Destroyed in Dam Break](#)

[Link: Kōgan Akigo](#)

Land Grab in Washington

by Jericho Hunt

A private group of investors has begun a massive land grab in the Free State of Washington. The target acquisitions: woodlands. In the past few months, millions of acres have been purchased. Who is behind the buyouts remains to be seen, but this event isn't without victims. Small communities have suffered due to the closing of woodland access, leaving the lumber industry with no place to harvest. The legal representative for the investors released this statement: "The investors have big plans for this land, and they ask locals to please be patient. Work will be coming, and everyone is going to win". Sadly, those are not comforting words for those who are suffering. It looks like this will be a wait and see.

Reference Forests: Controversy?

by Jackie McGee

Biotechnica is no stranger to cutting edge genetic engineering. Their 'super crops' and 'Orchards' are helping curb the food crisis across America. Organizations like the Food Investor's Corp (FIC) have fully endorsed these endeavors. In the last year Biotechnica has revealed what they call 'Reference Forests' to help restore decimated forests and rebuild the lumber industry. With three of these forests already up and running, Biotechnica has been working to grow their operations. The yield from each Reference Forest is enough to rebuild small communities. However, not everyone is happy about the Reference Forests. Green Fist, an environmental activist group, has demanded that Biotechnica be shut down for harming Mother Nature. In a statement from Green Fist's founder, "Green Hammer," he explains that, "These genetically engineered trees are an abomination to the Earth. They destroy the ecosystems around them and don't allow for natural selection. Not to mention that most of the trees grown are not native to the lands they're grown on. It's just one big cash-grab, man! We need to shut it down." Some scientists agree with the activist group, but most don't. Professor Geri McKennel, lead arborist for Biotechnica had this to say: "What we are doing here is rebuilding whole forests in a matter of a few short years. This is producing clean air and helping restore the natural order. These activists just don't understand. Yes, we have some trees that aren't native, but by growing them we may someday produce trees that will be able to grow in the most inhospitable places. We could even grow trees on Mars." The idea does sound amazing, but only time will tell if these Reference Forests are our friend or our end.

[Link: Reference Forests](#)

[Link: Green Fist](#)

Queen Morosha Does it Again!

From Solo of Fortune Magazine

The Queen has pulled off another amazing win for her organization with the recent recovery of Professor Kōgan Akigo. When asked who hired her services, the Queen had no comment. There's no denying that the Queen of Solos is making a name for herself and her organization with her recent string of high-profile successes.

► Player Information ◀

Biotechnica is looking for a team to stand guard over one of their Reference Forests in northern California. There has been a recent string of thefts from other sites and they believe that the next location to be hit will be Site RF003. The corporation isn't looking to hire people that will do more damage than good. They want people who will be sensitive to the ecosystem in the Reference Forest and leave a minimal footprint. Biotechnica will provide access to forest security drones, 1,000eb per person, and room and board while the team is there. Any team that accepts the job will receive this briefing from Professor Geri McKennel:

"As you are aware, in the last three months two of our Reference Forests have been hit by wood pirates. Whoever they are, they have cut down dozens of valuable trees and removed a few dozen burls. At first, we thought it was Green Fist, but it's looking more like someone out there doesn't want us cutting into their business ... no pun intended. These pirates have hit at night when the forests are unattended. Site RF003 is the next logical location for a hit. Your job is to go into the forest and set up an ambush. Find these pirates and find out who is funding them. As for dead or alive, Biotechnica doesn't want to know what happens after you get the intelligence."

The team is flown in via a VL-11 Corporate Bus (Helicopter) and dropped just outside of RF003 at a Biotechnica ranger station. The forest is dense and the trees tower over the surrounding region. It doesn't even look like RF003 was established in the last decade. A Biotechnica rep is waiting for the team at the station. He will point out the value of the forest, rambling on about Dalbergia which isn't even native to the region and how Biotechnica is able to acclimatize it to the region through genetic splicing. The forest is also densely populated with mahogany and oak. There is an access road that leads into the forest. The rep will give temporary access codes for the security drones (Use **Mini Air Drones** on **PG. 213**) to either a Netrunner or Tech. This will allow the team to control what they see and allow them to maneuver drones as needed. If there isn't a Netrunner or Tech, he will only offer a link for agents that offers a standard video security feed instead. The rep also provides the team with an access key to a firewatch tower located at the heart of RF003. He mentions that there is a decent supply of food inside along with hammocks. If there are any questions the rep will answer with vague responses and just point into the forest, wish everyone good luck and in a not-so friendly way emphasizes avoiding damage to the ecosystem.

It's about an hour hike to the firewatch tower and the site's nothing to brag about. It's constructed from fireproof materials and has a center lift, along with a ladder that goes to the top. In order to access the lift, the team will need to use the

access key. The inside of the watchtower isn't very high tech, but it does offer a 360° view of the forest. There's a solar panel that provides basic power for meteorology computers and communications for the security monitors. There's even a seismograph. The hammocks are not well made and won't support the weight of anyone with more than one cyberlimb. There are two metal folding chairs next to the computer console. The food comes in the form of freeze-dried packets and there isn't even a sink. Water must be carried up from a rain catch basin at the bottom of the tower. As for a toilet, there is an old wooden outhouse that smells like death.

► Gamemaster Notes ◀

The 'pirates' hitting RF003 are actually working for one of the Biotechnica investors out of the Free State of Washington. The idea is to drive Biotechnica to move all their operations out of NorCal and solely invest in the Free State of Washington instead. That would make millions for all the investors.

There are two teams of pirates that will hit RF003. There are a number of pirates with chainsaws equal to half the number of Edgerunners and a number of pirates with SMGS equal to the half the number of Edgerunners. All of the pirates have Kevlar®. (Chainsaw Pirates: Use **Road Gangers**; Add Very Heavy Melee Weapon; Replace Leather with Kevlar®. SMG Pirates: Use **Road Gangers**; Add Heavy SMG and Heavy Pistol Ammo x50; Replace Leather with Kevlar®.)

The first team will strike from the east while the other attacks from the northeast. The seismographs will go nuts because each team is driving large logging trucks. The trucks are unmarked and don't have any forms of identification of ownership inside. With the seismographs going off it will give the Characters enough time to get close to where the trucks are going before the pirates can do too much damage. The drones will show the trucks going deep into RF003. The chainsaws are loud and will cover any approach by the Characters.

The trick here is to nail each team before they do any damage. Unfortunately, at least one tree is going to get cut down. If the Characters don't split up, the damage is going to be worse. The pirates aren't there to fight either, but they also won't let themselves just get taken. They will put up a serious fight to escape. If a pirate is captured and interrogated the prisoner's head will explode right as he starts spilling the beans... Damn undetectable micro bombs.

In the morning, the Biotechnica rep will show up to see how things went. If there was any damage to the forest, he'll throw a fit. Total Pay is reduced by -100 eb per tree lost. He's really not amused by the fact that they still don't know who is hitting the Reference Forests but it's a start. He'll offer the team an extended contract to guard RF003.



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New Arms Race: Construction?

by Ziggy 'Front' Page

As Night City begins to rebuild, there's a new arms race hitting the streets: Construction. The sight of Zhirafa equipment is ubiquitous throughout the city as would-be architects and design engineers are scooping up high paying contracts to help rebuild. It's not just manpower either. Scientists have been jumping on the bandwagon. Petrochem has been working with companies to make better use of energy consumption from heavy construction machinery while Militech has been working on a new form of blast-proof material. Even Biotechnica has been participating with their 'Reference Forest' project. Of course, it's not all flowers. This mad rush for innovation and materials has led to an increase in construction site sabotage and theft which could jeopardize the progress being made in the Rebuilding Center. Director Bon Chaney, of the Night City Restoration Committee, put it this way: "Each theft, each delay, keep us from rebuilding residential blocks and helping get people back to some level of normalcy."

With so many people displaced by the catastrophe and the amount of homeless occupying the suburbs, disease and famine are a serious concern. Director Chaney is calling for people to work together to rebuild, and points out there will be more than enough work for everyone. Will Night City have a new Golden Age? Only time will tell.

[Link: Night City Restoration Committee](#)

[Link: Stolen GRAF3 Rampages Through Little Europe](#)

Health Warning

by Night City Health Department

A friendly reminder from the Night City Health Department: The Hot Zone is not safe for unprotected occupation or travel. Please make sure when entering the Zone to be properly equipped.

[Link: Hot Zone](#)



LITTLE DETECTIVE • BIG GUN

THE BAD GUYS NEVER SEE US COMING.

[Link: Danger Girl](#)

The Big Reopen is Here: HardGrind!

by HardGrind Harry

Why worry about commitment or cheating when you can have a discrete and disease-free exotic dancing experience. These braindances are so real they feel like the real thing. We even provide a disposable towels for your convenience. So avoid jealous partners and STDs and head on down to HardGrind Friday night for spirits and hard grinding!

[Link: Gunfight at Popular Braindance Strip Club](#)

[Link: Sex Braindance, Safer Than the Real Thing?](#)

MA&F Employees Get Sick

by IGG

Several employees of Merrill, Asukaga & Finch were diagnosed with radiation sickness after handling gold that was transferred to a Night City branch vault. Employees were unaware that the gold was radioactive. The depositor, one Mr. Krash, could not be reached for comment. In recent years there has been an increase in radioactive precious metals showing up across Night City and on the Black Market due to scavvers raiding the Hot Zone. Several banks and financial institutions have begun mandatory testing for all valuable metals prior to allowing them into any branch office. Merrill, Asukaga & Finch have offered a 500eb reward to anyone who can locate Mr. Krash for questioning.

[Link: The Treasure Trove in the Hot Zone](#)

Faisal's Customs

by Faisal's Customs

Are you in need of that special gun? Looking for a vehicle that screams you? Well then you are in luck with Faisal's Customs. If you can imagine it, Faisal's team can produce it.

Disclaimer: Faisal's Customs is not legally responsible for death or injury as a result of using his products. Faisal's Customs cannot guarantee that they can indeed produce the product that customers can imagine. Faisal's Customs will not produce weapons of mass destruction. So, no asking for nukes.

[Link: Faisal Farah, Entrepreneur of Night City](#)

[Link: Underground Fight Clubs Testing Faisal Tech](#)

► Player Information ◀

Taking to the streets usually offers some adventure, but today is special. The crew hits the asphalt looking for some action. As they hit their first local spot, they come across a Postal Service truck delivering a package to a shop on the corner. The truck is pretty tricked out with an Armored Chassis, Bulletproof Glass, and an Onboard Machine gun manned by a scrawny kid wearing a Flak vest and helmet that look about three sizes too big for him. The postal lady driving the truck is decked out in all black leathers and Kevlar®. Her Techhair is styled in a way that makes it look like she has cat ears. When she sees the crew, she'll wave and say "Hello," in her usually squeaky voice.

When it comes to knowing what is going on across the city, the mail lady sees a lot. If asked if there's anything fun happening, she tells the crew about some work being done two blocks down close to a gangland border. She also points out that she doesn't know why anyone would want to do work on the sidewalk there since the block usually gets shot up daily. After, she winks and struts back to the postal truck and speeds off, laying a rather large black strip.

Sounds like it might be fun to check out what's going on. It's sure better than sitting around being bored. As the crew gets to about four blocks away, they can hear the sound of gunfire. It looks like there's a party after all. At the one block mark the crew can see a large glass box sitting in the middle of the sidewalk. Inside there's a pile of neatly stacked currency, a pistol, a rifle, and a teddy bear.

Every few seconds someone runs up and tries to smash it, all while bullets ricochet all around them. The street and walkways are crowded with people, guns drawn, shooting at each other. Some of the people blazing away look like they might be gang connected, but there are about a dozen more that are just randomly shooting at the box or each other.

An older man dressed in casual attire approaches the crew and tells them that he could crack into that glass case easily, but there are too many trigger-happy choombas by it. He offers to split the swag if the crew clears out the crowd.

► Gamemaster Notes ◀

Militech is getting ready to launch their new Maximum Security Safe and wanted to do a little marketing. They hired street marketing guru Willy Maze to work his magic promoting it. The claim to fame for this safe is that it's indestructible (100 HP). When it comes to guerrilla marketing, Willy is the man. Without permission from the city, Willy took the Maximum Security Safe to a part of Night City known for gang activity and secured it to the sidewalk with massive iron bolts. Public works is going to be pissed, even though

they refuse to go to that block because of the gangs. While his street crew installed the safe, his Tech crew set up cameras all around to film the chaos. The safe was left concealed until about mid-morning when one of his team ran by and removed the covering.

The safe is made from a transparent material, so the 5,000eb, along with a Militech Avenger (Excellent Quality Medium Pistol), a Militech Bulldog (Excellent Quality Shotgun), and a teddy bear holding an envelope are in full public view. Inside the envelope there is a private invite to a Militech job fair. There is a large decal on the safe that reads 'Maximum Security Safe.'

In addition to mounted street cameras, there are drones flying around recording the entire show (Use Mini Air Drones). Any time a shot misses a Character roll 1d10. On a 7-10 the shot hits a camera drone instead.

The two gangs involved are low level boostergangs. The first is a minor local gang called the Albino Alligators (5 total; Use **Boosters** stats). They're all wearing T-Shirts with a cartoon-like white alligator carrying an Assault Rifle. Some have the logo tattooed on their upper arms. The second gang is the Piranhas (5 total; Use **Booster** stats). The remaining people on the street are a variety of locals (10 + 1d6). The GM can arm these bystanders as they desire.

No one will attack the Characters unless they try to approach the safe or if they start shooting at people trying to get to the safe. If the Albino Alligators lose more than two members, they retreat. If the Piranhas lose three members, they retreat. Both gangs take their dead and wounded with them. The crowd will disperse after half of them are either incapacitated or wounded.

Once the area is secured, an old man will emerge with a large cylinder on his back and a hose that runs down to a nozzle. He will turn the release on the nozzle and a whitish aerosol sprays onto one edge of the safe. It will take about two minutes to do one side. 1d6 streetrats (Use **Booster** stats) will make one more attempt to take the safe from the Characters.

These attackers are easily scared and if one of them dies the rest will flee. When the old man finishes, he asks if he can borrow someone's piece. He'll take the gun and tap the side of the safe. While the glass-like material doesn't break, the sealant used to hold it together gives way and all the glory falls to the ground.

If more than half of the Characters are in the Seriously Wounded Wound State the old man then turns the gun on the them. Just goes to show you can't even trust an old choomba. If not, he takes his share and leaves.



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Street Theaters Pop up in Suburbs

by Ziggy 'Front' Page

As the global economy struggles to balance out, imports and exports have suffered. This has made it more difficult for film companies to get their movies made. This was made worse by the crash of the Old NET. But a new trend is popping up around the suburbs of Night City: Street Theaters. Entertainers affiliated with Julliard Performers Guild have begun doing shows on street corners and it's gaining in popularity. There's no cost to attend the shows, but the performers do take donations. In some cases, these thespians are bringing in almost 500eb a night. The more elaborate the production the more people come to watch. This has drawn in Techs looking to make a little eb on the side. Eric Wells, thespian, explained it this way: "People are tired of spending hard earned creds on crappy reruns. They want real emotion and stories. The street theatre phenom is delivering just that." The downside to these street theaters is a slight increase in pick pocket thefts, but it's not enough to deter people from attending.

[Link: Julliard Performers Guild](#)

[Link: Foreign Cinema in Decline](#)

REO Meatwagon

by REO Meatwagon Rocks!

Our armored ambulances are ready for almost any warzone situation. We'll get you, any lost limbs or organs, and deliver you to the nearest medical facility. Reasonable rates.

[Link: REO Meatwagon Call Button](#)

Ghost NET

by Miller Marcus

When Netwatch closed down access to the Old NET, many Netrunners refused to let it be. Their infiltration into the Old NET has yielded valuable data and several 'ghost' stories. There are tales of NET phantoms who became trapped in the system when it was closed and Netrunners who fell victim to R.A.B.I.D.s. The question then becomes, are these really ghosts or just data memory scans that exist in the NET but aren't sentient? Artificial Intelligence experts like Professor Killgrave Shaw suggests that, "In some sense these 'ghosts' are sentient because they feel the emotions that the Netrunner would have felt. This makes them living beings." Theologians like Reverend Phillip Longfellow argue that, "The memory

ghost has no soul; therefore it is not alive. Are we to say that AIs are now soulful entities like humans? Doubtful. A program is just that, a program. It does what it was programmed to do, nothing more." While it may sound cold, the Reverend has a valid point. Of course, it also means that instead of losing loved ones in the future we could just download their memories and keep an AI version of them on our Agents. As for the 'ghosts' inside the Old NET, could they be retrieved or purged from the system? It's a possibility, but one Netwatch refuses to comment on. With Data Pool access becoming more common around Night City, it's possible that the Old NET could very well be dumped in lieu of a more local network system with global access linkage.

[Link: Specters of the NET](#)

[Link: Netwatch Frustrated Over R.A.B.I.D.s. in Old NET](#)

Gang War Ends Early

by Jackie McGee

Ongoing tensions in the suburbs began to boil over this week leading to a gang war between The Primetime Players and the Piranhas. The shooting had only lasted one minute when guns on both sides proved to have one fatal flaw: they were 3D printed using very unreliable materials. Both gangs suffered massive casualties caused by these extremely cheaply printed guns exploding in user's hads.. Within 24 hours of the incident, a teen going by the name Zip Print was found hanging from a lamp post with a bullet hole in his head and "cheap" carved in his chest. Underneath him was a pile of broken guns that he had sold to both gangs. While the murder of the teen is tragic, both gangs have declared a cease fire until they could buy more reliable guns.

[Link: 3D Printed Warriors](#)

Bring on the sunshine,

Bring on the smiles,

Hello Cutie is here!

Wash away that

cyber-psycho frown,

Grab your best gat in town,

Hello Cutie is here!



Good for
5eb off
your next
Hello Cutie
Purchase

[Link: Sanroo HelloCutie](#)

► Player Information ◀

When it comes to cult classic weapons, no one designs them like JayeZK. Her spin-offs of Sanroo's Hello Cutie line are everywhere. From the ShotFrog (Shotgun) to the Koi Kicker (Heavy Pistol), her creative endeavors have made a name for themselves. Anime fans can't get enough. With fame also comes things like big lucrative contracts and unwanted attention from unscrupulous con artists. JayeZK has reached out to the crew because over the last week she's been getting harassed by a rival 3D artist who goes by the name Gangster 3D. The guy has tried to break into her Agent, blackmail her with less than flattering pictures and vids, and generally shows up to every one of her outings looking for a fight. JayeZK has had enough. She asked the Characters to act as her protection next week during a street art show where she's presenting her new ideas to a rep from Sanroo. She offers a part of any commission that is offered by the company.

► Gamemaster Notes ◀

Gangster 3D (Use **Netrunner**) is a fake name, which becomes clear once Characters start digging for more information on the guy. If followed, he will lead the crew to the offices of DizCom, a fledgling design firm that specializes in peddling 3D print files. The DizCom office is located in a much larger building on the 20th floor. There's an elevator designated for the public to access the offices. There are a number of security officers at the front desk equal to half the Players (Use **Security Operative**; Add Cyberaudio Suite and Radio Communicators) and a number equal to the Players patrolling the building. They're all linked by an internal communications system. There is a private elevator and two sets of stairs, one on the north face and one on the east side, both with street access. The Ground Floor has a NET Architecture with an access point in the front desk and on the north face by the door. The exterior stair doors have cardkey locks which can be bypassed (Electronic/Security Tech DV10). The private elevator has a built-in defense system (**Sleep Gas Elevator**. See **PG. 216**). If the crew can access the private elevator, they find that it only has two buttons: Penthouse and Ground. Whoever this belongs to must have some serious creds.

The 20th floor stair access has the same security system as the exterior stairs and there is another NET Architecture which can be accessed from the 20th floor landing. This NET Architecture has 2 **Imps** present in it which won't attack the Characters unless they enter the lower right branch (the one with the Control Nodes) of the Architecture. If there are only 2 Characters, there is only 1 Imp. If the crew fails to bypass the door's security on the first try an alarm goes off (Electronic/Security Tech DV 12 to shut down). Alarms will summon the patrolling security guards who will promptly

throw out the Characters unless they decide to shoot it out. If that happens, NCPD will show up in 2d6 turns (1d6 officers at first, Use **Security Operative** stats).

When the Characters eventually get to the 20th floor, be it by regular elevator or back stairs, they come out onto a level that has nice white vinyl flooring and several holo-posters on the walls showing off various properties of DizCom (Buster Swine, Electric Bunny, Hyper-Active Hyena, Captain Piranha). As the Characters walk by the frames the figures will stop dancing and singing as they gaze at the visitors with scowling faces. They have completely gone from happy and joyful to downright terrifying. The long hallway leads to an office door with the DizCom logo all in bright blue colors. It's an automatic door, which opens when anyone gets within 2 meters. As the door glides open it will let out a series of giggles that sound like children. Inside there is a single desk and behind it a door. A woman is sitting there with an over-exaggerated smile (she flickers slightly). She welcomes the Characters and asks if they have an appointment. If anyone says no, she will ask if they'd like to make one. If the Characters lie, she looks confused for a moment and then suggests that the Characters are jokers. She then asks them to leave. If they refuse, skip ahead to the Cartoon Battle.

Trying to set up an appointment is a hassle. The woman tells the Characters that there is a three-week waiting list. She doesn't budge.

If at any point things become hostile, a **Cartoon Battle** occurs:

The outer doors to the office open. In the hallway the cartoon characters are literally coming out of the frames. Their eyes are glowing bright red. The secretary's eyes are also glowing an angry red. The cartoon characters will start growling before opening fire on the Characters.

The cartoon characters are actually holograms that surround drones (Use **Large Air Drones** with Very Heavy Pistols and Observation Cameras, see **PG. 213**). Anyone firing at the cartoon characters will notice that the bullets are going right through the bodies and hitting the wall further down. The drones hover inside the heads of the cartoons. After discovering this, the Crew can fire on the drones without having to aim for the head. There is 1 cartoon character and 1 Drone Control Node for every Player Character (Maximum 4). They are controlled by 2 Imps (see **PG. 212**) in the top floor's NET Architecture who each trigger two on their turn.

After the drones are defeated the PCs can grill the secretary, who is a pseudo AI and won't say anything. She can't stop anyone from entering the management office. The door has an electronic lock (Electronic/Security Tech DV 12). When the office door opens it reveals a bizarre scene: A man's upper

torso is plugged into a massive rig of tubes and wires. He has nothing below the ribcage. There are two drones hovering next to him with little robotic arms. The man, a Netrunner named Winston Frumighter, doesn't want trouble and will confess to being behind the harassment of JayeZK. He reveals that he was trying to scare off the Sanroo rep and get the 3D artist for DizCom. Gangster 3D is just a paid face. Mr. Frumighter promises to leave JayeZK alone if the Players let him live. If the Players attack Mr. Frumighter, he will fight back (Use Netrunner; Reduce MOVE Statistic to 0). The two drones in his office have no weapons and do not attack.

Later that day, JayeZK meets with the Sanroo reps, who decide not to use her.

► GROUND FLOOR NET ARCHITECTURE

Floor	On the Other Side of the "Door"	DV
1	Password	6
2	This Control Node controls the cardkey locks on the exterior doors.	6
3	This File contains the schedule of appointments for a Mr. Frumighter. There are a number of appointments with random people (a DV13 Local Expert Check reveals that they are all minor local artists). Additionally, Mr. Frumighter has had five appointments in the past two weeks with Gangster 3D.	6
4	Wisp	N/A
5	This Control Node controls the private elevator and can be used to operate it.	6
6	This Control Node can deactivate the Sleep Gas Elevator.	8

► 20TH FLOOR NET ARCHITECTURE

Floor	On the Other Side of the "Door"	DV
1	Password	8
2	Skunk, Killer	N/A
3	Hellhound	N/A
4	This Control Node controls the cardkey lock on the top floor as well as the building's alarm system.	8
5	Password. This floor splits into two branches	8

Floor	On the Other Side of the "Door"	DV
1	Asp	N/A
2	This file contains a comprehensive list of 3D artists and companies across Night City. There are notes about who has been contacted by DizCom and who needs to be "convinced" to join.	8

Note: There are 1 to 2 Imps, controlling the drones, located in the right branch. See the Gamemaster Notes for more details.

Floor	On the Other Side of the "Door"	DV
1	This Control Node controls the electronic locks on Mr. Frumighter's office	8
2	This Control Node controls 1 of the Cartoon Drones (Buster Swine)	8
3	This Control Node controls 1 of the Cartoon Drones (Electric Bunny).	8
4	This Control Node controls 1 of the Cartoon Drones (Hyper-Active Hyena).	8
5	This Control Node controls 1 of the Cartoon Drones (Captain Piranha).	8



SANROO

HelloCutie



Bring on the sunshine, bring on the smiles,

HelloCutie is here!

Wash away that cyber-psycho frown,
grab your best gat in town!

The cutest pistol
on the market!

So adorable
they'll bleed pink!



SANROO

BY HÉLIO FRAZÃO



BLACK DOG

2045 (PRESENT DAY)

It starts with mysteries. A scrap of a song.
A story your dad told you. A search for a piece of the puzzle.
A tale of star-crossed lovers. A forbidden treasure.
And a legacy to live up to.

LILAYAH AND TRACE

*a blind man lost, in the streets
a pattern here, I need to see
keep returning keep trying to leave
got a bad feeling that I need to feel
black dog runs at my side
down a road, no end in sight
the city sleeps but in my mind
got a knot that won't unwind...*

"Unbind?"

"Untie?"

"Frack." Lilayah wrinkles her nose as she tries to work out the next part of the verse. Sure, she can fill in the line with her own ideas, but that won't be his. It won't be what he would have said. And that's important. This might have been the last song ever. She needs to get it *right*. She owes him.

*a blind man lost, in the streets
a pattern here, I need to see...*

Trace looks up from his Agent and the half dozen screens he's got linked to it. "Ya know, that's about the two hundredth time you've sung that." He slides back in his chair and stares pensively out the sweeping glass window of the Conapt. "And you keep changing the tune. Fucking annoying, you know." He gives the Rocker a mildly pissed off look before he relents.

"I know, yah. But I don't know the tune. I don't have enough to work from. One crappy pirate datalink from a crappy bunch of old recordings from a studio session that happened how many years ago?" She looks up from her synth and glares at the Media, who shrugs.

"Your problem is obvious," he observes.

"Yah? You think?"

"You need more brains on the problem. Put it out on the Data Pool. See if anyone bites back. Maybe there was somebody at the studio session that night—someone who's still alive and didn't dump the memory."

Trace flips the screen view from the story he's been working on. He's not making much headway, anyway. Like Lilayah, he's only got fragments of the whole story,

and the guy who told it to him—the Old Man—doesn't know the whole thing either. He taps the datacodes to open his personal Pool link to broadcast, holds his Agent up to face Lilayah. "Repeat it. Again. As much as I'm fucking sick of hearing it, repeat it." And Lilayah does.

It's hard to say who's more surprised when, twenty minutes later, there's a return ping on Trace's message link.

The voice is a smooth contralto, with a slight metallic undertone. Female. Or vodered to sound that way.

"I saw your post. I think I can help you out."

KEPLER AND PNEUMO

In another part of Night City, Kepler is loading the upper mini-gun. It's been jamming too much, and she doesn't want it to crank up when she's on the Road away from a source of spares. She wipes her face with the back of her hand—the augmented one—and leaves a trail of cosmoline across her nose. She hears Pneumo chuckle from the corner of the Kombi where he sits when he's running the Data Pool. He's working on his pet project—a code frag he's been tracing for almost half a decade.

"Wha?"

"Trace is posting some song Lilayah's working on. I think it's that thing she's been hammering on." His voice is rough: he doesn't use it much when he's in the Face. Kepler throws a rag at him, then turns back to the mini-gun. "I don't know why the frack those two haven't hooked up yet," she says absently. The Netrunner flips up his goggles and begins to work through a stack of data-chips. He's looking for something good he can turn into fast euro to fund their next trip on the Road. "Not everyone who works together has to hook up and get married, Kep," he replies, voice still thick with London drawl. "You and me are kind of unusual around these parts."

"Yeah, but..." Kepler pauses in mid conversation. She's spotted something. Multiple silhouettes moving through the trash piles towards the Kombi. "Sorry. Busy. Nu." she grunts as she hoists herself into the saddle of the mini-gun. *Good thing I just reloaded,*

she thinks as she triggers the IR in her left eye and links to the gun's processor. Her amped vision IDs the shapes as a group of boosters trying to flank the Kombi's position. Looks like the Iron Sights boys are back. She flips the safety off, swivels the gun, and cuts loose. The roar of the heavy mini-gun shakes the whole Kombi, knocking books off shelves and dishes across the kitchenette. Iron Sights gangers scatter, fall. Some drag their wounded out of her field of fire. She cuts the mini-gun—no sense in wasting ammo. Those guys aren't going to be coming back for a while.

"Hey, Kep." says Pneumo, unplugging his ears with his extended cyberdigits. "Trace just pinged me. Something interesting."

Kepler grins. She was starting to get bored.

DAMIEN AND ZARA

Damien's just finished replacing the pistons in the forearm when the ping comes. *Fracking Russian cyberware*, he thinks, turning and letting his drone crawl down his arm toward the Agent propped up on the workbench. The drone's mag clamp picks up the Agent and brings it back to him; he talks out of the side of his mouth as he struggles with the recalcitrant Russian arm. "Go ahead," he says. He doesn't actually *need* to talk to the Agent—he's wired for full radio/audio—but customers appreciate the personal touch of seeing your face. He listens to Trace for a few minutes, then puts down the cyberarm and shuffles out to the workshop door. "Yo, Zara!"

The Solo looks up from the target she's just been punching holes in. Not too many people practice archery these days, but she's always thought it was a useful skill: silent, well-ranged, and you almost always

got your ammo back. "What?" she replies, slotting her optics back from targeting mode. "We in trouble or something?"

Damien stands in the door of the ramshackle metal container/office. "Nah." he says with a grin. "Just Trace and Lilayah. They want us to cover their high-priced butts while they check out one of Trace's story leads."

Zara pushes in the retainers and the bow folds down into an easy to carry package. The arrows are also collapsible and she keeps them in a holster across her back. The bow isn't her only weapon: as a professional, she's also a crack shot with the Kang Tao she keeps in her shoulder holster. She shrugs. Trace is a reliable source of income, and he's a lot smarter than most of the clowns she gets as her principals. She's good with anything he comes up with. "Let's roll," she says, picking up her go-bag and heading for her bike.

SAMANTHA

"So, like I said, I think I can help you," she says. "She" is named Samantha, and she's seven feet tall. Chromed from head to toe, she looks like a metal Amazon, down to the shaped metal muscles. Incongruously, she's wearing a tank top and warm leggings on a body that never feels pain or temperature unless she wants to. *Full Body Conversion*, thinks Damien. He's staring at her like a dog looking over a steak; not out of lust, but with the desire to get in there and dismantle her to see how she ticks. Her cool blue cyberoptics look him over, then through him, focusing on Lilayah. "You're the Rockerboy?" Samantha asks in that smooth contralto.

Lilayah nods and Samantha gestures to a couple of overstuffed leather sofas around a central coffee table. "Grab a seat," she offers. They do.

MEET THE CREW

The main Characters in *Black Dog* (Lilayah, Trace, Kepler, Pneumo, Damien, and Zara) were created with the help of six remarkable, real-life Cyberpunks we like to think of as "The Cyber6".

Five of the Cyber6 rock real world prosthetic limbs and that's something we thought a lot about as we wrote **Cyberpunk RED**.

Cyberpunk is closer than you think. Often, that idea's something to cause concern but when it comes to what has been accomplished in the world of prosthetic devices, that idea is one of joy and it was something we wanted to honor in this edition.

The Cyber6 aren't inspirational because they've got prosthetic limbs and live full lives. They're inspirational because they, each and every one of them, are a bright, shining example of how to make the world a better place. That'd be true no matter what.

We'll be introducing the Cyber6, and the Characters they created, in the sidebars in this story.

Trace's trained eyes scan the room. It's like a garage—no, it is a garage, except with a few pieces of overly comfy furniture set up in strategic spots; there's even a huge feather bed off to one side. But three things stand out in particular: One is a full-sized sports car parked in one of the vehicle bays—immaculately preserved for a vehicle two decades old. The second is a large framed holo of a Rockerboy—the legendary Johnny Silverhand, in an alcove surrounded by digital candles and assorted concert memorabilia.



BY ADRIAN MARC

The last thing is a large wooden crate. It's about eight feet long, four feet wide. It's bound with metal straps and has several sophisticated lock and defense devices bolted to it.

Samantha sits down gracefully. *Everything* she does appears to be graceful. As they join her, she reaches into her silvery cleavage; there's a soft pop and a small panel opens between her breasts. She extracts a slim plastic wafer: a datachip. She holds it up in front of Lilayah.

"What you have is just a fragment," Samantha explains. "Someone was there that night after the club was closed; they grabbed a sample before the bouncers threw them out. But what I have," and here she gestures with the slim blue chip, "is the complete song, recorded in his own voice. Johnny Silverhand." There's something in her voice; something that penetrates even through the perfectly vodered tones: a sense of awe. Both Trace and Kepler's eyes meet as they catch it. *She's a Silverhand fangirl*, they think at the same instant. *She's been saving this chip like a memento all these years.*

Samantha continues. "But before I give you this, I should tell you a couple things: The chip was recorded by Johnny just before his disappearance in 2023. But it's been damaged by—well, it's been damaged by an EMP blast."

Damien scans the chip with his eyes cranked to maximum magnification. After a few seconds, he says, "Radiation, right?"

Samantha looks surprised. "How did you know?"

The Tech shrugs. "After the Nuke, there were tons of blasted chips and other electronics around town. I'm a Tech, right? I get people all the time bringing EMP damaged chips to me. I've gotten to know the signs."

Samantha sits back thoughtfully. "Well, okay then. The whole song is there—I think. But part of it is garbled; like an encryption. I'm no Tech, I couldn't recover that part; I just made a copy of the original. This is one of those copies." Her eyes close as though she's remembering something painful. "You can have it though," she finally says.

Trace watches Samantha's face as she hands Lilayah the chip. Finally, he says, "So what do you want in exchange?" Samantha looks surprised, then

resigned as the Media says, "This is Night City, choomba. In this City, *nobody* gives anyone *anything* without a price. So, name it."

The silver woman slowly nods. "Okay, just one thing. But it's kind of a big thing." She gestures to the large wooden crate nearby and says, "I need you to deliver that to another place. A city. In New Mexico. To a place called Los Alamos Labs."

CITY BATTLE

They're dragging the Crate towards the Kombi. Samantha is with them, but toward the back. The gang drops in all around them. They drop the Crate and a firefight ensues. In the staccato din of autofire weapons and the boom of the heavier guns, Kepler runs towards the Kombi, with Zara and Pneumo covering her back. Pneumo tosses a dazzler bomb at their pursuers. Reaching the driver's side, Kepler opens the cargo hatch in the Kombi's back.

Meanwhile, Samantha has manhandled the Crate up onto her shoulders. She staggers towards the Kombi just as the cargo hatch drops, slamming onto the street. She tells Zara to dump her bike out the back—she'll take care of it.

Pneumo pushes the bike out onto the street and Samantha almost throws the Crate into the cargo bay before staggering back. "It's in!! Now get out of here!" she yells at the full deafening volume of her voder.

Damien yells to Samantha: "You fireproof?"

"Be a pretty stupid firefighter if I wasn't!" she retorts, her over-stressed ventilation system wheezing.

"Groovy," he yells, then opens up with a long tank/hose unit he's pulled out of

the back of the Kombi. A huge gout of fire streams out into the middle of the gangers. Napalm.

Kepler guns the Kombi, blasts right through the fire and over the debris toward the road, pausing only to let Trace and Lilayah clamber aboard through the open doors. They hurtle through the wreckage of the glowing Hot Zone, pursued by several road warrior vehicles packed with gangers. By now, everyone is shooting back at their pursuers. As they pass access points, Pneumo takes control of various cranes and other building machines, including a pair of huge GRAF3 construction mecha, which he uses to knock over one of the scaffolds surrounding a half-constructed building. The scaffold crushes one of the pursuing punknauts, but the rest keep chasing.

Suddenly Kepler slams a hard right and tears down between a row of stacked cargo containers. Gangers still glued to her trail, she slams through a security fence and into a large open area framed by hundreds of containers. From all angles, leather clad Nomads rush out with weapons. They recognize the Kombi as one of theirs, and turn their fire on the gangers, who run from the fusillade of Nomad fire. Kepler slams on the brakes, kills the motor. She slumps back in the seat as a large Nomad with an immense handlebar mustache and a rakish Stetson cruises up to the driver's window. He's carrying a smoking M249 SAW. He smiles and says in a friendly drawl, "Little Lady, if you're planning to join up with the rest of this Convoy, you're cutting it a mite fine I'd say."

NOMAD HIGH ROAD

"Good thing the Kombi was big enough," comments Pneumo with four of them now crammed into the passenger compartment. The Kombi is twenty-nine feet

KEPLER

created w/ the help of
Ashley Sherman



Kepler's family, a Florida Nomad Pack, was always scrambling to make ends meet. She was born missing the lower half of her right arm but due to her family's lack of money she wasn't able to get fitted with cyber until she ran off on her own to earn the ebs. These days she usually teams up with her husband, Pneumo.

Ashley Sherman was born in Chuluota FL, just outside of Orlando. Like Kepler, she was born missing the lower half of her right arm just below the elbow. Growing up, she lived on a farm riding and training horses, dancing, and scuba diving. Her first prosthetic arm was a gold i-Limb Quantum bionic arm by Össur. Today she lives in London pursuing her career in modeling and acting with her husband, James Young, and their child.

PNEUMO

created w/ the help of
James Young



Pneumo learned justice from his parents: honest cops in a corrupt system. He started Netrunning early to fight the powers that be and that eventually led to a chase and an accident that almost killed him. His family smuggled him out of the country, where he was rebuilt and met his wife and partner, Kepler.

A presenter on the BBC, double-amputee James Young is a passionate science communicator who earned the nickname "Metal Gear Man" after working with Japanese video game company Konami to design his own unique bionic arm. James' work, including "Can Robots Love Us?" can be seen on the BBC Three YouTube channel. He lives in London with his wife, Ashley Sherman, and their child.

long, shaped like a heavily armored, smooth sided box. It can sleep eight, ten in a pinch. It's a standard design used by Nomad families all over the Southwest: bathroom, kitchen, and storage spaces are crammed throughout its capacious roadframe. The Kombi is her home—the last thing Kepler ever got from her family in Florida.

It's blinding midday, heat shimmers rising off the line of endless asphalt headed East. Around them are dozens of vehicles: low slung cyberbikes, armed and armored ground cars of all makes and models, assorted Kombis similar to their own, and towards the middle the gigantic looming shapes of the Roadhaulers—the big, multi-jointed Nomad ground truck-trains that can carry tons of cargo containers as well as space for at least half a dozen families each. "We're lucky they let us in," comments Pneumo with a grin. Kepler shakes her head. "Not lucky, babe. It's thanks to Trace. The Aldecaldos are like, well, fucking Nomad royalty." She props her feet up against him—Pneumo is driving and she's taking the opportunity to rest her shoulders after her midnight helldrive. She adds: "You don't turn down the son of Old Man Aldecaldo if you still want a place in the Families." A clink interrupts her explanation: Damien is tinkering with some upgrade to the Kombi's engine he plans to install when they camp down for the evening. Over the rush of highway noise, she can also hear Lilayah's synth pinging as the Rocker tries to pin down the song she keeps working on.

***a blind man lost, in the streets
a pattern here, I need to see
keep returning keep trying to leave
got a bad feeling that I need to feel
black dog runs at my side...***

Running down the main storage bay of the Kombi, taking up the space that would normally hold Zara's bike, is the Crate. It's surprisingly heavy. It's also surprisingly

well protected. Samantha has warned them in no uncertain terms not to open the Crate. "Open it and you'll be signing your own death warrants," she says. "Even I can't open the thing. Just haul it out to New Mexico, to the address I've downloaded to your Agents, and it's done." She's also given them several thousand eb for expenses, but that's not the point. In Night City, if you promise someone you'll do something, you just do it.

In the back of the Kombi Zara sits, staring at her hands pensively. She finally reaches into her go-bag and pulls out a large wrapped package. It stinks of cosmoline, and as she unwraps it, she can see that the big gun has seen a lot of use, but it's been well taken care of all the same. As she was heading out of the garage, Samantha took her aside and pressed the package on her. "You should take this," the silver woman said. "He's not ever going to use it again, and I think you're the right person to carry it for him."

Like Samantha, the huge automatic is silver chromed. Zara lifts it, sights down the barrel. It seems very heavy. Heavy with some ineffable quality that's more than its weight.

She thinks she knows what it is, but she's afraid to find out.

GHOST STORIES

Evening in the desert.

While the rest of the group are gathering for food, Trace wanders over to the middle of the Nomad camp. He asks a few questions, then some more, until eventually, guided by the information he's gathered, he draws up to the fire next to a thin, long haired man roughly around forty. The Nomad raises a metal flask companionably at him. "You drink, young Aldecaldo?"

"You know me?" responds Trace, raising the flask and taking a swig. The Nomad nods. "I haven't seen you in a spell, but lessee ... you were about seventeen last time. I had a lot less grey in my hair then."

"You knew my old man, right?"

"Yes, I did."

"Mind if I ask you about something? The Nomad chuckles. "Fire away, young Aldecaldo."

"So, the Old Man told me a bit about the Arasaka thing. About the Bomb, the fight." Trace looks at the Nomad speculatively. "He said you were there." His companion nods, takes back the flask, and draws a swig. "Long time ago, that." Trace just looks at him, then to the fire, then back to the Nomad again.

"When you're young, choomba, you think you're immortal." The older Nomad reaches out, stirs the dying fire. Then he looks back at Trace. "So Old Man Santiago never told you what went down that day?"

"He told me some of it. But even he didn't know the end."

"Well, that's because he wasn't there. He'd moved on a bit from his days chasing around with Rogue and Johnny. Met your ma, settled down, ended up taking over the leadership of the Family. But me, I was there to the bitter end. Was a lot younger then, of course, about your age in fact. I was one of *El Lobos*—the Wolves—the warriors of the Aldecaldos. Wore a lot of leather and carried a long rifle; made a bit of a name for myself in fact.

"So ... lessee. We dropped out of the AV on the top floor. Shaitan covered the entry and Spider Murphy was hacking the cyberspace defenses. Johnny, I don't know why he was there. Maybe he was feeling bad about not having rescued his *compañera* after all those years.

Anyway, he was there, with his big silver arm and his big silver gun. And we went in, all the way down to where the Ara's had their Lab—where they were keepin' Silverhand's lady friend. Ten floors down into the building.

"Then they jumped us. They got the reporter guy in the first attack. We Lobos were pinned down; I lost my brother Antonio that day. Then that big *bastardo*, the Smasher, he came rolling in like *la tormenta*. Would have killed all of us, but then Silverhand stands up and yells something at him and starts shooting. He had to know it wasn't going to do any good—even that big silver gun wasn't going to stop the Smasher, but he tried and got torn up for his trouble. But it gave Shaitan a chance to get a grip on the Smasher and hold him while we grabbed the reporter and piled for the elevator to the top. We had to leave the Rocker behind; we just ran out of time.

"Here's what I still don't get. We were carrying a suitcase. They didn't tell me what it was, but it was pretty heavy. And during the fight, I looked around for that Morgan guy, the head *cabrón*, but he was nowhere in sight. He just took off with the suitcase and I think he headed down the stairwell. I didn't see him until we were lifting off in the extraction AV, when he and that *bastardo* Smasher went at each other.

"About a minute or two later, as we were pretty far away from the building, that Nuke went off."

Trace's eyes narrow. This is what he's been looking for.

THUNDER ON THE ROAD

Early in the morning. Dawn. On the road. Kepler stays to the middle of the convoy, toward the back. After several hours, dry

TRACE SANTIAGO

created w/ the help of
Trace Wilson



When your dad is the boss of an entire Nomad Nation, it can be hard to make your mark. Trace Santiago's doing that as a Media. He worked "legit" for a while but went solo after getting passed over for less "ethnic" reporters multiple times. Now he uploads his own reports directly to the Data Pool.

Trace Wilson is a children's author, bionics ambassador, and congenital amputee. Born without a right hand, Trace grew up with anxiety about being different. He published his first children's book at the age of 21, the same year he received his first bionic arm. The book, "Uniquely Me" and its sequel, "Uniquely Brave" help kids with disabilities learn to love the differences that make them unique and overcome their anxieties.

desert scrub hurtling by endlessly, they spot something, A dust cloud rising in the back, way back in the heat haze.

Trace pulls out his drone and deploys it. It streaks rearward, relaying its imagery back to the waiting Media. After a few minutes he grunts, "We got trouble coming. Bike gang."

But not the normal "road warrior" type bikers. These guys are anything but the typical gogang. It's nearly fifty *bosozoku* bikers—the dreaded Japanese bikers, heavily armed. These guys are elite. They have really good bikes armed with serious weapons: machine guns, grenade launchers, rockets.

They're also really good looking—Japanese idol singer good looking..

Lilayah is aghast. "We're gonna get killed by a fucking boy band?" she yells over to Zara.

Up to now, Zara hasn't jacked into the Gun. But this is a bad situation, no time to get warmed up on a new weapon. She pulls the link cable out of the butt of the big silver automatic, jacks it into her wrist. After a

moment, her eyes blur; the targeting reticule with all of its accessory heads up displays overlay her vision.

"I'd rather die." yells the Solo back as she aims, fires, aims again in a ceaseless rhythm.

Damien cuts in. "Was that guy wearing *makeup*?"

Zara shakes her head. "Not well."

Lilayah snorts. "If you wanna *call* it that."

The *bosozoku* unfurl tall black flags from their rear fenders and move in at high speed. Kepler guns it, putting the Kombi further into the middle of the convoy. Then the horde of bikes are on all of them. Engines howling, the pack of bikers flank the convoy. The convoy opens up: weapons from Kombis and Roadhaulers hammering, spewing shell casings all over the road behind them.

Nomad gyrocopters sweep down from the sky, sweeping the horde with light autofire. But the bikes are hard to hit. They weave in and out of the convoy, looking for something, probing, until they eventually spot the team's Kombi.



BY SEBASTIAN SZMYD

While Kepler weaves in and out of the tightly packed mob of vehicles, trying to shake their pursuers, Pneumo mans the top turret, sweeping heavy .50 cal machine gun fire downrange while struggling to avoid hitting any other members of the convoy. Meanwhile, Zara and Lilayah lean out of the armored Kombi windows and start tagging targets as they move into range. A biker tries to cut in front of Kepler, aiming to block her. Kepler revs the Kombi and rolls over him. Another biker runs up the open ramp of a nearby Roadhauler and goes airborne, leaping over the Kombi and trying to drop a grenade on Pneumo.

Without thinking, Zara snapshoots the grenade out of the air—the Gun's interface seems to boost her situational awareness to absurd levels. It almost seems to take her over, giving her a seemingly supernatural accuracy and a palpably cold eagerness. Later, Damien will determine that the Gun's cyber interface has been modified to create almost cyberpsycho levels of feedback, damping down the user's normal emotional reaction to combat situations, and giving them a robot-like control. But there's no time for that now. She keeps firing.

Two bikers swing out to the driver's side, opening fire on Kepler's rear quarter. Damien pops up from one of the gun ports and dumps a combination of napalm and fire onto the road. The Kombi on the other side swerves and sprays the leading biker with autofire; the bike skids and almost crashes into Kepler, who yanks the wheel to the right to avoid the bullet spray. She slams into the biker flanking them on the passenger side, who spins out into his partner. They outpace the explosion as the Roadhauler runs down both fallen bikes.

The big Roadhaulers start dropping spike mats, disrupting the tight phalanx of the bosozoku. Then, there's a sound of jet engines getting louder, louder. With an ear shattering sound of thunder, three

Nomad AV-4's drop in over the dry foothills, their red-eye directed mini guns hammering a high-pitched song of death. The big side doors roll back, revealing gimbal mounted .50 cal's that sweep doom from all sides. The bosozoku try to rally, but the sheer volume of fire breaks their ranks.

Protected by their hovering AV escorts, the convoy powers on towards the relative safety of distant Albuquerque.

HOT POTATO

The Convoy has pulled over in the tiny, deserted ghost town of Grants New Mexico. There used to be a Walmart in Grants—its doors have since been busted out and the entire building has been well looted. But the immense parking lot is still there, covered in drifting sand in some places, and the Convoy is using it to take time to lick its wounds and reload its weapons. Overhead, the AVs orbit, watching the road in either direction.

But down in the Kombi, there's a new fight in progress.

"Okay. What the hell is going on?" shouts Lilayah, sounding—well, pissed isn't half of it.

Zara rubs her head angrily. "Yah. What's so important that someone's willing to send a whole fucking army of mercenary bikers after us? Guys like that aren't cheap. That's Corporate level shit."

Pneumo shrugs. "Are you sure we were the target?"

Trace shakes his head. "I had the drone out, watching. The bikers swept the whole convoy, then zeroed in on us. There's no doubt we were who they were looking for."

"Look, no one was trying to kill us before we took this job. Well, no one who wasn't usually trying to kill us." Lilayah gestures at the Crate. "And they didn't attack us on the way in—only on the way out."

DAMIEN

created w/ the help of
Brian Marquez



Always fascinated with technology, when circumstances forced Damien to get a cyberarm at a young age, he wasn't upset. It was just one more toy to play with. Grown up now, he prefers work as a merc Tech instead of a Corp drone to earn the eb he needs to build what he sees in his mind's eye.

For as long as Brian Marquez can remember, he's been passionate about video games. Using that passion, he worked his way into a producer role in the industry and now fights to not only make games fun but playable by everyone. Having been born with one arm, he's always wanted to make sure he could play the games he loved and he's made a career out of making sure everyone else can, too.

ZARA

created w/ the help of
Angel Giuffria



Known for her discretion, Zara worked as a bodyguard for the criminal and wealthy and made good money doing it. When her identity got flashed onto the Data Pool by an enemy, she had to go underground to ensure she survived long enough to get revenge. Now, she's a hired gun for a group of Edgerunners.

An actress, model, and disability representation in the media advocate, Angel Giuffria was born missing her left arm below the elbow. The youngest person in the world to be fitted with a myoelectric prosthesis, Angel stays on the cutting edge of bionic technology because she believes it is important for users to be involved in the process. She can be seen in "Impulse" and "Chicago Med" and has a Masters Degree in Psychology.

"After we picked up the Crate," says Kepler.

"Yeah..." says Zara. "The Crate..."

Everyone stares at everyone else. No one wants to ask the next question. Finally, Trace looks over at Damien. "So ... you been snooping around like I suspect you've been?"

Damien looks a bit abashed. He spreads his hands. "Only external scans," he confesses.

"And...?" Trace prods.

"Umm. Yeah," says Damien. "Okay. It's using a lot of stored power. Pretty radioactive at one end. Won't kill us, but I'd say make sure your rad filters were working all the same."

"You want me to try and hack the protective systems?" offers Pneumo. Kepler shakes her head in the negative.

"I keep thinking about what the nice silver *señorita* said," says Trace. "The part about signing our own death warrants particularly stands out to my mind."

Zara grimaces. "Yeah, but someone's already tried to kill us twice to get this. That's what I call a pretty big hint." Pneumo laughs. Kepler folds her arms and glares at Pneumo. "I'm against this. There's a world of hurt in that crate, and I want nothing to do with opening it. We agreed to deliver it, and that's all we should do."

"On the other hand, if we're going to die," retorts Lilayah, "I'd really like to know what we're gonna be dying for."

"Hell. I already know what's in there," Trace asserts. The rest of the group stares at him expectantly. He shakes his head.

"It's Johnny Silverhand."

They stare at him as though he's just announced he's a space lizard from Planet X, and he raises a hand before the arguments start. "Look, it makes

sense. I ran a search on our *patron*. She used to be a pararescue before the war. Firefighter. First into the wreckage when the Nuke went off. Already had history with Silverhand when she saved him from a studio fire back in 2015. And she's a Silverhand fangirl. Maybe a Silverhand groupie even—I hear he got around a lot and wasn't particularly picky.

"So Silverhand vanished right after the Nuke. No one's seen him since. Word on The Street was Johnny was working a big job with some of his old mates—a hit on Arasaka. You put the clues together and it's obvious: silver fan-girly found Johnny's body and put it on ice. And now we're moving it."

"I've got past the ICE," announces Pneumo suddenly. He's not one to wait around for the committee to decide. He looks over at Damien. "Your turn," he says. The Tech hunkers down, working with his tools until there's a distinct click. Meanwhile, Kepler watches them both, furious.

Damien and Pneumo stand back, removing the blocky protective locks as they do so. Then they punch the access switch. There's a dull *chuff* as the seals on the crate release. Damien slides back the top as Zara stands ready to open fire with the big silver automatic. The rest of the group peers over the lip of the Crate.

Packed tightly into the protective foam padding is an eight-foot-long, four-foot-wide, hi-vis grey cylinder, shaped like a torpedo. It's covered in numbers, letters, and many, many words in Japanese. Angry words. Largest, in the center, is a huge, yellow and black radioactive warning trefoil.

Everyone stands silent for a long, long time. Finally Trace clears his throat.

"Well, I guess I'm fucked," he says.

THE BROKEN WHEEL

They all stare at the Crate and its deadly contents for a long while. Then: "I'm gonna have to tell the Trailmaster," says Kepler. "They'll need to know." She sounds flat, almost defeated.

"But why?" asks Lilayah, looking up from the ominous orange shape in the Crate. Confusion is all over her face.

"Because of the Law of the Broken Wheel," replies Kepler.

There are blank faces all around, save Trace's. He nods his head slowly. "The Law of the Broken Wheel," he repeats. "Back even before the Bad Old Days, the people who built the nukes wanted to make sure that even a thousand years later, their descendants would know not to mess with the stashes and stockpiles of atomic weapons—old reactors—nuclear waste.

So, they spread the idea of the "Broken Wheel": a simple iconography that even a post-holocaust culture could remember. The atomic trefoil—it's the Broken Wheel. Every Nomad kid learns about it. It's one of our most important bits of culture.

Nomads run into old atomics all the time—the Law of the Broken Wheel is that when you find something with that symbol, you get out of there fast. And you leave it alone."

"It is forbidden to travel on the Broken Wheel," intones Kepler solemnly, like a small child reciting a catechism. "Convoys, scavengers, even pirate Families avoid it like the plague. You're not allowed to keep anything marked by the Wheel, and no Family will carry it. It's an absolute taboo."

She stands up, spreads her hands, face determined. "You wanna come with me, Trace? Just in..."

He also stands. "I helped you lug it in. Guess I'll take the hit with you. Only fair, choomba."

They both rise and climb out of the Kombi, moving to the head of the mass of parked vehicles.

...

"Looks like Trace's connections weren't enough to keep us in the Convoy after all," mutters Pneumo.

"Shut up," grates Kepler. "I'm still royally pissed at you," she adds as she powers the Kombi down a dusty highway.

The Trailmaster kicked them out at Albuquerque. The rest of the Convoy is still headed east on US 40 to Oklahoma City, but their group is now traveling north of Santa Fe on a dusty, potholed road framed by dismal and lonely signs for Highway 84 North. It's a ghost road; probably no one's come up here since the start of the War. Shifting sands cover parts of it, punctuated by cracked, overheated asphalt.

They've covered a fair distance by the time they hear the sound of jet engines. Over the hill sweeps what Night City inhabitants call a *panzer*: a light fan tank with Chobham armor and a large 30mm cannon. It's way out of their league.

And now it's blocking the highway.

"Well," grunts Trace. "Guess it's time to saddle up or die."

"Hey, so yeah, they have a tank. Big deal," says Damien. "We've got a nuke."

"Not funny," snaps Lilayah, slamming a clip into her Minami 10.

"They won't shoot at us," asserts Pneumo. "The whole point is to get the Bomb. We're secondary."

Kepler looks back at him momentarily. "Maybe we should just surrender, Nu."

LILAYAH

created w/ the help of
Amelia Kotat



Like a lot of Rockerboys, Lilayah calls Seattle home. Or she did, before she moved to Night City. She sticks to her roots, though, and plays a style she likes to think of as cybergrunge. Lilayah also does jobs with her Edgerunner friends. After all, she won't change the world just by making music vids.

As Mike Pondsmith was working on this story, he realized he needed a Rockerboy to bring it together. That's why he asked Amelia Kotat, a friend whose posts influence hundreds of thousands of people daily, to help him make Lilayah. The grunge was entirely her idea. She's a big fan of it as well as of WoW. Amelia lives in Poland with her gorgeous cat.

But Trace shakes his head. "We're witnesses. They aren't going to want to leave anyone alive. Not if these guys are who I think they are."

"So we're screwed, blued, and tattooed," says Zara. She lifts the Gun, pulls out the interface cable and plugs in. "Might as well get ready for that Last Stand then..."

They're starting to take up positions when the panzer explodes.

Two attack AV-9s spiral out of the sun, mini-guns driving a hailstorm of death before them. The remnants of the panzer, victim of the lead AV-9's antitank missiles, is still a blazing inferno, its ammo cooking off as the second AV-9 settles down to earth in a swirl of jet engines and kicked up dust, right across their path.

The cockpit of the AV slides back. Flanked by an imposing pair of heavily armored guards, a small female figure climbs to the ground. She's dressed in black armor, but instead of a helmet she sports a cheerful pink beret. She waves to the dumbfounded group in the Kombi.

"Hi there!" she calls in a clear, girlish voice. "I'm Michiko! I'm here to rescue you!"

MY BROTHER'S KEEPER

"I owe you an explanation," Michiko begins as she sits down on the open Crate, treating its contents as though a multi-kiloton atomic weapon was everyday to her. "I've been following you for some time, but I first had to deal with a ... problem back in Night City that delayed me." There's a pregnant pause which seems to imply that someone, somewhere (or maybe even a large number of someones) are no longer among the ranks of the living.

"You're Michiko Arasaka, right?" avers Trace. His brow furrows, and Michiko smiles.

"I really haven't gone by that name since I married, but yes, I am Michiko Arasaka." She looks down at the orange cylinder she's sitting on and adds, "I suppose *technically* this bomb is mine, too."

She laughs a twinkly little laugh that from anyone else would seem like something out of an *anime*, but from her seems singularly appropriate. "You see," she

continues in a quiet, purposeful voice, "as soon as an atomic weapon was detonated in the Towers, my father sent people in to examine the ruins. When they found that the weapon was actually a Militech device, they were both relieved and concerned. Relieved because this meant Arasaka wasn't the cause of so much death and destruction. But concerned because what only a few people in the Company knew was that Arasaka had also planted its own weapon in the Towers—a much more powerful one—in the event that Militech was able to overrun the Headquarters and take possession of the secrets inside."

"My father's men were especially concerned because when they searched for our bomb—the Arasaka weapon—it was missing. They determined that only a very strong person, or a full body conversion, could have moved it. So they used radiation scanners to track the trail and eventually found that the device had been hidden in the basement of a nearby garage. Owned by a firefighter paramedic named Samantha Stevens.

"Unfortunately, my father ... passed away... He died before he could give the location team further instructions. So the decision was made to just leave the bomb where it was, but to keep a watch on the garage and the firefighter unless it was moved. And it stayed in the garage for fifteen years. Until now."

"So, you had your own bomb?" presses Trace. But before Michiko can respond, Pneumo leans over, waving his Agent in front of her. "And these are the trigger codes, aren't they?" he says, his cool British tones laden with amusement. Michiko's eyes scan the Agent screen, and widen. "These could very well be them," she confesses. "It is one of my father's command codes." She looks up, and the large brown eyes narrow. "How did you get these?" she asks, the girlish voice shifting to a sharp staccato of practiced command.

Pneumo's grin is triumphant. "I've been trying to track down what these went to for the past five years. I pulled them out of a system that was later tracked to a drifting yacht. As it happens, a yacht owned by your late father." He and Michiko exchange smiles like friendly sharks, interrupted only when Kepler cuts in with a dry: "And he's been a regular pain about it too." She smacks Pneumo on the head with one hand, but not too hard.

"And that's why they've been tailing us," says Zara flatly. "Arasaka wants to make sure their nuke never makes the headlines."

"No, they want to make sure who ever does have it doesn't set it off," counters Pneumo. "I'm sure I'm not the only one who has the det codes by now. I know there were others looking, much as I tried to cover my tracks. In my case, I really didn't know what the codes went to. I just wanted the answers. But you can bet the other hunters do know, especially if they also worked for Arasaka."

"—And someone wanted this thing to be taken off the market before the other guys could find it," Damien cuts in, and his expression turns grim. "Los Alamos was a famous nuclear facility. Back before the Collapse even. Stands to reason if there's any place you could get a nuke dismantled safely, it would be there."

"I have renounced the name of Arasaka," says Michiko, her small voice still hard and flat. "But I have *not* renounced the *responsibility* of that name. Far from it. And there are factions in the Company that would use this weapon for their own ends. Some would use it to discredit what little good will Arasaka has rebuilt after the War. Some would use it as a threat to make Arasaka more powerful—able to blackmail cities; even governments. It was because I had to deal with those people first that I was delayed from coming to your aid sooner. And for that, I am truly sorry."

Michiko stands up, her girlish demeanor instantly gone as though a switch has been flipped. "I am the heir of Kei Arasaka," she continues. "No matter *what* I feel about my legacy. So, I will act and help you take this demon's tool to a place where it can be properly disposed of." She looks up at the group around her. "Will you agree?"

Damien chuckles. "We can be on the side with the big ass gunships or we can go up *against* the big ass gunships. Sounds like an easy choice to me." He raises an eyebrow, cyberoptic glinting in the harsh light. "Anyone think different?" There are various nods of assent. The die is cast.

JUST CALL ME ANGEL IN THE MORNING

The rest of the trip is uneventful as the black AVs hover overhead protectively. About midday, they peel off to the North. Michiko radios a cheery "Good luck!" And then, they reach the front gates.

Los Alamos Labs is huge, covering an infinity of acreage. Most of it is falling apart. No one's been here in a decade as far as Kepler can tell as she threads through the maze of rusting security gates and warning signs.

Over her shoulder, Trace is reading Samantha's directions from his Agent, while Pneumo tries to pick up any kind of NET system still active in the endless ghost town.

"There," gestures Trace at last, pointing to the left. Kepler makes the turn and comes to a stop in an outside lot filled with assorted derelict ground cars.

"This is Building PF-4?" says Damien in disbelief. "This is the 'heart of America's nuclear deterrent'?" He snorts. The Plutonium lab is a nondescript, two-story brown building in a clutter of nondescript buildings. If it wasn't so huge, you wouldn't even notice it.

"Is it safe to get out?" asks Lilayah.

Damien shrugs. "We've all got enough anti-rad drugs in our system to pretty much stop anything short of a gamma burst. But the counter reads low background—that thing in the Crate is probably emitting more heat than what's outside."

Zara climbs out of the Kombi, the big silver gun drawn. Then she freezes. A half dozen security cams are watching them. There's a tinny hum as two roof-mounted autoguns track in line with the cams. Frack.

Then a woman's voice comes out of hidden speakers: "I'll bet Sammy gave you that." Zara nods slowly, holding it up. The voice continues, "Hang tight; I'll be right down."

A long, long minute passes before one of the heavy shielded roll-up doors finally opens and a blonde woman in a battered work clothes emerges. She waves, and walks over to them. "Hey, you're the guys Sammy sent? Welcome to the Lab. I'm Angel." She offers Zara a slim, well-callused hand. "Glad to see you made it."

The blonde woman is tall and almost ethereally beautiful, but in a way that seems to reflect a life of hardship and pain. A large tech's toolbelt hangs loosely around her waist. As the rest of the group climbs out of the Kombi, weapons at the ready, she grins and walks over. "Rough trip?"

Pneumo shrugs. "Been better. You our drop-off?"

Angel nods. "Mind if I check it out before delivery?" Kepler punches the ramp button and the back of the Kombi whines open to reveal the loading bay. Angel walks over to the Crate and looks into it. "Looks like a bomb to me," she says finally, then slaps her hands together in a business-like way. "Well, let's roll it inside," she adds briskly. "so I can get the thing disarmed."

Trace raises an eyebrow. "You're going to disarm it?"

Angel nods. "Can't think of a better place to disarm a lost atomic warhead than a place that makes them." She whistles one short tone, and from the depths of the huge building a large powered transport cart emerges. Damien nods to himself. *Of course they'd use robotics here, he thinks. Place is probably too*

dangerous for most non-shielded people. The cart rolls to a stop between them and Kepler maneuvers the Kombi's lift gate to slide the Crate onto it. It sags under the weight.

Angel gives a satisfied nod. "I'll have to thank Sammy for finding you. This thing has been on her mind since the day she found it. You've taken a real load off her shoulders." She turns back; raises a hand, exposing a thin blue plastic sliver—a cash chip. "You did a great job, and I want to thank you too." Angel hands the chip over to Kepler, whose eyes widen as she reads the amount on its display. "Sonova—"

"You earned it," says Angel. "Go buy yourselves another Kombi or something." She whistles at the cart, and it starts trundling back to the roll up door with the Crate aboard. Then she stops. "That's right," she says suddenly. "Sam told me you met because your Rocker was looking for something?"

"Samantha gave me this data chip," says Lilayah. Angel nods. She pulls out a second chip—this one is a match for the one in Lilayah's hand—and flips it to the startled Rocker. "Here," she says. "This is a full recording of the song you wanted. Made from the original studio session."



BY PEDRAM MOHAMMADI

Lilayah, protesting, says, "But how did you...?" And as Angel reaches the door she looks back and chuckles. Then says with a lilt in her voice: "Sammy isn't the only Johnny Silverhand fangirl out there, you know." And then she and the Crate are gone into the bowels of the huge brown building of PF-4.

There's a pause. Finally, Trace says, "So, now that we're filthy rich, wanna see if we can buy a drink somewhere?"

"Frack that," replies Zara. "Remember that place we passed outside of San Pueblo?" She drops the big silver gun into the holster at her back and smiles. "I think we should go back there and buy the whole fracking bar."

...

"I'm dying," says Samantha over the comlink. "All the dose I took when I moved the bomb has finally hit my spinal cord. Cancer."

"You shouldn't have done it, Sammy," says Angel. "Or waited till I could have sent help." But Samantha shakes her head. "We didn't know who or what owned the thing. And the rad detectors were going off all over the place from the last one. If I hadn't been full-body—if I hadn't been a rad-shielded firefighter—I would have been dead within the hour. As it was, I had enough time to clear all the important stuff out of that wrecked bunker. And to get rid of the hot stuff at the bottom of the Bay."

"And I thank you for doing that," Angel replies. Then adds, sadly, "Are you sure I can't do anything to help?"

Samantha shakes her head. "I promised I would get him to you in the end. Took me a while to find the right people—people I could trust—but they did the job. Now my bit is over." She sighs, breathes heavily as if blowing hair—hair that hasn't been there in three decades—out of the way. "Gonna go get me a glass of good rye whiskey, sit back on the couch, and when I feel it's about time, I'll hit the kill switch and shut down my life support."

Carefully, Angel rolls the heavy bomb casing over. She punches a code into the small keypad now exposed.

There's a hissing of compressed air, of utter cold that blows back her hair, as the casing splits to reveal the blue-white ice of the hidden cryo-chamber.

She looks tenderly down at the dark, frozen face behind its masking curtain of ice.

"Hello, my love." she says.

► Black Dog ◀

*a blind man lost, in the streets
a pattern here, I need to see
keep returning keep trying to leave
got a bad feeling that I need to feel
black dog runs at my side
down a road, no end in sight
the city sleeps but in my mind
got a knot that won't unwind
tonight is the night that we run
the hunter becomes what he hunts
the escape and the chase become one
run run*

*tonight is the night that we run
the hunter becomes what he hunts
the escape and the chase become one
run run*

*in concrete canyons squinting neon eyes
black dog beside me, like shadow needing light
stalk the backstreets, never at ease
locked in a chase that'll never cease
a bloody moon, portending doom
another cruel day is coming soon
have to end this but it's just begun
a final charge, with the rising sun
black dog in my head
guiding me to the end
black dog in my head
guiding me to the end
black dog in my head
guiding me to the end
black dog in my head*

*in concrete canyons squinting neon eyes
black dog beside me, like shadow needing light
stalk the backstreets, never at ease
locked in a chase that'll never cease
a bloody moon, portending doom
another cruel day, coming soon
have to end this but it's just begun
a final charge, with the rising sun
tonight is the night that we run
the hunter becomes what he hunts
the escape and the chase become one
run run
tonight is the night that we run
the hunter becomes what he hunts
the escape and the chase become one
run run*

HANDLE			
ROLE			
ROLE ABILITY	RANK		
NOTES			

HUMANITY	
OUT OF	

INT
REF
DEX
TECH
COOL
WILL
LUCK
MOVE
BODY
EMP

Awareness Skills	LVL	STAT	BASE
Concentration (WILL)			
Conceal/Reveal Object (INT)			
Lip Reading (INT)			
Perception (INT)			
Tracking (INT)			
Body Skills	LVL	STAT	BASE
Athletics (DEX)			
Contortionist (DEX)			
Dance (DEX)			
Endurance (WILL)			
Resist Torture/Drugs (WILL)			
Stealth (DEX)			
Control Skills	LVL	STAT	BASE
Drive Land Vehicle (REF)			
Pilot Air Vehicle (x2) (REF)			
Pilot Sea Vehicle (REF)			
Riding (REF)			
Education Skills	LVL	STAT	BASE
Accounting (INT)			
Animal Handling (INT)			
Bureaucracy (INT)			
Business (INT)			
Composition (INT)			
Criminology (INT)			
Cryptography (INT)			
Deduction (INT)			
Education (INT)			
Gamble (INT)			

Education Skills	LVL	STAT	BASE
Language (INT)			
→ Streetslang			
→			
→			
Library Search (INT)			
Local Expert (INT)			
→ Your Home			
→			
→			
Science (INT)			
→			
→			
Tactics (INT)			
Wilderness Survival (INT)			
Fighting Skill	LVL	STAT	BASE
Brawling (DEX)			
Evasion (DEX)			
Martial Arts (x2) (DEX)			
Melee Weapon (DEX)			
Performance Skills	LVL	STAT	BASE
Acting (COOL)			
Play Instrument (TECH)			
→			
→			
Ranged Weapon Skills	LVL	STAT	BASE
Archery (REF)			
Autofire (x2) (REF)			
Handgun (REF)			

Ranged Weapon Skills	LVL	STAT	BASE
Heavy Weapons (x2) (REF)			
Shoulder Arms (REF)			
Social Skills	LVL	STAT	BASE
Bribery (COOL)			
Conversation (EMP)			
Human Perception (EMP)			
Interrogation (COOL)			
Persuasion (COOL)			
Personal Grooming (COOL)			
Streetwise (COOL)			
Trading (COOL)			
Wardrobe & Style (COOL)			
Technique Skills	LVL	STAT	BASE
Air Vehicle Tech (TECH)			
Basic Tech (TECH)			
Cybertech (TECH)			
Demolitions (x2) (TECH)			
Electronics/Security Tech (x2) (TECH)			
First Aid (TECH)			
Forgery (TECH)			
Land Vehicle Tech (TECH)			
Paint/Draw/Sculpt (TECH)			
Paramedic (x2) (TECH)			
Photography/Film (TECH)			
Pick Lock (TECH)			
Pick Pocket (TECH)			
Sea Vehicle Tech (TECH)			
Weaponstech (TECH)			

OUT OF	HIT POINTS
SERIOUSLY WOUNDED	CRITICAL INJURIES
-2 TO ALL ACTIONS WHEN SERIOUSLY WOUNDED	ADDICTIONS
DEATH SAVE	

WEAPONS AND ARMOR

ARMOR	SP	PENALTY
Head		
Body		
Shield		

PENALTY APPLIES TO REF, DEX & MOVE

WEAPON	DMG	AMMO	ROF	NOTES

ALIASES

IMPROVEMENT
POINTS

OUT OF

REPUTATION
EVENTS

REPUTATION

LIFEPATH

CULTURAL ORIGINS

PERSONALITY

CLOTHING STYLE

HAIRSTYLE

WHAT DO YOU
VALUE MOST?

FEELINGS ABOUT
PEOPLE?

MOST VALUED
PERSON

MOST VALUED
POSSESSION

FAMILY
BACKGROUND

CHILDHOOD
ENVIRONMENT

FAMILY CRISIS

LIFE GOALS

FRIENDS

TRAGIC LOVE AFFAIRS

→
→
→

→
→
→

ENEMIES

Who?

What Caused It?

What Can They Throw at You?

What's Gonna Happen?

→
→
→

GEAR

NOTES

Ammunition

Cash

FASHION

HOUSING

RENT

LIFESTYLE

ROLE SPECIFIC LIFEPATH

CYBERWARE

Cyberaudio Suite		Data

Right Cybereye		Data

Left Cybereye		Data

Right Cyberarm		Data

Left Cyberarm		Data

[illegible][illegible][illegible][illegible]

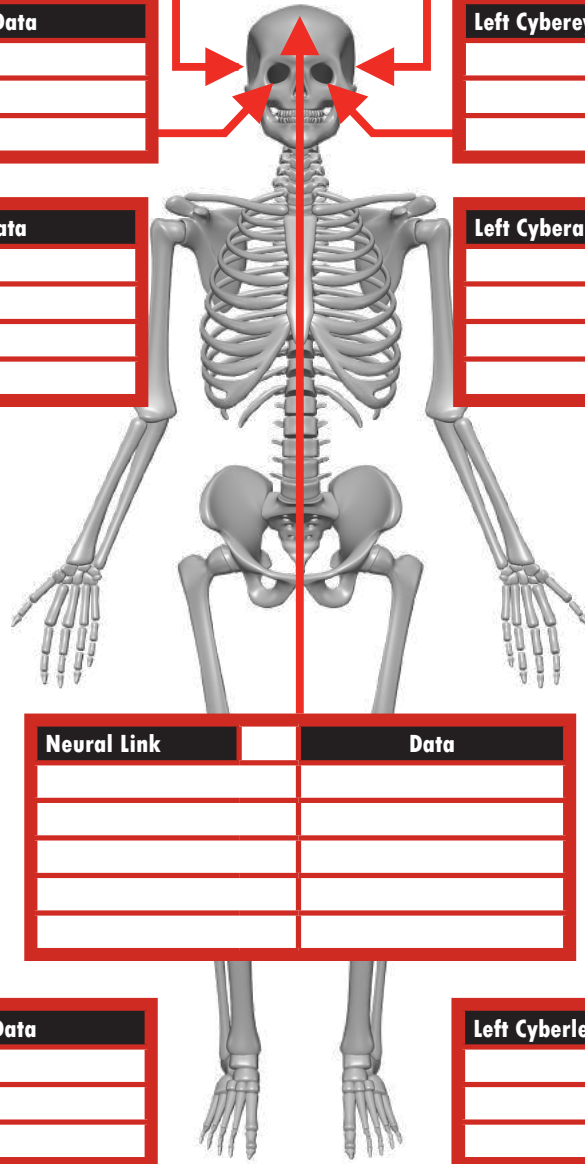
Neural Link		Data

Right Cyberleg		Data

Left Cyberleg		Data

For cyberware with a foundational requirement (i.e. a Cybereye) check the box to indicate you have it. Options go in the slots below.

For cyberware without a foundational requirement (i.e. Internal Cyberware) just note each piece in the slots below the category name.



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